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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL REGULAR MEETING

July 28, 2026

WEBVTT

1
00:00:08.330 --> 00:00:17.659
Boardroom: Okay, hello everyone, if you can hear me clap once! If you can hear me clap twice!

2
00:00:17.850 --> 00:00:19.870
Boardroom: If you can hear me clap 3 times!

3
00:00:21.050 --> 00:00:42.040
Boardroom: Okay, good! Thank you so much, everyone! I'm going to call to order the Berkeley City Council meeting. Today is Tuesday, July 28th, 2026. It is 6.03 PM. Can we start off with the roll, please, Clerk? Okay. Councilmember Kesarwani is currently… currently absent. Taplin. Present.

4
00:00:42.040 --> 00:00:47.330
Boardroom: Bartlett is currently absent. Tregeb? Hasn. O'Keefe? I'm here.

5
00:00:47.330 --> 00:00:48.230
Boardroom: Blackaby.

6
00:00:48.230 --> 00:00:48.910
Brent Blackaby: Here.

7
00:00:49.330 --> 00:01:14.329
Boardroom: Unapara? Here. Humber? Present. And Mayor Ishii? Here. Okay, quorum is present. Okay, alright. I know there are a lot of folks in here, and if it's your first time in a while, or it's your first time to a meeting, this is a reminder that if you have a conversation, please take it outside so that we can hear everything that's going on. There will be no booing and hissing. I understand there are a lot of strong feelings.

8
00:01:14.330 --> 00:01:32.169
Boardroom: And, we have a lot of young folks that are going to be here this evening, and so I really want us to set a good example for them. So

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I ask folks to be respectful, as they're giving their comments, and keep in mind, there are many things on the agenda this evening, so we have much to get through before we even get to our action items.

9
00:01:32.170 --> 00:01:44.210
Boardroom: So, I will… we have no ceremonial matters this evening, so I will pass it over to our city manager to see if he has any comments. I don't have any comments tonight. Thank you, Madam Mayor. Okay, very good.

10
00:01:44.320 --> 00:01:46.560
Boardroom: And is Mr. Albert here?

11
00:01:47.270 --> 00:01:52.449
Boardroom: Do you want to come up, Mr. Alpert? So…

12
00:01:53.860 --> 00:02:08.569
Boardroom: Before we go to public comment on non-agenda matters, I'm inviting Dr. Albert to the podium to redo his public comment from May 19th. Mr. City Clerk, if you could please put 2 minutes on the clock, or I guess Denise, if you wouldn't mind putting 2 minutes on the clock, please. Thank you.

13
00:02:09.669 --> 00:02:19.860
Boardroom: I am Dr. Steven Alpert. Berkeley residents have reason to be disappointed by the actions of this committee, its commissions, and council.

14
00:02:20.260 --> 00:02:26.539
Boardroom: Sorry. Shh, folks, please, there's a lot of whispering. Customers have demonstrated pro-developer bias.

15
00:02:26.560 --> 00:02:40.050
Boardroom: Local residents and business owners were not consulted about the plans to upsell North Shattuck, Solano, or College Avenues. In fact, the Council met first with developers. On February 24, this council overturned Berkeley's labor standards.

16
00:02:40.050 --> 00:02:56.460
Boardroom: passed in 2023, which required developers of large projects to provide contractors with fair pay, health insurance, and funds for apprenticeship training. During a Planning Commission meeting last fall, over 40 attendees expressed concerns that the proposed upzoning building heights were excessive.

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17
00:02:56.570 --> 00:03:10.100
Boardroom: Every commission member then stated increased heights were not a problem. Foremost, this Council supports the false narrative that building market-rate housing will readily produce affordable units. Real-world data contradict this.

18
00:03:10.320 --> 00:03:26.770
Boardroom: A recent study by Buchholz demonstrated that even under over overly optimistic conditions, in our area, it takes over 20 years for newly built market-rate housing to filter down and become affordable, whereas with historical data, it takes over 100 years.

19
00:03:26.920 --> 00:03:35.189
Boardroom: Evidently, these findings were troublesome to Councilmember Humber Humbert, who tried to discredit Buchholz as shown in this composite screenshot from his website.

20
00:03:35.360 --> 00:03:38.899
Boardroom: Please note the highlighted last sentence with two underlined links.

21
00:03:39.120 --> 00:03:47.820
Boardroom: As written, it clearly implies that Buchholz has received serious and swift methodological criticism from other economists, but neither link addresses the study.

22
00:03:47.820 --> 00:03:59.550
Boardroom: Council members also assert that building market rate apartments will invariably drive rents down. Housing data from nearby Energy will refute this, and the YMBY supply-side etiology they champion.

23
00:03:59.570 --> 00:04:06.510
Boardroom: As reported in Emeryville-Tatler, Emeryville went the MB Way. Now it has the most expensive rent in the East Bay.

24
00:04:06.590 --> 00:04:20.259
Boardroom: Building more was supposed to bring cheaper rent. What happened? Our Council's failure to build market rate housing may produce a similar outcome without addressing housing affordability. Thank you. Thank you.

25
00:04:20.560 --> 00:04:40.780

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Boardroom: Okay, so we will now take public comment on non-agenda matters. There are multiple seats up in the front, and if you have a seat next to you, if you could make sure to wave your hand so folks can see, there are folks, I just want to make sure everyone has a seat who wants one, especially if you are holding a small child and need a seat, there's some seats up front.

26
00:04:40.780 --> 00:04:41.990
Boardroom: Okay.

27
00:04:41.990 --> 00:04:58.289
Boardroom: Alright, so, if you have public comment on non-agenda matters, we have the list right here of folks. Okay, so we will have, 5 in-person speakers for items not on the agenda, and then we will go to the first 5 hands raised.

28
00:04:58.290 --> 00:05:12.929
Boardroom: on the Zoom, each speaker will have one minute each. I'll pick the names for the five in-person speakers, and you can come up in any order. And again, these are… this is just for public comments for items that are not

29
00:05:12.940 --> 00:05:22.290
Boardroom: on tonight's agenda. So if your card was picked, but you are speaking on an item on the agenda, just let us know and I'll pick a new card.

30
00:05:23.640 --> 00:05:35.370
Boardroom: Okay, the five non-agenda speakers for in-person are… Kara Hauser, Juliet Leftwich, Dennis Fanton?

31
00:05:35.600 --> 00:05:39.929
Boardroom: Maria Soule, and Derek Abbasi.

32
00:05:40.680 --> 00:05:43.380
Boardroom: You can come forward in any order.

33
00:05:45.640 --> 00:05:46.570
Boardroom: Hi!

34
00:05:46.840 --> 00:05:58.499

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Boardroom: Good evening. My name is Juliette Leftwich. I'm a long-term Berkeley resident and an attorney. I served on the Berkeley Police Accountability Board and Police Review Commission for 7 years.

35
00:05:58.860 --> 00:06:14.640
Boardroom: I'm speaking out tonight to express my strong objection to the incredibly aggressive new parking meter rules that were adopted by Council in June. Under those rules, meters will operate until 8 o'clock, and all day on Sundays.

36
00:06:14.640 --> 00:06:22.769
Boardroom: Fines will increase from $43 to $64, and new meters will be installed throughout the city, including on Hopkins Street.

37
00:06:23.030 --> 00:06:38.209
Boardroom: These rules were adopted hastily, without public input or input from small businesses, many of which are already struggling to survive. There was also no consideration of the impact on churches throughout our city.

38
00:06:38.310 --> 00:06:51.749
Boardroom: Oakland and San Francisco adopted similarly egregious parking meter rules and reversed course in response to public outcry. Our hope is that you will… Thank you. …be equally responsive to your constituents. Thank you.

39
00:06:55.050 --> 00:06:57.340
Boardroom: Okay, anyone else whose name was called?

40
00:06:59.110 --> 00:07:00.060
Boardroom: Thank you.

41
00:07:00.540 --> 00:07:17.300
Boardroom: Hi, John Kaner, Downtown Berkeley Association, I am so pleased to introduce… What, Kara Hauser… We're together, he's with me, Cara Huzzyk. Cara Hooser. Kara starts on Monday, we're gonna have 2 months of overlap, I retire September 30th. Kara.

42
00:07:17.520 --> 00:07:26.290
Boardroom: Hello, just want to say hello, and I'm delighted to, be here and join working with the city. I'm very happy to meet each of you who I haven't met yet, and, thank you!

43

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00:07:26.500 --> 00:07:28.890
Boardroom: Thank you so much, welcome!

44
00:07:29.260 --> 00:07:34.759
Boardroom: And… John, we will follow up with you later to thank you for your service.

45
00:07:39.080 --> 00:08:03.309
Boardroom: Good evening, my name is Derek Abbasi, and I'm part of a neighborhood coalition alerting this council that the developer at 1130 Oxford Street is abusing state housing laws to escape public discretionary review. Streamlined by-right approvals are meant for small-scale, missing middle projects that follow the letter and spirit of the law. Instead, this developer is using aggressive, bad faith tactics to claim the city is powerless. But these laws have strict criteria.

46
00:08:03.310 --> 00:08:14.309
Boardroom: To bypass SB 1123's hard 10-unit cap and build 32 luxury homes, the developer is illegally piecemealing a lot into 8 separate parcels. Furthermore.

47
00:08:14.490 --> 00:08:39.399
Boardroom: Sb 1123 applies exclusively to vacant lots unless existing buildings are abandoned and uninhabitable. Legally, the buildings are neither. It also sits directly within the known landslide and high fire hazard zone and the hillside overlay, and it won't even address the housing crisis as intended, as the result will be $2 billion homes with zero affordable housing. The city still retains oversight. Do not treat this as a done deal.

48
00:08:39.400 --> 00:08:41.309
Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you.

49
00:08:51.910 --> 00:08:55.270
Boardroom: Right here.

50
00:08:56.200 --> 00:08:59.330
Boardroom: Okay, alright.

51
00:09:04.190 --> 00:09:06.919
Boardroom: You can begin your time whenever you're ready.

52
00:09:07.130 --> 00:09:08.630

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Boardroom: Okay, thank you.

53
00:09:08.880 --> 00:09:09.719
Boardroom: You will, huh?

54
00:09:11.430 --> 00:09:14.850
Boardroom: My name is Dennis Fanton.

55
00:09:15.080 --> 00:09:21.500
Boardroom: I'm… Talking about the project that is being proposed for 1130 Oxford Street.

56
00:09:22.400 --> 00:09:26.310
Boardroom: And I have, really, one major point.

57
00:09:26.950 --> 00:09:33.300
Boardroom: At the May 28th meeting, the developer… of this 32…

58
00:09:33.820 --> 00:09:36.820
Boardroom: Home project on a steep hillside.

59
00:09:37.210 --> 00:09:43.859
Boardroom: on Oxford Street said, That these 32 homes were level in

60
00:09:44.570 --> 00:09:55.110
Boardroom: and ADA accessible, and all that good stuff. That was the exact comment. What I want to say is that

61
00:09:55.790 --> 00:09:58.349
Boardroom: These homes are, in fact, level in.

62
00:10:00.160 --> 00:10:06.030
Boardroom: But if you're in a wheelchair, you can't get into the Living space of the home.

63
00:10:06.920 --> 00:10:10.580
Boardroom: I assume this is by… design…

64
00:10:11.140 --> 00:10:14.430
Boardroom: Not necessarily to preclude people in wheelchairs.

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65
00:10:14.710 --> 00:10:16.020
Boardroom: Thank you.

66
00:10:16.480 --> 00:10:21.639
Boardroom: That's… is that my time? Yes, that's your time. Thank you very much for your comment.

67
00:10:24.780 --> 00:10:28.430
Boardroom: The fifth card was for Maria Soule.

68
00:10:30.170 --> 00:10:31.340
Boardroom: Oh, here she comes, okay.

69
00:10:36.700 --> 00:10:39.490
Boardroom: So are you slapping here? No, that's okay.

70
00:10:42.960 --> 00:10:45.480
Boardroom: It's a good thing I can almost run.

71
00:10:45.820 --> 00:10:51.500
Boardroom: I just want to mention that… I'm really…

72
00:10:51.640 --> 00:10:55.669
Boardroom: I'm happy that you all are going to get to take a little break.

73
00:10:55.880 --> 00:11:02.250
Boardroom: I'm gonna miss you, but I'm very glad you might get to rest and play.

74
00:11:02.810 --> 00:11:11.139
Boardroom: And do what serves you. But I want to also remind you, most sincerely, that most of us won't get to.

75
00:11:12.090 --> 00:11:14.080
Boardroom: Which is why we're all here.

76
00:11:15.100 --> 00:11:19.310

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Boardroom: Because all sorts of things matter to each and every one of us.

77
00:11:19.650 --> 00:11:26.150
Boardroom: And again, I am trying to emphasize that if we stop and breathe.

78
00:11:27.680 --> 00:11:34.469
Boardroom: And remember, it's not just me, it's we. We gotta figure out a way to get along.

79
00:11:35.090 --> 00:11:40.779
Boardroom: Because we can't help some people and hurt others. We can do better.

80
00:11:41.300 --> 00:11:46.780
Boardroom: So, I hope, again, you have a fine time.

81
00:11:47.120 --> 00:11:48.840
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks, Maria.

82
00:11:53.070 --> 00:12:03.739
Boardroom: Okay, and we'll go to the five, first five hands raised, on Zoom. Again, this is for non-agenda public comments. First is, Sharon.

83
00:12:07.060 --> 00:12:11.429
Sharon Friedman: I think if I'm on Agenda Item 27, is this my time to speak, or is it later?

84
00:12:11.780 --> 00:12:17.330
Boardroom: It's later, actually. We are, only addressing things that are not on the agenda at this time.

85
00:12:17.330 --> 00:12:18.539
Sharon Friedman: I'll wait till then, thank you.

86
00:12:18.890 --> 00:12:24.359
Boardroom: Thank you. Next is… this is call-in user.

87
00:12:26.660 --> 00:12:29.900
Boardroom: Should be able to unmute for non-agenda public comments.

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88
00:12:30.770 --> 00:12:31.669
Call-In User_1: I love it.

89
00:12:32.000 --> 00:12:33.380
Call-In User_1: Can you hear me.

90
00:12:33.630 --> 00:12:34.380
Boardroom: Yes.

91
00:12:35.880 --> 00:12:53.849
Call-In User_1: My name is Gordon Olveson, and I live in Modoc County. I hate homeless people. They are vermin. They are destroying our communities, and destroying our small businesses. I have to go out of business because of homeless people. They're all vermin, and they're all niggers trannies.

92
00:12:53.850 --> 00:12:54.370
TELEPHONE_USER: garage.

93
00:12:56.150 --> 00:13:09.189
Boardroom: Yeah. Okay. Next… Apologies, everyone. When comments are going, there are only certain times where we're able to cut them off, and so I apologize for that person's speech.

94
00:13:09.530 --> 00:13:15.379
Boardroom: Next is, makai Freeman, so 2 minutes.

95
00:13:22.180 --> 00:13:24.750
Boardroom: Makai, we put extra time on the clock for you.

96
00:13:25.540 --> 00:13:27.470
Boardroom: You can speak when you're ready.

97
00:13:32.610 --> 00:13:35.099
Boardroom: Oh, here she is. Go ahead, Makai.

98
00:13:41.460 --> 00:13:42.920
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Yes, can you hear me?

99

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00:13:43.320 --> 00:13:44.740
Boardroom: Yes, go ahead.

100
00:13:44.740 --> 00:13:46.510
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: That's a confusing thing.

101
00:13:47.270 --> 00:13:51.400
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Council members, and… Me ECM call.

102
00:13:52.870 --> 00:13:59.100
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: But listen, I was 10 years, and… Just knowing.

103
00:14:00.920 --> 00:14:02.679
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Right in the parking lot.

104
00:14:04.290 --> 00:14:05.829
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And here, folks.

105
00:14:07.240 --> 00:14:09.030
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Many disabled people.

106
00:14:09.890 --> 00:14:13.799
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: and seniors are act… But it's respected.

107
00:14:15.570 --> 00:14:17.219
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I'm so excited.

108
00:14:17.950 --> 00:14:19.680
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Reduction Services.

109
00:14:21.810 --> 00:14:28.240
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: We're not… This afternoon, it's not… Consulted beforehand.

110
00:14:29.640 --> 00:14:36.760
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: There's a num… no… I don't know… Mr. Hagen.

111
00:14:38.280 --> 00:14:39.870
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Suggesting fraud.

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112
00:14:40.800 --> 00:14:42.150
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: In the program.

113
00:14:43.720 --> 00:14:48.000
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Yeah, yeah, we're like… Examples of fraud.

114
00:14:48.680 --> 00:14:55.050
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And how the ducks… In terms of what… The ride.

115
00:14:56.450 --> 00:14:58.270
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Many seniors cannot.

116
00:14:59.000 --> 00:15:00.860
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: After it's not full.

117
00:15:01.670 --> 00:15:03.350
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Or the wrist interface.

118
00:15:04.220 --> 00:15:06.359
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: They are without transportation.

119
00:15:06.860 --> 00:15:08.520
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: That is needed for them.

120
00:15:09.930 --> 00:15:11.839
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: attend doctoral appointments.

121
00:15:12.660 --> 00:15:13.969
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Can you use it?

122
00:15:15.130 --> 00:15:16.190
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: and worship.

123
00:15:18.250 --> 00:15:19.780
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Nothing of data.

124
00:15:21.070 --> 00:15:22.070

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Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Auda?

125
00:15:24.080 --> 00:15:25.900
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Every astronomy.

126
00:15:27.150 --> 00:15:28.180
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: New York?

127
00:15:29.100 --> 00:15:33.270
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And seeing that… Let's talk about reduction.

128
00:15:34.200 --> 00:15:35.750
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: in this program.

129
00:15:36.870 --> 00:15:38.170
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Thank you very much.

130
00:15:38.420 --> 00:15:40.329
Boardroom: Thank you, Mackay.

131
00:15:40.920 --> 00:15:43.540
Boardroom: Okay, let's see…

132
00:15:46.620 --> 00:15:49.620
Boardroom: Next is Michael Pierce.

133
00:15:57.690 --> 00:16:03.680
Michael Pierce: Hi, I would like to cede my time to, on item 27 to…

134
00:16:03.680 --> 00:16:04.090
Boardroom: Oh.

135
00:16:04.090 --> 00:16:04.850
Michael Pierce: Aaron Friedman.

136
00:16:05.700 --> 00:16:20.499
Boardroom: I'm sorry, you can't… you have to wait until the speaker is here to see the time, at the time the comments on that item are being held. So you can stay on for that.

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137
00:16:20.690 --> 00:16:21.720
Boardroom: Thank you.

138
00:16:23.830 --> 00:16:27.210
Boardroom: Next is… David?

139
00:16:32.230 --> 00:16:47.000
David!'s iPhone: Hello! I just wanted to, well, I had a non-agenda comment. I was gonna, talk about how great, the new Bay Wheels expansion is, and how, helpful it's been to me, but…

140
00:16:47.160 --> 00:16:57.449
David!'s iPhone: Unfortunately, I wasn't able to get into the meeting right now. You may notice it is at capacity, folks are being turned away at the door, and…

141
00:16:57.450 --> 00:17:07.469
David!'s iPhone: it's just a, you know, a continuation of, I think, a really consistent problem that we have around public comment and around public feedback, where

142
00:17:07.470 --> 00:17:21.060
David!'s iPhone: you know, people who have… you know, I just got off work, and we just picked up the kids, and if I could have been here an hour ago, I would have been here an hour ago. And so I really hope that, you know, over time.

143
00:17:21.099 --> 00:17:26.010
David!'s iPhone: We're able to find ways of including people who

144
00:17:26.170 --> 00:17:31.450
David!'s iPhone: who have more obligations on their time, because our voices matter too. Thank you.

145
00:17:32.270 --> 00:17:36.769
Boardroom: Thank you, and I'm sorry that you and others were not able to get inside the meeting.

146
00:17:37.650 --> 00:17:55.090
Boardroom: So, as people exit the meeting, though, additional people are allowed in, and of course, people can participate, through audio-visual platform, Zoom, so, after…

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147
00:17:55.420 --> 00:18:02.310
Boardroom: Public comments, and perhaps after the consent calendar, there may be some additional, capacity in the boardroom.

148
00:18:02.910 --> 00:18:17.060
Boardroom: Yes, thank you, Mr. City Clerk. I think that's correct, that as folks are making their comments, they might also step out, so there's more room for others. Were you gonna say something? Yeah, may I ask a question? The commenter referenced, I think he referenced the

149
00:18:17.060 --> 00:18:24.420
Boardroom: Zoom meeting being at capacity, is that possible, or is there… That's not. Okay, there's unlimited capacity on Zoom? Well, there's…

150
00:18:24.830 --> 00:18:37.450
Boardroom: I think up to 1,000 people. Okay, we don't have that many. I mean, he was on the Zoom. Right. But he… okay, I just wanted to check that. Yeah, I think it's a room… a physical room capacity issue. Thank you, though, for checking.

151
00:18:37.960 --> 00:18:42.180
Boardroom: So that is… There's no more hands.

152
00:18:42.350 --> 00:18:49.780
Boardroom: One, hand raised… nope. There's no more hands raised online, we could take two more cards.

153
00:18:58.180 --> 00:19:00.749
Boardroom: We have Alec and Jackie.

154
00:19:11.920 --> 00:19:17.880
Boardroom: Oh, it's for an item on the agenda? Okay.

155
00:19:23.190 --> 00:19:24.630
Boardroom: Excuse me.

156
00:19:28.810 --> 00:19:42.879
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council. Thank you so much for offering this opportunity for public comment. I would like to comment on the proposal for corridor upzoning. In opposition to that plan, on the grounds of something that one of our previous speakers said.

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157
00:19:43.000 --> 00:19:46.020
Boardroom: We can't help some people and hurt others.

158
00:19:46.440 --> 00:19:52.129
Boardroom: I agree that the NIMBY-IMBY divide has come to define this discussion.

159
00:19:52.520 --> 00:19:55.590
Boardroom: I don't think that's a productive way to look for a solution.

160
00:19:56.000 --> 00:20:04.730
Boardroom: I have a different proposal that I think should appeal to all of you, because it helps all of you and your constituents in every district

161
00:20:05.420 --> 00:20:10.639
Boardroom: I call it EB, I-E-B-Y. Improve everyone's Backyard.

162
00:20:11.400 --> 00:20:12.210
Boardroom: Help

163
00:20:12.370 --> 00:20:28.780
Boardroom: all of the neighborhoods in the city become similar to these three places that we agree make Berkeley wonderful. Wouldn't each of you like to have a Solano or an Elmwood or a Shattuck in your district? We can do better, you can make it happen. Thank you.

164
00:20:29.570 --> 00:20:31.030
Boardroom: Thank you.

165
00:20:33.620 --> 00:20:39.779
Boardroom: And we just have one… we do have a hand raised on the Zoom, so this will be our final speaker.

166
00:20:41.700 --> 00:20:42.940
Boardroom: Andy?

167
00:20:43.150 --> 00:20:46.810
Andy Johnson: Thank you. I'm curious, on the Zoom presentation.

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168
00:20:46.970 --> 00:20:53.879
Andy Johnson: Is it possible for Brent Blackaby's video feed to be minimized until he is speaking?

169
00:20:54.110 --> 00:20:55.640
Andy Johnson: Thank you very much.

170
00:20:58.390 --> 00:21:01.130
Brent Blackaby: I'd be happy to minimize my video. Thank you.

171
00:21:04.500 --> 00:21:19.600
Boardroom: Thank you. I think that was our final of agenda public comment, so, alright, we will, we will move on to our consent calendar, but first, there is…

172
00:21:19.600 --> 00:21:43.519
Boardroom: an urgent item that we need to vote on. I will pass it over to Councilmember Lunapara to, introduce it. Thank you. This is an item showing our support and solidarity with, the workers at the Graduate Hotel in District 7, which they will be voting to unionize with Unite Here Local 2 this Friday, so it's a resolution in support.

173
00:21:44.660 --> 00:21:45.730
Boardroom: Second.

174
00:21:47.450 --> 00:21:59.630
Boardroom: I guess I'll… yeah, make a motion to accept this into the record. Thank you. And a second from Councilmember Atreka. As part of the consent calendar. Yes, thank you. Any comments or questions before we vote?

175
00:22:00.120 --> 00:22:15.490
Boardroom: Okay, go ahead, Mr. City Clerk. To accept the, the urgent item, to, on the, to the consent calendar, Councilmember Kastarwani? Yes. Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

176
00:22:15.490 --> 00:22:16.110
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

177
00:22:16.380 --> 00:22:29.010

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Boardroom: Napara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, motion carries. Okay, very good. Councilmember Treykov, did you want to also make some comments as well before we start?

178
00:22:29.280 --> 00:22:40.700
Boardroom: Yes, thank you. I would like to see if we can move item 28, which is a referral to the City Manager to update

179
00:22:40.700 --> 00:22:50.869
Boardroom: definitions in the CGMU district, and review restrictions related to the establishment of adult-oriented businesses in the Berkeley Municipal Code.

180
00:22:50.870 --> 00:22:55.269
Boardroom: To consent for the purpose of sending it

181
00:22:55.500 --> 00:23:01.399
Boardroom: back to the Land Use, Housing, and Economic Development Committee.

182
00:23:04.410 --> 00:23:10.289
Boardroom: Thank you, so, Mr. City Clerk, could you just speak to…

183
00:23:10.930 --> 00:23:24.529
Boardroom: Yeah, so if there's no objection, that item can be moved to consent. Thank you. For the purposes of moving it to Land Use Committee? Yes, that would be the action that would be recorded.

184
00:23:30.850 --> 00:23:34.309
Boardroom: No, so there are no objections? Okay. Alright.

185
00:23:34.440 --> 00:23:37.459
Boardroom: Then it will be… then it will be so. Thank you.

186
00:23:37.620 --> 00:23:40.520
Boardroom: Alright, anything else?

187
00:23:41.160 --> 00:23:42.120
Boardroom: That's unbelievable

188
00:23:42.320 --> 00:23:56.570

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Boardroom: I have comments on the consent calendar. I guess this would be the time. Great, thank you. Sorry, and folks, because we know we're going to have quite a long agenda, if I could ask that our folks keep their comments to a minimum, that would be great. Thank you.

189
00:23:57.990 --> 00:24:00.320
Boardroom: Yeah, thank you.

190
00:24:00.790 --> 00:24:15.340
Boardroom: I… first of all, I would like to appreciate my colleagues' collaboration on the urgency item that we just moved to consent, the resolution supporting the rights of workers at the Graduate, hotel.

191
00:24:15.340 --> 00:24:26.670
Boardroom: As well as, to the mayor for item 21, which is the rescission of the greenhouse gas endangerment finding and motor vehicle greenhouse gas emission standards under the Clean

192
00:24:26.670 --> 00:24:42.529
Boardroom: AIRACT to allow us to join, amicus Brief, in opposition to that rescission. And also, wanted to appreciate, Councilmember,

193
00:24:43.030 --> 00:25:02.909
Boardroom: Bartlett's authorship of item 22, relinquishment of Council Office Budget Funds, to support the Citywide Berkeley School Supply Distribution and Resource Fair, and excited to sponsor, all three of those items.

194
00:25:03.390 --> 00:25:18.800
Boardroom: I would like to ask that we withdraw item 23, from the consent calendar and from this agenda. Item 23 is the relinquishment of Council Office Budget Funds.

195
00:25:18.940 --> 00:25:28.109
Boardroom: To the Downtown Berkeley Association in support of the Social Service Outreach Coordination Position until further notice.

196
00:25:30.310 --> 00:25:39.139
Boardroom: Thank you to Councilmember Humber Humbert for sponsoring item 25. I would like to donate $150 for my discretionary funds.

197
00:25:40.380 --> 00:25:50.460

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Boardroom: And last but not least, I would like to express my sincere appreciation to my co-authors, to city staff.

198
00:25:50.470 --> 00:25:59.070
Boardroom: And to the many stakeholders who helped shape item 24, which is, our Renaissance item, revitalizing

199
00:25:59.070 --> 00:26:11.059
Boardroom: Enterprise and Neighborhood Through Activation, Investment, Safety, Streamlining, Accessibility, Networking, Collaboration, and Equity. Part 1, Performance Standards for Commercial District Activation and Blight Mitigation.

200
00:26:11.060 --> 00:26:16.760
Boardroom: This is the first of, several items we, intend to bring to the Council.

201
00:26:16.760 --> 00:26:26.309
Boardroom: To help continue to make our downtown and all commercial spaces, both those specifically named in the referral and, any that were not.

202
00:26:26.310 --> 00:26:43.690
Boardroom: even more vibrant and attractive for residents and visitors. I can't wait to receive our staff's recommendations, back to the Council for final adoption, and thanks again to everyone who so generously devoted their time and knowledge to this item.

203
00:26:45.380 --> 00:26:53.300
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Moving on to Councilmember Humbert. Thank you, Madam Mayor. I'll try to be brief here. Item 23,

204
00:26:53.320 --> 00:27:07.629
Boardroom: No, that's dropped. I'm talking about item 22, the relinquishment of Council Office Budget Funds, to support the citywide Berkeley School Supply Distribution and Resource Fair. I'd like to donate $150.

205
00:27:07.630 --> 00:27:16.750
Boardroom: Thank you, I think it's Councilmember Bartlett, for authoring that. And then, I… brief comments about item 25.

206
00:27:16.830 --> 00:27:25.570

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Boardroom: which is the Russell Street Halloween Festivities 2026 through 2029, relinquishment of Council Office Budget Funds.

207
00:27:25.570 --> 00:27:37.039
Boardroom: to general fund and the grant of such funds. And I authored that. I know we have a long meeting ahead of us, so I will be… thank you, Eric Panzer, brief.

208
00:27:37.130 --> 00:27:44.299
Boardroom: I just wanted to thank the Claremont Elmwood Neighborhood Association and all the neighbors who volunteer for this

209
00:27:44.300 --> 00:28:04.059
Boardroom: fangtastic event each year, and make it possible. I will always go to bat for neighborhood events like this that are the lifeblood of our community. And I'm pleased to be able to do this monster-sized funding item so that neighbors can keep working their magic for at least another 4 years. Thank you.

210
00:28:04.600 --> 00:28:12.030
Boardroom: Thank you for that very punny, those very punny comments. I'm gonna go online to Councilmember Blackaby, please.

211
00:28:12.450 --> 00:28:31.750
Brent Blackaby: Thank you, Madam Mayor. I'll also be brief. I wanted to thank Councilmember Lunapara for bringing the urgent item on the Graduate Hotel Labor support, and for allowing me to join as a co-sponsor. I was also proud to join with Councilmember Lunapara and Councilmember Tregeb on Friday, to walk the picket line with workers supporting their fight to form a union.

212
00:28:31.750 --> 00:28:34.790
Brent Blackaby: As we all know, Berkeley's a proud Union town.

213
00:28:34.790 --> 00:28:41.680
Brent Blackaby: And we strongly stand with workers and fight for their right to self-organize. So thank you, Councilmember Lunapar, for bringing the item.

214
00:28:41.680 --> 00:28:54.289
Brent Blackaby: On item 3, I just wanted to thank Councilmember Taplin for, making his nomination of Anay Sharma to join the Police Accountability Board. With this nomination, we have a full Police Accountability Board with an alternate

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215
00:28:54.290 --> 00:29:02.570
Brent Blackaby: That may be the first time in history that we've actually had a full complement plus alternate, so I just wanted to thank everyone, the mayor, and all colleagues for

216
00:29:02.570 --> 00:29:20.039
Brent Blackaby: Getting the board, back on full footing. On the couple council relinquishment items, item 22, thanks to Councilman Bartlett for bringing this. Our office would like to, relinquish $200 towards the citywide Berkeley School Supply Distribution and Resource Fair.

217
00:29:20.390 --> 00:29:31.620
Brent Blackaby: And on item 25, I don't have as many puns as Councilmember Humbert, I don't have any, but we'd like to contribute $250 towards that, and with that, I'm done. Thank you.

218
00:29:32.610 --> 00:29:36.679
Boardroom: Mayor, just a brief announcement. There's a,

219
00:29:37.060 --> 00:29:47.309
Boardroom: green Toyota Celica convertible that's parked outside here, and it's, leaking quite a bit of oil into the,

220
00:29:48.360 --> 00:30:04.649
Boardroom: curb, off the curb area, so an engine company is coming to investigate that, so if that's your car, please check in with the fire department staff at the front gate, and just for everybody else, don't be alarmed, that's what the…

221
00:30:04.650 --> 00:30:19.899
Boardroom: fire engine is here to look at. Thank you. Green Toyota Selca convertible. Thank you. Park right outside here. So, if that is your car, please, please move it, or address it. Thank you. Alright, moving on to Councilmember Luna Para.

222
00:30:21.760 --> 00:30:28.189
Boardroom: Thank you. I want to thank the Mayor for leading item 21.

223
00:30:28.480 --> 00:30:36.790
Boardroom: And on the discretionary items, item 22 and item 25, I'd like to donate $200 from my discretionary fund to each.

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224
00:30:37.580 --> 00:30:41.489
Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you very much. Moving on to Councilmember Kisserwani.

225
00:30:42.950 --> 00:31:03.240
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. I wanted to, recognize item number 13. This is awarding funds pursuant to the item that I authored to the Berkeley Food Network to address the issue of food insecurity. I see Andrew Christman is here, as are some board members, so I'm really pleased that we can make that funding award.

226
00:31:03.240 --> 00:31:09.969
Boardroom: I also want to thank Councilmember Lunapada for the item related to the workers at the Graduate Hotel.

227
00:31:09.970 --> 00:31:29.530
Boardroom: And, finally, I want to be recorded as donating $100 to the Berkeley School Supply and Distribution Resource Fair, item number 22, as well as $100 for the, Russell Street Halloween Festivities, item number 25. Thank you very much. Thank you very much, Councilmember Taplin?

228
00:31:29.670 --> 00:31:39.620
Boardroom: Thank you, and good evening. I'd like to thank Councilmember Lapata for the urgency item, and on items 22 and 25, I would like to be recorded as relinquishing $200 to each. Thank you.

229
00:31:40.160 --> 00:31:50.189
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Bartlett? Thank you, Madam Mayor. I'd like to, thank everyone for helping through the supply bank. It's a really crucial, crucial service they provide for schools.

230
00:31:50.190 --> 00:32:10.139
Boardroom: And item 13, I want to congratulate the Berkeley Food Network and thank Councilmember Kessarwani for your work, and City Manager for putting forward this, much-needed food support. As we said before, we're becoming more and more food-stressed, so look out for food and help people eat. The Renaissance, good work, Councilmember… are you Vice Mayor? No?

231
00:32:10.140 --> 00:32:34.789
Boardroom: Congratulations, Councilmember Trigo, Renaissance, good work. This addresses blight in the community, basically. Stores and buildings that are unbuilt. We've had to go through exorbitant lengths to get people to build on fellow properties where rats will come and people come

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do bad things. It's just a good system that you've designed here, to help jumpstart the process. Thank you for that.

232
00:32:34.880 --> 00:32:52.199
Boardroom: I'd like to give $200 for the Russell Street Halloween party. It's coming up, I guess, kind of soon, huh? Okay, kind of, right? It's like July, okay. And Councilor Lunopara, thank you so much for your resolution and support of the workers.

233
00:32:52.200 --> 00:32:55.110
Boardroom: At the Graduate Hotel, a good group of people over there. Thank you.

234
00:32:55.480 --> 00:32:58.430
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Vice Mayor O'Keefe.

235
00:32:58.890 --> 00:33:16.069
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor. I would like to start by thanking Councilmember Lunapar for bringing the urgent item. I'm really happy, for a chance to, support my… well, I was gonna say my union brothers and sisters, but I guess my potential union brothers and sisters, in their fight, so thank you very much. It's really, it's a great item.

236
00:33:16.110 --> 00:33:25.179
Boardroom: I'd like to also thank Councilmember Traum for his work on Renaissance, and for inviting me to co-sponsor it. I'm very happy to be part of that work, and I just want to say, you know, that…

237
00:33:25.320 --> 00:33:42.770
Boardroom: downtown has a lot of issues, and I just want to really honor your work, in representing the downtown. I think you're really taking that seriously and taking it head on and doing an excellent job, so I'm really happy to support you. And thank you for the acronym. Oh, yes, I helped him with the ridiculous acronym. But I helped beyond that, too.

238
00:33:42.770 --> 00:33:59.280
Boardroom: So anyway, thank you for that. And then regarding the, relinquishment of funds items, I will donate $200 to item 22, and $200 spooky dollars. Did I do it right? To item 25. That's it.

239
00:33:59.620 --> 00:34:24.500
Boardroom: Okay, thanks everyone. I also want to thank Councilmember Linopara for bringing the urgency item forward, and very proud to support the workers, in their union organizing campaign, and I wish them luck on

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Friday when they have the vote. Thank you so much. We have a number of different, grants that have come in, so I really want to thank city staff for all of their hard work to bring funding into our city. Many folks don't know this, but our city staff do a lot to leverage funding,

240
00:34:24.500 --> 00:34:42.160
Boardroom: and access other grants for us. I'd like to add Councilmember Blackaby to item number 21, which is the rescission of the greenhouse gas endangerment finding in motor vehicle greenhouse gas emission standards under the Clean Air Act. Basically, the EPA is saying that

241
00:34:43.570 --> 00:35:02.469
Boardroom: that motor vehicles do not cause greenhouse gases, which we know is not correct, and, we are signing on to the amicus brief, and really proud to be doing that, and thank you so much to our city attorney's Office for assisting us, by writing this item. I'm excited to see item 24 moving forward, thank you very much for your leadership.

242
00:35:02.470 --> 00:35:12.970
Boardroom: Councilmember Trey Gubb, and for item 25, I will also give $100 for my discretionary account for the Russell Street Halloween Fair. So, thank you very much, Councilmember Humbert, for that.

243
00:35:12.970 --> 00:35:21.529
Boardroom: And with that, I will see if there is any public comment on consent calendar and information items only.

244
00:35:29.050 --> 00:35:31.050
Boardroom: John is making his way up.

245
00:35:35.650 --> 00:35:45.240
Boardroom: John Kainer, Downtown Berkeley Association. I want to also thank, Councilmember Tregeb for his leadership on this, renaissance item.

246
00:35:45.240 --> 00:35:56.109
Boardroom: I think we can all agree that the empty pit on Harold Way and the boarded-up, Center Street across from BAMPFA is not an ideal situation.

247
00:35:56.300 --> 00:36:08.399
Boardroom: We have 17 stalled housing projects. Actually, I think one's going forward. We're hoping that Course Basis is gonna move forward on the Center Street, project, soon.

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248
00:36:08.430 --> 00:36:31.459
Boardroom: And, and as staff and council approach this, it's obviously making sure we don't have unintended consequences, that we're dealing with real issues, and also fixing them. So, for example, as we know, the Center Street project, it takes about 9 months to get PG&E to decommission power. So, Spaces was going to move ahead in decommissioning.

249
00:36:31.460 --> 00:36:33.490
Boardroom: Then the market turned, etc.

250
00:36:33.490 --> 00:36:37.720
Boardroom: And then we had this vacant storefront. So we want to be able to shore up, make sure.

251
00:36:37.720 --> 00:36:48.120
Boardroom: Thank you. They will bring back in pop-ups. Thanks, John. And one quick… John, no, no, no, John, I'm sorry. We've got a lot of comments tonight. Thank you. Thank you so much. Okay. Come on up, Andrew.

252
00:36:48.170 --> 00:36:49.319
Boardroom: And Pam?

253
00:36:53.980 --> 00:37:16.409
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor, Council, City Manager. I'm Andrew Crispin, the Executive Director of Berkeley Food Network, and I'm joined tonight by Pam Gray, the Board Chair of Berkeley Food Network. As many of us know, affordability is a crisis facing so many community members, especially here in Berkeley, but we are so excited to be awarded this contract, to be working with the City to address food insecurity for our housing insecure community members.

254
00:37:16.610 --> 00:37:24.629
Boardroom: We're really grateful on behalf of the community, thank you, and we're looking forward to continued partnership with the city. Thank you. Thank you, and thank you all so much for your work.

255
00:37:27.180 --> 00:37:27.900
Boardroom: Okay.

256
00:37:30.990 --> 00:37:32.490
Boardroom: Sorry, come on up.

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257
00:37:33.860 --> 00:37:35.380
Boardroom: I'll be translating for her.

258
00:37:35.960 --> 00:37:39.969
Boardroom: Buenas tardes, mi nombres Rosalva Rodriguez.

259
00:37:40.090 --> 00:37:46.430
Boardroom: Trabajo en el hotel graduado Sanos y medio, y estamos luchando por la union.

260
00:37:46.800 --> 00:37:59.700
Boardroom: Porque es todos los dias acceso de trabajo, yo tengo pruebas. Todos los dias 10 de cuartos, 25 cuartos, 20 un cuartos, muchos checados, estamos cansados, tamos soluchando.

261
00:38:00.140 --> 00:38:05.000
Boardroom: Para que entre la union en estamos de su ayuda y diso apoyo. Muchas gracias.

262
00:38:05.960 --> 00:38:07.040
Boardroom: Thank you.

263
00:38:07.310 --> 00:38:21.980
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Rosava Rodriguez. I've been working for 2 years at the Graduate Hotel. Me and my coworkers are organizing the union because of the excessive work that happens at that hotel. I've had to clean 18 to 22 rooms. I hear… I have proof right here.

264
00:38:21.980 --> 00:38:27.919
Boardroom: We're tired of this, and we're getting together because we deserve the union. Thank you for your support.

265
00:38:28.400 --> 00:38:29.680
Boardroom: Thank you.

266
00:38:39.750 --> 00:38:58.680
Boardroom: mucho trabajo lo que estamos haciendo. Y venemos aqui para la union para todos mis companeros, que hay un mejor futuro y un buen me nestra para todos. Gracias.

267
00:38:59.670 --> 00:39:00.649

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Boardroom: Thank you.

268
00:39:00.800 --> 00:39:17.470
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Maricela Castro. I've been working at the Graduate Hotel for the past 20 years. I'm also joining the union because there's an excessive load of work at the hotel. Me and my coworkers, we deserve better, and that is why we're forming the union, and we would love your support. Thank you.

269
00:39:18.800 --> 00:39:19.939
Boardroom: Thank you.

270
00:39:25.810 --> 00:39:45.339
Boardroom: Angelica salinas, voy para 202an valer nuestros valores, y fuerzo que hacemos por el limpiesa en ese hotel. Gracias.

271
00:39:46.360 --> 00:39:47.360
Boardroom: Thank you.

272
00:39:47.480 --> 00:40:03.549
Boardroom: Hi there, my name is Angelica Salinas Chicas. I am here because I am asking for your support in our fight for our union. We deserve better, respect, and also, we're deserving, better treatment in the hotel, and that is why I'm here standing with my coworkers.

273
00:40:04.010 --> 00:40:05.270
Boardroom: Thank you.

274
00:40:20.610 --> 00:40:29.820
Boardroom: Muy buenas tares a todos. Muy buenas tares a todos. Pues el a primera vez que estoy aqui,

275
00:40:30.010 --> 00:40:33.190
Boardroom: Estoy orgullozo por mi trabajo.

276
00:40:33.620 --> 00:40:39.349
Boardroom: Me gusto se trabajo, y pes, tengo sais meses en este hotel.

277
00:40:39.520 --> 00:40:48.099
Boardroom: in… Trabajando ahi, me gusto mucho, la que pasa me dan mucho, trabajo y me salgo muy cansado.

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278
00:40:48.140 --> 00:41:06.809
Boardroom: A veces me dan este 22 o 16, 15, y pues contanta eso, a veces no veces no medan tiempo del launchar, y un poquito tiempo de descanzar, y pues…

279
00:41:07.300 --> 00:41:18.330
Boardroom: Me gusto se trabajo lo que pasa el que esta en el cargado sobre eso, me puso una este un papel yo no sabia, y tuve que vermar.

280
00:41:18.330 --> 00:41:32.559
Boardroom: Y medio oportunidad de algo que pero no estanto, de algo que no hice. Y entonces meiva despedir, pero le dije por favor, que me de… este oportunidad porque yo quiero ese trabajo.

281
00:41:32.560 --> 00:41:49.439
Boardroom: Gracias a Dios, yo luchep por ese trabajo, gracias a Dios que encontre estoy muy felice en ese trabajo. No mas que yo veo el quierente no tiene poquito de paciencia y la que esta incarregado sobre eso, pero espero que mis companeros.

282
00:41:49.440 --> 00:41:54.180
Boardroom: problemas. Yo apricos.

283
00:41:57.810 --> 00:42:05.720
Boardroom: desa oja el gerente, me puso, muy desa esperada, muy propado, porque la verdano…

284
00:42:05.830 --> 00:42:11.780
Boardroom: No quiero que me despiden, porque esto muy orgoyoso de pesar ahi.

285
00:42:11.990 --> 00:42:23.410
Boardroom: esas mi parlabres, pero que si le dije bien porque no se… creo que esto. Muchisima gracias. Thank you.

286
00:42:23.990 --> 00:42:32.780
Boardroom: Well, I'll give you some time to maybe summarize, if you can, since technically you're over time. I'm not sure what's happening with the sound, I'm sorry about that.

287
00:42:34.810 --> 00:42:42.210

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Boardroom: Alright, my name is Florentina Salas. I've been working at the Graduate Hotel for the past 6 months. Reason why I'm fighting, it's because

288
00:42:42.210 --> 00:42:54.999
Boardroom: At work, it's very excessive work. I was recently given a warning for, not completing some work because I was not able to finish within the amount of time.

289
00:42:55.000 --> 00:43:09.139
Boardroom: I felt that that was really disrespectful, and that is one of the reasons why I'm fighting for the union. I really enjoy working there, and I want to continue working there, but, it is really… the things that need to change in the hotel is the workload.

290
00:43:10.280 --> 00:43:12.530
Boardroom: Thank you.

291
00:43:18.780 --> 00:43:22.869
Boardroom: Anyone else have public comment on consent calendar information items only?

292
00:43:24.500 --> 00:43:26.380
Boardroom: Muchas gracias.

293
00:43:26.900 --> 00:43:28.600
Boardroom: Muchas gracias porrini.

294
00:43:30.450 --> 00:43:37.879
Boardroom: Okay. Okay, so now go to… speakers on… Oh, one more consent? Okay.

295
00:43:44.810 --> 00:43:54.390
Boardroom: I know we have so much to do, but this is the general consent calendar now. What does relinquish mean when you were…

296
00:43:54.520 --> 00:44:06.389
Boardroom: We're happy to talk about that later, we don't usually do the back and forth, so if you have questions, you can ask them later. Alright, well, I just want you to remind us that there's earthquakes everywhere, fires everywhere, and…

297

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00:44:06.820 --> 00:44:21.710
Boardroom: We need to consider safety and response times. I'm really in support of the, child resources and the police accountability, and Berkeley Food Network. Oh my god, please!

298
00:44:22.120 --> 00:44:38.649
Boardroom: People are hungry! Alright, and anything to do with youth services, dogs, and playgrounds. So, yeah, and then I don't understand what's going on with the social service outreach Coordinator, and I understand that this isn't a response, but I'm really wanting

299
00:44:38.650 --> 00:44:49.929
Boardroom: us to choose wisely what we invest in. Thank you. Thanks, Maria. And relinquishment just means we're giving it from our different, accounts.

300
00:44:50.070 --> 00:44:50.960
Boardroom: So…

301
00:44:51.300 --> 00:45:06.670
Boardroom: All right. Okay, so now we'll go to public comments on the consent calendar for those with their hands raised on Zoom, and the first is a caller with a phone number ending in 211.

302
00:45:11.950 --> 00:45:13.349
1510****211: Hi, this is Eid.

303
00:45:13.500 --> 00:45:19.809
1510****211: So I have a very important comment about consent item 3. Police Accountability Board.

304
00:45:20.020 --> 00:45:23.740
1510****211: Berkeley always, through the ages, has one of the best police departments in the whole country.

305
00:45:23.990 --> 00:45:25.960
1510****211: Second, I'd like to bring a memory of a grip.

306
00:45:26.080 --> 00:45:27.000
1510****211: beef, please.

307
00:45:27.210 --> 00:45:31.840

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1510****211: Of Berkeley, that have, Josh Butler.

308
00:45:32.420 --> 00:45:37.069
1510****211: Here, we had a theft in our San Francisco store of embezzlement, actually, over a million dollars.

309
00:45:37.390 --> 00:45:44.160
1510****211: He was great, because I was written from the criminals from jail, and he appointed two policemen in front of our house in Euclid.

310
00:45:44.470 --> 00:45:49.079
1510****211: We paid $6,000 a month, which went to the city of Berkeley, not to the policeman.

311
00:45:49.330 --> 00:45:51.599
1510****211: The Bruce Minh, and

312
00:45:51.720 --> 00:45:53.370
1510****211: We really have to look forward.

313
00:45:53.510 --> 00:46:02.989
1510****211: Two things. The other thing I'd like to mandate, please, everybody, walk in downtown Berkeley, see how many stores are closed. We are sending all of the businesses to Oakland and Emeryville.

314
00:46:03.410 --> 00:46:04.579
1510****211: Let's work together.

315
00:46:04.760 --> 00:46:09.980
1510****211: And please give me a call, 510-848-5000.

316
00:46:10.110 --> 00:46:13.630
1510****211: 52 years old, phone number. Thank you. I will call again.

317
00:46:14.270 --> 00:46:15.280
Boardroom: Thank you.

318
00:46:16.430 --> 00:46:17.600
Boardroom: Okay.

319

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00:46:21.720 --> 00:46:24.959
Boardroom: Next is… Benito?

320
00:46:29.670 --> 00:46:31.260
Benito Delgado-Olson: Yeah, hi, good evening, can you hear me?

321
00:46:32.140 --> 00:46:32.900
Boardroom: Yes.

322
00:46:33.460 --> 00:46:35.040
Benito Delgado-Olson: Okay, very good. Well…

323
00:46:35.120 --> 00:46:47.529
Benito Delgado-Olson: Hi, good evening. My name is Benito Delgado-Olson, I'm the ED of SupplyBank.org. Really just calling in to say thank you to, all of the Council members who contributed to the 16th Annual

324
00:46:47.570 --> 00:46:58.549
Benito Delgado-Olson: Resource fair and school supply distribution scheduled for August 8th at, San Pablo Park. For 16 years, what began as a pilot at the former South Berkeley YMCA,

325
00:46:58.550 --> 00:47:13.009
Benito Delgado-Olson: now serves about 1,300 BUSD students annually, and we really appreciate, Councilmember Bartlett, as well as, the Mayor and Councilmember Traaguub, and all the Council members who have contributed and helped us,

326
00:47:13.010 --> 00:47:30.280
Benito Delgado-Olson: seek funds to keep this important event going for the Berkeley community. I'm also happy to share, that before all of your contributions this evening, we're at about $28,000, and our goal is $30,000, so I'm very confident that this, program and event will move forward. So just thank you all so much again.

327
00:47:30.730 --> 00:47:32.619
Boardroom: Thank you so much.

328
00:47:35.210 --> 00:47:49.639
Boardroom: Okay, next is, former Councilmember Cheryl Davila. Oop, wait a second. It jumped around. Hold on. Wait, alright, let's go, hold on a second, James, we will…

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329
00:47:49.870 --> 00:47:52.810
Boardroom: Mtu next.

330
00:47:53.330 --> 00:47:58.540
Boardroom: Former council member… Cheryl Davila.

331
00:48:01.960 --> 00:48:09.030
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Yeah, so there's a lot of things on the consent calendar. I guess…

332
00:48:09.460 --> 00:48:22.930
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: the Food Network is a good thing, and honestly, I don't even know what's on the consent calendar, because I really didn't look at it, but, I'm hoping y'all do the right thing, and it's just…

333
00:48:23.300 --> 00:48:40.419
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Today, I was listening to my friend talk about her trip back from Palestine, and things are just so egregious over there, and you all are just sitting there, not doing anything about all the things that you could be doing for this world and this country by…

334
00:48:40.430 --> 00:48:48.720
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Passing, resolution in support of Getting rid of apartheid, and…

335
00:48:48.900 --> 00:49:00.600
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Palestine, and freeing Palestine, and… but you're into surveillance and control and domination, but I'm praying that you all change, and…

336
00:49:01.260 --> 00:49:04.759
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Things change for everyone in the city of Berkeley.

337
00:49:04.760 --> 00:49:05.979
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks, Cheryl.

338
00:49:07.290 --> 00:49:10.670
Boardroom: Next is James White.

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339
00:49:14.960 --> 00:49:17.679
Boardroom: Oh, James?

340
00:49:18.660 --> 00:49:20.960
Boardroom: I don't do this?

341
00:49:21.400 --> 00:49:22.960
Boardroom: Okay.

342
00:49:25.660 --> 00:49:29.799
Boardroom: James, raise your… Hand if you… there you are.

343
00:49:31.170 --> 00:49:33.560
Boardroom: Okay. Go ahead, James.

344
00:49:34.890 --> 00:49:41.810
james white: I'd like to say kudos to Cheryl for calling in on that important topic, and kudos to your board for allowing her.

345
00:49:41.810 --> 00:49:42.165
Boardroom: P.

346
00:49:42.520 --> 00:49:52.489
james white: This is Judy Stroyer, City Council Death Squad. We've been challenging boards like yours for years as genocide's been continuing, and you continue to silence people, so in this case, I,

347
00:49:52.650 --> 00:49:53.580
james white: I'm happy that you're.

348
00:49:53.580 --> 00:49:58.369
Boardroom: This is a public comment on consent calendar and information items only, so…

349
00:49:58.370 --> 00:50:13.389
james white: Alright, well, I'd like to speak about the women, trying to do the union, and I'd like to give a thought that maybe if we could imagine a situation where, a group of white European men went to, Honduras or Guatemala.

350

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00:50:13.390 --> 00:50:22.679
james white: or anywhere. I have a free speech here, so please do not jump down my throat with your liberal viewpoint, intolerance. But imagine some white guys going to,

351
00:50:22.680 --> 00:50:35.889
james white: Guatemala, and, going to a city council speaking English, and one after another, just, like, telling people that work is so hard, and, you know, something… we need more of this, and, like, treat us like this. Come on, man. Seriously, there's a lot of people in this country starving.

352
00:50:36.730 --> 00:50:42.309
Boardroom: Okay, and next is Todd Andrew.

353
00:50:42.560 --> 00:50:51.119
Boardroom: I just want to say I strongly disagree with the comments, and we welcome anyone who comes to speak in any language, and we'll give them time for translations, so…

354
00:50:56.410 --> 00:50:57.100
Boardroom: Exciting.

355
00:50:57.660 --> 00:51:02.220
Todd Andrew: those kinds of people would stay out of here. I did not raise my hand for, comment right now.

356
00:51:02.330 --> 00:51:14.039
Boardroom: Sorry about that. Alright, I think that's our final comment on the consent calendar, so I will come back to see if we, can approve the consent calendar. Is there a motion to approve? So moved. Second.

357
00:51:14.180 --> 00:51:15.920
Boardroom: Can we take the roll on that, please?

358
00:51:17.340 --> 00:51:21.680
Boardroom: I move.

359
00:51:22.770 --> 00:51:23.630
Boardroom: No, no.

360
00:51:25.920 --> 00:51:29.689

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Boardroom: To approve the consent calendar.

361
00:51:30.430 --> 00:51:32.750
Boardroom: Councilmember Kesarwani? Yes.

362
00:51:33.140 --> 00:51:34.500
Boardroom: Kaplan? Yes.

363
00:51:34.630 --> 00:51:40.409
Boardroom: Bartlett? Yes. Trageum? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

364
00:51:40.410 --> 00:51:41.170
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

365
00:51:41.630 --> 00:51:43.079
Boardroom: Luna Parra? Yes.

366
00:51:43.200 --> 00:51:57.520
Boardroom: Humbert? Yes. And Mary Ishii? Yes. Okay. Consent calendar has passed. Consent calendar passes. And then, just as another quick note, the, the TV has been set up in the, gymnasium.

367
00:51:57.690 --> 00:52:17.589
Boardroom: for overflow for people to watch the meeting. It's just the gymnasium is the building, next to the parking lot, right there on Browning Street. So we'll let the people in line know so they can participate from there as well. And like I said earlier, as people exit the meeting, additional people will be, admitted into the boardroom.

368
00:52:18.260 --> 00:52:36.659
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Mr. City Clerk. And so, just, so folks know where we're at, we've just finished the consent calendar, we're moving on to the action calendar, and, we have item 26, which we have our staff right in front of us, and I believe you do not have a presentation, but you are here for any questions, is that correct?

369
00:52:36.660 --> 00:52:50.540
Boardroom: Okay, thank you very much. Are there any questions? We are moving on to Action Calendar Item 26, Referral Response Inclusionary Housing In Lieu Fee Analysis and Fee Update for Single Family Residential Units.

370

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This information provided by Zoom. The City of Berkeley cannot certify the following text since we did not create it.

00:52:53.080 --> 00:53:01.410
Boardroom: I see no hands raised for any questions. So, is there any public comment for item number 26?

371
00:53:04.140 --> 00:53:06.210
Boardroom: Anybody online?

372
00:53:06.520 --> 00:53:14.069
Boardroom: So this is to raise your hand online if you wish to give comments on the inclusionary housing in lieu fee analysis.

373
00:53:14.240 --> 00:53:16.559
Boardroom: Otherwise, please lower your hand.

374
00:53:17.940 --> 00:53:26.099
Boardroom: Okay, to comment on item 26, we have former Councilmember Cheryl Davila.

375
00:53:28.240 --> 00:53:30.390
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: I'm sorry, what's the name of this item?

376
00:53:31.040 --> 00:53:42.429
Boardroom: This is for item number 26, and if you don't have a comment on 26, I'd like to ask that you put your hand down so we can hear comments on this item only, please.

377
00:53:42.850 --> 00:53:57.379
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Well, I'm gonna make a comment on it, just, you wouldn't tell me what it was, so I'm gonna look it up real quick. And you took 3 seconds off my time last time, which was not nice, but… 26.

378
00:53:57.720 --> 00:54:04.130
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: You could have just repeated it, referral for response, inclusionary housing. Yeah, inclusionary housing.

379
00:54:04.260 --> 00:54:18.540
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: We need to have inclusionary housing. We need to have 100% affordable housing. We don't need to have market rate. A lot of those units are empty. People need to…

380

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This information provided by Zoom. The City of Berkeley cannot certify the following text since we did not create it.

00:54:18.980 --> 00:54:23.240
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: be able to live and stay in Berkeley at an affordable rate.

381
00:54:23.460 --> 00:54:25.719
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: And the way things are going.

382
00:54:25.850 --> 00:54:36.240
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: black and brown people are gonna not be in Berkeley. So that's what you need to make sure that you take the highest percentage, charge them.

383
00:54:36.640 --> 00:54:40.310
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: The highest amount, not to include

384
00:54:40.930 --> 00:54:47.249
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: If they try to do the in-Luffies, they should be very expensive.

385
00:54:47.250 --> 00:54:49.750
Boardroom: Thank you for your comment.

386
00:54:53.970 --> 00:55:03.460
Boardroom: Okay… And… next is… Sarah Bell?

387
00:55:06.310 --> 00:55:19.710
Sarah Bell (she/her): Hi, I assume you can hear me. I am chair of the Housing Advisory Commission, and I wanted to give some color on the HACC recommendation on the residential unit flora Area deduction.

388
00:55:20.110 --> 00:55:36.270
Sarah Bell (she/her): We voted to advance the 2,500 square foot exemption because that was what was studied. But a number of members of the commission thought that reducing the in-lieu fee by that much for single-family homes was too much of an exemption for them.

389
00:55:36.460 --> 00:55:49.450
Sarah Bell (she/her): A brand new 2,500 square foot single-family home in Berkeley is a luxury. I'm getting into my personal opinion now. Someone building, one should contribute more to our housing trust fund.

390
00:55:49.600 --> 00:56:06.799

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Sarah Bell (she/her): It is my personal opinion that our housing trust fund monies, build housing for people at risk of, experiencing displacement or even homelessness, and this exemption should be eliminated for single-family homes, or at least greatly reduced. Thank you very much.

391
00:56:07.200 --> 00:56:08.260
Boardroom: Thank you, Sarah.

392
00:56:09.790 --> 00:56:10.830
Boardroom: Alright…

393
00:56:17.850 --> 00:56:20.140
Boardroom: Next is James White.

394
00:56:22.930 --> 00:56:24.720
james white: Yes, no, I think with the…

395
00:56:25.900 --> 00:56:37.099
james white: I want to say that I think the comments, were pretty racist that the feral woman was talking about, and as a white man take offense to her black and brown comments? I think that's,

396
00:56:37.340 --> 00:56:39.100
james white: pretty, distasteful.

397
00:56:39.100 --> 00:56:44.600
Boardroom: Excuse me, do you have a comment on item number 26? We're taking public comment for item 26.

398
00:56:44.600 --> 00:57:01.880
james white: Yes, I do. And please don't interrupt me. I'm going to make my point, but you can't interrupt when people are making their point. The reason why we have this problem with the housing anyway is because the boomers printed money for 20 or 30 years. We should be looking fundamentally why our housing is unaffordable

399
00:57:01.960 --> 00:57:14.689
james white: for our youth, and it's not a black and brown thing, it's a generational thing. The boomers sold us out to the Jews, and since then, we've been basically eating, eaten crap while we go to war for them, over and over again.

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400
00:57:18.970 --> 00:57:25.789
Boardroom: Again, people, I'm… folks, I'm very sorry for these comments. I apologize.

401
00:57:27.200 --> 00:57:33.029
Boardroom: Okay, next is… Seth.

402
00:57:35.120 --> 00:57:38.629
Seth: Hello, people of Berkeley. I'm sorry for the…

403
00:57:38.810 --> 00:57:55.679
Seth: disgraceful act of our previous speaker. I think it's really important that we start looking towards a rent-to-own model. We need some high-rises built here in Berkeley. We need, you know, 15, 20, 30-story high-rises with rent-to-own public housing.

404
00:57:56.040 --> 00:58:10.789
Seth: And we also need, you know, any kind of job facilities and things like that in the lower level, so that people can go and get services in the same building that they live in, as well as maybe a food distribution place. So, Canada's putting us to shame.

405
00:58:11.230 --> 00:58:15.299
Seth: We have rampant homelessness, rampant poverty, rampant crime.

406
00:58:15.350 --> 00:58:31.519
Seth: You know, it's basically, you know, I feel like I'm living in a fetid country that has completely fallen apart, and is not taking care of the poorest of the poor. You judge a nation by how well it treats its poor people, and America is abysmal. We need public housing for all.

407
00:58:31.520 --> 00:58:39.819
Seth: And we also need rent-to-own property so that working-class families can get microloans either through the government or even through the landlord.

408
00:58:42.400 --> 00:58:43.680
Boardroom: Thank you.

409
00:58:45.300 --> 00:58:48.380
Boardroom: Next is, Andrew Talbot.

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410
00:58:51.340 --> 00:58:54.019
Andrew Talbot: Hello, thank you for the chance to comment on this item.

411
00:58:54.580 --> 00:59:11.739
Andrew Talbot: I just wanted to mention that inclusionary fees, unless they're funded as a subsidy, are generally just a tax on new housing, and I generally think we should be taxing existing housing, if we want to pay for new housing, rather than taxing new housing. We do want new housing, we want a lot of it as much as we can, and so…

412
00:59:12.320 --> 00:59:24.409
Andrew Talbot: as much as we can balance those fees, it makes sense. And I agree that, balancing those towards multifamily versus single-family is a way to go if we're going to have those fees at all. So, thank you for the comment, and I appreciate it.

413
00:59:24.740 --> 00:59:25.540
Boardroom: Thank you.

414
00:59:26.230 --> 00:59:34.310
Boardroom: Okay, and we have, one more commenter, we have Virginia Browning.

415
00:59:43.350 --> 00:59:45.420
Boardroom: Virginia should be able to unmute.

416
00:59:57.230 --> 01:00:05.359
Boardroom: Last call, Virginia… Let's see, let's try a city.

417
01:00:09.070 --> 01:00:10.110
Boardroom: Okay.

418
01:00:10.740 --> 01:00:13.530
Boardroom: Virginia, can you unmute?

419
01:00:16.270 --> 01:00:17.840
Boardroom: That's… okay.

420
01:00:19.270 --> 01:00:21.440
Boardroom: Virginia, can you hear us?

Unofficial Text File

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421
01:00:22.300 --> 01:00:24.390
Boardroom: You should be able to unmute.

422
01:00:25.270 --> 01:00:27.620
Boardroom: No, no. Okay.

423
01:00:33.390 --> 01:00:34.770
Boardroom: No, it's not.

424
01:00:36.120 --> 01:00:39.260
Boardroom: I don't think she's fully connected.

425
01:00:39.940 --> 01:00:51.050
Boardroom: Okay, we'll have to move on. Sorry. Okay, I'm sorry. You can always send your comments in writing to the council at berkeleyca.gov, and Council will receive your comments.

426
01:00:51.550 --> 01:00:56.670
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Okay, we're coming back to Council for comments, starting with Councilmember Humbert.

427
01:00:56.940 --> 01:01:13.269
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. I want to thank the staff in the Planning Department and the City Manager's Office for their work on this item. I think it's a sensible approach to ensure that the very largest single-family homes are, as well, making a contribution to our affordable housing fund.

428
01:01:13.350 --> 01:01:31.899
Boardroom: In my view, at least, there's very little reason for most homes to be more than 2,500 square feet, and with this approach, the size of the fee will still scale with the amount by which a single-family home exceeds that level, exceeds 2,500 feet. This seems… square feet. This seems to me very fair.

429
01:01:31.900 --> 01:01:36.390
Boardroom: And I thank you again to all who worked on it. I'm prepared to move it forward.

430
01:01:37.590 --> 01:01:40.870
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Lenapara, did you have comments?

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431
01:01:41.190 --> 01:01:45.200
Boardroom: I just really wanted to thank staff for their work on this. I,

432
01:01:45.660 --> 01:01:54.209
Boardroom: I worked on the referral to… to… to pass this… to get this done originally, and I'm very thankful for all the work that has gone into it. Thanks.

433
01:01:55.450 --> 01:01:58.770
Boardroom: Would you perhaps like to move the item? Yeah, I'll move the item.

434
01:01:59.020 --> 01:02:15.849
Boardroom: Do we close the public hearing, Mayor? Oh, thank you, yes. Move to close the public hearing? Second. To close the public hearing on item 26, Councilmember Kesarwani? Yes. Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

435
01:02:15.850 --> 01:02:16.660
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

436
01:02:16.850 --> 01:02:22.479
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mary Sheet? Yes. Okay, public hearing is closed.

437
01:02:22.610 --> 01:02:23.980
Boardroom: Okay.

438
01:02:24.870 --> 01:02:30.149
Boardroom: Would you… I'll move the item. Second. All right. Can we take the roll now, please?

439
01:02:30.230 --> 01:02:46.570
Boardroom: To approve the, resolution amending the inclusionary housing fee, Councilmember Kesarwani? Yes. Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Drago? Aye. Yes. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

440
01:02:46.570 --> 01:02:47.520
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

441

Unofficial Text File

This information provided by Zoom. The City of Berkeley cannot certify the following text since we did not create it.

01:02:47.520 --> 01:03:03.150
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes, and thank you also to Councilmember Lunapara. And Mayor Ishh. Yes. Thank you. Motion carries. Motion carries. Thank you very much to our staff, thank you for being here, and for being available for questions and your work.

442
01:03:03.440 --> 01:03:28.430
Boardroom: Okay, great. We are moving on to item 27, which is the referral to schedule Hopkins Street for paving with enhanced safety improvements for all users. So, the way that this is gonna go, since I'm guessing all of the rest of you are here for this item, is that we are gonna have a presentation, by the author of the item, Councilmember Kesarwani, and then we will have presentations by the

443
01:03:28.430 --> 01:03:31.380
Boardroom: rest of the council members who have supplementals.

444
01:03:31.380 --> 01:03:50.009
Boardroom: And then, we are gonna take any questions from council members, and then we will move to public comment. As in the past, if you have a small child with you or a child with you, I will allow you to come to the head of the line so that you may take them home for dinner or bedtime, etc. And then,

445
01:03:50.400 --> 01:04:00.029
Boardroom: likely at some point, we will need to take a break, and we will continue to do the comments, and then, we will come back to do Council comments.

446
01:04:00.270 --> 01:04:01.960
Boardroom: and our votes.

447
01:04:02.380 --> 01:04:05.879
Boardroom: Missing anything? Okay, I think that's everything. Alright, very good.

448
01:04:05.980 --> 01:04:30.980
Boardroom: So, and one thing else I want to say, if you cannot stay and you still want to make sure that you give some kind of comment, feel free to email it to us. If you give your comment and you're thinking about, you know, maybe heading out and watching from home, please do so, so that way we can allow folks who are in the overflow room to come in and be able to give their comment. So, I just ask that when you've kind of finished, if you

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449
01:04:30.980 --> 01:04:55.689
Boardroom: can watch at home, that you allow others to give their comment here in person. Okay, passing it on to Councilmember Kesarwani. Thank you very much. Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. I, I want to begin by thanking Interim Public Works Director Wahid Amiri, who I know is online, and the Public Works team, Fire Chief Sprague, and City Manager Paul Budenhagen for their work in helping us get to this point tonight.

450
01:04:55.910 --> 01:04:59.520
Boardroom: I also want to thank my co-sponsors, Mayor.

451
01:04:59.530 --> 01:05:13.160
Boardroom: Adina Ishii and Councilmember Mark Humbert on this item. I also want to thank every member of the public who has engaged on this topic. My office has received more than 1,100 emails on Hopkins Street.

452
01:05:13.160 --> 01:05:22.520
Boardroom: And I want to say something that may surprise some people. The emails from District 1 and from across the city have actually been pretty evenly split.

453
01:05:22.520 --> 01:05:34.660
Boardroom: between support and opposition, that tells me this is a genuinely contested question in our community, and I have tried to take all of those voices seriously.

454
01:05:34.690 --> 01:05:53.470
Boardroom: I want to acknowledge up front that this item does represent an unprecedented change in how the public right-of-way is used in a residential neighborhood. I do not take that lightly, but I also want to explain why I believe this action is necessary and overdue.

455
01:05:53.470 --> 01:06:04.949
Boardroom: Hopkins Street has been recommended as a low-stress east-west connector route in Berkeley's bicycle plan, and it is a documented high-injury corridor.

456
01:06:04.950 --> 01:06:16.319
Boardroom: The proposed safety treatments in this item are not arbitrary. They are directly informed by where people have been killed and severely injured on this street.

457
01:06:16.340 --> 01:06:22.070

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Boardroom: A pedestrian was killed at Hopkins in Monterey in April 2017.

458
01:06:22.470 --> 01:06:40.280
Boardroom: Four cyclists suffered severe injuries on Hopkins at Carlotta, Monterey, the Alameda, and Albina between April 2016 and November 2023. A pedestrian suffered a severe injury at Hopkins and Peralta in June 2021.

459
01:06:40.330 --> 01:06:52.310
Boardroom: The median age of those killed or severely injured on this corridor is 67 and a half years old. These are our neighbors, our seniors, our community members.

460
01:06:52.500 --> 01:07:06.879
Boardroom: This is also a corridor home to King Middle School, the North Branch Library, and multiple preschools. It is a street that children walk and bike to every day. All of us deserve a safer street.

461
01:07:07.730 --> 01:07:26.309
Boardroom: To get into the details of this item, this item asks the City Manager to repave Hopkins Street from Sutter Street to San Pablo Avenue with enhanced safety features for all users. Specifically, the item directs staff to design one-way Class 4 separated bikeways.

462
01:07:26.310 --> 01:07:33.679
Boardroom: That is, physically protected bike lanes on each side of Hopkins, from the Alameda to Peralta Avenue.

463
01:07:33.800 --> 01:07:41.629
Boardroom: essentially the Ohlone Greenway. This configuration was considered to be the safest by our Public Works staff.

464
01:07:41.770 --> 01:07:50.369
Boardroom: Because it allows cyclists to travel in the same direction as adjacent vehicle traffic, reducing conflicts at intersections.

465
01:07:50.550 --> 01:08:05.030
Boardroom: The item also calls for Class 2 buffered green-painted bike lanes from Sutter Street to the Alameda, similar to what we have on Monterey Avenue. Traffic calming features west of Peralta Avenue to Stanage Avenue.

466
01:08:05.030 --> 01:08:22.910

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Boardroom: a raised intersection at Hopkins and Monterey, California for pedestrian safety, bus boarding islands at AC transit stops, and a comprehensive curb management plan to address parking, loading zones, ADA spaces, and waste collection needs.

467
01:08:22.930 --> 01:08:42.690
Boardroom: Critically, the item also requires outreach to businesses, schools, houses of worship, and residents as staff develop the detailed engineering design, if this item is approved tonight. Because we want that design to be responsive to the operational needs of everyone along this corridor.

468
01:08:42.689 --> 01:08:44.640
Boardroom: I also want to note

469
01:08:44.880 --> 01:08:51.250
Boardroom: That 3 years ago, fire department concerns were among the reasons this project was paused.

470
01:08:51.250 --> 01:09:07.200
Boardroom: At the April meeting of the Facilities, Infrastructure, Transportation, Environment, and Sustainability Council Policy Committee, Fire Chief Sprague's department confirmed that bike safety infrastructure on Hopkins retains workable emergency access.

471
01:09:07.200 --> 01:09:11.699
Boardroom: That is a significant development that made this item possible.

472
01:09:11.779 --> 01:09:36.769
Boardroom: Finally, the pavement condition of Hopkins Street is unacceptable. Two segments are rated failed, eight more are rated poor. The street has been waiting for repaving for years, and it is critical, I think, that the Council provide direction tonight so that our public works staff can move forward. The time to act is now, while Hopkins is already scheduled for repaving in fiscal year 2028.

473
01:09:37.399 --> 01:10:02.399
Boardroom: I look forward to hearing from the public tonight, and I look forward to the discussion with my colleagues. Before I fully wrap up, I would like to share screen and just show a couple of really minor amendments. Sure, and just so you know, you're on here twice if you wanna, oh, I'm on twice. If you wanna turn off your video on your computer. Okay, but I'm gonna need that to share, right?

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474
01:10:02.400 --> 01:10:09.840
Boardroom: You don't need to have your video on if you want to just… Oh, okay, I see. So just, let's just do that.

475
01:10:09.840 --> 01:10:12.760
Boardroom: Okay, well, I'd like to be… Just in case.

476
01:10:12.860 --> 01:10:14.280
Boardroom: Up to you.

477
01:10:14.580 --> 01:10:17.189
Boardroom: Okay, I'm gonna make this bigger.

478
01:10:19.920 --> 01:10:24.880
Boardroom: I think this is the right version. So, okay, so…

479
01:10:25.330 --> 01:10:31.520
Boardroom: I understand there was a lot of, I think…

480
01:10:31.670 --> 01:10:54.969
Boardroom: reasonable fear about this bullet related to removal of trees, and I just want to be clear, I think one of the most beautiful aspects of Hopkins Street is the tree canopy, from McGee to the Alameda, and I… and my co-sponsors… I don't think, Councilmember O'Keefe, none of us ever had an intention of destroying that, and so I… I was thinking of a different tree.

481
01:10:54.970 --> 01:11:08.889
Boardroom: Which is also a problem. So, in any case, we just want to make this language, better aligned to what our expectation is, so we are deleting that bullet, and we are suggesting

482
01:11:09.010 --> 01:11:27.749
Boardroom: the new language that you see here, assess street trees along the corridor with arborist input, and determine minimally invasive, appropriate treatments if old street trees are intruding into the usable street with impacting storm drainage. So, you know, we can look at potentially trimming roots

483
01:11:27.850 --> 01:11:33.540
Boardroom: And things like that. So we just want to make that clear. And then… In the past.

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484
01:11:33.790 --> 01:11:38.680
Boardroom: when we have talked about Hopkins, there has been a placemaking piece.

485
01:11:38.760 --> 01:11:50.240
Boardroom: So we want to make clear that placemaking can be considered based on available funds after prioritizing paving and safety infrastructure, so we've added that.

486
01:11:50.240 --> 01:12:00.590
Boardroom: And then finally, just to be very clear, we are stating that this referral supersedes all other prior Council action related to the design of Hopkins Street. Thank you.

487
01:12:01.030 --> 01:12:14.499
Boardroom: Thank you very much. I want to pass it over to Vice Mayor O'Keefe to give her presentation, next, since your districts are both, connected, so… Thank you, and actually,

488
01:12:14.500 --> 01:12:21.739
Boardroom: I don't have my screen sharing set up. Councilmember Castorani, would you mind sharing your screen, with mine on it? Would you do me that solid? Thank you.

489
01:12:21.900 --> 01:12:30.990
Boardroom: I can talk… I'm not going to talk about the text of it just yet, but I will get to that. I just want to make a brief statement about where I'm coming from.

490
01:12:31.730 --> 01:12:37.179
Boardroom: well, I'll start by just summarizing. My supplemental,

491
01:12:37.410 --> 01:12:50.769
Boardroom: removes the, it keeps almost all the elements in place, but it removes the Class 4 protected bike lane. That's the primary change. My reason for this is I do not believe a separated bike lane is necessary here.

492
01:12:50.770 --> 01:13:04.299
Boardroom: There are other options for bicycle safety and providing access for that area that may not be as appealing. We grant that as the protected bike lane for cyclists, but given the trade-offs required

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493
01:13:04.760 --> 01:13:18.990
Boardroom: They… it's more appropriate to have a different… different kinds of, bike infrastructure. I'm primarily concerned about the loss of parking spaces required by their proposal, namely 100%.

494
01:13:19.020 --> 01:13:33.750
Boardroom: of the parking between McGee and Peralta, slash Ohlone Greenway. That's the projection, and we'll hear from staff about that, to be able to comment on that more. But that's the current projection, and also, approximately one-third of the parking

495
01:13:33.900 --> 01:13:40.840
Boardroom: east of McGee, so that would be… I think it would be the north side of Hopkins, would lose all of its parking as well.

496
01:13:41.420 --> 01:14:00.550
Boardroom: I believe that this loss of parking would have a severe detrimental impact to the merchants, as well as to the people who use cars, or many, and who rely on this area, not just for shopping, but also for exercise at the track and the pool and recreation. Many of the people who use these facilities are older people.

497
01:14:00.800 --> 01:14:04.260
Boardroom: Disabled people, and people with small children.

498
01:14:04.890 --> 01:14:10.599
Boardroom: And I have to speak up for those people, and I have to protect their access to these facilities.

499
01:14:11.240 --> 01:14:12.430
Boardroom: My… nope.

500
01:14:13.720 --> 01:14:14.680
Boardroom: Thank you.

501
01:14:18.200 --> 01:14:30.119
Boardroom: I'd like to continue, I appreciate it, but if we could hold that, right now, I do appreciate it, but it's better if we can… if we could all just, say our pieces, I think that would be wonderful, and then you… we're looking forward to hearing from everybody.

502

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01:14:30.120 --> 01:14:45.889
Boardroom: So my supplemental, does keep the paving and pedestrian improvements. Paving is obviously necessary, and I think that was very well laid out by Councilmember Kassarwani, so I won't repeat that. I agree with that. I want the street to be paved. I want the pedestrian improvements. It is a dangerous corridor for pedestrians.

503
01:14:45.890 --> 01:14:47.960
Boardroom: Both of these are deeded.

504
01:14:48.370 --> 01:14:58.820
Boardroom: And so we keep that, and we just make the major change of changing the, the bicycle infrastructure, so that the parking… with the goal of the parking loss being minimized.

505
01:14:59.790 --> 01:15:11.699
Boardroom: So just to get into some details, thank you very much for sharing the screen. So you can see this, this change here, it just takes out the Class 4 bike lane and just says, refer to pave the street. And then as we go down.

506
01:15:13.090 --> 01:15:28.589
Boardroom: Can you go down? Thanks, appreciate it. These changes just, once again, they're, enacting that, and I do want to read this paragraph here. From McGee to San Pablo, so that's where the, that's starting, where the street narrows if you're heading.

507
01:15:28.690 --> 01:15:35.999
Boardroom: west on the street. It narrows at McGee. And so, starting at that portion, all the way down to,

508
01:15:36.130 --> 01:15:43.030
Boardroom: to Stanage, oh, I'm sorry, this is just adjusting her language.

509
01:15:45.020 --> 01:16:01.349
Boardroom: Right, okay, so incorporate Class 3 bicycle infrastructure, which is a shero, which I know is not very popular, but that is the only real way to incorporate, bicycle infrastructure without losing parking. However, I did include this language that, I wanted to provide flexibility

510
01:16:01.350 --> 01:16:05.780
Boardroom: So it says, and or alternative bicycle safety improvements.

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511
01:16:05.780 --> 01:16:17.620
Boardroom: staff recommends that do not require the removal of parking spaces. There have been some designs floating around, by, not by city staff, but by other, other people who, have training in engineering.

512
01:16:17.620 --> 01:16:37.680
Boardroom: We're actually… it's possible we could widen the street, or we can do different things, and I really wanted to provide staff with the flexibility to be more creative, because I understand that sharrows are not popular, and if we could do something better than that without losing parking, I would be okay with that. So, we included that language to provide that flexibility. And then, if you could scroll down a bit more…

513
01:16:37.770 --> 01:16:38.740
Boardroom: Thank you.

514
01:16:42.400 --> 01:16:59.120
Boardroom: The rest… this is just… I don't think the bus boarding islands are necessary without the Class 4 bike lane, so I removed that. And then if you scroll down just more, there's two more things that I want to highlight, thank you. I wanted to also pair this with, a referral to…

515
01:16:59.180 --> 01:17:19.089
Boardroom: actually implement Rose Street as a bicycle boulevard. It is marked as a bicycle boulevard on the bicycle plan. It is not one right now, it is just a regular street if you drive it. There's no bicycle boulevard infrastructure on it, but I do agree that we should have better bicycle access to this area, and I think we already have

516
01:17:19.570 --> 01:17:27.930
Boardroom: a plan in place to do that, and so I'd like to move forward with that. Bicycle boulevards are a really underutilized

517
01:17:28.070 --> 01:17:33.460
Boardroom: way of getting safe bicycle infrastructure. We have a lot of streets in Berkeley.

518
01:17:33.580 --> 01:17:39.539
Boardroom: A lot of them don't need high traffic, and we can take streets, and we can make them into

519
01:17:39.870 --> 01:17:41.430

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Boardroom: a very…

520
01:17:42.120 --> 01:18:00.380
Boardroom: of, like, practically their own bike lane by just limiting traffic. And you can limit traffic by putting up very cheap, relatively concrete barriers and, and roundabouts. There's a lot of relatively inexpensive interventions that you can make on existing streets, parallel to busy streets.

521
01:18:01.040 --> 01:18:21.090
Boardroom: that is such a better policy that I want to pursue that instead of this. So, that's my proposal for addressing what I know is not a satisfactory, bike, bike infrastructure for many. So I think we should pursue a bicycle boulevard along Rose, which is, once again, already in the bike plan. And then lastly…

522
01:18:21.920 --> 01:18:38.080
Boardroom: This is important… I want everybody to understand this language, because I would hope that all of us would be willing to incorporate this language in our proposals. We all saw the cost estimates, which are huge, as much as $20 million, perhaps, for this project.

523
01:18:38.150 --> 01:18:48.790
Boardroom: And our FF budget's only $15 million. So that… when I saw that, I got very concerned that this project, no matter what the outcome of this meeting tonight.

524
01:18:49.050 --> 01:18:51.719
Boardroom: I got very concerned that

525
01:18:52.210 --> 01:18:55.100
Boardroom: It wouldn't be possible to implement it.

526
01:18:55.100 --> 01:19:20.059
Boardroom: at all, because it's just too big. So I wanted to add this language that would give city staff the option to break it up into pieces and maybe do some of it one year and some of it another year. Because the most important thing to me is that the dang street gets paved. It has been languishing for too long. We have to… if we don't manage to pave the street in the next 5 years, we have absolutely failed.

527
01:19:20.060 --> 01:19:22.480
Boardroom: So, I put in this language.

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528
01:19:22.790 --> 01:19:26.680
Boardroom: To maximize the chances of it actually getting done.

529
01:19:27.330 --> 01:19:33.350
Boardroom: And I think that's it. Thank you very much. Thanks for your help, Councilmember Kessler. Thank you very much.

530
01:19:33.810 --> 01:19:45.130
Boardroom: I'm going to pass it over to Councilmember Taplin to present his supplemental, and then we will go online to allow Councilmember Blackaby to present. Oh, no, yeah, you can stop sharing.

531
01:19:45.620 --> 01:19:54.510
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor, and good evening, everybody. I would like to thank my co-sponsor, Councilmember Gunapada, as well as Councilmember Kasarwani, and her co-sponsors, Mayor Ishii and Councilmember Humbert.

532
01:19:54.670 --> 01:20:12.790
Boardroom: As I pored over the torrent of emails we received urging the repaving of Hopkins with pedestrian, bicycle, and transit improvements, I was especially moved by the testimony of West Berkeley families detailing the dangerous conditions they risk on their commute to Ruth Actee Elementary, King Middle School, North Branch Library, and Kingpool, and shops in Hopkins.

533
01:20:13.250 --> 01:20:23.339
Boardroom: Given the collaborative effort between the City of Berkeley and the Alameda County Transportation Commission to add bicycle Boulevard treatments on Sandich Avenue as part of the San Pablo Corridor Parallel Bike Improvements Project.

534
01:20:23.340 --> 01:20:39.419
Boardroom: I am proposing that we extend the one-way protected bike lanes from Peralta Avenue at the Olin Greenway to Standage Avenue. In so doing, the City would create a low-stress bikeway connection on Hopkins and Standage and advance the city-wide low-stress bikeway network that the 2026 bicycle Plan Update recommends. Thank you.

535
01:20:40.580 --> 01:20:43.970
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Blackaby?

536

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01:20:44.550 --> 01:20:59.179
Brent Blackaby: Thank you, Madam Mayor. Like Councilmember O'Keefe, I'll make a short statement, and then I'll share my screen, show my supplemental. I want to thank, as well, Councilmember Kesarwani and O'Keefe for bringing forward the original Hopkins item and restarting the process that brings us to today.

537
01:20:59.180 --> 01:21:11.960
Brent Blackaby: I'd also like to thank Councilmember Bartlett for co-sponsoring the supplemental that we're presenting now. As we all know, Hopkins Street is a vibrant commercial district that's frequented by thousands of Berkeley residents every day.

538
01:21:11.960 --> 01:21:25.299
Brent Blackaby: People shopping for groceries, grabbing coffee, picking up lunch or dinner, browsing for plants for their homes or gardens, swimming, attending birthday parties, running on the track, dropping off kids at soccer practice, going to church, attending school, and so much more.

539
01:21:25.590 --> 01:21:35.980
Brent Blackaby: These represent people of all ages, from kids to seniors, using all modes of transport, driving, walking, biking, folks who are disabled, and those who aren't.

540
01:21:36.230 --> 01:21:45.099
Brent Blackaby: Lots of people visit Hopkins, including 20,000 or more Berkeley residents who live in the 1700-foot-high Berkeley Hills.

541
01:21:45.110 --> 01:22:01.109
Brent Blackaby: that starts just steps away from the eastern end of Hopkins. Most of those folks can't just bike home, don't have access to reliable public transportation, and must drive to and from Hopkins, many of whom have been, in fact, doing this for decades.

542
01:22:01.260 --> 01:22:13.759
Brent Blackaby: Many of these people are my constituents, some of them are Councilmember O'Keeffe's and others, and these people would be negatively impacted by the significant parking loss in the item that we're considering tonight.

543
01:22:14.110 --> 01:22:28.039
Brent Blackaby: So, given the complexity of the current situation and all of the equities we're trying to balance, I respectfully suggest that

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Council would be well-served to seriously consider multiple options before settling on one.

544
01:22:28.340 --> 01:22:48.049
Brent Blackaby: My item simply would refer to staff the development of two alternatives for consideration. One is the current plan put forth by Councilmember Kesarwani, centered around the Class 4 protected bike lanes along most of Hopkins that would eliminate more than half the parking spots in the corridor, 145 at our last estimate.

545
01:22:48.460 --> 01:23:01.560
Brent Blackaby: And the second direction would be an alternative plan that retains parking for as many residents as possible who travel to and from Hopkins by car, while expanding the potential solution space just a bit.

546
01:23:01.690 --> 01:23:10.229
Brent Blackaby: to think not just about Hopkins, but also Hopkins, Ada, and Rose Streets together as potential pathways for bicycle infrastructure.

547
01:23:10.640 --> 01:23:15.130
Brent Blackaby: After all, we're really talking about trying to do several things all at once here.

548
01:23:15.290 --> 01:23:34.229
Brent Blackaby: We're trying to figure out how to keep and expand access to Hopkins for all Berkeley residents, how to maintain the vibrancy of the businesses and community spaces there, how to improve safety for all in this corridor, how to connect North Berkeley and West Berkeley for bicyclists, and how to do all of this as cost-effectively as possible.

549
01:23:34.480 --> 01:23:48.389
Brent Blackaby: Respectfully, I think we would be better able to evaluate whether a protected bike lane all the way from the Alameda to Gilman along Hopkins is the right solution if we look at it side by side with the best possible alternative.

550
01:23:48.840 --> 01:23:51.530
Brent Blackaby: This is not an easy puzzle to solve.

551
01:23:51.780 --> 01:23:57.900
Brent Blackaby: But we do have a very capable and accomplished public works staff that is well equipped to help us solve it.

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552
01:23:57.950 --> 01:24:14.869
Brent Blackaby: And I think we should give them a chance. I think we can all probably attest to Interim Public Works Director Wahit Amiri and his team, and are looking forward to the leadership of incoming Director Jamie Parks. I will say that Councilmember O'Keefe and I have watched them plan and implement an effective traffic calming project

553
01:24:14.870 --> 01:24:18.430
Brent Blackaby: All along Marin Avenue, from the circle to the top of the hill.

554
01:24:18.530 --> 01:24:34.009
Brent Blackaby: Working with the fire department, they've cleared sightlines, they've slowed traffic up and down the hill. Having reviewed results to date, they're looking further to improve safety, they're now in the process of converting four 3-way stops into four-way stops, knocking on a giant amount of wood.

555
01:24:34.030 --> 01:24:40.869
Brent Blackaby: They've seriously improved safety all along Marin Avenue with no serious incidents since implementation.

556
01:24:41.250 --> 01:24:45.699
Brent Blackaby: So let's give Jamie and Wahid and our Public Works team a chance.

557
01:24:46.170 --> 01:24:58.710
Brent Blackaby: Let's also try to find a way to bring our community together around a solution here. Bring down the temperature a bit, improve safety for everyone, strengthen the vitality of this treasured neighborhood, and do it cost-effectively.

558
01:24:59.020 --> 01:25:12.660
Brent Blackaby: Let me just say, I have the utmost respect for all of the advocates of the plan and Councilmember Kastarwani's item. These people, I know many of them, they have the best interests of our community at heart. I respect their advocacy so much.

559
01:25:12.870 --> 01:25:17.340
Brent Blackaby: Safety for all users of our streets is one of the top priorities in our city.

560

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01:25:17.480 --> 01:25:26.860
Brent Blackaby: But as city council members, our job is to balance all the interests and equities at play here. While many bicyclists support protected bike lanes, we've heard from many others who don't.

561
01:25:27.070 --> 01:25:30.690
Brent Blackaby: There's clearly not only one right way to do this.

562
01:25:30.860 --> 01:25:50.319
Brent Blackaby: I think development of a second balanced alternative will give us the best chance to hold the two plans up against each other and ultimately make the best decision either way by having fully considered all the options presented by staff. So let me very briefly, I'll share my screen with the language from the supplemental, which is here.

563
01:25:51.590 --> 01:25:58.180
Brent Blackaby: It's basically just an amendment, like Councilmember O'Keefe's was, an amendment to Councilmember Kastarwani's item.

564
01:25:58.320 --> 01:26:11.100
Brent Blackaby: Which basically moves… but we do want to move forward with the repaving. We want to refer to staff the development of two alternate plans for repaving Hopkins enhanced safety through the Hopkins-ADA-Rose corridor.

565
01:26:11.100 --> 01:26:21.850
Brent Blackaby: We do need BFD to review and approve both plans, as the prior BFD approval refers to two previous options. The alternative on the table tonight has not been approved by BFD.

566
01:26:22.140 --> 01:26:34.030
Brent Blackaby: We need to coordinate with AC Transit on bus stops and traffic calming measures, and as Councilmember O'Keefe indicated, this request and the resulting plans would supersede the conceptual design approved by Council in 2022.

567
01:26:34.070 --> 01:26:43.249
Brent Blackaby: Then we'd ask, staff to return to Council for final direction before developing the detailed engineering plan. So again, Alternative 1 is as current.

568
01:26:43.410 --> 01:26:55.019

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Brent Blackaby: Alternative 2, as I've laid it out, would ask for staff to have time to give maximal flexibility, develop a balanced comprehensive plan for the corridor, minimize parking loss.

569
01:26:55.280 --> 01:27:02.749
Brent Blackaby: And the key principles here is consider implementation of Class 2 or Class 4 bike lanes only where parking loss is less than 15%.

570
01:27:03.020 --> 01:27:19.230
Brent Blackaby: Expedite the study and implementation of safety enhancements on Rose and or Ada as part of a more comprehensive plan. I think there are multiple ways to get bicycles in and out of this area that don't just rely on Hopkins. Pedestrian safety, slowing vehicle speeds by using traffic calming.

571
01:27:19.230 --> 01:27:32.389
Brent Blackaby: curb management plan to manage parking, and so on. So that's… that's the item, is to add the ask for basically the second plan. So, in closing, let me just say, the question to me is not whether or not

572
01:27:32.490 --> 01:27:41.070
Brent Blackaby: We support bicycle and pedestrian safety as a city, because we do. In fact, we've approved and implemented safety projects all across Berkeley.

573
01:27:41.160 --> 01:27:59.529
Brent Blackaby: The question is, what is the appropriate treatment for this particular corridor, given its many users and uses? And I think we could benefit from more staff input before we make such a momentous decision. I'll add that given that any Hopkins project is likely a multi-year effort, as Councilmember O'Keefe suggested.

574
01:27:59.530 --> 01:28:09.229
Brent Blackaby: I'd also support a plan tonight that begins paving on segments where we can reach agreement right away, and I think there might be somewhere we could do that, so we could begin the paving process

575
01:28:09.230 --> 01:28:20.040
Brent Blackaby: And then focus staff's attention on preparing an alternative for consideration addresses the remaining street segments, especially in that narrow area in the Hopkins Commercial District. So, thank you very much.

576
01:28:27.120 --> 01:28:28.740

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Boardroom: Thank you.

577
01:28:30.260 --> 01:28:35.460
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Did you have a question, Councilmember Treykop? I have questions.

578
01:28:35.700 --> 01:28:46.320
Boardroom: Whenever there's time. Okay. So, I think everyone has now presented their supplemental and the original items, so we are moving on to questions. Go ahead.

579
01:28:48.020 --> 01:28:58.970
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. This first set of questions, is… it's for staff, I believe. Is staff available to answer questions?

580
01:28:59.610 --> 01:29:03.100
Boardroom: Staff's available, they're all… everybody's on low. Oh, great.

581
01:29:07.220 --> 01:29:12.170
Boardroom: Alright, thank… Thank you so much.

582
01:29:12.630 --> 01:29:22.600
Boardroom: I want to better understand how, these proposals align with the recently adopted 2026 bike plan and other relevant planning documents.

583
01:29:22.630 --> 01:29:34.830
Boardroom: Do I understand correctly that Hopkins, from Sauter to Monterey, is designated as Class 2 bicycle Infrastructure, and from Monterey to Gilman as Class 3?

584
01:29:40.180 --> 01:29:43.099
Boardroom: Sorry, who were you asking this question to?

585
01:29:43.290 --> 01:29:49.670
Boardroom: This is for staff. For staff. We have our Interim Director of Public Works, Wahita Miri, who can

586
01:29:49.830 --> 01:29:50.809
Boardroom: Field that.

587

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01:29:51.210 --> 01:30:04.490
Wahid Amiri: Yeah, good evening, Mayor, Council Members, Wahir Amiri, the Interim Director of Public Works. I also have staff available with me. Mark Helmbrecht, our Transportation Manager, will field that question.

588
01:30:13.760 --> 01:30:16.320
Mark Helmbrecht: You got real specific there about the bike plan.

589
01:30:16.460 --> 01:30:22.760
Mark Helmbrecht: The bike plan's identified as a Complete Streets Corridor study.

590
01:30:23.130 --> 01:30:24.900
Mark Helmbrecht: And,

591
01:30:25.500 --> 01:30:31.840
Mark Helmbrecht: The actual designations there, I'm going through the bike plan to get to the underlying information. Give me a minute.

592
01:30:49.300 --> 01:30:50.949
Mark Helmbrecht: It's gonna take me a few.

593
01:31:06.190 --> 01:31:14.309
Boardroom: While he's looking, can I just ask, Councilmember Trekup, how many questions do you have?

594
01:31:14.630 --> 01:31:24.149
Boardroom: I have 5 minutes worth of questions. I have more questions, probably, but I'm limiting them to within the 5-minute allotment.

595
01:31:25.470 --> 01:31:30.499
Boardroom: Okay. Can I maybe ask Fire a question in the meantime?

596
01:31:30.500 --> 01:31:31.450
Mark Helmbrecht: Yeah.

597
01:31:31.450 --> 01:31:45.390
Boardroom: Great. What is the fire department's position on the various alternatives before us? And, are you at this point able to say that you're comfortable with the range of options being considered?

598

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01:31:48.050 --> 01:31:56.780
David Sprague: So, FHIRE has reviewed and approved the traffic calming features in the Hopkins Alternative 1 and 2 that were rented to fights.

599
01:31:57.280 --> 01:32:06.860
David Sprague: We also generally have confirmed that lane widths, that we understand in this new alternative that are either 11 or 10 and a half feet, are acceptable.

600
01:32:07.160 --> 01:32:13.930
David Sprague: However, for the new… Proposed configuration that you're discussing tonight.

601
01:32:14.040 --> 01:32:15.459
David Sprague: We have not…

602
01:32:15.620 --> 01:32:22.099
David Sprague: There is not a design yet, so we have not seen that, we have not reviewed it, and we would need a complete design set from Public Works.

603
01:32:22.430 --> 01:32:24.960
David Sprague: Once that's available, we can evaluate.

604
01:32:25.030 --> 01:32:26.809
Boardroom: Folks, please don't interrupt.

605
01:32:27.270 --> 01:32:28.259
Boardroom: Sorry, go ahead, Chief.

606
01:32:28.260 --> 01:32:38.289
David Sprague: potential impacts to evacuation times, and confirm that design maintains workable access for day-to-day fire and medical emergencies. Does that answer your question, Councilmember?

607
01:32:39.110 --> 01:32:40.499
Boardroom: Yes, thank you.

608
01:32:40.620 --> 01:32:45.550
Boardroom: for Mark, are you ready?

609

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01:32:46.820 --> 01:32:49.489
Mark Helmbrecht: Yeah, I'm still back up.

610
01:32:49.490 --> 01:32:50.280
Wahid Amiri: Okay, okay.

611
01:32:50.280 --> 01:32:55.740
Mark Helmbrecht: Yeah, it does call for a complete streets corridor study, and from…

612
01:32:56.870 --> 01:33:01.859
Mark Helmbrecht: Looking at it, it's… get it up… from Monterey to Sutter.

613
01:33:02.710 --> 01:33:09.269
Mark Helmbrecht: It is… Bike Lane Class 2 is the underlying to the figure.

614
01:33:11.610 --> 01:33:12.670
Mark Helmbrecht: Goodness.

615
01:33:15.380 --> 01:33:22.060
Mark Helmbrecht: And from Monterey to… Gilman…

616
01:33:25.360 --> 01:33:35.759
Mark Helmbrecht: It has a… under… the underlying is Bike Route Class 3, but the whole thing is recommended to look at and study, Class 4 cycle tracks.

617
01:33:37.250 --> 01:33:39.480
Boardroom: Okay, thank you.

618
01:33:40.250 --> 01:33:54.989
Boardroom: So, I did notice that Hopkins was not identified in the Plan Bay Area 2050 Plus as either a priority development area corridor for CycleTrack, or as an equity priority community.

619
01:33:55.020 --> 01:34:03.049
Boardroom: And that the combined 2022 outreach comment density map shows Hopkins received, one of the…

620
01:34:03.200 --> 01:34:22.370

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Boardroom: lower number of public comments during the bike plan process, at least at the time. So, could you broadly explain how this proposal, or these proposals, align with the recently adopted bike plan, the city's broader bicycle network priorities, and other planning documents?

621
01:34:22.440 --> 01:34:40.250
Boardroom: I just, and I will just outright say I support, you know, approving something today, but I'm just trying to understand, the general alignment with the broader vision of where the city is going.

622
01:34:48.060 --> 01:34:50.320
Mark Helmbrecht: Can you ask the question again, Councilmember?

623
01:34:50.450 --> 01:34:52.360
Boardroom: Yeah. Sure.

624
01:34:52.770 --> 01:34:56.610
Boardroom: Easy asking? How does… fine.

625
01:34:57.920 --> 01:35:02.980
Boardroom: how does it… how do these, like, Hopkins, how does,

626
01:35:04.650 --> 01:35:14.440
Boardroom: low-stress bike infrastructure along the Hopkins corridor align with the recently adopted bike plan.

627
01:35:14.820 --> 01:35:17.869
Boardroom: The city's broader bicycle network priorities.

628
01:35:18.020 --> 01:35:23.550
Boardroom: and other planning… documents,

629
01:35:23.870 --> 01:35:34.660
Boardroom: And I will note, the project prioritization corridors in the bike plan appear to prioritize rows ahead of Hopkins in Tier 1 and 2, so I just wanted to try to understand.

630
01:35:35.070 --> 01:35:37.040
Boardroom: How all of this clears.

631
01:35:37.520 --> 01:35:47.840

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Mark Helmbrecht: Yeah, so Hopkins is identified in the 2026 bike plan as, to be studied as part of the low-stress network, so that is

632
01:35:48.110 --> 01:35:50.659
Mark Helmbrecht: in the plan.

633
01:35:51.890 --> 01:36:05.610
Mark Helmbrecht: The Complete Street Studies, typically are looking at both on corridor and adjacent to the corridor. So we do both of those as part of a complete street study when we… we move those forward.

634
01:36:05.650 --> 01:36:20.789
Mark Helmbrecht: You know, the bike plan sees Hopkins as part of the citywide bicycle network, and it shows up on the… on all of the mapping in the bike plan, and so it is looking for

635
01:36:21.890 --> 01:36:24.529
Mark Helmbrecht: cycling infrastructure to be on Hopkins.

636
01:36:25.070 --> 01:36:26.149
Mark Helmbrecht: Is that fair?

637
01:36:29.380 --> 01:36:32.929
Boardroom: Sounds good to me.

638
01:36:35.920 --> 01:36:37.940
Boardroom: I think this,

639
01:36:42.280 --> 01:36:53.139
Boardroom: I think, this next question is for Councilmember Kesarwani. And I appreciate your work on this proposal,

640
01:36:54.140 --> 01:37:11.109
Boardroom: Can you speak to how, in your evaluation of this proposal, we can, ensure convenient access for seniors and people with disabilities, the ones that,

641
01:37:11.260 --> 01:37:17.919
Boardroom: Are not able to depend on, a bike, or able to walk.

642
01:37:18.260 --> 01:37:24.970

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Boardroom: And, as… as part of the,

643
01:37:25.850 --> 01:37:39.870
Boardroom: parking demand management, is… I was just there, I noticed there were some 4-hour, designated parking spots. I was wondering if those are some of the ones, maybe in

644
01:37:40.100 --> 01:37:43.460
Boardroom: Under consideration for a shorter period of time.

645
01:37:44.050 --> 01:38:00.440
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. So, you know, I first want to say, you know, our community is very diverse, and we want to make sure that this plan meets the needs of everyone. And so, to your question about seniors and people with disabilities.

646
01:38:00.520 --> 01:38:07.780
Boardroom: When we develop this comprehensive curb management plan, we want to make sure we have

647
01:38:07.900 --> 01:38:15.530
Boardroom: the adequate ADA parking spaces, close to the shops and, and close to the track,

648
01:38:15.530 --> 01:38:21.240
Boardroom: loading zones… you're not asking about businesses, so I won't get into that, but… but,

649
01:38:21.240 --> 01:38:36.359
Boardroom: we want to make sure that, people with mobility issues can continue to access the commercial district, and part of having the ADA spaces close to the businesses and looking at metering elsewhere

650
01:38:36.420 --> 01:38:59.970
Boardroom: And by the way, when you create the bike lane that's safe, all of a sudden, people who were driving before can now get there without the need to park. So we are expecting that with all of that… Folks, excuse me! No booing, please. …that we will continue to maintain strong access for people with disabilities with the ADA spaces.

651
01:38:59.970 --> 01:39:14.260
Boardroom: And by the way, you know, I go to the Hopkins corridor regularly. I think there is a lack of the ADA spaces right now, and so

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part of what this item will do is make sure that we have that access moving forward.

652
01:39:15.720 --> 01:39:25.089
Boardroom: Thank you. I wanted to ask staff, if…

653
01:39:25.330 --> 01:39:42.810
Boardroom: these proposed designs have been coordinated with AC Transit, or East Bay Paratransit, and if not, that's perfectly fair, because this is a referral. I'm just wondering, at, like, whether…

654
01:39:43.460 --> 01:39:47.679
Boardroom: for something to move forward tonight.

655
01:39:47.970 --> 01:39:50.620
Boardroom: How would that coordination take place?

656
01:39:50.730 --> 01:39:53.090
Boardroom: So, Councilman…

657
01:39:54.400 --> 01:39:55.420
Wahid Amiri: Go for it, Paul.

658
01:39:55.420 --> 01:40:06.659
Boardroom: These proposed designs have not been coordinated with AC Transit yet. Should something move forward, that would be a part of what staff does.

659
01:40:07.830 --> 01:40:18.660
Boardroom: What metrics will the city use to determine whether the project is successful, meets its objectives?

660
01:40:19.260 --> 01:40:25.399
Boardroom: Following implementation, shorter term and longer.

661
01:40:26.910 --> 01:40:40.449
Wahid Amiri: So, similar to how we track and gauge other CIPs and projects, Councilmember, we'll do pre- and post-studies. Although we don't have, great data currently, we have data from a few years ago.

662
01:40:40.500 --> 01:40:56.989

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Wahid Amiri: As part of the process, we will do our best to gather information, do the curbside parking management analysis, along with other engineering and operational studies, and then from there, we can set our metrics. And we will do a post-analysis, similar to

663
01:40:56.990 --> 01:41:05.680
Wahid Amiri: what we're planning to do for Marin, Adeline, other areas that we've brought in safety measures or infrastructure to see what we've done good.

664
01:41:05.820 --> 01:41:13.720
Wahid Amiri: where things we need to tweak for the future, so we have a good lesson learned type of a protocol. So that's how we'll address that.

665
01:41:15.170 --> 01:41:18.889
Boardroom: Thank you. Almost done.

666
01:41:19.060 --> 01:41:38.200
Boardroom: Between 2011 and 2026, the report states that there were 46 pedestrian and bicycle crashes along the Hopkins corridor, resulting in 3 fatalities, 5 suspected serious injuries, 20 suspected minor injuries, 13 possible injuries, and 5 unspecified injuries.

667
01:41:38.320 --> 01:41:44.980
Boardroom: Could staff explain what is meant by those injury classifications and how they're determined?

668
01:41:46.850 --> 01:41:54.129
Wahid Amiri: Good question. Mark and I were looking at this a few minutes ago, so I'll hand it over to him. He'll, he'll yield this question.

669
01:42:04.240 --> 01:42:06.480
Mark Helmbrecht: There we go.

670
01:42:09.170 --> 01:42:25.489
Mark Helmbrecht: Those are determined by Berkeley Police Department. So, as part of their crash analysis and doing police reports associated with crashes, they characterize the results of those crashes, and they get loaded up, into sweaters.

671
01:42:25.490 --> 01:42:30.459
Mark Helmbrecht: And then end up on the, Berkeley Police Transparency Hub.

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672
01:42:31.760 --> 01:42:34.230
Boardroom: Okay.

673
01:42:34.650 --> 01:42:40.409
Boardroom: I think those are all my questions. Thank you. Thank you very much. Vice Mayor O'Keefe?

674
01:42:40.830 --> 01:42:46.579
Boardroom: How did I become next? Thank you. Did you have questions? Yeah, of course. Just a couple.

675
01:42:46.680 --> 01:43:00.379
Boardroom: Thank you so much, all of you, for being here. My first… a couple of them were, already asked by Councilmember Tigu, so I appreciate that. For, Interim Director Amiri,

676
01:43:01.410 --> 01:43:10.420
Boardroom: Have you, consulted the Zero Waste Department, and are there any concerns regarding, how a garbage truck might access the…

677
01:43:10.520 --> 01:43:13.510
Boardroom: plan the, Councilmember Councillor Wadi's item.

678
01:43:14.000 --> 01:43:16.519
Wahid Amiri: Yes, we have. As part of the…

679
01:43:17.220 --> 01:43:23.240
Wahid Amiri: assessment, I did touch base with our Zero Waste leadership, and

680
01:43:24.140 --> 01:43:29.420
Wahid Amiri: With the separated cycle track, we envision that we'll have

681
01:43:29.760 --> 01:43:35.920
Wahid Amiri: 10 and a half, or at some locations with wider crypto curb allowance, we'll have 11 feet travel lanes.

682
01:43:36.200 --> 01:43:42.750
Wahid Amiri: As I've said before, it… it allows us, for vehicles, for throughput.

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683
01:43:43.140 --> 01:43:56.619
Wahid Amiri: Again, sometimes calculated depending on, you know, if it's a bus next to a zero-waste vehicle or a fire truck, so it will have to be calculated movement. But operationally, there are challenges.

684
01:43:56.850 --> 01:44:11.979
Wahid Amiri: Throughput is one thing, but to be able to use our vehicles and our operation, we do need to look at that in a deeper fashion during detailed design. So, we know there are going to be challenges.

685
01:44:12.190 --> 01:44:19.330
Wahid Amiri: But the specific challenges haven't been identified. All we know is that there will be operational challenges.

686
01:44:19.930 --> 01:44:31.360
Boardroom: So, just to make sure I understand you, is it… are you saying that there could be challenges if a bus happened to come in one direction while the garbage truck was on the street?

687
01:44:32.100 --> 01:44:42.390
Wahid Amiri: Given the lane dimension, they would have to maneuver in a calculated manner, just to make sure that there's no issue. So, again, we do feel it's safer

688
01:44:42.530 --> 01:44:52.869
Wahid Amiri: 10 and a half feet to some areas of 11 feet wide is much safer than the original 10 that we were seeing flying around the community in some designs. But nevertheless.

689
01:44:52.920 --> 01:45:06.649
Wahid Amiri: some chassis and some of the larger vehicles, with the side mirrors, they go a little bit above and beyond 10 feet. So, yes, depending on the driver, the skill sets, the environment.

690
01:45:06.650 --> 01:45:08.119
Boardroom: It, it will…

691
01:45:08.120 --> 01:45:12.289
Wahid Amiri: It requires some level of calculations, you know, maneuvering past each other.

692

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01:45:12.950 --> 01:45:24.619
Boardroom: Great, thank you very much. And I wanted to say, Director Amiri, that I know, I understand it's really… we're going to ask you a lot of really detailed questions, and I just want to say, just to acknowledge for you and for the public, that

693
01:45:24.760 --> 01:45:42.380
Boardroom: they have not done detailed design drawings, and so it is very difficult to answer these questions, and so I just want to say I really appreciate you doing your best to give us the information that you can, but I understand that it's hard until you've done the detailed drawings that you cannot do until we give you direction, so I appreciate you working with us.

694
01:45:42.600 --> 01:45:55.199
Boardroom: So, next question. Has there been any sort of parking study or analysis of how the parking lots might affect, the merchants or access to the facilities at the park?

695
01:45:56.140 --> 01:46:12.849
Wahid Amiri: We have not done that assessment. That will be part of the curbside management assessment and outreach that hopefully will be part of whatever option Council directs us to pursue. But we have conducted visual, conceptual, based on site visits, just to

696
01:46:12.960 --> 01:46:17.679
Wahid Amiri: Again, get a better understanding between the…

697
01:46:17.800 --> 01:46:30.960
Wahid Amiri: one-sided south side, dual cycle track compared to separated cycle track, what that means, and between the two, given the framework that protected bike lanes is the driving criteria.

698
01:46:31.170 --> 01:46:47.370
Wahid Amiri: what design would save the most curbside parking? That we have done on a conceptual level, but to your question, Councilmember, we have not done any detailed walking, talking, and actual simulation or any engineering assessment for anything further.

699
01:46:47.440 --> 01:46:53.959
Wahid Amiri: That will be part of it. Once we get direction, then absolutely, we will go through the motions.

700
01:46:53.960 --> 01:47:08.660

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Boardroom: Of course, yeah, thank you, but you just wanted to clarify, you don't have that, and this isn't a criticism, just trying to understand what we know and what we don't know. You, you don't yet know how the parking loss… you know what the parking loss would be approximately, but you don't know how it would affect the area. Is that correct?

701
01:47:08.790 --> 01:47:25.430
Wahid Amiri: Okay. Because we have not done outreach to any of the businesses. Again, our assessment and high-level conceptual feedback was just based on eyeballing it, making some measurements, because we had a lot of requests, and we were doing our best to be able to give some conceptual feedback in a timely manner.

702
01:47:25.430 --> 01:47:28.010
Boardroom: Yeah, you're doing your best. I understand. Once again, it's not a criticism that you don't have.

703
01:47:28.010 --> 01:47:28.640
Wahid Amiri: Understood.

704
01:47:28.640 --> 01:47:32.729
Boardroom: establish it, yeah. So thank you very much.

705
01:47:32.870 --> 01:47:35.880
Boardroom: Changing topics a little bit,

706
01:47:35.920 --> 01:47:54.129
Boardroom: Regarding, you know, I mentioned bicycle boulevards in my presentation. Could you say, just, you know, in a most general sense, what types of… if you were to develop rows as a bicycle boulevard, what types of interventions would that typically entail? I'm not asking for a recommendation officially, just what would it look like?

707
01:47:55.310 --> 01:48:10.650
Wahid Amiri: In terms… and I'll… I'll defer this to our bicycle guru, Mark Helenberg, but in terms of bicycle Boulevard or protected bike lanes that… that will drive how we answer the question, Councilmember.

708
01:48:10.650 --> 01:48:27.269
Boardroom: I guess I'm wondering, if you were to follow the direction in my supplemental, which says, go forward with the, recommendation in the bike plan to turn Rose into a bicycle boulevard, what would that look like on a general high level?

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709
01:48:27.270 --> 01:48:33.440
Wahid Amiri: Sure, I'll hand it over to Mark, but just in general, obviously, we'll look at vertical deflection for traffic calming.

710
01:48:33.440 --> 01:48:34.970
Boardroom: Sorry, what is vertical defection?

711
01:48:34.970 --> 01:48:41.119
Wahid Amiri: But our, speed cushions that is, you know, part of our toolbox now, which, again.

712
01:48:41.200 --> 01:48:57.399
Wahid Amiri: it's spaced out, and we've done some live test runs with our colleagues at the fire department to make sure that it's more friendlier to the fire engines and BC transit. And then from there, we'll also lower the speed limits. There's other traffic calming measures that we have in our toolbox that

713
01:48:57.450 --> 01:49:11.560
Wahid Amiri: we would implement along the corridor to make sure that it qualifies and the conditions for a successful bicycle boulevard is present. With that, I'm going to also hand it to our bicycle guru, as I said, Mark Helmbrick, if he wants to add anything else.

714
01:49:11.920 --> 01:49:12.440
Wahid Amiri: No.

715
01:49:12.440 --> 01:49:14.210
Mark Helmbrecht: That's exactly right, Wahid.

716
01:49:14.760 --> 01:49:20.989
Mark Helmbrecht: The other thing is the current volume on rows is above the volume that we

717
01:49:21.240 --> 01:49:35.580
Mark Helmbrecht: try to achieve on bicycle boulevards, so we would likely have diverters, at least one, somewhere along rows, to lower the total volume of traffic, along rows. And like Wahid was saying, we need to bring the speeds down slightly.

718
01:49:35.580 --> 01:49:42.219

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Mark Helmbrecht: And then we'd be looking at, options under AB43 to potentially, lower the speed limit, so…

719
01:49:42.650 --> 01:49:45.420
Boardroom: Great, so slower traffic and a lot less of it.

720
01:49:45.990 --> 01:49:47.099
Boardroom: Great, thank you.

721
01:49:47.100 --> 01:49:48.490
Wahid Amiri: That is the goal.

722
01:49:48.490 --> 01:49:51.659
Boardroom: Yes. Always.

723
01:49:52.280 --> 01:50:10.830
Boardroom: What is… and, I'm asking you this question because I believe you've already done this calculation, otherwise I wouldn't put you on the spot with this, but what is the approximate… and once again, I know that your cost… you can say your disclaimer if you need to, but I know your cost estimates are very, very…

724
01:50:11.070 --> 01:50:29.380
Boardroom: general and your best guess, and they could change, so I do understand that, but given that, what is the approximate cost differential between, my supplemental, which just has, a Class 2 painted bike lane from Sutter to McGee, and then Sharro's from McGee to San Pablo,

725
01:50:29.540 --> 01:50:33.340
Boardroom: versus Kessarwani's item? What is the cost differential there?

726
01:50:36.260 --> 01:50:42.309
Wahid Amiri: Right off the top of my head, that's 3…

727
01:50:42.510 --> 01:50:50.339
Wahid Amiri: It'll be close to $5, $5, $6 million between the two. And that, again, is for this, concrete separation.

728
01:50:50.680 --> 01:51:08.199
Wahid Amiri: And some other miscellaneous. And again, between both of those, I'm taking out the placemaking element as well, as part of that.

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The GI is consistent, no matter… GI, meaning the green infrastructure needs, is consistent and is mandatory, no matter what alternative Council directs us to pursue.

729
01:51:08.200 --> 01:51:10.019
Boardroom: Right, it's a matter of state law, is that correct?

730
01:51:10.020 --> 01:51:12.500
Wahid Amiri: Yes, it's per our permit.

731
01:51:12.670 --> 01:51:15.839
Wahid Amiri: And that's something that, it's a mandatory.

732
01:51:15.840 --> 01:51:18.010
Boardroom: It is good for the environment, so it's not…

733
01:51:18.010 --> 01:51:18.560
Wahid Amiri: So…

734
01:51:18.560 --> 01:51:21.880
Boardroom: We don't have to be so sad about it, but it is expensive.

735
01:51:21.880 --> 01:51:23.220
Wahid Amiri: Expensive, but good.

736
01:51:23.220 --> 01:51:37.900
Boardroom: Yes, great. Councilmember, can I just ask how many more questions you have? I know there are many children, and I'd like to get to their comments. Two. Okay. And I appreciate your indulgence, because this is, as you know, this is my district, so I do actually have more questions, but I've chosen just these ones.

737
01:51:37.960 --> 01:51:50.200
Boardroom: So, second to last question, do you have any data on, bike usage around the city, or specifically in this area? Does Public Works keep track of that?

738
01:51:51.210 --> 01:52:00.839
Wahid Amiri: We have some data from 2022 that Mark analyzed, so I'm gonna hand it over to him. I believe our consultant at the time

739

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01:52:01.030 --> 01:52:08.529
Wahid Amiri: Analyzed an intersection for bicyclists, vehicles, and also pedestrians, so…

740
01:52:08.650 --> 01:52:11.689
Wahid Amiri: With that, I'm gonna hand it to Mark to give you the numbers.

741
01:52:19.710 --> 01:52:30.080
Mark Helmbrecht: informal, questions. The… 2022… Analysis included,

742
01:52:32.020 --> 01:52:43.370
Mark Helmbrecht: Traffic counts, and pedestrian counts, and bicycle counts at Monterey and Hopkins performed by the consultant Parametrics.

743
01:52:43.620 --> 01:52:44.670
Mark Helmbrecht: And…

744
01:52:45.490 --> 01:52:51.780
Mark Helmbrecht: At that time, they took both weekday and weekend counts. They had a Tuesday, Thursday, and a Saturday count.

745
01:52:51.880 --> 01:52:55.489
Mark Helmbrecht: Smooshing those kind of numbers together.

746
01:52:55.690 --> 01:52:57.520
Mark Helmbrecht: Roughly, the numbers were…

747
01:52:57.800 --> 01:53:02.990
Mark Helmbrecht: And these were 12-hour counts, so 7 a.m. in the morning till 7 o'clock at night, roughly

748
01:53:03.440 --> 01:53:05.380
Mark Helmbrecht: 300 bicyclists a day.

749
01:53:05.990 --> 01:53:10.060
Mark Helmbrecht: Roughly… 3,000 pedestrians a day.

750
01:53:10.570 --> 01:53:17.480
Mark Helmbrecht: during those 12-hour periods, and 8,500 vehicles during that period. So those were…

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751
01:53:18.340 --> 01:53:21.180
Mark Helmbrecht: The gross numbers kind of, like, synopsis.

752
01:53:22.370 --> 01:53:25.390
Mark Helmbrecht: Other than that, there's older counts,

753
01:53:26.010 --> 01:53:35.040
Mark Helmbrecht: down at Sacramento that had average daily traffic around 8,500, so… Fairly consistent there.

754
01:53:35.280 --> 01:53:39.729
Mark Helmbrecht: And then it… the counts and the data get older and older, so…

755
01:53:40.370 --> 01:53:42.499
Mark Helmbrecht: I don't… I don't want to go too far afield.

756
01:53:43.730 --> 01:53:58.060
Boardroom: And what about, this is related to the first question, I was curious about that, and also, do you keep track of how much our other bicycle infrastructure is utilized? Like, for instance, when we, like, the bike lane on Milvia, or the bike lane on, Bancroft?

757
01:53:58.060 --> 01:54:04.140
Boardroom: Do you keep track of that? I don't need a full accounting, I'm just curious if you have some general numbers that you could share with us.

758
01:54:05.020 --> 01:54:05.350
Mark Helmbrecht: I…

759
01:54:05.350 --> 01:54:06.219
Wahid Amiri: Don't have…

760
01:54:06.220 --> 01:54:09.479
Mark Helmbrecht: those off the top of my head. I know we have some data sets that…

761
01:54:09.480 --> 01:54:10.910
Wahid Amiri: Are collected by the…

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762
01:54:10.910 --> 01:54:13.240
Mark Helmbrecht: Sorry, go ahead.

763
01:54:13.360 --> 01:54:14.800
Boardroom: Go ahead,

764
01:54:14.800 --> 01:54:24.690
Mark Helmbrecht: There's a professor at UC Berkeley that takes a… has a class that takes annual bike counts, and we have… we have those. I can share those data with, Council. I don't have those at my fingertips.

765
01:54:25.040 --> 01:54:25.690
Boardroom: Okay.

766
01:54:25.690 --> 01:54:39.489
Wahid Amiri: But we are looking at infrastructure, because that's something I've heard many times, and I know funding is tight, but, for example, at the Delaware Crossing, that we implemented the race crosswalks and the auto detection.

767
01:54:39.490 --> 01:54:47.910
Wahid Amiri: we were looking to see if we can get counters as well, too, so… but that's something that Public Works is looking into when funding is available. So it's similar to how

768
01:54:47.910 --> 01:55:05.579
Wahid Amiri: We're looking where we can improve as far as our safety projects, our CIP, pre- and post-implementation. We would like to, as part of any future project, to be able to collect the data, so that way we have data and facts to talk about, and not assumptions and predictions.

769
01:55:05.760 --> 01:55:24.699
Boardroom: That would be… yeah, I support that. Not to get too editorial right now, but that's wonderful. I wish we had more data. And once again, not a criticism, I'm glad you're working on it. Okay, and last question. Have we ever removed all of the parking from such a long segment of any road in Berkeley before?

770
01:55:26.030 --> 01:55:30.610
Wahid Amiri: Not that I have read on or experienced.

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771
01:55:32.040 --> 01:55:37.609
Wahid Amiri: I think the closest is Dana and Milbius, from what I can recall.

772
01:55:38.110 --> 01:55:40.539
Boardroom: How long a segment is that?

773
01:55:43.020 --> 01:55:44.399
Wahid Amiri: Mark, do you know?

774
01:55:45.920 --> 01:55:46.759
Wahid Amiri: I don't know.

775
01:55:46.760 --> 01:55:48.989
Boardroom: Is it, like, one block, or 4 blocks?

776
01:55:48.990 --> 01:55:56.010
Mark Helmbrecht: Moving once, all along Berkeley High, essentially, although there's, you know, bus stops in there.

777
01:55:57.110 --> 01:56:03.030
Mark Helmbrecht: And then the Dana… runs, essentially, Bancroft to… Dwight?

778
01:56:06.200 --> 01:56:08.119
Boardroom: And you removed all the parking from that?

779
01:56:09.530 --> 01:56:16.569
Boardroom: Durant or Dwight? That's a two-block difference. Anyway, it's okay, I don't, we don't need to get into the details too much, but,

780
01:56:16.790 --> 01:56:22.460
Boardroom: I was just curious if we had any experience with this type of… this type of change. It seems… it seems…

781
01:56:23.060 --> 01:56:27.639
Boardroom: very dramatic to me, so I was curious about that. I will,

782
01:56:27.890 --> 01:56:47.369

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Boardroom: I do have another minute left, so if I think of any more questions, I might flag you down, but for now, I can stop. Okay, thank you. So, I do want to take a pause on our questions and allow our younger members of the audience, we've got some children here, to give their public comments so that they can go and have bedtime. So, if you have a small child.

783
01:56:47.370 --> 01:56:52.309
Boardroom: Please come up to give your public comment.

784
01:56:52.310 --> 01:57:13.180
Boardroom: And there are some children that are also outside, so I'm hoping that we can have them give their public comment, you can cycle out, other folks can give their public comments. And another thing I want to say is that, we have so many speakers here this evening, we are going to limit our public comment to 3 hours. That will be 2 hours in person and 1 hour online.

785
01:57:13.180 --> 01:57:19.139
Boardroom: So, if you are here with a child and would like to give a public comment, please come up.

786
01:57:20.040 --> 01:57:23.739
Boardroom: And then we will come back, and Councilmember Blackaby, you are first for questions.

787
01:57:32.090 --> 01:57:33.719
Boardroom: Come on up, whenever you're ready.

788
01:57:37.060 --> 01:58:00.840
Boardroom: Hi there. My name is Justin McAdams, I'm a resident in the neighborhood up near North Berkeley Bart. This is my daughter, Natalie, she's 7. Natalie goes to Ruth Actee Elementary, she will go to King Middle. She grew up in Berkeley, she learned to ride her bike here. We love to ride our bike all over, North Berkeley and elsewhere. We take the Greenway up to Solano Avenue.

789
01:58:00.850 --> 01:58:14.539
Boardroom: down to Strawberry Creek Park. But one area that we would love to go that I won't let Natalie ride her bike to is up to the North Branch Library. We're there at least once a week, and every time we go there, we have to drive.

790
01:58:14.560 --> 01:58:26.239

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Boardroom: It is really scary riding a bike up Hopkins. If we do that, she… I make her ride on the sidewalk, or I ride in the middle of the street, because drivers there are not safe.

791
01:58:26.290 --> 01:58:38.270
Boardroom: It is very scary, and so we ask the Council to vote yes on, Councilman Kesarwani's, proposal. Thank you very much. Thank you.

792
01:58:43.440 --> 01:58:44.440
Boardroom: That wipes!

793
01:58:48.570 --> 01:59:12.579
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Naomi Schiffman, this is Dahlia. We live in Westbrae, and one of the reasons I was so excited to live and be able to raise our family in Berkeley is for the bikeability, for the accessibility, and it's just been heartbreaking over the past 8 years to watch as we have just been unable to implement this plan.

794
01:59:12.580 --> 01:59:25.050
Boardroom: for so many reasons, it feels like bureaucratic warfare at this point, nope, to reopen this, and to continue doing more studies, and more thinking, and more debating, like, we've done it.

795
01:59:25.180 --> 01:59:34.120
Boardroom: We've done it, we've had the conversations, let's just implement this and move on. Thank you. Thank you.

796
01:59:36.530 --> 01:59:40.790
Boardroom: Shh, folks, please!

797
01:59:41.310 --> 01:59:49.419
Boardroom: Excuse me, that's really inappropriate. You're yelling at a small child. Go ahead.

798
01:59:49.840 --> 02:00:00.049
Boardroom: Hi. So, a lot of us are here tonight for a very simple reason. We want our kids to be able to get to school and to move around the city safely and independently.

799
02:00:00.370 --> 02:00:04.500
Boardroom: And we think that that matters more than maximizing street parking.

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800
02:00:04.500 --> 02:00:29.460
Boardroom: I'm thinking, of course, about my kids, but also about the kids in West Berkeley and South Berkeley, who a few years ago might have gone to Longfellow, but because of our progressive values, we now force them to go to MLK. We are progressive enough to make them go across town. Does that progressivism end, as it so often does when a driver is inconvenienced? Rose Street is not an alternative. It is too steep. It is a cut-through between SAC and MLK, and it is busiest

801
02:00:29.460 --> 02:00:52.299
Boardroom: Right when people are going to and from school. It is not an alternative, it is an excuse. And it is identical to doing nothing, and it should be rejected. We also want our kids to grow up in a world with a stable climate. You know that transportation emissions are the number one source of climate emissions in Berkeley. Some of you have built your whole careers and identities, around climate change. So, I'm out of time. Do the right thing. Thanks. Thank you.

802
02:01:00.230 --> 02:01:10.909
Boardroom: Hi, council members. My name is Daniel Cheng. I go to the Evangel Bible Church of Berkeley on, Hopkins and Ordway, and my daughter, Evelyn, who's 9, she has a few words to say.

803
02:01:11.650 --> 02:01:17.820
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Evelyn, and my family and I attend Evangel Bible Church of Berkeley on Hopkins Street.

804
02:01:18.700 --> 02:01:34.519
Boardroom: If you build a bike lane on Hopkins Street, then all of our parking in front of church will be gone. The moms at the church will need to carry their babies for blocks, and it will be tiring for them. Please vote no for bike lanes on Hopkins Street. Thank you for your time.

805
02:01:35.870 --> 02:01:36.960
Boardroom: Thank you.

806
02:01:50.530 --> 02:02:03.020
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Chris. I've been a resident of Berkeley for 15 years. My daughters are three and a half and one and a half, and I expect they'll probably be walking and biking to school before I'm ready for it.

807
02:02:03.480 --> 02:02:11.180
Boardroom: I've spoken in support of Hopkins safety improvements in the past, and now it's more important to me than ever before.

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808
02:02:11.440 --> 02:02:14.939
Boardroom: Hopkins is a direct route for students to get to middle school.

809
02:02:15.020 --> 02:02:25.180
Boardroom: I appreciate all the work that's gone into these proposals and supplementals, but I want to stress that sharrows and bypass routes, like Rose, are steep climbs.

810
02:02:25.180 --> 02:02:41.779
Boardroom: and cannot be made safe. They do not protect our most vulnerable road users. It's disingenuous to say that Rose Street is a real alternative. It cannot be made safe for children without physically separated infrastructure and removal of parking. Please, quote-unquote, save Hopkins.

811
02:02:41.780 --> 02:02:54.800
Boardroom: by taking sensible action to prevent further injury and death. Do not let children trying to get to school become a statistic because you voted to prioritize parking over truly safe road improvements. Thank you. Thanks so much.

812
02:02:59.560 --> 02:03:09.040
Boardroom: Nice catch, Liza. Hi, my name is Sonia Trous. Hopkins Street is more than 30 feet wide. There's enough room for parking.

813
02:03:09.140 --> 02:03:20.960
Boardroom: and a bike lane, and one lane of car traffic. People going the other direction make it one way. People going other direction can go on Rose Street. That's a street.

814
02:03:20.960 --> 02:03:40.889
Boardroom: I know that people don't want, like, a new, different plan, but I think the most realistic plan is something that gives everybody what they want, right? You're hearing a lot of, like, we need parking, we need a bike lane. There is room for both. And going forward, we should be replacing, car, moving cars with moving bikes.

815
02:03:40.890 --> 02:03:47.270
Boardroom: Nobody ever got hit by a parked car. The parked cars are not the problem. It's moving cars. So…

816

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02:03:47.270 --> 02:04:06.140
Boardroom: We say our budget is an expression of our values. Our road budget is also an expression of our values. We want people to be going in bikes, not going in cars. Take lanes away for moving cars, give those lanes to moving bikes. We could even wind up with more parking. Okay, thank you. Thank you.

817
02:04:15.630 --> 02:04:23.639
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Oscar. I am, 15 years old, going into sophomore year at Berkeley High.

818
02:04:23.830 --> 02:04:26.830
Boardroom: And I just wanted to come up here to say a couple words.

819
02:04:27.050 --> 02:04:33.110
Boardroom: First of all, I've been biking to school since…

820
02:04:33.520 --> 02:04:36.570
Boardroom: 6th grade, I went to Longfellow.

821
02:04:36.830 --> 02:04:38.410
Boardroom: But,

822
02:04:41.610 --> 02:04:45.209
Boardroom: Something I wanted to say was that…

823
02:04:46.320 --> 02:04:56.160
Boardroom: There's many bike lanes in Berkeley, but a lot of them are Just, like, next to… Parking spots?

824
02:04:56.260 --> 02:05:00.670
Boardroom: And something I've always, grown up, like, learning, and, like.

825
02:05:01.230 --> 02:05:09.969
Boardroom: being aware of is that someone can open the door, and you could get hit, by the car door. This has happened to me, like.

826
02:05:10.090 --> 02:05:14.310
Boardroom: 2 to 3 times, and…

827

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02:05:16.800 --> 02:05:21.750
Boardroom: Yeah. Do you… oh, that's okay, did you need more time? Okay, thank you.

828
02:05:32.560 --> 02:05:36.120
Boardroom: So, my name is Finn.

829
02:05:36.480 --> 02:05:40.529
Boardroom: I go to Ruth Act Elementary, and…

830
02:05:40.710 --> 02:05:45.050
Boardroom: Oftentimes, me and my friends after school walk to, like.

831
02:05:45.160 --> 02:05:47.809
Boardroom: Rocks or coals or something, and…

832
02:05:48.070 --> 02:05:54.899
Boardroom: It'd be nice if we could bike there, because it would make it a lot faster and a lot easier to get there, but since there's no bike lanes…

833
02:05:55.040 --> 02:05:56.760
Boardroom: We can't really do that.

834
02:05:57.230 --> 02:06:05.179
Boardroom: And, like… A lot of people have gotten injured while they're biking, or died because…

835
02:06:05.340 --> 02:06:11.490
Boardroom: They were biking, and there's not a bike path, and a car comes and hits them, and…

836
02:06:13.210 --> 02:06:15.050
Boardroom: That seems bad.

837
02:06:17.090 --> 02:06:18.480
Boardroom: You?

838
02:06:23.320 --> 02:06:25.399
Boardroom: Okay, do we miss any children?

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839
02:06:27.850 --> 02:06:43.009
Boardroom: I do not see any. Okay, I think we had those who were outside come in as well. Alright, so we are gonna take a 10… actually, let's make it a… we're gonna take a 15-minute break, and we're gonna come back and do questions, from the council members. Thanks, everyone.

840
02:06:47.300 --> 02:07:01.179
Boardroom: Okay, if you can hear me clap once! If you can hear me clap twice! If you can hear me clap three times!

841
02:07:02.700 --> 02:07:07.260
Boardroom: Okay, everyone, please take your seats!

842
02:07:07.610 --> 02:07:21.049
Boardroom: Please finish your conversations or take them outside. Thank you so much. Okay, thank you very much for your patience. We are gonna go back to Councilmember questions with Councilmember Blackaby.

843
02:07:21.050 --> 02:07:26.330
Brent Blackaby: Great. Thank you, Madam Mayor. I hope it won't take the full 5 minutes. Is Chief Sprague still on?

844
02:07:27.660 --> 02:07:28.160
David Sprague: Yes.

845
02:07:28.530 --> 02:07:32.039
Brent Blackaby: Chief, so just to re-up on the fire review part.

846
02:07:32.040 --> 02:07:34.419
Boardroom: Alright, so, folks, please!

847
02:07:34.750 --> 02:07:40.349
Brent Blackaby: What are the next steps for FHIRE's review of this current alternative on the table?

848
02:07:41.600 --> 02:07:47.460
David Sprague: The next steps would occur once Public Works gets us a full, design set.

849
02:07:47.650 --> 02:07:54.400

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David Sprague: And at that point, we would evaluate 3 things, 3 primary things. One is emergency vehicle turning movements.

850
02:07:54.850 --> 02:08:07.270
David Sprague: We'd analyze potential impacts to evacuation time, and we'd confirm that the design maintains workable access for day-to-day fire and medical emergencies, on and immediately adjacent to Hopkins.

851
02:08:07.460 --> 02:08:14.959
Brent Blackaby: Okay, so it's evacuation from, like, catastrophic and then day-to-day emergency access, so it's kind of that full gamut.

852
02:08:15.550 --> 02:08:16.290
David Sprague: Right.

853
02:08:16.290 --> 02:08:20.700
Brent Blackaby: Okay, and how long might that process take to do that review study?

854
02:08:20.700 --> 02:08:26.559
David Sprague: I… It'd be between 2 and 4 weeks, depending on complexity.

855
02:08:26.930 --> 02:08:36.160
Brent Blackaby: And what happens if we reach a gotcha, if something doesn't work, if you can't approve it, what happens? You come back to us? Just… what's… what happens if it doesn't pass?

856
02:08:36.160 --> 02:08:46.529
David Sprague: The normal process is that staff from FIRE and Public Works, communicate and coordinate on these things, every, you know, every time one of these projects goes through the process.

857
02:08:46.590 --> 02:08:53.320
David Sprague: And, normally they're able to make modifications to the design to,

858
02:08:53.320 --> 02:09:10.739
David Sprague: to, be able to prove it through the process. So, like, one of the… one of the kind of fatal… fatal things would be if we couldn't get the lanes to, 11 preferred or 10 and a half minimum for short distances. That… that could be something where we would have a substantial problem, but…

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859
02:09:10.850 --> 02:09:17.290
David Sprague: Outside of that, generally staff can work together to, come to a,

860
02:09:17.410 --> 02:09:21.110
David Sprague: A design set that works for, all users.

861
02:09:21.280 --> 02:09:40.580
Brent Blackaby: Okay, thank you. To Public Works team, can I ask a little bit about the loading zone kind of issue? So, on the segment of… again, in the current plan, where the cycle track might be on both sides of the street, if you've got amenities like King Pool, King Track, schools, libraries, all that kind of stuff.

862
02:09:40.640 --> 02:09:44.969
Brent Blackaby: What happens with loading zones in those areas? How does that work in conjunction with

863
02:09:45.060 --> 02:09:50.250
Brent Blackaby: Car traffic with the protected bike lanes, how do we accommodate all that?

864
02:09:50.890 --> 02:10:08.060
Wahid Amiri: So, it depends. If there's, in the areas or blocks that have 36 feet curb to curb, obviously, if we have to implement protective bicycle lanes, it removes the curbside parking, but there's other areas, this corridor.

865
02:10:08.340 --> 02:10:11.240
Wahid Amiri: Changes roadway width 3-4 times.

866
02:10:11.410 --> 02:10:22.820
Wahid Amiri: And areas that are 41 feet, which is, again, in the McGee area, in the Monterey, we can, depending on what directions we get from Council, we can look at

867
02:10:23.390 --> 02:10:42.710
Wahid Amiri: what that means as far as protected bike lanes and travel lanes. Getting to the wider sections, we can design one side, and that's in segments that are about 45 to 46 feet in width. We can permit one side, again, floating.

868

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02:10:42.780 --> 02:10:47.800
Wahid Amiri: With protected bike lanes, But to your point, Councilmember.

869
02:10:47.930 --> 02:10:57.079
Wahid Amiri: for loading needs, etc, we would have to look at side streets as well, too. I… when we were out there a couple of times, we did observe that

870
02:10:57.290 --> 02:11:03.299
Wahid Amiri: The Monterey Market has a few really large delivery vehicles that belong to them.

871
02:11:03.540 --> 02:11:18.170
Wahid Amiri: That is already parked on the side streets. So, given that once we restrict or remove parking, and we are able to only allow floating, parking at specific segments that we have.

872
02:11:18.400 --> 02:11:34.820
Wahid Amiri: the geometry to allow it safely, parking becomes scarce, right? So we have to take into account, near Kingpool, there's already ADA stalls, and we have actually one or two more that have been requested a while back that we'll need to implement, so that itself

873
02:11:35.080 --> 02:11:41.599
Wahid Amiri: requires wider buffer to meet ADA requirements, and additional curb cuts, depending on where

874
02:11:41.670 --> 02:11:57.860
Wahid Amiri: the layout of that specific ADA stall is implemented. So, to your question, we would really have to look hard and be strategic as far as side streets. And that, again, as part of the curbside management plan, we'll also look at metering.

875
02:11:57.870 --> 02:12:09.430
Wahid Amiri: to make sure that we have sufficient turnaround for businesses and so forth. So, again, all of that will be taken into account, once we get direction and we implement the curbside management, plan.

876
02:12:09.900 --> 02:12:15.250
Brent Blackaby: Okay. Because I'm thinking beyond even the commercial piece, the… the pool…

877

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02:12:15.580 --> 02:12:22.950
Brent Blackaby: tennis courts, birthday parties in the park, all of the Saturday-Sunday traffic with

878
02:12:23.260 --> 02:12:28.780
Brent Blackaby: soccer and sporting events and stuff at the, you know, at the, at the park.

879
02:12:29.330 --> 02:12:37.680
Brent Blackaby: with no parking, it's like you're gonna have even more loading, unloading, I think, than you do now. Because right now, parents come and park and whatever, leave their kid or do their stuff.

880
02:12:37.680 --> 02:12:50.250
Brent Blackaby: Now, if we're removing or reducing parking, we're gonna have… anyway, that just, to me, feels like an issue that we're gonna have to think through a lot, and there's parts of that long block along King Pool. There are not side streets.

881
02:12:50.420 --> 02:12:52.959
Brent Blackaby: Right, it's like, you have a long, extended life.

882
02:12:52.960 --> 02:12:59.430
Boardroom: Sorry, can you keep to your questions, please, just so we can move on to our public comment, if you have more questions?

883
02:13:00.590 --> 02:13:06.149
Boardroom: since you're making some statements right now, so I'm asking if you can keep that to the comment period.

884
02:13:08.060 --> 02:13:12.810
Brent Blackaby: I was asking for feedback on whether or not that How will we accommodate that?

885
02:13:13.650 --> 02:13:25.290
Wahid Amiri: Yeah, we would have to try to look at side streets, Councilmember. To your point, yes, towards the Kingpool area. Again, as I mentioned, there's already 2 to 3 ADA stalls that are going in there.

886
02:13:25.290 --> 02:13:38.620
Wahid Amiri: Space is going to be limited, so our only option is to look at the side streets once we get into curbside management and outreach to discuss the business needs and frequencies and so forth.

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887
02:13:38.980 --> 02:13:53.920
Brent Blackaby: Okay, thank you. On the parking piece, I think we received update from staff, I just want to make sure this is still accurate. Roughly 274 or so spaces along the whole Hopkins Strip, parking slots currently.

888
02:13:54.070 --> 02:14:08.299
Brent Blackaby: And in the current plan, we'd be losing about 145 of those. Again, it's order of magnitude, it's not perfect. As Councilmember O'Keefe said, we know you haven't done the detailed work, but that feels… so that's about a little more than half of the parking sort of goes away in… with this plan.

889
02:14:08.640 --> 02:14:11.650
Brent Blackaby: Yes. Order of magnitude. Okay.

890
02:14:11.650 --> 02:14:16.239
Wahid Amiri: And that's not taking it to Stanage. If we're going to Stanage.

891
02:14:16.390 --> 02:14:21.290
Wahid Amiri: Based on the supplement I heard earlier, that adds another 47, just to be clear.

892
02:14:21.490 --> 02:14:34.200
Brent Blackaby: Okay, so maybe it goes from 145 to 190, or 192, or something. Thank you. Councilmember O'Keefe, if we go with your plan on the Cycle 2 extension to McGee and Sherro's

893
02:14:34.460 --> 02:14:44.439
Brent Blackaby: what is your understanding, and this could be back to Public Works as well, what's your understanding of parking impact if we do Class 2 instead of Class 4?

894
02:14:44.760 --> 02:14:47.070
Brent Blackaby: along that longer stretch to McGee.

895
02:14:47.180 --> 02:14:54.379
Brent Blackaby: And then do Sherro's, or again, something else from McGee to Gilman. What happens to parking in those areas?

896

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02:14:54.380 --> 02:15:10.459
Boardroom: I definitely want to let Public Works answer, but I will say, I actually, so I asked for a Class 2 bike lane, which is just a painted lane. We actually have that already, it's just, you know, hard to read the paint, because there's… it's rubble. But…

897
02:15:10.460 --> 02:15:23.229
Boardroom: I don't believe it's buffered, and once again, I really want to defer to Public Works to explain this. I think I left the word buffered in on my item, and I believe there's not room for a buffer between the, the bike lane and the traffic lane, so…

898
02:15:23.290 --> 02:15:32.169
Boardroom: Assuming there's no buffer, which is my intent, I believe we could keep all of the parking, but I want to hear from Public Works. Thank you for the question.

899
02:15:33.940 --> 02:15:46.749
Wahid Amiri: So we would have to take a look at it, Councilmember, but just in general, as you mentioned, there are segments that has already Class 2. We can bring a higher visibility, whether that's the green pavement or fresh striping.

900
02:15:46.930 --> 02:16:05.870
Wahid Amiri: But, again, in areas that we implement shareholds or a hybrid between Class 2 and Sherro's, obviously that doesn't impact curbside parking, so it would remain the same. But again, if there's any specific details, that's something that we'll have to take a closer look and really see the true impacts. But I…

901
02:16:05.910 --> 02:16:18.840
Wahid Amiri: again, based on the past referral that was issued by you and Councilmember Hesarwani, based on that design, when we looked at it, I think just having pedestrian enhancement

902
02:16:18.950 --> 02:16:24.020
Wahid Amiri: That, I think only impacted 4 curbside parking stalls, just in reference.

903
02:16:24.440 --> 02:16:24.760
Brent Blackaby: Yeah.

904
02:16:24.910 --> 02:16:32.070

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Boardroom: Actually, could I… do my director jump in? Is that, my recollection is that was to accommodate some ADA, an additional ADA space, is that correct?

905
02:16:32.070 --> 02:16:35.610
Wahid Amiri: 80 and also some bulbouts and some refuge.

906
02:16:35.610 --> 02:16:36.320
Boardroom: Thanks.

907
02:16:36.950 --> 02:16:43.480
Brent Blackaby: So the difference between the current Kessarwani plan and what Councilmember, O'Keefe laid out is

908
02:16:43.629 --> 02:16:47.319
Brent Blackaby: Recovery of a substantial amount of that bus parking.

909
02:16:47.320 --> 02:17:05.860
Wahid Amiri: Correct. If it's maintaining the existing Class 2 with, again, shareroads, and if traffic calming is part of that, hopefully it is, then yes, we maintain current, or close to current count. So obviously, as I mentioned, we'll have to take a closer look at it, but the numbers shouldn't change substantially.

910
02:17:06.330 --> 02:17:12.059
Brent Blackaby: Okay, last group of questions, and I'm done. If we did ask you to develop

911
02:17:12.200 --> 02:17:27.049
Brent Blackaby: in my item, we… this alternative plan, where we give you more of an ability to say, here's the guidelines, come back with something. What's the timeline, order of magnitude for something like that? Conceptual plan is not a detailed engineering plan, it's a conceptual plan.

912
02:17:27.250 --> 02:17:30.660
Brent Blackaby: Given the workload you've got, like, kind of what's the timeline for something like that?

913
02:17:30.660 --> 02:17:37.769
Wahid Amiri: If we prioritize a council member within the next 4 months, we can probably deliver a conceptual that we feel confident with.

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914
02:17:37.900 --> 02:17:50.880
Wahid Amiri: But again, if we're balancing multiple competing urgencies and priorities that Public Works is doing on a daily basis, then realistically, we'll need closer to 6 to 7 months to do it responsibly and thoughtfully.

915
02:17:51.110 --> 02:17:53.969
Brent Blackaby: Understood, thank you. Last bit,

916
02:17:54.309 --> 02:18:09.530
Brent Blackaby: the kind of other hybrid approach, I think, that's coming through from what Councilmember O'Keefe has mentioned is, if we agreed on a certain segment of street, just… we all agree on treatment and move forward on paving, and we shrank the… the set.

917
02:18:09.740 --> 02:18:20.230
Brent Blackaby: not necessarily do the full, sort of, piece of Hopkins, but maybe you just look at the Hopkins Ada Rose corridor from McGee to Ordway. Like, that piece that gets you from the commercial district

918
02:18:20.290 --> 02:18:37.439
Brent Blackaby: Either to Sacramento or back onto Gilman to kind of get to the rest of us. If we just did the shorter segment, does that save a little time? Can you do both a paving and move forward with paving on the eastern side while you finish a study on the western side? Is that feasible? And does that save you a little time if we did that?

919
02:18:38.110 --> 02:18:50.179
Wahid Amiri: It's more efficient if we do the design complete, Councilmember. If costs are a challenge or a factor, we can look at phase and construction, which obviously

920
02:18:50.180 --> 02:19:07.450
Wahid Amiri: as cost because of, you know, mobilizing and so forth, but the preference is to be able to capture the full corridor design at once. When we do LiDAR, we do our measurements, it just makes more sense, and it's better engineering just to put everything in perspective, but again.

921
02:19:07.450 --> 02:19:15.380
Wahid Amiri: we can phase out construction, but the recommendation is to do whatever design holistically, so we can see from San Pablo to Sutter

922
02:19:15.459 --> 02:19:22.750

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Wahid Amiri: Where the pieces fit and how things interact, so that way we have the full picture going into design, completed, and bid-ready, set.

923
02:19:23.700 --> 02:19:25.399
Brent Blackaby: Great, thank you so much, I'm done, thank you.

924
02:19:26.889 --> 02:19:29.419
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Councilmember Bartlett?

925
02:19:30.359 --> 02:19:45.599
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. This question for, Mr. Heary. So, is there a deadline by which, we must choose, an option or a lane configuration, that will result in delaying pavement paving?

926
02:19:46.209 --> 02:19:50.669
Boardroom: Like, so in order to delay the paving, do we have a deadline in which to make a decision?

927
02:19:52.070 --> 02:19:58.280
Wahid Amiri: So, currently, We have about 6 point… 1 or 6.3 million.

928
02:19:58.390 --> 02:20:12.890
Wahid Amiri: program for fiscal year 28, so we'll just have to work backwards. Usually, we get into design 6 to 8 months prior to that. We, roll out in two packages, Councilmember. First, the concrete curb repairs, and then the pavement.

929
02:20:12.960 --> 02:20:20.899
Wahid Amiri: based on the time of the year, just to, you know, beat Mother Nature before the weather conditions change, so,

930
02:20:21.030 --> 02:20:39.010
Wahid Amiri: we can… if there's a precise timeline you're looking for, we can provide that to you, but that's generally the rule of thumb. So, fiscal year 28, unless Council directs us to change that, but that's where it's programmed right now, so that should give you a timeline of when we need to make decisions to align everything up.

931
02:20:39.480 --> 02:20:57.999
Boardroom: Thank you. And, and seeing how there's so many elements here at play in this plan, so many inputs that we're trying to negotiate and navigate here, and, with unstudied impacts, really. Could public engagement, post-decision by this council.

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932
02:20:58.000 --> 02:21:06.270
Boardroom: Could that result in a different alignment being selected, or would the community be consulted about mitigation only?

933
02:21:06.510 --> 02:21:29.580
Boardroom: I mean, I can speak to that, Councilman Wright. I think whatever direction you give us, that's the direction we're gonna go. And so, you know, per the referrals that are out there now, it sounds like what the direction is, is we're not asking whether we should do this or not, we're trying to understand how to impact loading, how to impact, you know, ADA placement, things like that, not the basic structure of the proposal. Okay, thank you.

934
02:21:29.580 --> 02:21:33.429
Boardroom: And I guess lastly, this is a high level, if you're just to guesstimate here.

935
02:21:33.430 --> 02:21:42.659
Boardroom: What would you guess the cost differential between the Hopkins plans as is, and versus an alternative, like the Rose Street alternative?

936
02:21:47.290 --> 02:21:53.480
Wahid Amiri: I would need some time to take a look at that, Councilmember. There's a lot of moving pieces, elements,

937
02:21:53.900 --> 02:21:59.159
Wahid Amiri: We can get back to you with some sort of a rough order of magnitude, or planning purposes, cost.

938
02:22:00.510 --> 02:22:01.599
Boardroom: Okay, thank you.

939
02:22:03.790 --> 02:22:07.199
Boardroom: Thank you. Excuse me, Councilmember Humbert.

940
02:22:08.040 --> 02:22:16.560
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. And, I'm gonna try to, keep my questions, fairly,

941
02:22:17.090 --> 02:22:32.389

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Boardroom: they're gonna be fairly consistent, and they're gonna be in the nature of, yes… they're gonna ask for yes or no answers, to help… to keep us, on track here. Maybe in the nature of cross-examination, but I don't want to say that.

942
02:22:32.900 --> 02:22:36.120
Wahid Amiri: Is maybe an option?

943
02:22:36.120 --> 02:22:55.630
Boardroom: Yeah, well, possibly. The first one is, can staff please confirm that a cycle track is shown as the envisioned network improvement for Hopkins Street in Figure 2, Low Stress Bikeway Network Vision of the Berkeley Bicycle Plan? Can you confirm that?

944
02:22:56.760 --> 02:22:59.950
Wahid Amiri: Mark is looking that up right now. Mark Helmbrick.

945
02:22:59.950 --> 02:23:00.620
Boardroom: Yeah.

946
02:23:10.260 --> 02:23:11.330
Mark Helmbrecht: You know, I'm mute.

947
02:23:12.830 --> 02:23:18.149
Boardroom: And if he can't find it, I can represent that it… that's the case.

948
02:23:20.070 --> 02:23:22.700
Mark Helmbrecht: It's shown on the low-stress bike…

949
02:23:23.420 --> 02:23:29.939
Mark Helmbrecht: Way Network Vision as a study cycle track and as a primary transit route.

950
02:23:29.940 --> 02:23:43.090
Boardroom: Yeah, okay, thank you. Can staff please confirm that a cycle track is shown as the recommended network improvement for Hopkins Street in Figure 3 recommended network improvements of the Berkeley bicycle plans?

951
02:23:50.200 --> 02:23:54.149

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Mark Helmbrecht: It's cons… it's consistent there, and it… yes, it calls for an…

952
02:23:54.540 --> 02:24:00.109
Mark Helmbrecht: Cycle track study and a complete street corridor study as a primary transit route.

953
02:24:00.470 --> 02:24:08.700
Boardroom: Okay, and this is… this is maybe for planning staff, I'm not sure, maybe for the city manager. Does…

954
02:24:09.100 --> 02:24:27.419
Boardroom: the Plan Bay Area discuss Berkeley's bicycle network at the individual project level? I'll suggest that it doesn't, and that's kind of a follow-up to Councilmember Trigub's question. Does Plan Bay Area discuss Berkeley's bicycle network at the individual project level?

955
02:24:27.770 --> 02:24:41.850
Boardroom: I don't believe it does, but we'll have to double-check. Pardon? I do not believe it does, but I'll have to check. Thank you. Here's another one. Is it correct that the Berkeley Climate Action Plan includes as a strategy, and this is a quote.

956
02:24:41.850 --> 02:24:54.200
Boardroom: Accelerate implementation of the city's bicycle and pedestrian plans, and continue efforts to make walking and cycling safe, healthy, and enjoyable alternatives to driving. End quote.

957
02:24:54.620 --> 02:24:55.530
Boardroom: Yes.

958
02:24:55.880 --> 02:25:11.650
Boardroom: Okay, thank you, City Manager. Is it also correct that the Berkeley Climate Action Plan includes a strategy that reads, quote, manage parking effectively to minimize driving demand and encourage and support alternatives to driving?

959
02:25:12.450 --> 02:25:32.039
Boardroom: We'll have to double-check, but I'm assuming the answer is yes. That's what I do in depositions. I'll represent that it does. Is it correct that the City of Berkeley has an adopted and still enforced climate emergency declaration that reads, in part, quote.

960

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02:25:32.040 --> 02:25:41.840
Boardroom: The City of Berkeley endorses a just citywide emergency mobilization effort to end citywide greenhouse gas emissions as quickly as possible.

961
02:25:42.490 --> 02:25:44.560
Boardroom: Yes, yes. Okay, thank you.

962
02:25:44.970 --> 02:26:09.070
Boardroom: Is it correct that the Complete Streets Policy adopted by the Metropolitan Transportation Commission in 2022 includes the following language? Quote, Safety shall be prioritized for all modes, especially the safety of vulnerable road users. That includes people biking, walking, and rolling. The safety of vulnerable roadway users should not be compromised

963
02:26:09.130 --> 02:26:14.670
Boardroom: to achieve improved level of service for people driving personal automobiles, end quote.

964
02:26:15.770 --> 02:26:39.430
Boardroom: Would have to check, but assume yes. Yeah, I'll represent that that's correct. Councilmember, how… I'm sorry, how many more questions do you have? Just a couple more, Madam Mayor. Okay, alright. But actually, just one. Are staff aware of any adopted city policy or plans or policies that explicitly prioritize the provision or convenience of non-disabled car parking

965
02:26:39.430 --> 02:26:46.430
Boardroom: Over pedestrian and bicycle safety, alternative transportation forms, or climate action.

966
02:26:46.430 --> 02:26:51.699
Boardroom: No, we're not, Councilmember. Thank you. Those are my questions. Okay, thank you. So…

967
02:26:55.420 --> 02:27:02.000
Boardroom: Thank you, everyone. So, alright, so, earlier I was saying that I wanted to limit the comments.

968
02:27:02.000 --> 02:27:21.480
Boardroom: To 3 hours, 2 hours in person, 1 hour online. We've already used some of that time. We did miss a child, so thank you for being first. But I… we actually need to vote on that, so I would like to make a

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motion to, suspend the rules and allow us to limit public comment to 3 hours, 2 hours in person, 1 hour online. Second.

969
02:27:21.480 --> 02:27:31.500
Boardroom: Thank you. Can we take the roll on that, please? Okay, on the motion, Councilmember Kisarwani? Yes. Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Aye. O'Keefe?

970
02:27:31.610 --> 02:27:34.769
Boardroom: I'm gonna vote yes, but I'd like to make a comment afterwards, if that's okay.

971
02:27:34.980 --> 02:27:37.500
Boardroom: Yes. Blackaby?

972
02:27:37.500 --> 02:27:38.300
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

973
02:27:38.450 --> 02:27:54.249
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Umber? Yes. And Marishi? Yes. Okay, motion carries. I was also told that there might be another child that's outside that also would like to speak. Is it this person here, or… Okay. Alright, if there are any other children that were missed, please feel free to come to the front.

974
02:27:54.250 --> 02:28:02.289
Boardroom: I'm gonna start over here with this… Mayor, Mayor, no? I think we should keep your comment for the comment period, because I really want to let everyone give their comments.

975
02:28:02.360 --> 02:28:09.379
Boardroom: Okay, go ahead, please, coming up. Go ahead. Go ahead.

976
02:28:09.990 --> 02:28:14.429
Boardroom: Hello, thank you for taking the time to hear us out, board members.

977
02:28:14.630 --> 02:28:29.869
Boardroom: contrary to, Ms. Kaswari's statement, it is not genuinely contested about the cycle lane. We had voted this on, for Measure Double F, and we voted this down. The people of Burke, they've already voted and decided we do not want to have

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978
02:28:29.870 --> 02:28:46.749
Boardroom: this, public endangerment project, enforced on us. I live on the 1600 block of Hopkins. I've been there for 30 years. My family's been in the neighborhood for 80. We definitely want to, help, bicyclists, but the problem is that,

979
02:28:46.750 --> 02:28:51.819
Boardroom: We need to paint standard shoulder bike lanes on Rose and Hopkins in Sacramento.

980
02:28:51.820 --> 02:29:12.799
Boardroom: And pave the road. We've waited 10 years, we've had 2 water main breaks, and Bike Walk Berkeley is holding our basic infrastructure projects hostage. The parents and children running stop signs on bicycles is a child endangerment, and must be ticketed, as well as stop signs and red light runners. San Francisco makes millions of dollars in tickets each year. It is child endangerment. People who…

981
02:29:13.050 --> 02:29:15.559
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks for your comment.

982
02:29:16.400 --> 02:29:17.180
Boardroom: Team.

983
02:29:17.470 --> 02:29:18.479
Boardroom: Come on up.

984
02:29:22.150 --> 02:29:29.930
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Thea, and I'm an upcoming freshman at Berkeley High. I'm a member of the Youth Commission, but I'm speaking as an individual.

985
02:29:29.930 --> 02:29:51.169
Boardroom: As a young person, I know that many of my friends and peers bike all throughout Berkeley, and Hopkins Street is a really popular place for kids my age because of its proximity to King Middle School and its various restaurants and shops. Kids my age don't have driver's license or cars, and a lot of people bike or use public transportation to get around. If you've, like, seen the bike racks at Berkeley High School, they're always packed.

986
02:29:51.170 --> 02:30:06.539

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Boardroom: And my friends have told me horror stories about how, like, stressful and unsafe it feels to bike on Hopkins. Young people want to be able to travel safely, and that's why we want protected bike lanes on Hopkins. We deserve streets that make biking safer for everyone, especially the youth in Berkeley. Thank you for your time.

987
02:30:06.920 --> 02:30:08.020
Boardroom: Thank you.

988
02:30:12.690 --> 02:30:14.229
Boardroom: Whoever's next, come on up!

989
02:30:15.850 --> 02:30:18.069
Boardroom: I have somebody seating the tie.

990
02:30:20.410 --> 02:30:21.080
Boardroom: Okay.

991
02:30:21.080 --> 02:30:45.779
Boardroom: So you have 2 minutes. Okay, and so, folks, if you have someone who's seating you time, if you could just organize them so that we can move along as quickly as possible, that would be great. Go ahead. Okay, good evening. I have two questions. Who won the 2020 election? Second question. Who signed off on fire safety issues for one-way Class 4

992
02:30:45.780 --> 02:30:49.650
Boardroom: Separated bikeways on Hopkins that you are now proposing.

993
02:30:50.170 --> 02:30:53.620
Boardroom: The answer is, Biden won the election.

994
02:30:53.810 --> 02:30:57.190
Boardroom: And no one from the fire department signed off.

995
02:30:58.910 --> 02:31:00.280
Boardroom: No one.

996
02:31:01.220 --> 02:31:01.930
Boardroom: Okay.

997
02:31:02.160 --> 02:31:08.970

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Boardroom: Fire Chief Sprague sent me the letter, which I sent to you yesterday, and which I've distributed at this meeting.

998
02:31:09.580 --> 02:31:12.240
Boardroom: And I'd like you to read along with me.

999
02:31:13.200 --> 02:31:24.699
Boardroom: Despite what Keserwani's, assurance that the fire department signed off, Sprague unequivocally states that he did not.

1000
02:31:25.150 --> 02:31:32.009
Boardroom: He said, he writes, it is also important to distinguish what the fire department has and has not approved.

1001
02:31:32.010 --> 02:31:47.549
Boardroom: The newly proposed configuration involving one-way protected bicycle lanes on both sides of Hopkins is a different design, and the fire department has not reviewed that configuration. The Council's sponsors are lying to us.

1002
02:31:47.550 --> 02:31:54.280
Boardroom: The lie is on page 7, updated review by fire department. Approval has not been given.

1003
02:31:54.410 --> 02:32:01.940
Boardroom: I listened to the entire two-hour audio of the fights meeting that's referred to as when the sign-off took place.

1004
02:32:02.830 --> 02:32:20.250
Boardroom: And at minute 40, member Humbert questions Sprague hypothetically on the emergency response with bike lanes. He says, Sprague says, it feels risky to me. I don't know that it's not an option, but it doesn't feel super safe for my… and then Humbert interrupts him.

1005
02:32:20.770 --> 02:32:40.059
Boardroom: Do you hear that? It feels risky to me. I don't know that it's not an option, but it doesn't feel safe. Council, I am asking you to drop this item. City Manager and Attorney investigate how this deception and unauthorized proposal came before us tonight. Thank you.

1006
02:32:43.730 --> 02:32:49.290
Boardroom: When you're… yeah, please come on up, whoever's next. As soon as that person's done, yeah, just come on up.

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1007
02:32:52.150 --> 02:33:10.030
Boardroom: My name is Helen Walsh, speaking today as an individual resident. Accessibility of public right-of-way is a Title II civil rights requirement. It cannot be treated as secondary to any transportation mode. The three supplementums for item 27 highlight difference.

1008
02:33:10.400 --> 02:33:16.330
Boardroom: priorities, but none provide the accessibility structure that Title II requires.

1009
02:33:16.330 --> 02:33:33.630
Boardroom: What is still missing is a full accessibility analysis of ADA parking displacement, loading access, waste collection access, tree route and curb damage, and impacts on floating bus stops and mid-block crossings on residents with disabilities.

1010
02:33:33.630 --> 02:33:55.360
Boardroom: These are core public right-of-way functions. The fire department's emergency access statement is important, but emergency access is not the same as accessibility. Title II requires access for residents with disabilities, senior, paratransit, and service vehicles. Emergency access does not replace accessibility analysis. Thank you.

1011
02:33:55.360 --> 02:33:59.210
Boardroom: Thanks so much for your comment. I'm sorry, thank you.

1012
02:34:02.390 --> 02:34:07.309
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Lisa Chow, and Andrea Alshul has given me her, minute.

1013
02:34:07.310 --> 02:34:30.250
Boardroom: Mayor and Councilmembers, I'm opposed to the installation of cycle tracks in Hopkins as proposed by Councilmember Keserwani. I park in the disabled parking spot at Kingpool several times a week throughout the year. I'm glad it's right by the sidewalk at the entrance of the path to the pool, because if a cycle track is installed by the sidewalk, I fear for being able

1014
02:34:30.250 --> 02:34:42.579
Boardroom: to have safe access to the pool. My experience with cyclists is that the majority do not heed pedestrians. The cyclists ride right through stop signs, and if you say anything, they'll say, fuck you!

1015

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02:34:42.590 --> 02:34:49.939
Boardroom: Now, with electric bikes that go faster and are more powerful, it's an even more dangerous situation.

1016
02:34:50.060 --> 02:34:59.879
Boardroom: I'm appalled by how much money, over $3 billion, the cycle tracks will cost. How is it that you have money for that when we had to supplement the budget, when Measure F

1017
02:34:59.890 --> 02:35:18.649
Boardroom: for repaving the streets and sidewalks? How is it you have money for that, but are laying off city employees? How is it you have money for that, but you can't build housing for the homeless? And how is it that you have money for that, but none for janitorial staff to clean our pools and showers, leaving us in unsanitary conditions?

1018
02:35:19.090 --> 02:35:36.020
Boardroom: Consider alternate routes like Rose and Ada. Work towards consensus, not division. Hopkins needs to be repaved now. Safety and access for disabled, seniors, and all other residents in Berkeley. Don't violate the American Disabilities Act.

1019
02:35:43.570 --> 02:35:44.860
Boardroom: Can I start?

1020
02:35:44.860 --> 02:36:08.750
Boardroom: Thank you. 14-year Hopkins-McGee resident who shuttled the needed stop sign at McGee-Hopkins to installation. No deed will go unpunished if the Kesarwani item passes. It will create further pedestrian hazards by adding concrete-divided perilous bike tracks. It will not have had the input of the blind population. Here's a reply I received today from the Center for the Blind, East Bay.

1021
02:36:08.750 --> 02:36:33.109
Boardroom: Bike tracks and bus islands, absolutely done without us in mind, equals us, blind folks. For all pedestrians, imagine being on foot trying to cross at Monterey Hopkins with multiple stop sign intersections. East, west, north, south, while inexperienced kids on bikes merge with e-scooters, e-riders, e-bikers, move within concrete dividers, have to figure out who can drive first, second, third. Indecision can confuse the driver and the pedestrian, causing an accident.

1022
02:36:33.140 --> 02:36:51.150

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Boardroom: What about bike… e-bike riders who want to supersede people in front of them? E-bikes can speed up to 35 miles an hour. Sean O'Neill was killed trying to cross Monterey Hopkins 10 years later. The same intersection will harbor increased dangers, with more lanes and rising indecision about traffic law. Thank you.

1023
02:36:56.130 --> 02:37:06.080
Boardroom: Michael France has asked me to use one minute of his time. Thank you. My name is Bryce Nesbitt, and unlike Mr. Humbert, I don't have the option of

1024
02:37:06.250 --> 02:37:18.019
Boardroom: interrogating staff, but if so, I would ask, do you have access to temporary traffic lights that can be installed within 24 to 48 hours? Now, why the heck would I ask that?

1025
02:37:18.850 --> 02:37:21.479
Boardroom: Because you have a known unsafe intersection?

1026
02:37:21.920 --> 02:37:30.679
Boardroom: It's Ada at Sacramento. It's miserable to cross. It's the site of a cyclist's death, where that cyclist was dragged by a car.

1027
02:37:30.820 --> 02:37:38.769
Boardroom: It's an incredibly fast, high-speed road, and you could solve that right away, and it would help. Walk to school for…

1028
02:37:38.910 --> 02:37:44.530
Boardroom: Ruth Acti, and bike to the Hopkins District. Why are you not doing that?

1029
02:37:45.540 --> 02:37:56.110
Boardroom: The Ada route in general has been a subject of community interest, including extensive drawings, conceptual studies, counts, for a long time.

1030
02:37:57.420 --> 02:38:01.960
Boardroom: There was even $50,000 in the budget to study alternatives here.

1031
02:38:02.240 --> 02:38:06.759
Boardroom: And my drawing here shows the three little monkeys.

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1032
02:38:07.720 --> 02:38:24.149
Boardroom: Why would you not… why would you take this action without having studied that route in terms of costing and practicality? I know that it hasn't been done. I know that Free Javandale, the director who was eventually fired over allegations of having cooked the books on Hopkins.

1033
02:38:24.310 --> 02:38:37.829
Boardroom: Had resisted studying that for quite some period of time, but just before he was let go by the city, he sent me an email, personal email, which is in your council record, actually quite warm to that.

1034
02:38:39.880 --> 02:39:02.359
Boardroom: At the time, it was called the Ada Bypass. I don't like that name, even though I coined it, because bypasses are a very car-centric concept. Think back to the 50s, when towns were bypassed by the highway and then died. It's now called the Ada Ultra Lost Bikeway, because that's what it is. It's a great route, beautiful way to get to the business district, and you can do it today.

1035
02:39:12.280 --> 02:39:18.639
Boardroom: I'm a cyclist, I'm trying to hydrate, and thank you, Bryce. Good evening.

1036
02:39:19.330 --> 02:39:31.680
Boardroom: Well, I'm glad he clarified that, because to somebody like me, bypass has a whole different meaning. I pedal at 12 or 14 miles an hour.

1037
02:39:32.430 --> 02:39:35.450
Boardroom: Good year, I might get 3,000 miles in.

1038
02:39:35.830 --> 02:39:40.030
Boardroom: I got a lot of competition for a bike lane. Officer Valet…

1039
02:39:40.560 --> 02:39:46.750
Boardroom: Berkeley Police confirmed for me, last Monday, Had coffee with a cop.

1040
02:39:47.400 --> 02:40:05.889
Boardroom: Motorized skateboards, rental scooters, stupid hoverboards piloted by the Darth Vader young men, and of course, electric bicycles. All go 25, legally. Guess where they do it? In a 4-foot-wide bike lane.

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1041
02:40:05.890 --> 02:40:11.990
Boardroom: They're going 10 miles an hour faster than me. It's just like being out with cars, which I'm comfortable with.

1042
02:40:12.070 --> 02:40:17.449
Boardroom: Protected bike lanes don't protect pedal bicycles. Thank you.

1043
02:40:24.240 --> 02:40:27.069
Boardroom: Thank you, Diana, for the extra minute.

1044
02:40:28.260 --> 02:40:40.199
Boardroom: My name is Ann Parker. I live in the area. I'm a practicing physician primarily for children and adults with neurodevelopmental disabilities, cerebral palsy, things like that.

1045
02:40:40.730 --> 02:40:50.379
Boardroom: My primary concern is maintaining safety on Hopkins Street. To me, that means repaving the street now.

1046
02:40:50.380 --> 02:41:04.689
Boardroom: We've heard so much tonight about what we don't know about the plan, the CycleTrack 4 plan that is supposedly going for recommendation. I had no idea we knew so little.

1047
02:41:04.800 --> 02:41:22.490
Boardroom: So, to me, safety means repaving the street now, improving crosswalks by repairing, repainting, and adding warning lights, considering speed bumps to slow down cars and cyclists. Scooters.

1048
02:41:23.240 --> 02:41:29.950
Boardroom: What is not safe is some of the things that are being proposed. By bus.

1049
02:41:30.490 --> 02:41:38.540
Boardroom: islands. I would love to demonstrate for you what it's like when my blind kids try to go up curves and across

1050
02:41:39.010 --> 02:41:56.880
Boardroom: lanes where there are cyclists, often coming both ways, and then, to get up a curb and finally start to walk again. So I don't want bus lanes, they're dangerous. Or, I'm sorry, bike islands. I don't want barriers, they're dangerous.

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1051
02:41:57.330 --> 02:42:04.879
Boardroom: And losing parking is not something that's just about losing parking. If we lose parking, we have people

1052
02:42:04.880 --> 02:42:20.379
Boardroom: driving out of their driveways. And the cameras that we now have on our cars don't show you who's coming, they show you who you're about to hit. So please don't think it's just indulging wealthy people by not being able to park.

1053
02:42:20.380 --> 02:42:26.979
Boardroom: on the street. Tonight, I encourage you to go forward, to reschedule paving.

1054
02:42:27.070 --> 02:42:45.129
Boardroom: as agreed to in February, and to reject item 22. Thank you. Thanks for your comment. I know I have an extra minute. I'm sorry, you got your extra minute, so your time is up. Thank you. Could I have an… Thank you. Okay. Pave now, appropriate, with appropriate…

1055
02:42:45.540 --> 02:43:09.949
Boardroom: improvements. Every year of delay means more cracked pavement, more potholes, more accidents, and a bigger repair bill for the city down the road. We can't wait another decade. We must decouple the repair of Hopkins and safe bike infrastructure. Move for general safety now, continue working towards a bike plan that suits the scale and culture of our neighborhood.

1056
02:43:09.950 --> 02:43:17.929
Boardroom: With regard to the development of bike lanes, I encourage more time. A quote from our mayor.

1057
02:43:18.110 --> 02:43:22.239
Boardroom: Take… a quote from the mayor is, take a step back.

1058
02:43:23.350 --> 02:43:34.090
Boardroom: Breathe, rest your mind, and come with a fresh perspective. I thank you for that. I really do, Mayor. And, I thank you for your time.

1059
02:43:34.190 --> 02:43:35.950
Boardroom: Thank you.

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1060
02:43:36.560 --> 02:43:52.930
Boardroom: I'm so sorry, but if you've given your minute, you… But if you've given your minute, you can't speak. Okay. So, thank you. You can't receive an assignment? Mr. City Clerk, can you please confirm? That's been our practice.

1061
02:43:53.020 --> 02:43:57.040
Boardroom: Thank you.

1062
02:43:58.380 --> 02:44:04.269
Boardroom: Thank you, City Council. You probably know me, my name is Derek Rodriguez.

1063
02:44:04.460 --> 02:44:07.839
Boardroom: Today I'm speaking on behalf of Cal Berkeley Democrats.

1064
02:44:08.000 --> 02:44:13.300
Boardroom: In supporting improvements along Hopkins that would protect the safety of our residents.

1065
02:44:13.440 --> 02:44:20.650
Boardroom: That, I believe, is the true lens through which this decision should be made. It should be paramount to address pedestrian safety concerns.

1066
02:44:20.750 --> 02:44:26.619
Boardroom: It is unfortunate if said concerns are only addressed after someone is injured, fatally or otherwise.

1067
02:44:27.410 --> 02:44:47.030
Boardroom: It is with this in mind that I also advocate for bike lanes, and to address those concerned with business and living arrangements surrounding parking, I say to the city, let the community be involved in the planning process. If we can decide how to integrate greater bike lanes while still maintaining accessibility to people's housing and local businesses.

1068
02:44:47.190 --> 02:44:59.949
Boardroom: I say we should listen to our community, and follow our concerns from either side to the benefit of everyone. We shouldn't let this spill into partisanship. Let's create a solution with the people's approval, and allow us to take part of the planning process. Thank you.

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1069
02:45:11.920 --> 02:45:15.560
Boardroom: I'm Veteranika Fookson, former Vice Mayor of Berkeley.

1070
02:45:15.890 --> 02:45:20.120
Boardroom: What I'm concerned about is that we're in a culture war.

1071
02:45:20.510 --> 02:45:23.499
Boardroom: And it's very, very, very painful.

1072
02:45:23.610 --> 02:45:26.680
Boardroom: To see people on both sides.

1073
02:45:27.160 --> 02:45:30.220
Boardroom: Fighting the way it's been going on.

1074
02:45:30.620 --> 02:45:38.030
Boardroom: Tonight, there's one point of agreement, and that is that Hopkins Street needs to be repaved.

1075
02:45:38.550 --> 02:45:46.379
Boardroom: You don't have complete information about anything else, and you've heard that the fire chief has not signed off on this.

1076
02:45:46.410 --> 02:46:00.350
Boardroom: I will tell you something that someone said to me the other day. I was talking, standing next to a cyclist, and I said, are you… have you heard about what's going on on Hopkins Street? And he said, oh, yes.

1077
02:46:00.420 --> 02:46:03.229
Boardroom: And I said, well, what do you think about it?

1078
02:46:03.320 --> 02:46:04.569
Boardroom: He said, well.

1079
02:46:04.610 --> 02:46:13.530
Boardroom: I think we should have bike lanes, and I said, have you thought about all the other people in the community who may need other ways to go?

1080
02:46:13.530 --> 02:46:27.020

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Boardroom: And he looked at me and he said, you want to hear what he said to me? Thank you, I'm sorry, unless someone wants to give you a round, you will not be here to know the difference. Okay, this person's giving you a minute. That's culture war.

1081
02:46:27.120 --> 02:46:30.170
Boardroom: I will not be here to know the difference.

1082
02:46:30.400 --> 02:46:36.020
Boardroom: And I tell you, I had everything I could do but to raise my hand to that young man.

1083
02:46:38.390 --> 02:46:39.599
Boardroom: Thank you very much.

1084
02:46:46.050 --> 02:46:50.279
Boardroom: Before I close, should I have, 3 extra minutes from the audience?

1085
02:46:52.930 --> 02:46:53.910
Boardroom: Thank you.

1086
02:46:56.510 --> 02:47:04.739
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Moni Gongobhat. Hi, I am a candidate for City Council in District 1, and I'm a West Berkeley resident.

1087
02:47:05.410 --> 02:47:16.329
Boardroom: We all want the same things, believe it or not. We want safety, we want accessibility, and we want to be able to participate in this clean transportation future.

1088
02:47:17.450 --> 02:47:23.689
Boardroom: Councilmember Blackaby's supplemental proposal in this item is the most safe.

1089
02:47:23.820 --> 02:47:32.840
Boardroom: fair, sensible, and environmentally sustainable plan. I am an able-bodied biker and a driver.

1090
02:47:32.920 --> 02:47:41.520
Boardroom: However, I could not in good conscience support a plan that serves a small number of able-bodied people like myself.

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1091
02:47:41.520 --> 02:47:44.380
Boardroom: While reducing accessibility for elders.

1092
02:47:44.380 --> 02:48:08.860
Boardroom: People with small children, people with disabilities, and people who can't afford thousands of dollars to buy an e-bike, the kind of e-bike that's required to carry small children uphill. Remember, I'm from West Berkeley. A clean transportation future should include clean transportation options for all. The main proposal fails to do that. Furthermore, we need to be able to identify the problem

1093
02:48:09.330 --> 02:48:11.689
Boardroom: And then address it at its source.

1094
02:48:11.690 --> 02:48:35.820
Boardroom: What's the problem? A lack of safety. What is the source of that problem? Unsafe driving. All the infrastructure in the world will not address this behavioral issue. As a biker, I have seen cars parked in the protected bike lanes on Novia, which I support the protected bike lanes. I've also seen a car cut off a cyclist, to turn onto that cycle track.

1095
02:48:35.820 --> 02:48:42.140
Boardroom: We need to raise awareness and enforce traffic rules, which is not happening on Hopkins.

1096
02:48:42.140 --> 02:48:56.350
Boardroom: Furthermore, the main plan will result in environmental harms, resulting from increased car traffic, traffic jams, and circling around Hopkins, thereby increasing our city's greenhouse gas emissions.

1097
02:48:57.630 --> 02:49:08.500
Boardroom: City Council, I ask you, are you somebody who is disabled, elderly, or do you have children? Are you not able to afford e-bikes to bring your families along?

1098
02:49:08.520 --> 02:49:26.830
Boardroom: Do you have kiddos like me who use King Pool and play sports on King Field? I don't have a newborn… while nursing a newborn, or bringing your parents along to watch their grandchildren play? If not, I urge you to adopt a Mamdani level of compassion on this issue.

1099

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02:49:28.570 --> 02:49:30.519
Boardroom: Pave Hopkins now.

1100
02:49:31.210 --> 02:49:44.969
Boardroom: be cost-effective with the funds that would have been allocated to the cycle track, and repave and maintain the long list of bicycle streets that need attention across Berkeley. And 3.

1101
02:49:44.970 --> 02:49:58.639
Boardroom: Adopt the most humane and sensible plan in this item, which is Councilmember Blackaby's plan, and thank you also to, Councilmember O'Keefe. I appreciate you, I appreciate this work, and thank you for allowing me to speak.

1102
02:50:05.600 --> 02:50:12.599
Boardroom: I have minutes being seeded by Laura Parsons, Lisa Oglesby, and Marilyn Simons.

1103
02:50:14.060 --> 02:50:21.460
Boardroom: Right there, yeah. And I'm just gonna read this, because otherwise I will flub up and waste time. So, okay.

1104
02:50:21.840 --> 02:50:43.389
Boardroom: The fight over Hopkins Street has been long and hard fought, and it has taken its toll on the community. Distrust in city government is at or near an all-time high, and general community dissatisfaction continues to grow. I read in a recent Chronicle article that Ben Gerhardt Stein of Walk Bike Berkeley reported the organization finally had enough political juice

1105
02:50:43.390 --> 02:50:47.470
Boardroom: to push the cycle track plan through Council.

1106
02:50:47.520 --> 02:51:07.419
Boardroom: It's a troubling statement. Without political influence, Friends of Hopkins Street, a true grassroots organization with no clout, no outside or city funding, no regional or statewide well-funded organizational support, must simply rely on facts and data to influence you. Over the years, that approach has not worked.

1107
02:51:07.420 --> 02:51:31.370
Boardroom: To avoid having to address our facts and data, we were maligned as too old, as obstructionists and NIMBYs, and as caring more about our cars than about children. We were told that staff quit because

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of us. You name it, and somebody has said it about us. But by sticking to facts and data, we've accomplished some things. For instance, no one is now insisting that a two-way cycle track on Hopkins is a good or safe idea.

1108
02:51:31.370 --> 02:51:32.680
Boardroom: Because it isn't.

1109
02:51:32.900 --> 02:51:56.480
Boardroom: And by sticking to the facts and data, we see an opportunity to settle the Hopkins issue once and for all. It centers around actually permitting staff to gather facts and data. Council members have long substituted their own amateur judgments for the professional ones of staff members, which has led to ideology creeping into policy making and further disrespect

1110
02:51:56.480 --> 02:52:19.880
Boardroom: distrust of our elected officials. But you have the opportunity to turn that around by taking the handcuffs off staff and letting them explore the many options available for providing a great low-stress east-west connection to West Berkeley and the Bike Boulevard network from North Berkeley. There is no inherent reason why the only option ever considered is Hopkins, nor is there an inherent reason why

1111
02:52:19.880 --> 02:52:27.970
Boardroom: It must be… it must include cycle track, especially one on an almost 100% residential street. In fact.

1112
02:52:28.110 --> 02:52:32.670
Boardroom: There are contraindications for such a plan.

1113
02:52:32.670 --> 02:52:57.629
Boardroom: That is an ideological desire, no more, no less. Let staff figure this out, hands untied, and get clout and juice and influence and ideology out of the decision-making process. Councilmember Blackaby included a plan in his most recent district newsletter that is close to ideal. It would allow staff to evaluate the efficacy of ADA bypass and the use of rows as alternative

1114
02:52:57.630 --> 02:53:05.219
Boardroom: to Hopkins. After all, 3 out of the 4 local schools cited as a need for a cycle track are actually

1115
02:53:05.290 --> 02:53:16.159

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Boardroom: located on Ada and Rose. The fourth St. Mary's College High School, is located at the end… north end of Albina Avenue, which is the car entrance to the school.

1116
02:53:16.990 --> 02:53:41.979
Boardroom: It's heavily trafficked, especially in the morning, and it's rare to see a student bicycling to school at this entrance. I know, because I live there. Staff could look at the accident statistics on Hopkins and actually analyze whether a cycle track would make a difference. In its analysis, it would certainly exclude the accidents that didn't even occur on Hopkins, whose inclusion supporting the cycle tracks is a clear indication of ideological

1117
02:53:41.980 --> 02:53:43.180
Boardroom: creep.

1118
02:53:43.180 --> 02:54:07.999
Boardroom: As it now is, we are beginning to understand that your constant praise of staff is in celebration of their having done exactly what you told it to do, not a testament to their ability to do quality analysis work. We believe they are capable of the latter. It's hard to imagine why you would not support Councilmember Blackaby's or O'Keefe's Supplementals. If you claim your support for cycle tracks on Hawkins is true.

1119
02:54:08.000 --> 02:54:22.500
Boardroom: fully grounded in facts and not based on ideology, you will not be threatened by the study of alternatives, since you must believe your preferred plan is the best one and will emerge on top. Please support their proposals and restore transparency to public trust.

1120
02:54:32.970 --> 02:54:39.120
Boardroom: My name is Chris Hamilton. You're about to put the cart before the horse if you approve Kesarwani's proposal.

1121
02:54:39.150 --> 02:54:51.800
Boardroom: How deceptively and ironically ironic it is to say that the failed road condition on Hopkins demands immediate paving when the supporters

1122
02:54:51.800 --> 02:55:04.040
Boardroom: of this proposal, and their minions on the Infrastructure Council, ensured that it would not be paved so that it would descend into this condition.

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1123
02:55:04.040 --> 02:55:23.740
Boardroom: Why should we listen to voices in support of this referral by Councilmember Kesharwani? They are the ones who shamelessly displayed their children to you in the past, disingenuously claiming an enclosed two-way bicycle track was safe for their kids.

1124
02:55:24.020 --> 02:55:38.980
Boardroom: The same ones who railed against supporters of Safe Hopkins for opposing this dangerous alternative, claiming we wanted to put their children in danger. Now everyone agrees… Thank you. …this is not the right thing to do.

1125
02:55:43.430 --> 02:55:56.189
Boardroom: Hi there. My name is Benjamin, this is Ruben. We just put Ruben's younger sister, Frida, to bed, and we came back here to join you all at the meeting. Thank you to Council, huge thank you to the staff, who've done an incredible amount of work on this project over many, many years.

1126
02:55:56.190 --> 02:56:19.339
Boardroom: often without gratitude, without thanks, and subject to much vitriol. So we want to start by just saying thank you to the staff of the City of Berkeley for the work that has gone into this, and for the work that will still come and will go into this. We want to speak in support of the current referral. We think that it offers a direction that is aligned to the City's vision, to the safety of the streets, to the safety of future users of the streets.

1127
02:56:19.340 --> 02:56:28.040
Boardroom: And I also want to say that I think it leaves an appropriate amount of discretion for staff to work out some of the details that address some of the concerns that have been spoken.

1128
02:56:28.040 --> 02:56:48.229
Boardroom: And I also want to say that I think that the general tenor, the general dialogue is slightly hyperbolic. I don't think Hopkins needs to be saved from this proposal. I do acknowledge that there are some people who will be inconvenienced, that there are real costs to this, but I think that overall, it is in the right direction. Thank you. Thank you.

1129
02:56:53.560 --> 02:56:58.589
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor Ishii and Council Members. Thank you for listening to this item.

1130

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02:56:58.670 --> 02:57:17.700
Boardroom: I have 3 points that I'd like to bring up tonight, and the first is safety. The second is the importance of the commercial node at Monterey and Hopkins, and lastly is cost. First, as an ardent walker, I, you know, I used to bike in my childhood, but now I'm kind of primarily a walker.

1131
02:57:17.700 --> 02:57:31.229
Boardroom: And I find those protected cycle barriers very confusing, and actually fairly dangerous, because it's hard for me sometimes, you know, I'm in fairly good shape, but I'm, you know, 74 years old.

1132
02:57:31.240 --> 02:57:50.719
Boardroom: And I can still climb over these barriers, but they're a little bit of a challenge. There's a time when I can envision when I won't be able to do that. Second, the four-block commercial node from McGee to Sacramento, I would argue, is one of the absolute jewels of Berkeley. Monterey Mark is not just a neighborhood grocery store, it was founded in 54,

1133
02:57:50.740 --> 02:58:00.339
Boardroom: by Tom and Mary Fujimoto. I see one of the Fujimotos here. I'm gonna run out of time, so I'm afraid I'll have to cut this short, but people come from all over to your shop there.

1134
02:58:06.120 --> 02:58:11.650
Boardroom: Hi, I wanna… I've sent a comment, so… and you've heard some good comments.

1135
02:58:11.650 --> 02:58:26.149
Boardroom: I want to talk about this young versus old thing that goes… somebody called it culture wars. It's… it's really awful, you know? I mean, why not encourage a dialogue between all of us? We shouldn't be on different sides.

1136
02:58:26.150 --> 02:58:50.730
Boardroom: There's a few people at the top of this pyramid that's not… that is, you know, owning most of the stuff, and everybody else is paying, okay? We didn't create this. I bought my house relatively recently with friends. I rent rooms out that you could afford. I keep them affordable. There could be lots of people in Berkeley that could do that.

1137
02:58:50.730 --> 02:59:02.610

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Boardroom: If a dialogue were encouraged that… encouraged different kinds of things than just high-rises or hatred of old people. It's… it is really…

1138
02:59:02.610 --> 02:59:13.000
Boardroom: Not… you guys need to think about a dialogue among community members to get rid of this. It's awful. It's terrible. And disabled people, too. I'm disabled, too.

1139
02:59:13.000 --> 02:59:14.129
Boardroom: Thank you.

1140
02:59:25.020 --> 02:59:29.599
Boardroom: Hi, I'm asking… I'm asking for 3 minutes, so I'm at 2 minutes from…

1141
02:59:29.910 --> 02:59:35.529
Boardroom: Margaret Lee and Martha Richards. Good, thank you.

1142
02:59:35.820 --> 02:59:43.550
Boardroom: Okay. Hi, my name is Sally Nelson, so it's 3 minutes, there we go. My name's Sally Nelson. I got the 2 here, where was the third person?

1143
02:59:44.310 --> 02:59:58.050
Boardroom: We… Just the three total. Okay, you said you were asking for 3, so… go ahead. Total. Okay. You heard my name, Sally Nelson. We have two important issues here.

1144
02:59:58.250 --> 03:00:04.830
Boardroom: We all need low-stress, street between North and West Berkeley.

1145
03:00:05.010 --> 03:00:11.600
Boardroom: Children in North Berkeley need a safe bicycle right to school, and actually, there are lots of kids who are bicycling

1146
03:00:11.600 --> 03:00:26.020
Boardroom: on Rose Street these days. And Hopkins Street, with its many potholes and crevices, needs to be repaired and paved. Both needs can be satisfied by designated Rose Street, rather than Hopkins as the safest bicycle route

1147

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03:00:26.170 --> 03:00:40.630
Boardroom: For all of us, including children, Rose Street is where the schools are located, three schools. I am a retired cyclist. For 40 years, I used my bicycle for buying groceries and running errands.

1148
03:00:40.700 --> 03:01:00.200
Boardroom: Cycle tracks in the roadways are to be avoided. They are dangerous. The city should not build them. Concrete curves designed to separate cyclists from vehicle traffic will not keep out electric scooters and bicycles who whiz by at dangerously fast speeds.

1149
03:01:00.430 --> 03:01:05.069
Boardroom: Cyclists have already sustained serious injuries.

1150
03:01:06.180 --> 03:01:12.060
Boardroom: As a cyclist, I consistently avoided roads that had cycle tracks.

1151
03:01:12.280 --> 03:01:21.689
Boardroom: The shops on Hopkins Street need to be accessible to people of all ages, including those of us who now use wheelchairs, walkers, and canes.

1152
03:01:21.940 --> 03:01:32.880
Boardroom: Now we need to park our cars, and we need the parking spaces. Cycle tracks on Hopkins would negatively impact the businesses there, including Monterey Market.

1153
03:01:33.010 --> 03:01:49.170
Boardroom: People with their homes on Hopkins need access to their driveways, as well as street parking for maintenance and repair people. Postal Service people… postal service vehicles need access to street parking, since they are not allowed

1154
03:01:49.360 --> 03:01:52.549
Boardroom: To double park or block driveways.

1155
03:01:52.840 --> 03:01:56.430
Boardroom: Cycle tracks would interfere with mail delivery.

1156
03:01:57.000 --> 03:02:06.689

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Boardroom: Hawkins Street without cycle tracks can continue to provide access to the swimming pool and tennis courts and New Monterey Market and other businesses.

1157
03:02:07.830 --> 03:02:15.729
Boardroom: Regarding the Climate Action Plan, concrete is not environmentally friendly at all.

1158
03:02:17.130 --> 03:02:24.000
Boardroom: Manufacturing cement generates 8% of the carbon dioxide that is produced globally.

1159
03:02:24.240 --> 03:02:28.240
Boardroom: Plus, it produces a lot of other toxic gases.

1160
03:02:29.260 --> 03:02:31.410
Boardroom: There are plenty of other streets.

1161
03:02:31.730 --> 03:02:51.660
Boardroom: for cyclists to ride to their desired destination. If safety is what today's bicycles seek, then the city should repair and repave Hawkins Street without a cycle track. So vote no on building a cycle track, vote yes to repair and pave Hawkins Street without cycle tracks. Thank you very much.

1162
03:02:54.040 --> 03:02:55.150
Boardroom: Thank you.

1163
03:02:58.970 --> 03:03:09.599
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Gail Alcock, and I'm resident of D2, and I was really happy when I moved to Berkeley in 1990, and I could actually…

1164
03:03:09.830 --> 03:03:14.319
Boardroom: get up all the Berkeley Hills, which I could not do in San Francisco, so…

1165
03:03:14.810 --> 03:03:18.580
Boardroom: Biking is a great thing in the city, and…

1166
03:03:18.950 --> 03:03:21.690
Boardroom: I've had my share of accidents.

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1167
03:03:21.930 --> 03:03:26.500
Boardroom: And the worst one was on the concrete of the…

1168
03:03:27.040 --> 03:03:33.730
Boardroom: bike barrier, and I have bounced off cars, and bounced on the asphalt, and I have been

1169
03:03:34.670 --> 03:03:41.640
Boardroom: you know, I don't want to think about it. It makes me think that I shouldn't be biking, except today, when I got here.

1170
03:03:42.060 --> 03:03:56.369
Boardroom: I took the bike boulevards. They're fabulous. People slow down. Two kids are coming towards me, rollerblading side by side, and then there's a big, huge Amazon truck parked there, and…

1171
03:03:56.490 --> 03:04:13.300
Boardroom: It's fine, and the cars go around them, and they wait for everybody, and the Amazon delivery guy waits for me and says, you go ahead, so… Thank you. Yeah, these are broken teeth. Thanks so much, I'm so sorry about your accidents. Thank you. Thanks. $15,000. Thank you.

1172
03:04:16.920 --> 03:04:19.150
Boardroom: I have two people seeking their time for me.

1173
03:04:20.250 --> 03:04:21.500
Boardroom: Thank you, I see you're in the back.

1174
03:04:22.470 --> 03:04:28.280
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Maxine Skykes-Kennedy, I live on Hopkins Street and have an architecture practice in South Berkeley.

1175
03:04:28.300 --> 03:04:33.219
Boardroom: I'm a member of the North Berkeley design team that has worked extensively on the Hopkins Street redesign.

1176
03:04:33.220 --> 03:04:58.219
Boardroom: I support paving improvements, safer pedestrian crossings, and expanded bicycle infrastructure. But I strongly oppose the current proposal to remove hundreds of parking spaces along Hopkins Street to create protected bike lanes. First, it's fiscally irresponsible. Berkeley is facing a $30 million budget deficit, yet this project would go from

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$6.8 million to almost $15 million. At the same time, other neighborhoods are still waiting for basic

1177
03:04:58.220 --> 03:05:01.569
Boardroom: Street repairs, which is a top priority for safe cycling.

1178
03:05:01.670 --> 03:05:12.550
Boardroom: Second, NACDO and Caltrans bikeway design guidelines strongly recommend that cycle tracks not be installed in places with frequent driveways and intersections, which Hopkins Street has.

1179
03:05:12.810 --> 03:05:21.250
Boardroom: Also, cycle tracks would not have prevented the serious accidents listed in Exhibit 3 all occurred at intersections which cycle tracks do not protect.

1180
03:05:21.320 --> 03:05:36.970
Boardroom: Third, removing all of that parking will be detrimental to our neighborhood. Not everyone has the physical ability or circumstances to bike everywhere. We have spoken with business owners who believe this could threaten their livelihoods. Churches, preschools, and people using the King Fields, pool, playgrounds, and tennis courts

1181
03:05:36.970 --> 03:05:46.889
Boardroom: Plus, Cedar Rose tennis and pickleball courts all depend on nearby parking. It will make it especially difficult for people from other districts to use all these amazing businesses and facilities.

1182
03:05:47.130 --> 03:06:03.739
Boardroom: For the people like me and my family who live on Hopkins Street, it's not just a thoroughfare to get from point A to B. We are a neighborhood of families with children, elderly, and pets, and we have asked for years for traffic coming, such as to add a stop sign on Hopkins and Ordway, to no avail.

1183
03:06:03.740 --> 03:06:13.179
Boardroom: This proposal will cause cars to go even faster than they already do, because the street will appear wider. Now, there will be four lanes of vehicles, making it like a freeway of wheels.

1184
03:06:13.210 --> 03:06:23.070
Boardroom: Along Hopkins Street, many of the lots are more than one unit, and do not have off-street parking. Nowhere else in Berkeley has all of the parking been removed from a residential street.

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1185
03:06:23.070 --> 03:06:34.069
Boardroom: For residents, it would be very difficult for things we depend on every day. Deliveries, caregivers, maintenance vehicles, especially those with large equipment, and visiting friends and family all will have nowhere to pull over or park.

1186
03:06:34.070 --> 03:06:45.640
Boardroom: I think about how it would make it very difficult for my elderly father, who uses a walker, to visit us. It will also be difficult and dangerous for families with small children to have carpools if there's nowhere to pull over.

1187
03:06:45.830 --> 03:07:05.000
Boardroom: There is a better way. Our North Berkeley design team, made of architects, engineers, planners, and landscape architects, drafted plans and street sections, and show that there are viable options for a balanced alternative to have both bike lanes and only 50% parking reduction. Our group provided 5 options to the council members and public works.

1188
03:07:05.000 --> 03:07:18.200
Boardroom: Please don't vote for this proposal just to prove you have gotten something approved, when it's not the best solution. Approve a balanced option, like Bacabee, I'm sorry if I'm saying your name wrong, that works for everyone. Thank you very much.

1189
03:07:26.520 --> 03:07:29.539
Boardroom: I have 3 seated minutes.

1190
03:07:31.680 --> 03:07:42.400
Boardroom: Sorry, can you hold your hand up, the people in the back? Oh, okay, wait, there are a lot of people holding their hands up. You just need three. You just need 3, so could you…

1191
03:07:42.600 --> 03:07:45.719
Boardroom: Can you decide who the three are, please?

1192
03:07:45.900 --> 03:08:01.370
Boardroom: And my wife, and you're not my wife. Okay, so one here, second person there, thank you, and the third person is in the back, thank you. Thank you.

1193

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03:08:01.660 --> 03:08:08.990
Boardroom: So, my name is Martin Hammer. I'm an architect, and I've lived on Hopkins Street for 27 years.

1194
03:08:09.110 --> 03:08:19.959
Boardroom: Saturday, I distributed flyers in front of the shops, notifying people of the city's current plan to install cycle tracks and remove all street parking from McGee to Peralta.

1195
03:08:19.960 --> 03:08:32.029
Boardroom: which almost no one on Hopkins was aware of until our North Berkeley design team began informing them two and a half weeks ago, when the significantly changed current plan was first made public.

1196
03:08:32.450 --> 03:08:41.169
Boardroom: I handed a flyer to a man getting into his car to explain the city's plan. He said, I don't care, man. I'm pro-bike.

1197
03:08:41.600 --> 03:08:42.899
Boardroom: He doesn't care.

1198
03:08:44.090 --> 03:08:59.040
Boardroom: After this, after he had just accessed the shops with his car, and parked in a spot to be eliminated by the city's plan. I had just talked with the co-owner, a co-owner of Magnani's, who described the vast majority of comments

1199
03:08:59.140 --> 03:09:07.350
Boardroom: She received from customers who drive from all over, some of them needing wheelchairs, stating the importance of retaining street parking.

1200
03:09:07.500 --> 03:09:11.869
Boardroom: She also described nasty attack comments from pro-bike people.

1201
03:09:12.200 --> 03:09:23.950
Boardroom: All of that said, I'm pro-bike. I've bicycled 100-mile bike rides, I've bicycled all over Berkeley and the East Bay. I want safe bicycling in Berkeley.

1202
03:09:24.910 --> 03:09:38.349

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Boardroom: However, I'm also pro-pedestrian, pro-business and their customers and staff, pro-Hopkins Street residents and nearby residents, pro-recreation facility users, pro-churchgoers, pro-preschools.

1203
03:09:38.440 --> 03:09:46.910
Boardroom: As an architect for 40 years, every day, I work to create balanced designs. I know a balanced design when I see it.

1204
03:09:47.160 --> 03:09:50.120
Boardroom: This is not a balanced design.

1205
03:09:50.870 --> 03:09:57.519
Boardroom: It gives a subset of bicyclists everything it wants, and harms virtually every other constituent group.

1206
03:09:57.730 --> 03:10:08.789
Boardroom: Most of it due to the staggering, unprecedented removal of street parking. 175 of 239 spaces from the Alameda to Peralta

1207
03:10:08.790 --> 03:10:17.790
Boardroom: And now another 83 spaces, if C.M. Taplin's supplemental extending to the tracks to Stanage occurs.

1208
03:10:18.170 --> 03:10:29.770
Boardroom: Including 100%, 122 spaces over 7 contiguous blocks from McGee to Peralta. It's never been done for good reason. It causes significant harm.

1209
03:10:31.240 --> 03:10:54.939
Boardroom: Including matters of safety, access, and equity. I'm confident no one in Berkeley, including council members, would support the removal of 100% of parking on the street they live on. And how can you approve a plan that removes 175 to 258 parking spaces, as much as 80%, when a parking study admittedly has not been done?

1210
03:10:55.490 --> 03:11:03.139
Boardroom: That is… it's mind-boggling. I can't… I can't even… I'm speech… I'm almost speechless, but I'm gonna continue.

1211
03:11:04.640 --> 03:11:23.590
Boardroom: Berkeley prides itself on innovation and representative democracy. One solution to this seemingly intractable conflict is to put

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representatives of all key stakeholders together with an independent mediator to work out a consensus conceptual design.

1212
03:11:23.720 --> 03:11:35.310
Boardroom: What do they all want? What and need? Where can they compromise? In my profession, I've seen mediation work, and believe it can work here in a matter of months, not years.

1213
03:11:35.370 --> 03:11:46.920
Boardroom: I strongly encourage Council to approve the original referrals by CMs O'Keefe and Kessarwani for repaving pedestrian and pedestrian improvements that everyone agrees on.

1214
03:11:47.300 --> 03:11:55.189
Boardroom: And to facilitate independent mediation resulting in a consensus design that can be overlaid on the original referrals plan.

1215
03:11:55.190 --> 03:12:09.220
Boardroom: And I want to get a show of hands for people who oppose this… the city's plan to see if it comports with Representative… or, CM Kasarwani's 50-50 plan. Thank you. Thanks for your time. Thank you.

1216
03:12:09.220 --> 03:12:10.140
Boardroom: Thank you.

1217
03:12:18.160 --> 03:12:20.390
Boardroom: Good evening.

1218
03:12:20.410 --> 03:12:32.919
Boardroom: It's been, really cool seeing this whole process. My name's Nick, I'm the, head coach for the Berkeley Mountain Bike team, and I'm a shop owner in Berkeley and a resident of Hopkins Ave.

1219
03:12:32.920 --> 03:12:50.710
Boardroom: I just wanted to come out here and really express, the need for greater safety on the Hopkins corridor, and I do believe that cycle tracks are a wave towards that. Right now, I consider it's the Hopkins Speedway, especially, where I live between the Alameda and Sutter.

1220
03:12:50.710 --> 03:13:15.700
Boardroom: The street is extremely wide. I've seen drivers coming by at speeds in excess of 50 miles an hour. So I think, a big theme that we have here tonight is increasing safety and making sure that everyone

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feels like they have a place at the table. I just wanted to make sure that we, really consider how we can make traffic calming and safer for everyone. I do believe that bike lanes and bike infrastructure

1221
03:13:15.700 --> 03:13:23.120
Boardroom: help protect the most vulnerable people in our communities, and, thank you for your time. Yeah. Thank you.

1222
03:13:26.920 --> 03:13:32.220
Boardroom: Let's see, I have minutes from Steve Jackson, Chris Ascott, and Chris Crawl.

1223
03:13:33.240 --> 03:13:42.200
Boardroom: Missing one. Sorry, I see two… Steve Jackson? Chris Baskin? Chris Call. Do you want to give me a minute?

1224
03:13:42.820 --> 03:13:53.750
Boardroom: Okay, I see that third… Alright, I saw that third person in the back. Are you gonna give your minute, sir, with the glasses? I'm sorry, in the standing in the back, are you giving your minute as well?

1225
03:13:54.300 --> 03:14:03.550
Boardroom: Yes, you, sir, with a collared shirt. No? Okay. I'm taking one from this man with the orange shirt, and then this person with the backpack.

1226
03:14:03.580 --> 03:14:19.000
Boardroom: Okay, and from… Alright, we're all in a giving mood still. So, 4. That's four. Thank you so much. 4 total, yep. Alright, thank you. So, my name is Margaret Torne. I'm a walker, bike rider, and a climate change scientist for my day job.

1227
03:14:19.390 --> 03:14:30.670
Boardroom: I oppose the referral by Kesserwani, I strongly support the supplemental by C.M. Blackaby, and I want to say I'm not here to talk about parking.

1228
03:14:30.910 --> 03:14:44.839
Boardroom: What I specifically support is I support infrastructure that enhances safety for bicyclists, pedestrians, and motorists, and accessibility for all. I really strongly support small businesses that make Berkeley special.

1229

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03:14:45.340 --> 03:14:53.330
Boardroom: I think we can demand progress that brings us together by insisting on inclusive solutions, and I'm sorry I'm not hearing very much of that.

1230
03:14:53.610 --> 03:15:06.560
Boardroom: And really looking for tight stewardship of the city budget and taxpayer dollars, especially before the city asks for more bond measures and sales tax increases.

1231
03:15:07.540 --> 03:15:17.830
Boardroom: Most especially, I think we would all feel better if we felt we had policymaking that was evidence-based and expert-based. And a digression? I said I'm a scientist.

1232
03:15:18.590 --> 03:15:30.960
Boardroom: I'm federally funded, and it almost makes me cry when I think that my own city doesn't want to believe in evidence and use it openly, and tells the staff what to do. That's heartbreaking, because we are better than that.

1233
03:15:31.550 --> 03:15:34.219
Boardroom: So good policy manages trade-offs.

1234
03:15:34.380 --> 03:15:50.009
Boardroom: trade-offs and compromise. That might sound abstract, but I think without sound, transparent and inclusive governance, what we will have is waste and failure and more stalling. It's already taken a long time, and I'm sorry for the people waiting for all these improvements.

1235
03:15:50.010 --> 03:15:56.909
Boardroom: But things will cost more, stall out again, waste city resources, and ultimately not accomplish our goals if we don't

1236
03:15:56.920 --> 03:15:59.880
Boardroom: Practice a better,

1237
03:16:00.290 --> 03:16:17.369
Boardroom: process, and that's why I support, Blackaby's Amendment. And in terms of evidence, I want to reinforce what we've heard, that currently, although the, chief of the fire department said, yes, they could consider 10 and a half feet and 11, and that was a change.

1238

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03:16:18.010 --> 03:16:37.879
Boardroom: They… let's not say that they've reviewed it, because they haven't seen this plan. We also… we need to prevent more injuries, totally in favor of that, but we don't actually have an analysis that says, what can we do in intersections, and how do cycle tracks intersect with danger in intersections?

1239
03:16:38.830 --> 03:16:39.740
Boardroom: And…

1240
03:16:40.070 --> 03:16:53.069
Boardroom: I guess my last main point is that I think we are being asked, many people across the city being asked to sacrifice for a greater good, and that greater good is one thing that people had in mind, which was the cycle track.

1241
03:16:53.560 --> 03:17:00.989
Boardroom: And I don't think we've really asked, what are we asking people to sacrifice? And as a result, there's a real dis…

1242
03:17:01.140 --> 03:17:09.420
Boardroom: dissension, and there's a lack of engagement with many stakeholders. Like, who has studied the shops or tried to work with them to mitigate options?

1243
03:17:09.790 --> 03:17:10.849
Boardroom: Who has done that?

1244
03:17:10.950 --> 03:17:17.879
Boardroom: Who has studied the effect of raised curbs and tracks in front of our disabled residents, and said, how can we mitigate it?

1245
03:17:18.310 --> 03:17:26.839
Boardroom: There's been really a lack of searching for a solution that could bring people together, and so we're sacrificing the money for other

1246
03:17:27.030 --> 03:17:39.339
Boardroom: districts who need it. If we put in an extra $6 million, which I think we heard earlier, that's coming out of someone else's safety. Let's make sure we know what that greater good is for everyone.

1247
03:17:39.620 --> 03:17:57.829

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Boardroom: And I think people would go along with the sacrifice if we know, but if we recognize that sacrifice is autonomy, being able to live with accessibility independently and safely, it's the shops, it's schools, including the special needs pre-care near a house, and people need to drive there.

1248
03:17:58.010 --> 03:18:16.870
Boardroom: the churches we've heard from. So these are sacrifices, and we can make them, but we need to know why, and that the impacts, really, we try to engage and mitigate them. Otherwise, it's just we want cycle tracks, that was the solution. Thank you. That was 3 minutes or 4? That was 4. Perfect, thank you. Thanks.

1249
03:18:19.710 --> 03:18:21.339
Boardroom: Next speaker, please.

1250
03:18:28.490 --> 03:18:30.730
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Martino.

1251
03:18:31.150 --> 03:18:38.520
Boardroom: For the last 20 years, I've been riding a bicycle as my main way of getting around in this town.

1252
03:18:39.360 --> 03:18:43.699
Boardroom: I'm 86 years old, so I'm an elder.

1253
03:18:44.070 --> 03:18:51.710
Boardroom: Now… I am dead set against this, proposal.

1254
03:18:52.210 --> 03:19:02.989
Boardroom: And here's why. What it's going to do is destroy the small stores and places to hang out on the, on,

1255
03:19:03.150 --> 03:19:09.970
Boardroom: The, the, the avenue there, just as… Traffic has…

1256
03:19:10.180 --> 03:19:20.639
Boardroom: Parking spaces, have been used to, against small businesses all over town.

1257
03:19:20.830 --> 03:19:34.020

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Boardroom: And we are losing the ability to find a place where we can shop, where we can hang out, we can just be with people, anywhere in this city, because we're losing them. Thank you for your comments.

1258
03:19:34.860 --> 03:19:35.680
Boardroom: Next.

1259
03:19:41.360 --> 03:19:53.140
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Mahmoud Hosseini. Hi. Oh, I'm sorry. My name is Mahmoud Hosseini. I do the business next to the monitoring market for 24 years.

1260
03:19:53.400 --> 03:19:55.150
Boardroom: As a flower's window.

1261
03:19:56.020 --> 03:20:07.530
Boardroom: And I see the sign here, bike life is matter. I think business life is matter, and neighborhood life is matter, too.

1262
03:20:09.320 --> 03:20:17.090
Boardroom: If it's that thing, I'm not against the bike, I'm the… I'm the biker, I do the two, three days biking. If it's that things happen.

1263
03:20:17.210 --> 03:20:26.340
Boardroom: For sure, I'm gonna be homeless without any question, without any question, because I'm 60 years old. I don't think so anybody give me job.

1264
03:20:26.830 --> 03:20:41.949
Boardroom: And then, I don't think so the guys… I think I know the Hopkins better than anybody, because I'm there from 10 o'clock to 7 o'clock, 6 days a week. I know the street really well, I know the whole people.

1265
03:20:42.590 --> 03:20:43.880
Boardroom: I think there…

1266
03:20:44.320 --> 03:20:49.929
Boardroom: Thank you for your cup. Does someone want to give them… you'll give them a minute? Okay, go ahead, one more minute.

1267
03:20:50.140 --> 03:20:56.699

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Boardroom: I think you guys didn't think about the monetary market. Monetary market, they have 37 employees.

1268
03:20:56.960 --> 03:20:59.150
Boardroom: They have 37 cars.

1269
03:20:59.420 --> 03:21:11.389
Boardroom: They come in at 4 o'clock in the morning. Where… I mean, I'm not trying to talk about behind the monetary market, behind the monerie Market, but where is those people they have to put the car?

1270
03:21:11.610 --> 03:21:17.079
Boardroom: 37 employees coming at 4 o'clock in the morning. There's no parking for them.

1271
03:21:17.820 --> 03:21:26.210
Boardroom: I think if it's not there, you cannot have your vegetable and fruit. Let me tell you that much. Thank you very much.

1272
03:21:26.820 --> 03:21:27.790
Boardroom: Thank you.

1273
03:21:40.150 --> 03:21:58.469
Boardroom: Can I start? Well, my name is William, I'm the mail carrier for 12, 13, and 14 Hopkins. I'm opposing that parking, the bike link, for the parking, because it's gonna affect me, and I have deliveries to make. It's gonna cost me more time if you put that bike link on that street.

1274
03:21:58.680 --> 03:21:59.920
Boardroom: So…

1275
03:22:00.370 --> 03:22:15.740
Boardroom: if you go to put it, where are we supposed to… what were we supposed to do in getting our deliveries made to the customer? You guys, as the customer, need deliveries, too, as we deliver the parcels to you guys, so if you put that bike lane, it's gonna be…

1276
03:22:15.920 --> 03:22:30.970
Boardroom: not good for me, and it's gonna cost time, and it's gonna delay, and it's gonna really affect us, because like I said, you already took two parking spaces already from us already. So, by putting that bike lane, it's gonna interfere with my job.

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1277
03:22:31.100 --> 03:22:37.600
Boardroom: And it's gonna interfere with the customer, so I'm opposing the bike lane, so there shouldn't be a bike lane at all, and I…

1278
03:22:37.760 --> 03:22:45.920
Boardroom: fought this a couple years back, and you thought about it, so I hope you guys decide, and I'm not putting that bike lane for my job.

1279
03:22:50.460 --> 03:22:59.650
Boardroom: Hi, Carol Marasovic and Marvin Snow are donating minutes. Two minutes. Thank you. My name is Nancy Rader, I live in District 6.

1280
03:22:59.780 --> 03:23:08.660
Boardroom: Opponents of the cycle track are cast as pro-car, anti-climate, anti-safety, and selfish, and a big dose of ageism, for sure.

1281
03:23:08.710 --> 03:23:21.189
Boardroom: But let's be fair. In 1976, Berkeleyans voted to support street barriers that greatly reduced traffic on most residential streets in the flats, a feature that's found in very few cities.

1282
03:23:21.250 --> 03:23:30.469
Boardroom: Berkeley's extensive bicycle boulevard network was built on that foundation, allowing cyclists to get across town safely on quiet, pleasant streets.

1283
03:23:30.520 --> 03:23:45.149
Boardroom: Although inconvenient to drivers, virtually everyone supports these quiet streets, even those of us in the hills who do not directly benefit, because we're not pro-car, anti-climate, anti-safety, or selfish. We are old, a lot of us.

1284
03:23:45.360 --> 03:23:52.479
Boardroom: Protecting residential streets requires that drivers use the major streets, unless they want to get lost in the maze.

1285
03:23:52.620 --> 03:24:12.500
Boardroom: But now a group of activists has decided that the bike network isn't good enough and that cycle tracks should be added to our congested main streets so cycles can ride directly to their commercial destinations without having to walk a block or two. And in the hope that drivers will get so frustrated that they'll give up their cars.

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1286
03:24:12.520 --> 03:24:32.490
Boardroom: In an ideal world, sure, but over 10,000, maybe 20,000 of us live in the hills with narrow roads and blind corners. And not everyone has the luxury of working, shopping, and caring for kids or family members within bike-commutable distance. Nor does everyone have time in their busy lives to bike miles a day with a cart in tow.

1287
03:24:32.650 --> 03:24:49.390
Boardroom: Most importantly, many people cannot safely bike at all. Roughly 12% of Berkeleyans are over 70, and about 8% of people under 70 have disabilities. That's 20% of our population. Now, a relative few of those folks do bike, but not many.

1288
03:24:49.740 --> 03:24:59.300
Boardroom: Whereas the ADA promotes universal designs that benefit everyone, such as curb cuts that allow strollers and rolling grocery carts to easily use the sidewalk.

1289
03:24:59.300 --> 03:25:12.650
Boardroom: or automatic door buttons that allow people holding two coffee cups to exit. Cycle tracks inherently harm people with disabilities who need parking near their destinations and safe access to the curb and public transit.

1290
03:25:12.650 --> 03:25:18.369
Boardroom: They also need unbroken streets and sidewalks to avoid upturned wheelchairs and tripping and falling.

1291
03:25:18.380 --> 03:25:33.739
Boardroom: Berkeley has tens of thousands of ADA violations that it is obligated to correct, yet this proposal would spend $5 million on bike infrastructure that would create new bike barriers… not barriers for people with disabilities.

1292
03:25:34.070 --> 03:25:42.229
Boardroom: No barriers, erecting barriers in the town that was a cradle of disability rights and independent living movement.

1293
03:25:42.230 --> 03:26:01.460
Boardroom: So please, let's care about all Berkeleyans, let's improve our bike network, especially on Ada and Sacramento streets, let's fix our broken streets and sidewalks, and let's keep our public spaces accessible to all. Let's also consider what the congestion that will be added will do to our emergency response times. Thank you, Nancy. Thank you.

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1294
03:26:08.530 --> 03:26:31.430
Boardroom: Hello, my name's Rachel Bradley, and I've lived here all my life. I went to middle school at King, I took my kids to soccer games and swimming lessons next door, I drove my elderly mother to walk on the track when she needed a level and protected surface to exercise safely. I continue to shop every week at the Monterey Market, and I have invested energy and love in this community for many years.

1295
03:26:31.470 --> 03:26:38.950
Boardroom: I strongly urge the Council to adopt Councilmember O'Keefe's practical and financially responsible proposal.

1296
03:26:39.140 --> 03:26:50.729
Boardroom: to repave Hopkins with necessary enhancements for pedestrian safety. It deserves special respect, since the upper part of Hopkins falls in her council district, and she is herself a regular cyclist.

1297
03:26:50.730 --> 03:27:04.090
Boardroom: The city's budget is in trouble, and this is not the time to sink millions of extra dollars into cycle tracks on Hopkins, especially without properly evaluating reasonable alternatives. It's home to many important civic amenities that we all deserve access to.

1298
03:27:04.090 --> 03:27:13.400
Boardroom: The current state is dangerous to everybody, especially pedestrians. The longer we wait, the more it will cost. Please keep it simple, and repave Hopkins now. Thank you.

1299
03:27:18.620 --> 03:27:26.570
Boardroom: Hello. Thank you to Council and staff. I'm a parent of two young children, and I live on Hopkins Street.

1300
03:27:27.200 --> 03:27:43.949
Boardroom: I'm the parent of two young children, and I live on Hopkins Street. Currently, Hopkins Street is not safe to bike on. As a family, we choose to bike when possible. Currently, I will not let my children ride on Hopkins Street. The traffic in the street moves incredibly fast, creating an unsafe ride for cyclists.

1301
03:27:44.080 --> 03:27:49.190
Boardroom: The installation of bike lanes will naturally slow traffic in the area, making the street safer for everyone.

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1302
03:27:49.460 --> 03:27:59.190
Boardroom: My wife saw, just about a month ago, saw a middle school student hit on their bike in the middle of the intersection from our front porch. We constantly see close calls there.

1303
03:27:59.370 --> 03:28:05.809
Boardroom: I support the current referral to install bike lanes on Hopkins Street to continue connecting the bike network.

1304
03:28:05.950 --> 03:28:08.649
Boardroom: The protected bike lanes will make the neighborhood safer.

1305
03:28:08.790 --> 03:28:22.469
Boardroom: We are right now deciding between safety and the inconvenience of lost parking. Safety should always take priority. Let's plan for the future, let's give our children a safe route to ride their bikes to school and everyone else a safe route to get around without driving. Thank you. Thank you.

1306
03:28:26.350 --> 03:28:34.570
Boardroom: Good evening, I'm Alice Green. I'm 85 years old, and I want safety riding my bike.

1307
03:28:34.840 --> 03:28:49.930
Boardroom: And on Hopkins, it is not safe. It's so narrow, there's just nothing. There's no narrow bike lane, no nothing. Please make that street safe. I use it a lot.

1308
03:28:50.020 --> 03:28:59.700
Boardroom: And I, I, I've lived in Berkeley for 32 years, very near Hopkins, and I implore you to.

1309
03:28:59.830 --> 03:29:06.740
Boardroom: Implement this plan and make it safe for bikes. Thanks. Thank you.

1310
03:29:10.970 --> 03:29:22.700
Boardroom: Hello, my name's Lucinda Young, and I also am a senior. I will be 70 years old this year. My primary form of transportation is bicycle, although I also drive as well.

1311
03:29:22.700 --> 03:29:41.729

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Boardroom: And I strongly support this recommendation. Thank you, staff, for your hard work and all the extensive outreach you've done on this. I travel to Hopkins, usually on my bike, though I also drive occasionally, but usually on my bike, at least weekly. I've been doing it for a decade. It's extremely unsafe.

1312
03:29:41.730 --> 03:29:58.740
Boardroom: And, in addition to… let's just not wait for another fatality or serious accident to correct this problem. We've got a big problem on Hopkins. My second reason, besides safety, for strongly supporting this, is we are in a full-blown climate emergency.

1313
03:29:58.740 --> 03:30:18.270
Boardroom: And half of our greenhouse gas pollution comes from transportation, mostly cars. Our, climate emergency plan specifically calls for… its number one recommendation is to reduce VMT by making cycling, walking, and public transit modes mainstream. Thank you.

1314
03:30:23.560 --> 03:30:41.479
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Stefan Zager. I've lived with my family on Hopkins Street across from King Park for 15 years. I'm also probably the most experienced urban cyclist you're ever likely to meet, or one of them. I've lived and biked in North Oakland and Berkeley for 35 years. I also spent 5 years working full-time as a bicycle messenger.

1315
03:30:41.480 --> 03:30:44.219
Boardroom: I'm here to ask you to vote no on this motion.

1316
03:30:44.220 --> 03:31:03.530
Boardroom: The main problem with the current proposal is that it is a blunt force, one-size-fits-all design that is badly matched to the quirks of Hopkins Street. What makes sense for the residential blocks does not make sense for the commercial areas. The stretch from Gilman to Monterey handles more vehicle traffic than the ones above and below. The area around the tennis courts, pool, park, and track has its own unique requirements.

1317
03:31:03.540 --> 03:31:19.129
Boardroom: Say what you will about the previous design process, but it at least was an attempt in good faith to tailor a plan to the diverse nature of the problem, and to hammer out sensible compromises among stakeholders. The proposal under consideration tonight has all the nuance of a Walmart parking lot.

1318
03:31:19.300 --> 03:31:34.680

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Boardroom: And I know… I know that the motion directs staff to conduct outreach to stakeholders, but the problem is that once you make separate class… Thank you. I'm sorry, your time's up. Minute in the back. Oh, sorry, with the green shirt, I'm taking your minute. Go ahead.

1319
03:31:34.930 --> 03:31:47.120
Boardroom: The problem is that once you make separate, separated Class 4 bikeways on both sides of the street, the non-negotiable north star of the plan, well, Hopkins is not that wide, and it leaves no wiggle room for adapting to local conditions.

1320
03:31:47.120 --> 03:32:02.080
Boardroom: You have an opportunity to do something really great here. Hopkins has a lot of room for improvement. You also have an opportunity to really harm this neighborhood and everyone who visits it for generations to come. It's your job as council members to consider all the stakeholders here.

1321
03:32:02.080 --> 03:32:05.840
Boardroom: And to forge a reasonable compromise. This is not that. Thank you.

1322
03:32:14.260 --> 03:32:18.709
Boardroom: I think I… I think I have another minute from… Carla?

1323
03:32:18.790 --> 03:32:43.050
Boardroom: woman with the yellow shirt and the hat. Thank you. Okay, thank you. I'm Corey Cody, and I've lived and voted in Berkeley for over 30 years, and I consider this plan to be flawed. First of all, I think it's fiscally irresponsible. My understanding, and I think I'm underestimating, is that it would cost an extra $5 million.

1324
03:32:43.220 --> 03:33:00.420
Boardroom: a lot of money, and this is a time when we're being asked to vote for more sales tax and for bonds. I'm not gonna vote for those things. And you know what? When we… when the whole city realizes that something irresponsible, like this

1325
03:33:00.450 --> 03:33:11.270
Boardroom: plan has been… if it, God forbid, gets implemented, people are going to not want to vote for these extra taxes.

1326
03:33:11.330 --> 03:33:19.960

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Boardroom: So, what I'm hearing today is that some people want this, but the majority do not. And,

1327
03:33:20.170 --> 03:33:26.940
Boardroom: So I think it's really, in my heart, it's not just that it's fiscally irresponsible, it's that…

1328
03:33:26.940 --> 03:33:49.080
Boardroom: It inflicts real harm on the majority of people who are involved with this neighborhood. This is a thriving, intergenerational neighborhood, and my understanding is that 100 parking spaces, but now I've been educated that it's more like 175 parking spaces will be lost. So.

1329
03:33:49.100 --> 03:34:03.549
Boardroom: What does it mean? Is it a minor inconvenience to lose a parking space? Because that's what I've heard from the other side. To lose a parking space means that many Berkeleyans will no longer have access to a neighborhood.

1330
03:34:03.550 --> 03:34:12.210
Boardroom: They'll no longer have access to the services of the small-scale mom-and-pop businesses that make this neighborhood so successful.

1331
03:34:12.400 --> 03:34:24.939
Boardroom: Realistically, we get to the… many of us get to these small shops by car. And guess what? If you have a car, you have to park it. And many of us need

1332
03:34:25.040 --> 03:34:30.820
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks for calling. Is that 2 minutes already? That's it. Oh my god. Thank you. Well, please vote against this.

1333
03:34:34.830 --> 03:34:59.790
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council. My name is Jean Walsh, and I am on the AC Transit Board of Directors. This is my first Berkeley Council meeting. I picked a great one to come to. I'm speaking tonight in my personal capacity. I've heard a lot of talk tonight and in the media about cycling versus parking. I haven't heard a lot about transit, and I just wanted to bring up the fact that, people who ride the bus are often seniors, people with disabilities, people who can't bike, people who can't

1334
03:34:59.790 --> 03:35:24.699

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Boardroom: afford a car, and they, they depend on transit. AC Transit runs line 12 along Hopkins, and it carries an average of about 3,000 people per day, and AC Transit staff have been working on this project with your staff for several years, have been following along, and I know that previous versions, the staff was concerned about bus boarding islands. This current proposal by, Councilmember Kesarwani has the bus boarding islands.

1335
03:35:24.700 --> 03:35:41.820
Boardroom: which make it safer and improve transit operations. So I support that proposal as a, individual, and I am confident that if your staff continue to work with AC Transit, you'll have a great project that benefits the entire community. Thank you so much.

1336
03:35:43.140 --> 03:35:51.420
Boardroom: And Mayor, just a quick time check, there's about, 44 minutes left in in-person public comment. Yep, thank you.

1337
03:35:52.980 --> 03:35:59.699
Boardroom: Good evening, Council. My name is Mark Hedlund. Biking on city streets, including Hopkins, is legal.

1338
03:35:59.700 --> 03:36:19.130
Boardroom: The question before us tonight is whether Hopkins will be safer for everyone, including people on bikes. I strongly support Councilmember Kesarwani's item with Councilmember Taplin's and, Lunapara's Supplemental, and I urge you to vote for them tonight, fund them, and get them done.

1339
03:36:19.130 --> 03:36:25.580
Boardroom: Please do not send this item back for more study and delay. It's been 8 years since the initial referral.

1340
03:36:25.580 --> 03:36:34.960
Boardroom: Making other streets safer will not make Hopkins safe. And as Councilmember O'Keefe notes, delay only makes repaving Hopkins more expensive.

1341
03:36:34.960 --> 03:36:47.919
Boardroom: There is no magic compromise that preserves all parking on Hopkins and makes Hopkins safer for everyone. You have to choose the policy you believe is best for Berkeley. Please choose safety for all. Thank you very much.

1342

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03:36:47.920 --> 03:36:49.000
Boardroom: Thank you.

1343
03:36:52.250 --> 03:37:05.919
Boardroom: Mark also organizes kitticle Mass. If anyone has been on that, it's amazing. Go ahead. Good evening, Mayor and Councilmembers. My name's Innervon Chatterjee, I'm a North Berkeley resident and a car-free Hopkins shopper.

1344
03:37:06.480 --> 03:37:12.970
Boardroom: I'm worried about the real and very immediate harm that would be caused by ignoring Vision Zero and the climate emergency.

1345
03:37:13.090 --> 03:37:32.530
Boardroom: Your worst option today would be to refuse to actually make a tough choice, or to refer this to staff and throw them under the SUV by just making them deal with a political, difficult choice without any kind of support. Staff need your direction and policy. Please make a decision today, and don't leave us all hanging. Thank you. Thank you.

1346
03:37:35.700 --> 03:38:00.649
Boardroom: Good evening, Council. I'm Liza Lutzger. In my day job, I am a traffic safety public health researcher, and… but tonight I'm speaking as an individual, but also on behalf of Walk Bike Berkeley. We understand that change is hard, but we are in strong support of Councilmember Kesarwani's referral and Taplin and Lunapara's supplemental. Ideally, we'd like to extend the protected lanes at least to Milvia to create a true low

1347
03:38:00.650 --> 03:38:15.549
Boardroom: stress-protected network connecting West Berkeley and our neighbors to the north with downtown Berkeley and the CAL campus. We especially encourage strong curb management strategies to meet the needs of people with disabilities and cherished local businesses.

1348
03:38:15.550 --> 03:38:23.469
Boardroom: As council members, you make the decisions for the benefit of the city, both as it stands now, and what it will look like in the future.

1349
03:38:23.470 --> 03:38:45.589
Boardroom: We are at a crossroads as we add much-needed housing, and also as the micromobility movement booms. You must make a choice. You can choose to meet this moment by giving in to people's anger, speculation,

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and worst fears, or you can choose to rely on the reams of evidence that point towards the success of a connected and protected network. Thanks.

1350
03:38:50.850 --> 03:38:57.610
Boardroom: Good evening, Council. My name is Jacob Dadman. I'm here representing the Sierra Club.

1351
03:38:57.760 --> 03:39:06.709
Boardroom: We strongly support item 27, directing the City Manager to proceed with the Hopkins Street repaving project while implementing protected bike lanes.

1352
03:39:06.880 --> 03:39:15.460
Boardroom: We also support extending the protected bike lanes west to Stanage Avenue and east to Sutter Street, consistent with Berkeley's adopted bicycle plan.

1353
03:39:15.630 --> 03:39:39.639
Boardroom: Transportation is the largest source of greenhouse gas emissions in California and in Berkeley. Meeting our climate goals requires more than just transitioning to cleaner vehicles. It requires creating communities where walking, bicycling, rolling, and public transit are safe, convenient, and attractive choices for everyday trips. Streets are among the most important public spaces we have.

1354
03:39:39.640 --> 03:39:40.900
Boardroom: And they should be safe.

1355
03:39:41.470 --> 03:39:53.390
Boardroom: For decades, Berkeley has adopted policies calling for a safe, connected network for walking, bicycling, and transit. The Hopkins Project is the product of those commitments. Thank you very much.

1356
03:39:54.270 --> 03:39:55.509
Boardroom: Thank you.

1357
03:39:58.740 --> 03:40:21.179
Boardroom: Good evening, Mary Ishi and Councilmember. Sam Greenberg here, speaking on behalf of East Bay for Everyone. We are here today in strong support of finally building protected bike lanes on Hopkins for many of the reasons that have already been shared here. We know that protected bike lanes are how to make streets safe for people riding bikes. But I also want to speak briefly to how we know that sharrows are not, and in fact, studies have shown sharrows to actually make streets

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1358
03:40:21.180 --> 03:40:30.360
Boardroom: less safe. I want to read you a quote from traffic engineer James McKay, who pioneered the use of sharrows in the United States, who once explained why he

1359
03:40:30.360 --> 03:40:42.780
Boardroom: pioneered them in an interview. Quote, part of it was the city of Denver's reluctance to do much of anything for bicycles, and quote, I was always under pressure to do less as the Denver bicycle planner.

1360
03:40:42.820 --> 03:40:58.649
Boardroom: We have known for a long time that sharrows are unsafe. It's not just that they don't make streets safer, they make streets less safe. And we've known for a long time that this has been enough process. It's time to end the process and protected bike lanes on Hopkins. Thank you.

1361
03:40:58.770 --> 03:41:00.620
Boardroom: Thank you, Sam.

1362
03:41:04.650 --> 03:41:16.680
Boardroom: Hello, Council and Mayor. My name is Brandon Young. I'm here to voice my support for, Councilmember Keserwani's item with, Councilmembers Lunapara and Taplin's supplemental. That's all. Thank you.

1363
03:41:17.610 --> 03:41:18.890
Boardroom: Thank you.

1364
03:41:22.470 --> 03:41:27.019
Boardroom: Hey, everyone. If y'all could make a decision on this, I could be at dinner.

1365
03:41:27.140 --> 03:41:45.990
Boardroom: Here to support Councilmember Quesarvani's, proposal and the supplemental by Councilmembers Taplin and Lona Parra. Change can be hard. I understand people's frustration, fear. Climate change is harder, and it's harder already on the people

1366
03:41:46.100 --> 03:42:00.600
Boardroom: and the places where I come from, that may not be in the room today. I wasn't gonna speak, but I couldn't help myself. Because we have… I moved to Berkeley. I'm not gonna say how long I lived here, because I

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don't think it matters, but I moved here because I thought we believed in climate change.

1367
03:42:00.600 --> 03:42:13.030
Boardroom: Process doesn't save lives. Plans don't save lives. The only thing that saves lives is bold and visionary action. And you have an opportunity to do that today. That's why you're our electeds.

1368
03:42:13.230 --> 03:42:26.080
Boardroom: This is not a popularity contest, this is a contest of, do we believe in climate change? Are we allowed… going to make changes to our infrastructure? So I hope you choose the right thing the world is watching. Thank you.

1369
03:42:30.660 --> 03:42:44.189
Boardroom: I will try and keep it brief, but I may use a minute from Sam here, if I need it. So, my name is Daria Rubel, I am a candidate for City Council District 1, and,

1370
03:42:44.320 --> 03:43:08.770
Boardroom: First of all, I just want to recognize what a difficult decision this is, how many stakeholders there are on all sides, and I want to encourage you to use your wisdom to make a decision tonight, and not delay this any longer. As a 20-year resident of District 1, I use Hopkins regularly, and I recognize that parking is important.

1371
03:43:08.950 --> 03:43:19.820
Boardroom: But lives are more important. And a protected bike lane from Stanich to Sutter is the right choice. I would be open to the possibility of a parallel

1372
03:43:19.820 --> 03:43:29.000
Boardroom: path, for part of that passage that protects parking, but we need to have protected bike lanes to save lives. Thank you very much.

1373
03:43:29.290 --> 03:43:30.850
Boardroom: Thank you, Daria.

1374
03:43:36.840 --> 03:44:01.840
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor Ishii and City Council. My name is Mia, and I am a resident of Berkeley. I'm speaking here in support of item 27 with, with the Luna Parraut Taplan Supplemental. As a pedestrian and micro-mobility user in North Berkeley, it cannot be overstated how crucial these safety improvements are for our community. This plan

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perfectly aligns with Berkeley's Vision Zero initiative, and only benefits our community by encouraging safe usage of bicycles

1375
03:44:01.840 --> 03:44:04.589
Boardroom: and other forms of micromobility.

1376
03:44:04.590 --> 03:44:24.169
Boardroom: While still fostering region connectivity. Additionally, the repaving of the street benefits all users of the road and is a responsible use of city funds. I also urge the Council to keep the Class II buffered bike lanes and not compromise for share rows. As someone who uses these streets as a micro-mobility user, I don't feel safe using share rows, and it's not a worthwhile compromise.

1377
03:44:24.250 --> 03:44:37.280
Boardroom: North… even though, you know, this has been on the agenda for a while, and I believe that North Berkeley residents deserve a decision today. Berkeley cyclists and pedestrians deserve to be safe on their streets. Their lives matter, too. Thank you.

1378
03:44:37.530 --> 03:44:38.850
Boardroom: Thank you, Mia.

1379
03:44:43.680 --> 03:44:57.480
Boardroom: Hi. Thank you, City Council. I live in District 3, and I recently biked down on Telegraph to visit my parents, and it's, if you've ever biked it, it does not feel safe. You switch between just a painted

1380
03:44:57.480 --> 03:45:15.619
Boardroom: bike lane, and being just in the road on a ferro. And every couple blocks, you're merging in, merging out of the traffic. And every time I go through that, I feel just a constant feeling, like, this time that I merge in, a car might not see me, and that just might be it for me.

1381
03:45:15.690 --> 03:45:24.540
Boardroom: And I would really not want that for Hopkins. For that reason, I'm here to encourage you to add bike lanes all the way down Hopkins.

1382
03:45:25.640 --> 03:45:48.019
Boardroom: Additionally, as we fulfill our part of fixing California's housing crisis, we need more ability for people to move around in Berkeley, for more people to live in Berkeley, and I believe the best ideal solution is to add more bike capacity, because they can be added

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without needing more cars, more parking structures, and everything. Thank you. Thank you.

1383
03:45:51.040 --> 03:45:59.570
Boardroom: I want to thank everyone here for being positive in your responses. I really appreciate folks not booing, and thank you.

1384
03:46:01.820 --> 03:46:19.790
Boardroom: Hello, City Council. My name is David Woolsey, and I live in the Hopkins area neighborhood and shop at Monterey Market, and I, too, am concerned about the loss of parking. But what I want to talk about is how bicycle paths get planned into

1385
03:46:19.960 --> 03:46:37.799
Boardroom: main traffic thoroughfares. There's an issue with air pollution that's generated by cars, either by internal combustion engine, tire wear, brake wear, etc. This is not the place that I would choose to bicycle, is in a main traffic thoroughfare.

1386
03:46:37.990 --> 03:46:57.930
Boardroom: Find a way parallel, and make that the bicycle path. Now, I understand that that neighborhood, the street grid, is all wonky, and it's hard to find a parallel path. This is a general piece of advice for other bicycle paths. Don't mix them on the main streets.

1387
03:46:58.030 --> 03:47:06.200
Boardroom: put them on the parallel streets as bicycle boulevards. Otherwise, you wind up breathing stuff you really oughtn't be breathing. Thank you.

1388
03:47:11.200 --> 03:47:15.600
Boardroom: Hi there. I'm Tim Cara Bruce.

1389
03:47:16.000 --> 03:47:26.550
Boardroom: I live in District 5. This is my first time attending a meeting. I'm urging the Council to vote yes on the item, and the supplemental to build protected bike lanes on Hopkins.

1390
03:47:26.750 --> 03:47:32.220
Boardroom: I ride a bike on Hopkins with my kids. I have Sasha, who's 7, and Zev, who's 2.

1391
03:47:32.370 --> 03:47:41.490

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Boardroom: I asked Sasha what she likes to do on Hopkins, and she said, the library, King Park, Joya Pizza, of course, and to visit our family in Westbrae.

1392
03:47:41.860 --> 03:47:49.940
Boardroom: I bought their helmets. This is Sasha with the butterflies and Zev. This inch of foam is what protects them.

1393
03:47:50.670 --> 03:47:56.199
Boardroom: They're precious, precious heads when we're riding on Hopkins and other shared roadways.

1394
03:47:57.120 --> 03:48:11.029
Boardroom: I don't expect you to prioritize these heads over all of the other lovely heads in Berkeley, but I do expect you to weigh them appropriately, Sasha and Zev, all the things that they will do with their lives against a handful of parking spaces. Thank you.

1395
03:48:12.190 --> 03:48:13.390
Boardroom: Thank you.

1396
03:48:17.120 --> 03:48:34.480
Boardroom: Hi, my name's Janice Moroda, and I grew up in Berkeley, on Rose in California. We shop mostly at the co-op where my father was a car mechanic, but if we ran out of milk, Grandma and I would walk down California Street to where it was, I think it was the Lewis Market.

1397
03:48:34.480 --> 03:48:56.809
Boardroom: And now, I don't live that close. I have to drive. I'm… does it… because I can't ride a bicycle, does that mean that I can't live in… I can't eat in Berkeley? What I'll do is I'll shop in El Cerrito if I can't shop at Monterey Market. I shop between 9.45 and 10.30 on Tuesdays and Wednesdays, because that's the only time I can sort of get in there and…

1398
03:48:57.610 --> 03:49:03.780
Boardroom: And park, and shop at a regional, you know, without a huge crowd, and then get out. So…

1399
03:49:03.940 --> 03:49:22.109
Boardroom: I think maybe the demand on Hopkins is too much, where all of us are using that corridor. I used to walk, though, to the North Branch Library. It's still my library, but now I have to drive there. So, I hope

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there's still room in Berkeley for some of us who need cars. Thank you. Thank you.

1400
03:49:27.240 --> 03:49:34.519
Boardroom: Hi, my name is Jocelyn Racinos, and I work at Berkeley Little School. We're on Hopkins and McGee, and so…

1401
03:49:34.520 --> 03:49:47.800
Boardroom: before this, there was a stop sign there now. We used to have a loading zone, and because the stop sign was added, it's now, red, and then we were giving a loading zone, like, right next to the… the apartments next door.

1402
03:49:47.800 --> 03:50:00.189
Boardroom: But what's gonna happen if this is passed is that we're gonna get rid of that loading zone, and where are we gonna drop off 42… we serve 42 students between the ages of 18 months to 5 years old, and not everyone drives a bike.

1403
03:50:00.190 --> 03:50:25.150
Boardroom: When they're dropping off their children, so… and I think about those parents that are coming with an 18-month-old and a 2-year-old, it makes it really hard for them to drop them off at school. I'm also a parent, I have my son that goes to work with me, he's at Berkeley Little School, and it's gonna make it very challenging, so I really want to also keep that in mind, that we have a preschool there that has been already affected by the previous loading zone being remote.

1404
03:50:25.150 --> 03:50:28.869
Boardroom: Moved, and then now we're gonna have an… well, hopefully not, but…

1405
03:50:28.870 --> 03:50:32.240
Boardroom: I don't want it to keep affecting. Thank you. Thank you.

1406
03:50:40.220 --> 03:50:42.659
Boardroom: I'm David White, I live in Peralta.

1407
03:50:42.850 --> 03:51:01.639
Boardroom: I met a lot of people in the last week passing this flyer around on Hopkins. In the back of it has all collision incidents involving a bicycle on Hopkins between Sutter and Stanage 2011 to 2026. 15 years, 8 accidents.

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1408
03:51:01.990 --> 03:51:08.000
Boardroom: Not the 23 that shows up in this… Flyer that was at the… Meeting.

1409
03:51:08.210 --> 03:51:26.580
Boardroom: All 8 of the accidents were in intersections. There's no protection at an intersection. Most of them were left-hand turns. Cycle tracks don't stop left-hand turns. But the most poignant person I met, and all the time, and it was an accident, and we were in the same line.

1410
03:51:26.850 --> 03:51:34.589
Boardroom: I met a woman who thanked me for flyering, because she says, I have a son in the preschool.

1411
03:51:34.900 --> 03:51:39.910
Boardroom: And I won't be able to drive them to school anymore, because there's no parking.

1412
03:51:40.040 --> 03:51:53.499
Boardroom: Think about it. If there's no parking, it means all the… Thank you. Thank you so much. Oh, there's someone over here. Okay. If there's no parking, that means the machines have to be moving.

1413
03:51:53.880 --> 03:51:58.600
Boardroom: If they have to be moving, it means there's no way to drop a kid off.

1414
03:51:58.780 --> 03:52:04.109
Boardroom: Or pick up an ant, Or certainly not stuff a kid in the backseat.

1415
03:52:04.560 --> 03:52:11.799
Boardroom: You are stopping life on this planet if you don't let people pause on a street.

1416
03:52:12.590 --> 03:52:25.070
Boardroom: 100% parking, blocking it off, doesn't work. How does branding work? You call it a protected bike lane, but you're sending kids through 100 driveways.

1417
03:52:25.240 --> 03:52:35.030

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Boardroom: with problems, every single one, as an intersection. It's making things more dangerous, it makes things harder to park.

1418
03:52:35.290 --> 03:52:48.460
Boardroom: Try to park after you get out of your driveway, go 5 feet, and then get around a cement block. That's what people are gonna have to do, have a little cement rodeo, twice a day, forever.

1419
03:52:49.340 --> 03:52:50.369
Boardroom: Thank you.

1420
03:52:58.200 --> 03:52:59.110
Boardroom: Ready?

1421
03:52:59.300 --> 03:53:07.859
Boardroom: Good evening, Madam Mayor and Council Members. My name is Sarah, and for 16 years, I've been part of Evangel Bible Church of Berkeley.

1422
03:53:07.860 --> 03:53:32.150
Boardroom: And over the years at our facility, I've helped to prepare lunches on Sundays, refreshments on Wednesdays, we also have special meals for large day conferences on Saturdays, as well as evening events during the weekdays. Removing access and parking to Hopkins would limit my ability to contribute to my community. And I really want you to hear that, and it would limit my ability to meet urgent needs.

1423
03:53:32.210 --> 03:53:51.929
Boardroom: as well as, it would put my safety at risk, especially at night when I'm even more concerned about my physical safety. I really do urge you to make a decision to continue the repavement of the roads, certainly, but I do strongly urge you to not remove our access to our church building. Thank you.

1424
03:53:53.280 --> 03:53:54.420
Boardroom: Thank you.

1425
03:54:00.450 --> 03:54:05.280
Boardroom: Mayor, council members, thank you very much. Mike Olson, District 5 resident.

1426
03:54:06.440 --> 03:54:13.609

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Boardroom: On June 10th, I was riding my bicycle in West Berkeley when I was hit from behind by a truck.

1427
03:54:13.930 --> 03:54:31.900
Boardroom: The BPD police report confirms that the driver was completely at fault, failure to provide sufficient room when she was passing a cyclist on the road. Fractured ribs, facial lacerations, road rash, bruising… I am very lucky because it could have been much worse.

1428
03:54:32.600 --> 03:54:38.240
Boardroom: Councilmember O'Keefe has suggested that cyclists simply use a different road.

1429
03:54:38.620 --> 03:54:48.620
Boardroom: I moved to Berkeley in 1979. That's 47 years of city taxes and parcel fees and economic activities supporting local businesses.

1430
03:54:48.760 --> 03:54:50.910
Boardroom: I paid for those roads, too.

1431
03:54:51.280 --> 03:55:02.179
Boardroom: Cyclists, including me, should be able to use those roads safely. I encourage a yes vote on item 27 and supplementals. Thank you. Thank you.

1432
03:55:05.970 --> 03:55:08.589
Boardroom: Acknowledge and see, Jim.

1433
03:55:08.990 --> 03:55:12.760
Boardroom: And, Lori C here, let me show you in the back there.

1434
03:55:13.140 --> 03:55:15.629
Boardroom: Sorry, where was Jim? Oh, thank you.

1435
03:55:17.390 --> 03:55:27.310
Boardroom: Good evening, I'm Bruce Chamberlain, and I live in District 4. I've been riding my bike in Berkeley for over 20 years, and frequent the Hopkins Business District.

1436
03:55:27.620 --> 03:55:36.520

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Boardroom: I'm a huge proponent of bike boulevards and use California and or Ada to access this area. My concerns for this action item are as follows.

1437
03:55:36.520 --> 03:55:54.789
Boardroom: The process and eventual council item appear to have involved political manipulation and fast-tracking a solution. I attended the February FITES committee meeting, where Councilmember O'Keefe presented a February consent item sponsored by Kesarwani and Ishii.

1438
03:55:54.790 --> 03:56:11.330
Boardroom: Based on a good faith, compromised effort to move forward with paving Hopkins while including improvements. During the meeting, both Luna Parra and Humbert hijacked the proposal, not only giving it a negative declaration, but inserting cycle tracks into the item. It went from there to the item before you now.

1439
03:56:11.380 --> 03:56:30.069
Boardroom: Many people are surprised that a solution to Hopkins is being held hostage by the demand for cycle tracks, when there are other options to consider. The authors and sponsors of this solution are fixated on cycle tracks being a foundational starting point, rather than a review discussion of options that may not include cycle tracks.

1440
03:56:30.140 --> 03:56:49.909
Boardroom: It can only be seen as a political power move. The bike lobby wants a victory, but they've already had several victories, and I ride on them frequently. Bancroft, Milvia, Oxford. The key point is the appropriate application of bikeway infrastructure, including cycle tracks. The Hopkins corridor is not the appropriate place.

1441
03:56:50.000 --> 03:56:51.610
Boardroom: for this design.

1442
03:56:51.670 --> 03:57:07.009
Boardroom: The agenda item is vague in many respects, and omits key details that are needed to make an informed decision. It lacks a map showing the impact on Hopkins. A huge impact, we've heard, of all the parking spaces is not mentioned as well. The number is not mentioned.

1443
03:57:07.010 --> 03:57:14.440
Boardroom: With these and other deficiencies, I don't see how a council member could approve this measure in good governance, not to mention conscience.

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1444
03:57:14.680 --> 03:57:28.529
Boardroom: The rationale under fiscal impacts is disingenuous and has a cognitive dissonance. As everyone knows, the city has a budget crisis. Using $3-4 million of additional funds for the bikeway concept is unreasonable.

1445
03:57:28.570 --> 03:57:35.710
Boardroom: And a profligate use of the citizen's budget, especially when there are other, less expensive, effective options.

1446
03:57:35.890 --> 03:57:48.209
Boardroom: I have a strong sense you care about good governance and practices and fiscal responsibility. This agenda item fails in both of these categories. Politicians are temporary.

1447
03:57:48.470 --> 03:58:02.830
Boardroom: But their policies can have long-lasting effects. Please consider the long-term impacts, positive and negative, to the community at large when deciding the fate of this plan. Thank you. Thank you.

1448
03:58:12.650 --> 03:58:26.110
Boardroom: Hi again, my name is Daniel Chang, my daughter spoke earlier. I've been attending Evangel Bible Church for the last 20 years, and during my time as an undergrad, I put 10,000 miles on my bike inside the city of Berkeley.

1449
03:58:26.110 --> 03:58:32.840
Boardroom: I'm supportive of safety improvements, better signage, and street crossings on Hopkins, but please do not remove access to our church.

1450
03:58:32.960 --> 03:58:36.809
Boardroom: 100% of our church members have been priced out of the city.

1451
03:58:36.830 --> 03:58:54.960
Boardroom: There's no parking on Ordway. Multiple times a week, we have at least a dozen cars and half dozen vans that depend on Hopkins for access to our church, including people with disabilities and many mothers who are currently nursing, newborns, and a few more on the way. Unlike Monterey Market, we do not have a parking lot.

1452
03:58:55.500 --> 03:58:59.090
Boardroom: It's not just access only, it's safety.

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1453
03:58:59.090 --> 03:59:17.180
Boardroom: not just on Sundays, but multiple times during a week. We have children's programs at night. In the winter, that's always after dark. And many of our… many of our, members come in, and they would have to park for blocks and walk in the dark with their children. Thank you. Thank you.

1454
03:59:23.340 --> 03:59:43.360
Boardroom: I'd like to request additional time with representing the three wonderful children over there, Phoebe Mabel and Simon Wong. My name is John Michael Wong, and I'm representing Evangel Bible Church of Berkeley. I'm one of the elders, the corporate secretary, and have been part of the church for over 20 years.

1455
03:59:43.360 --> 03:59:55.269
Boardroom: And we oppose the elimination of parking for Class 4 separated bikeways, because for us, Hopkins Street is no mere transportation corridor, but it is a place of life and worship for us.

1456
03:59:55.270 --> 04:00:04.040
Boardroom: Christians from Berkeley and beyond have been at Hopkins and Ordway since the 1930s, teaching the Bible for nearly 100 years.

1457
04:00:04.040 --> 04:00:20.800
Boardroom: And curb access is essential for our gathering for worship and keeping an open door to guests from all the nations. We teach Jesus Christ and Him crucified and resurrected and returning soon, and He is the only way of salvation.

1458
04:00:20.850 --> 04:00:29.950
Boardroom: And for us, Hopkins is no mere way to get from point A to point P, but it is the destination for us, for our life and worship.

1459
04:00:30.160 --> 04:00:46.670
Boardroom: Parking is already scarce, and I say to you that no alternatives can substitute for the loss of curb access to our building, which has been built by sweat and tears and giving sacrificially over many generations.

1460
04:00:46.670 --> 04:01:00.589
Boardroom: Those with special needs, disabled, blind, pregnant, small children who come, many who would love to drive or bike, but simply

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can't. And any substitutes, for example, just adding a disabled parking spot is no help to commuters and first-time guests.

1461
04:01:00.590 --> 04:01:16.769
Boardroom: Because our dear neighbors who live on Hopkins will already need it first. Adding loading zones adjacent to the building is also no help to anyone, because it will actually remove even more parking, especially for the residents with whom we share all the neighboring streets.

1462
04:01:16.820 --> 04:01:28.689
Boardroom: The decrease in parking, we anticipate, also will increase cruising and driver distraction, as people looking for parking will cause more risks to the entire neighborhood.

1463
04:01:28.770 --> 04:01:40.319
Boardroom: And so, also, as a registered civil engineer with these technical comments against the Class 4 bike paths, I urge you to choose a more sensible path in this decision. Thank you. Thank you.

1464
04:01:48.640 --> 04:02:05.909
Boardroom: As a forever resident of Hopkins, I want to say that, personally, I just… I don't know why we're having this sort of existential conversation about driving. There's over 400 streets in Berkeley. We're proposing a cycle track on one street.

1465
04:02:05.910 --> 04:02:10.959
Boardroom: And… yet, like, now we're debating, like, whether we're gonna become, like, Amsterdam or something.

1466
04:02:10.960 --> 04:02:26.460
Boardroom: The issue at hand is this. The cycle tracks are necessary for the streets where we cannot traffic calm them. That's the main arterial roads. The traffic calming's for the neighborhood streets where cars don't need to go through the full length. Now, I…

1467
04:02:26.480 --> 04:02:32.380
Boardroom: Even though there's no evidence to suggest that cycle tracks destroy businesses, I think that there is some…

1468
04:02:32.380 --> 04:02:48.799
Boardroom: case to be made about preserving the parking in front of the businesses. I will concede on that. And so, I do think that if we can find a way to do a cycle track with the parking in front, as Castorania

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suggested, that that would be a good idea. But, I just, like, I don't understand the existential conversation about driving. Like.

1469
04:02:48.880 --> 04:02:51.429
Boardroom: You still have 400 streets, I don't… Thanks, Cheryl.

1470
04:02:58.470 --> 04:03:03.910
Boardroom: Good evening, and Brian is seating me a minute. Thank you very much.

1471
04:03:04.320 --> 04:03:06.159
Boardroom: I previously co-chaired

1472
04:03:06.320 --> 04:03:13.939
Boardroom: Georgia Tech's Bicycle Infrastructure Committee, and I bike regularly in Berkeley and in the East Bay. Mayor, as you know.

1473
04:03:13.940 --> 04:03:29.120
Boardroom: I'm a professional scientist with a doctorate, and in my work, I cannot let opinion lead me to a conclusion not supported by the data. In that spirit, I have brought hard data showing that the Council is right to call for protected cycle tracks on Hopkins.

1474
04:03:29.190 --> 04:03:37.890
Boardroom: I have a study here, an example, one of many, that says that bicycle infrastructure, specifically separated and protected bike lanes, leads to fewer fatalities.

1475
04:03:38.020 --> 04:03:41.139
Boardroom: Commissioner Tregob, that's our metric for success.

1476
04:03:41.870 --> 04:03:48.320
Boardroom: and better road safety outcomes for all users, drivers included. I will be happy to share the study with you.

1477
04:03:49.250 --> 04:04:02.390
Boardroom: Commissioner Blackby, I live in the hills. I do bike from Hopkins into the hills on my e-bike with my groceries. That constituency exists. Sorry, can you just address the Council as a whole, please, in your comments? Thank you. Certainly.

1478
04:04:05.980 --> 04:04:21.270

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Boardroom: In this study, the authors, quote, say, quote, the research has boiled it down for city planners. Create cycling facilities and you'll see the impact. They found that safer cities aren't due to increases in cyclists, but the infrastructure built for them specifically separated and protected bike lanes.

1479
04:04:21.420 --> 04:04:30.819
Boardroom: This is significantly associated with fewer fatalities. For example, in San Francisco, a 50% reduction was seen when protected cycle tracks were installed.

1480
04:04:30.910 --> 04:04:49.920
Boardroom: I will be happy to share all of these studies with Council, and in fact, have already done so by email. 66% of businesses in San Francisco saw increases in business when cycle tracks were added. No study has shown a significant decrease in business for any bicycle infrastructure.

1481
04:04:49.960 --> 04:05:06.089
Boardroom: Finally, regarding fire issues, this has been done elsewhere. These are not the first protected cycle tracks. Other places for decades have solved the fire access issues. This is a solved problem. Vote in favor, please, of protected cycle tracks. Thank you.

1482
04:05:10.020 --> 04:05:15.500
Boardroom: So, Mayor, we have, 15 minutes left in this comment period.

1483
04:05:17.550 --> 04:05:34.949
Boardroom: Okay, good evening, Mayor and Council Members. My name is Abby Thorne-Lyman. I live on Hopkins Street between Sacramento and Gilman. I back out of my driveway every morning at rush hour, and I will tell you, backup cameras do, in fact, see who is coming. I can tell you from experience, I see them on Hopkins every day.

1484
04:05:34.950 --> 04:05:37.580
Boardroom: I want to address the matter of commercial parking.

1485
04:05:37.580 --> 04:06:01.009
Boardroom: If you had a use generating as many trips as Monterey Market does today, if you had that use coming in to the city of Berkeley, you would not be looking for how many parking spaces you can fit to accommodate that use if it were a new use. You would be looking to do transportation demand management measures, to get people out of their cars, you would have far, far more bike parking in front of Monterey Market.

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1486
04:06:01.010 --> 04:06:08.330
Boardroom: And you would probably tell them to build bike lanes. I strongly support Councilmember Kasharwani's referral.

1487
04:06:08.330 --> 04:06:11.069
Boardroom: And so I appreciate your time tonight. Thank you.

1488
04:06:11.370 --> 04:06:12.470
Boardroom: Thank you.

1489
04:06:19.900 --> 04:06:20.960
Boardroom: Good evening.

1490
04:06:21.220 --> 04:06:25.340
Boardroom: I'm a long-term, Hopkins Street resident of 32 years.

1491
04:06:25.340 --> 04:06:50.340
Boardroom: And I'm urging you to oppose this plan. I fully support model transportation, but removing critical parking will harm our small businesses, the residents, and visitors, especially the seniors. As someone who works in risk management, I can tell you this plan creates new safety hazards. On any given day, hundreds of kids jumping in and out of cars will have to navigate fast-moving scooters and

1492
04:06:50.340 --> 04:06:51.439
Boardroom: e-bikes now.

1493
04:06:51.440 --> 04:07:03.460
Boardroom: The fire department hasn't signed off on this project. Staff have already said buses and garbage trucks will face operational constraints. Key studies haven't been completed. What exactly are you voting on?

1494
04:07:03.880 --> 04:07:13.709
Boardroom: There are better options, safe park corridors parallel to Hopkins on a street without heavy traffic or bus routes. Repave Hopkins Street. Thank you very much.

1495
04:07:14.010 --> 04:07:15.360
Boardroom: Thank you.

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1496
04:07:20.300 --> 04:07:28.789
Boardroom: I'm married to him, a pediatrician, so 32 years on Hopkins, and I oppose the,

1497
04:07:28.790 --> 04:07:51.750
Boardroom: the bike lanes, specifically. The reason is that safety is my concern, and I feel like the safety has not been actually been addressed. When you speak to the planners, no one's really assessed what's gonna happen. We know kids, especially preschoolers, and I'm a pediatrician, so I know how these brains work. They can…

1498
04:07:51.750 --> 04:07:53.319
Boardroom: They do not…

1499
04:07:53.450 --> 04:08:02.869
Boardroom: navigate bikes that are coming down. I'm also a biker, so I know how quickly you can come down Hopkins Street, and that can be very dangerous for kids

1500
04:08:02.930 --> 04:08:23.849
Boardroom: Which, who are not quite functionally, there yet, developmentally. So, you guys, it's gonna be $20 million. I would add a few more… many more millions for all the lawsuits that are gonna come your way, because it's so poorly planned. Thank you so much.

1501
04:08:28.340 --> 04:08:33.580
Boardroom: I'd like an extra minute, my wife, Cindy. Hi, my name is Howard Goldberg.

1502
04:08:33.850 --> 04:08:51.140
Boardroom: My wife Cindy and I have lived on Hopkins Street in the same house, for 48 years, and a lot of the things I want to say have been said by people who are opposing this plan, but I think about it in one different way. I think I try to put myself now, there's… there's cycle tracks.

1503
04:08:51.580 --> 04:09:09.300
Boardroom: And all the more bicycles and e-bikes and scooters that are coming down, and it's gonna be a raceway. I mean, oh, I have my own lane now, I can go as fast as I want. And I'm trying to think of myself backing out of my driveway, backing out.

1504
04:09:09.570 --> 04:09:15.289

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Boardroom: And… If I lose, just for a fraction of a second.

1505
04:09:16.440 --> 04:09:26.950
Boardroom: My concentration, which is bound to happen, you know, if a phone rings, or you're talking to somebody, all of a sudden, you're immediately upon them.

1506
04:09:27.330 --> 04:09:30.870
Boardroom: Bam! There's gonna be something happening, a bad thing.

1507
04:09:31.340 --> 04:09:44.129
Boardroom: And that doesn't happen when the cyclist is 7 or 8 feet out. There's parking there, and they're out further. There's more time to respond in just that fraction of a time.

1508
04:09:44.130 --> 04:09:52.810
Boardroom: So I think that this is a very dangerous situation that you're creating if you put a cycle track there. I just think there's going to be more and more accidents.

1509
04:09:53.590 --> 04:09:55.439
Boardroom: And lastly.

1510
04:09:56.740 --> 04:10:03.280
Boardroom: If we're such in a budget crunch, why would you want to spend all this more money on this?

1511
04:10:03.400 --> 04:10:22.999
Boardroom: I, in good conscience, cannot possibly think about wanting to pass an extra sales tax or vote for a $30 million bond, and you're putting an extra $5 or $10 million into this thing. Please don't do it. Thank you.

1512
04:10:29.890 --> 04:10:44.280
Boardroom: I am Dr. Celeste Marks. I urge that item 27 be rejected in favor of passage of Councilmember Black Group B's or Councilmember O'Keefe's compromise proposals.

1513
04:10:44.280 --> 04:10:54.500
Boardroom: Alternative, much safer east-west bicycle routes can be implemented on nearby Rose and Ada streets. Protected bicycle…

1514

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04:10:54.500 --> 04:11:15.549
Boardroom: bicycle paths on both sides of Hopkins will significantly disrupt refuse collection, access for tradespeople, contractors, and caregivers for residents and businesses, and eliminate much-needed parking, you just heard, for small businesses near Monterey Market. If you approve.

1515
04:11:16.000 --> 04:11:18.610
Boardroom: Councilman Casawani's proposal.

1516
04:11:18.810 --> 04:11:20.050
Boardroom: referral.

1517
04:11:20.170 --> 04:11:26.110
Boardroom: You should remove the requirement that staff only consider tracks.

1518
04:11:27.710 --> 04:11:28.739
Boardroom: Thank you.

1519
04:11:36.170 --> 04:11:50.959
Boardroom: My name is Judith Small. I've lived on Peralta off of Gilman for over 40 years. I'm here to speak on behalf of Mahmoud Hosseini, who you already heard from, a while ago, the flower seller, beloved flower seller, who sells flowers from his cart on

1520
04:11:51.170 --> 04:11:59.779
Boardroom: Market at the curbside… near Monterey Market at the curbside. Mahmood has been described very accurately as the soul of the neighborhood.

1521
04:11:59.830 --> 04:12:13.889
Boardroom: We call him that because he not only sells beautiful flowers, which he arranges with an artist's eye, but he greets all of us, so many of us, young and old, children, all sorts of people, including cyclists, with great generosity and charm.

1522
04:12:14.580 --> 04:12:38.609
Boardroom: In 2021, 2022, there was a group of residents who came together to support Mahmoud, to support… to make sure that he did not lose his livelihood. This is not an exaggeration. He will lose his livelihood if he loses his spot, some kind of spot, in the neighborhood. We had productive conversations with the city then. We hope that as you

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continue your deliberations, we will be able to stay in touch with you to ensure that he is able to stay in the neighborhood.

1523
04:12:38.610 --> 04:12:40.500
Boardroom: Go ahead. Thank you. Thank you.

1524
04:12:50.830 --> 04:13:13.119
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Zach, I live in D1, and I'm proud of my council members' leadership on this. I travel across, and also along Hopkins very frequently. Every crossing is a nail-biter. High speeds are routine, visibility is poor, especially at night. But drivers are creatures of habit. Paint does not correct drivers who drift into bike lanes, but physical protections do.

1525
04:13:13.120 --> 04:13:24.160
Boardroom: And, Rose was repaved without protections, and now drivers speed 15% faster, with casualties mounting. On the other hand, Milvio, with its protected bike lanes, feels safe.

1526
04:13:24.160 --> 04:13:42.510
Boardroom: We should be trying to bury Robert Moses, not curl up next to him. 1970s bike policies, like vehicular cycling and sharrows, have had a half century to bring about the biking renaissance. They haven't. They don't work. Let's get these bike lanes built along the Taplin-Lunipara lines. Thank you. Thank you, Zach.

1527
04:13:48.700 --> 04:14:11.650
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Pedro, I live in District 1 near North Berkeley-BART, and this is my first time attending a council meeting. I'm here to urge you to vote yes on Councilmember Kasarwani's item with the Taplin Lunapara amendments. My wife and I are walkers and micro-mobility users, and don't feel safe when we're on or across Hopkins with the current infrastructure. Today's proposal is a huge step in the right direction to build on previous

1528
04:14:11.650 --> 04:14:17.029
Boardroom: work done to make mobility safer for all in Berkeley, please vote yes on these protected cycle tracks.

1529
04:14:17.030 --> 04:14:18.100
Boardroom: Thank you.

1530
04:14:24.070 --> 04:14:48.840

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Boardroom: Hello, my name is Corey Boussay, and I'm Vice Chair of the board for Bike Use Bay, but speaking tonight in a purely personal capacity. I am a homeowner and live on Hopkins Street in D1, and I'm strongly in favor of Rashi's proposal to add protected bike lanes to Hopkins, and I further support the proposal to extend those lanes to Standage, thinking ahead to the San Pablo parallel

1531
04:14:48.840 --> 04:14:50.469
Boardroom: Roots Project.

1532
04:14:50.500 --> 04:14:52.260
Boardroom: Coming up into the future.

1533
04:14:52.260 --> 04:15:15.130
Boardroom: From my house on Hopkins, I frequently bike to Monterey Market, as well as all the other shops, where I've had multiple close calls and harrowing experiences, one in particular stuck in my mind when a driver continuously honked at me and tailgated me nearly the entire length of my journey for taking the lane to avoid being in the door zone. It's very intimidating to know you have an aggressive person

1534
04:15:15.200 --> 04:15:28.940
Boardroom: behind you, who could kill you with a simple press of their gas pedal… gas pedal right behind you. If I was a less confident cyclist, I might have never biked on Hopkins again. We need to give people the opportunity to do. Thank you.

1535
04:15:35.010 --> 04:15:54.700
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Steven, and as a frequent pedestrian and a novice cyclist, I look forward to a protected bike lane on Hopkins. I would love to take more trips through the city by bike, but after many near misses due to dangerous drivers, I've self-limited my cycling trips throughout the city. Please continue with plans for the separated bike lanes, ensuring our streets are accessible and safe for everyone.

1536
04:15:55.350 --> 04:15:56.530
Boardroom: Thank you.

1537
04:16:00.690 --> 04:16:09.229
Boardroom: Hello, thank you for your time. My partner and I currently live on Stanage within a quarter mile of Hopkins Street Corridor in District 1.

1538
04:16:09.670 --> 04:16:16.419

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Boardroom: Every day, we both bike along and across Hopkins to commute to work, and to patron the shops on Hopkins.

1539
04:16:16.780 --> 04:16:22.140
Boardroom: I've recently been involved in a bike accident, and while I'm okay this time.

1540
04:16:23.170 --> 04:16:28.500
Boardroom: If there was a structured and protected Class 4 bike lane, it could have been completely avoided.

1541
04:16:29.150 --> 04:16:38.759
Boardroom: I know that biking in Berkeley can be dangerous, and I'd like Berkeley to fulfill its Vision Zero action plan by building the infrastructure required to make biking a safe alternative to driving.

1542
04:16:39.070 --> 04:16:44.490
Boardroom: I urge you to approve the proposed plan to include the protected bike lane. Thank you. Thank you.

1543
04:16:48.280 --> 04:17:04.890
Boardroom: Thank you for your time. My name is Jarrah Lewis. I live two blocks from Hopkins in D1. I bike commute and walk my dog on and across Hopkins Street daily. I also drive, and I support Councilmember Kasarwani's proposal to repave Hopkins with protected bike lanes and pedestrian improvements.

1544
04:17:04.900 --> 04:17:29.500
Boardroom: This has been said before, Berkeley voters have already made their feelings clear by electing representatives who adopted the bike plan and the Vision Zero Action Plan. If Berkeley is serious about Vision Zero, protected bike lanes are the only option here, and human lives must be valued over the convenience of car users. Physical barriers are not, quote, appealing, they are life-saving. The only intervention that has been proven to lower mortality rates for cyclists, and notably has also been shown to lower mortality rates.

1545
04:17:29.520 --> 04:17:45.549
Boardroom: for elderly pedestrians. Sharro's and the Ada or Rose Street alternatives are not viable alternatives, they are distractions to allow the city to keep kicking the can down the road. Please do the right thing and adopt Councilmember Kisarwani's proposal with the extension to Stanage. Thank you so much. Thank you.

1546

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04:17:46.240 --> 04:17:51.070
Boardroom: I just want to give a warning, I think we have 3 minutes left, is that right?

1547
04:17:51.660 --> 04:17:56.219
Boardroom: Yeah. Two. Two, three. I was on the bubble, but I made it.

1548
04:17:56.880 --> 04:18:01.089
Boardroom: My name is Barry Fike. I taught at Ruth Acti for 13 years.

1549
04:18:01.230 --> 04:18:04.639
Boardroom: I've lived in Berkeley since 1961.

1550
04:18:05.020 --> 04:18:07.600
Boardroom: I have two big fears at my age.

1551
04:18:08.020 --> 04:18:11.120
Boardroom: Being hit by a car while on my bike.

1552
04:18:11.670 --> 04:18:21.279
Boardroom: Number two, a decline in my driving skills as I get older, and hitting a child on a bike or scooter who drifts into my car lane.

1553
04:18:21.710 --> 04:18:28.140
Boardroom: Protected bike lanes address both of these well-founded fears. Sharrows do not.

1554
04:18:28.550 --> 04:18:43.239
Boardroom: As for fear of business being hurt by the proposed changes, that is not well-founded, and runs counter to numerous studies, all of which demonstrate that there will be a positive or, at worst, a neutral economic impact.

1555
04:18:43.940 --> 04:18:51.259
Boardroom: Change is hard, but I stand with the young and the forward-looking on this. The climate crisis is real.

1556
04:18:51.620 --> 04:18:59.650
Boardroom: Please support the younger generation's hard-fought solutions to it. Please support Rashi's proposal. Thank you.

1557

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04:19:04.420 --> 04:19:16.349
Boardroom: Ray, I think you're our final speaker in person. We've got… I know… 40!

1558
04:19:16.800 --> 04:19:24.500
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council Members. My name is Ray Yep. I'm a District 5 resident.

1559
04:19:24.820 --> 04:19:40.569
Boardroom: I recognize that this is a difficult decision for you, and that you've put a lot of thought and energy into the subject. I'm here to tell you that your work is not done. You don't have the right solution yet.

1560
04:19:40.780 --> 04:19:44.849
Boardroom: We have a very divisive situation here.

1561
04:19:45.020 --> 04:19:48.680
Boardroom: And I would like to see you find a solution

1562
04:19:48.770 --> 04:20:05.840
Boardroom: That… where everyone sitting around the table can say, I can live with that. Now, that may sound like mission impossible, but I think you have before you a proposal by Councilmember Blackaby that can get you there.

1563
04:20:06.100 --> 04:20:09.299
Boardroom: I have confidence in what he has stated.

1564
04:20:09.630 --> 04:20:14.490
Boardroom: I also have confidence in what Councilmember O'Keefe has proposed.

1565
04:20:14.710 --> 04:20:23.559
Boardroom: And I have confidence in Waheed Amiri. I have gotten to know him, and he has to get it done. Sorry, just turn this up, Ray. Okay, wait.

1566
04:20:24.160 --> 04:20:27.360
Boardroom: How many people… hold on, hold on.

1567
04:20:27.650 --> 04:20:36.690

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Boardroom: If you all speak, I will not let them talk. So how many people are in line? 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6… Maria, are you in line? 7.

1568
04:20:36.810 --> 04:20:51.699
Boardroom: Okay, there are 41 people online, so… at least, because not everyone has raised their hand, so I will let you all speak. If you do not let people seed you a minute, because otherwise we're just really cutting it. So, come on up, you have one minute, 1 a minute each.

1569
04:20:56.580 --> 04:21:03.190
Boardroom: My name is Sandra, and I've been a member of Evangel Bible Church of Berkeley for over 15 years. I've…

1570
04:21:03.470 --> 04:21:15.779
Boardroom: Seen pedestrians… in all my years here, I've seen pedestrians greatly outnumber cyclists consistently. Rather than adding bike lanes, I believe improving pedestrian safety at this location should be the greater priority.

1571
04:21:15.780 --> 04:21:23.689
Boardroom: Our church members regularly cross Hopkins at Ordway to reach the church entrance, yet there is no crosswalk or walk signal there.

1572
04:21:23.930 --> 04:21:42.910
Boardroom: Many of our church members keep watch to routinely help elderly, children, and visually impaired visitors cross safely. At least one time, the paratransit dropped off our blind visitor, BC, across the street, and she had no safe way of crossing Hopkins by herself. She also wasn't within our site for us to assist her.

1573
04:21:43.100 --> 04:21:50.950
Boardroom: And for me, being pregnant myself right now, I also double-check multiple times before crossing Hopkins because the cars go so fast.

1574
04:21:51.130 --> 04:22:00.010
Boardroom: What we need here is pedestrian safety and access to our church, not a bike lane that can introduce e-bikes and e-scooters. Thank you.

1575
04:22:07.950 --> 04:22:32.860
Boardroom: Good evening, I'm Clara Wong with Evangel Bible Church of Berkeley. I strongly urge you to preserve parking on Popkins Street for safety. I've been part of the church since 2005, while attending UC Berkeley as an Air Force ROTC cadet, and when I was injured in 2005 using

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crutches, there were many times it was difficult to find parking, and had to ask church brothers to come and help me park. We've been taught to love our neighbors, and we've been serving them by not parking in front of their homes.

1576
04:22:32.860 --> 04:22:57.860
Boardroom: as well as preserving the parking spaces immediately around our church building on Hopkins and Ordway for families with pregnant moms, young children, visitors, and guests. With my three children, even with existing parking on Hopkins Street. I've often needed to park two or three blocks away on Wednesday evenings for Bible study, and this has become very difficult in the last year walking with my bilateral foot brace, walker, or at times wheelchair in the dark evenings as I anticipate an ankle replacement surgery.

1577
04:22:58.610 --> 04:23:10.000
Boardroom: Removing parking in Hopkins will further exasperate and make it even more dangerous for our church families and many young children to walk in across many streets access to our church building for gathering and worship. Thank you.

1578
04:23:15.230 --> 04:23:30.469
Boardroom: Hello, I'm John Heller. I use bicycle as my primary source of transportation, but I'm speaking in opposition to this proposal because I don't believe we have done what is the responsible thing to do here, which is to conduct

1579
04:23:30.470 --> 04:23:37.580
Boardroom: A business impact survey to make sure that the businesses that are impacted

1580
04:23:37.720 --> 04:23:41.360
Boardroom: Can survive a disruption of this nature.

1581
04:23:43.240 --> 04:24:00.250
Boardroom: We've heard this area described as a treasure. A previous speaker described the Hopkins-Monterey area as a treasure of small businesses, and it really is. But a treasure of that nature needs to be nurtured and honored and supported, not taken for granted.

1582
04:24:00.760 --> 04:24:03.769
Boardroom: I have no doubt that both sides hope

1583
04:24:04.380 --> 04:24:07.639

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Boardroom: That these businesses will survive this disruption.

1584
04:24:07.750 --> 04:24:16.379
Boardroom: But hope is different from empirical evidence, and we need to conduct a study to make sure that that's the case. Thank you.

1585
04:24:20.400 --> 04:24:43.420
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Kevin Jones, I'm a Berkeley resident for over 20 years, and I just want to suggest to you guys to read the book, Bike Lanes Are White Lanes. This is seriously about gentrification, this is not about safety, let's be real. And these bike lanes will hurt the businesses. Valencia… businesses on Valencia, after their bike lane was installed, lost

1586
04:24:43.420 --> 04:25:07.530
Boardroom: 70% of their businesses. It will close down businesses, so if you actually care about the residents that are here, the business owners that are here, you will actually rethink this program, okay? Because seriously, this is about gentrification. I don't care what the people from the gentrifier land, oh, excuse me, the Turner Lab have to say, or all these people that are pushing for these bike lanes to help

1587
04:25:07.530 --> 04:25:15.720
Boardroom: property values. That is what this is about. This is about plans happening in the future, and not for the people that already live here.

1588
04:25:22.070 --> 04:25:26.939
Boardroom: Wow, tough act to follow. My, my name is Michael Boland.

1589
04:25:27.050 --> 04:25:36.230
Boardroom: I'm a landscape architect, and city planner. I worked for my whole career in the public realm, working on complicated public realm projects.

1590
04:25:36.580 --> 04:25:39.189
Boardroom: I think we can all agree Hopkins Street is a mess.

1591
04:25:40.100 --> 04:25:52.879
Boardroom: But I have to tell you, I think this process is a bigger mess. And, I think it's shocking that 8 years have passed, and Hopkins Street is still unpaved. But I don't think it's unexpected.

1592

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04:25:53.280 --> 04:25:59.150
Boardroom: Why? Because this process has pretty much broken every… rule…

1593
04:25:59.590 --> 04:26:06.990
Boardroom: Around good governance and good planning processes, starting by the solution… with a solution, rather than actually defining the problem.

1594
04:26:07.590 --> 04:26:23.780
Boardroom: So, unless you are all interested in experiencing this over and over and over again, when every bike project comes along, I urge you to stop and create an authentic, inclusive process that engages everyone.

1595
04:26:23.990 --> 04:26:25.670
Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you.

1596
04:26:32.290 --> 04:26:56.089
Boardroom: Good evening, thank you all for your time. My name's Casey, it's a pleasure to see. Many of you have spoken with you before, you've seen me biking around town with my twins on the back of my e-bike. I would love to bike to Hopkins, I'd love to bike to King Pool and King Playground, but it's not safe to do so. I have an older kid, as well who's riding on their own, and it's not safe. Painted bike lanes are not sufficient.

1597
04:26:56.090 --> 04:27:20.569
Boardroom: I was on Alcatraz last week, luckily with not… without my kids, and I was hit by a delivery truck that decided that they should cut into the bike lane, and luckily, they hit the back of my bike right where my kids would have been had they been with me. Paint is insufficient. We need protected bike lanes, especially on a collector street, which is what Hopkins is. Paint is insufficient, sharrows are insufficient.

1598
04:27:20.570 --> 04:27:36.889
Boardroom: We need protection, and if you build it, they will come. So I don't care what the past has been, you are hearing from people who would bike, who would choose to get there in safer methods if they had it. Thank you.

1599
04:27:42.560 --> 04:27:48.079
Boardroom: Hey, hey, excuse me, folks, come on.

1600
04:27:50.050 --> 04:27:57.820

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Boardroom: Really? Go ahead, Maria. I am so impressed with all of us, and I thank you, Mayor, for your gracious space.

1601
04:27:59.700 --> 04:28:04.229
Boardroom: Whatever we end up fighting over is not the right question.

1602
04:28:04.740 --> 04:28:07.400
Boardroom: Bicycles could…

1603
04:28:07.530 --> 04:28:17.720
Boardroom: create rickshaw, help everyone get around, right? And they'd get all the exercise they ever needed. I've already been through…

1604
04:28:17.890 --> 04:28:32.299
Boardroom: Milvia, and Temiscal, and the First Church on Dana, it's like, oh my god, we solve one thing, and we create other things. And if there was just more paying attention.

1605
04:28:32.630 --> 04:28:37.460
Boardroom: and courtesy, it would be better because we have lots of traffic rules.

1606
04:28:37.680 --> 04:28:40.580
Boardroom: And yet there's still endless accidents.

1607
04:28:42.210 --> 04:28:48.449
Boardroom: I've almost been run over more by bicycles than cars, so it's like…

1608
04:28:48.720 --> 04:28:53.939
Boardroom: Can't we learn how to live together better? Thank you. Thanks, Maria.

1609
04:28:54.560 --> 04:29:08.490
Boardroom: Okay, we are gonna take a 10-minute break, and then we will return and do our online comment. If you are here for online comment, please raise your hand. We are up to 50 right now. 53! Okay.

1610
04:29:09.020 --> 04:29:25.430
Boardroom: Yes, sorry, yes, we are gonna make, sorry, I will entertain a motion to extend until, what? 12.30? 12.30. 11.30. I can't hear. 12.30. Okay, folks, please, if you can keep it down so we can hear each other…

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1611
04:29:26.570 --> 04:29:32.080
Boardroom: Motion to extend till 1230. Second. Alright, can we take the roll on that, please?

1612
04:29:32.200 --> 04:29:46.909
Boardroom: Okay, to extend the meeting till 12.30 a.m, Councilmember Kessarwani? Is absent. Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Tragum? Aye. O'Kee? Yes. Blackaby?

1613
04:29:46.910 --> 04:29:47.570
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

1614
04:29:47.990 --> 04:29:54.150
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii?

1615
04:29:54.670 --> 04:29:59.550
Boardroom: Yes. Motion carries.

1616
04:30:17.880 --> 04:30:40.680
Boardroom: Okay, hello everyone! Let's take your seats, please.

1617
04:30:40.680 --> 04:30:49.440
Boardroom: quiet down, quiet down, we're gonna get started again. We're moving to our online comments. Okay.

1618
04:30:50.090 --> 04:31:00.019
Boardroom: Folks, thank you! Alright, we have 53 comments online, and we are starting with Ben Gerhardstein.

1619
04:31:00.740 --> 04:31:05.640
Boardroom: Oh, and actually, I know that you have been given a minute by Libby, so I will…

1620
04:31:05.990 --> 04:31:10.579
Boardroom: Give you 2 minutes. Oh, and 3, sorry, you've been given 3 minutes.

1621
04:31:11.280 --> 04:31:12.240
Ben Gerhardstein: I'll take two.

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1622
04:31:12.430 --> 04:31:16.689
Boardroom: Alright, good. Two total, but, you know, just… you need it.

1623
04:31:16.820 --> 04:31:21.360
Ben Gerhardstein: Fair enough. Good evening, Council. I'm Ben Gerhardstein with Walk Break Berkeley.

1624
04:31:22.040 --> 04:31:34.100
Ben Gerhardstein: I so wish I could be with you in person for this important vote. Walk Bright Berkeley, together with North Berkeley Now, Berkeley Neighbors for Housing and Climate Action, East Bay for Everyone, Telegraph for People.

1625
04:31:34.100 --> 04:31:44.040
Ben Gerhardstein: East Bay Yimby, Sierra Club's Northern Alameda County Chapter, and Bike East Bay, urge you to pass Councilmember Kesarwani's referral, along with Councilmember Taplin's supplemental.

1626
04:31:44.510 --> 04:31:58.929
Ben Gerhardstein: Our coalition of Safe Streets, Housing, and Environmental Organizations strongly supports repaving and rebalancing Hopkins Street to get people of all ages and abilities more safe, sustainable transportation options to and through North Berkeley.

1627
04:31:59.190 --> 04:32:04.059
Ben Gerhardstein: As a Vision Zero city, Berkeley has established that safety is our highest priority.

1628
04:32:04.360 --> 04:32:11.959
Ben Gerhardstein: At least 10 Council-approved plans and policies support making pedestrian, bicycle, and transit improvements on Hopkins when it's repaved.

1629
04:32:12.640 --> 04:32:17.940
Ben Gerhardstein: We oppose Councilmember Blackaby's and Councilmember O'Keefe's supplementals.

1630
04:32:18.490 --> 04:32:25.070
Ben Gerhardstein: as they seek to further delay or deny bicycle improvements on Hopkins to continue prioritizing car parking.

1631
04:32:25.300 --> 04:32:35.129

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Ben Gerhardstein: That's unacceptable, because there are no alternative bicycle routes that will provide critical, safe connections to West Berkeley and to the schools, parks, and shops on Hopkins.

1632
04:32:35.320 --> 04:32:37.679
Ben Gerhardstein: We do not need more study on this issue.

1633
04:32:39.030 --> 04:32:52.939
Ben Gerhardstein: Please think toward the future. With increased housing development in Berkeley, the city needs to redesign Hopkins and other automobile-dominated streets to encourage new neighbors to make walking, biking, and transit primary forms of transportation.

1634
04:32:53.050 --> 04:32:59.389
Ben Gerhardstein: Value to do so invites more congestion, traffic injuries, and climate pollution in Berkeley.

1635
04:33:00.010 --> 04:33:11.300
Ben Gerhardstein: For too long, this Hopkins project has been a cloud over our community. Please pass Kasarwani's and Taplan's items and empower staff to move this project forward without delay.

1636
04:33:11.550 --> 04:33:18.049
Ben Gerhardstein: Vote for a smooth, safe Hopkins for all, and for a brighter, safer future for Berkeley. Thank you.

1637
04:33:19.029 --> 04:33:20.120
Boardroom: Thank you, Ben.

1638
04:33:22.279 --> 04:33:24.309
Boardroom: Next is Andrea.

1639
04:33:29.020 --> 04:33:31.390
Boardroom: Andrea H?

1640
04:33:31.580 --> 04:33:34.669
Boardroom: You should be able to unmute.

1641
04:33:35.099 --> 04:33:41.049
Boardroom: And on deck are Charles Siegel, Sharon Friedman, and Seth. Just so you know, you're on deck.

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1642
04:33:42.580 --> 04:33:44.590
Boardroom: Andrea?

1643
04:33:44.599 --> 04:33:50.859
Andrea H: Sorry about that. I was dual screening. Thank you for taking my comment. My name's Andrea Horbinski.

1644
04:33:52.369 --> 04:33:58.289
Andrea H: I want to echo everything that the pro bike lane speakers have said. I also want to,

1645
04:33:58.529 --> 04:34:10.929
Andrea H: correct some misinformation that has been spoken both by commenters and also by, I believe, some council members about the mistaken, belief that bike lanes harm nearby businesses.

1646
04:34:10.959 --> 04:34:25.349
Andrea H: Worldwide studies and rebalancing have shown that businesses, in fact, benefit when streets are rebalanced for pedestrians and bicyclists. Valencia Street in San Francisco, a city report, actually found that,

1647
04:34:25.369 --> 04:34:36.499
Andrea H: that merchants were not harmed by the bike lane, contrary to their claims. So, for all these reasons and many more, I would urge you to support rebalancing Hopkins, and once again.

1648
04:34:36.499 --> 04:34:50.999
Andrea H: Remember that Berkeley should not be a necropolis for boomers, but instead, it's a living city. It should be… it should meet the needs of its residents as they evolve for the future to confront climate change and support the city's stated goals. Thank you.

1649
04:34:51.000 --> 04:34:51.809
Boardroom: Thank you.

1650
04:34:52.919 --> 04:34:56.959
Boardroom: Next is Charles. Shhh, folks, please.

1651
04:34:57.130 --> 04:34:58.710
Boardroom: Thank you.

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1652
04:34:58.710 --> 04:35:05.750
Charles Siegel: Hello, I support the bike lanes on Hopkins, and I also would like to con…

1653
04:35:05.960 --> 04:35:14.210
Charles Siegel: to correct some misinformation that could have easily been corrected if people had looked at Google and learned the facts before speaking.

1654
04:35:14.380 --> 04:35:24.200
Charles Siegel: Some people have said that this will hurt businesses on Hopkins, but Google will tell you that bike lanes help… protected bike lanes help business.

1655
04:35:24.570 --> 04:35:40.399
Charles Siegel: Some people have said that this will make it more dangerous for pedestrians, but Google will tell you that protected bike lanes make streets safer for all users, including pedestrians and drivers, as well as bicyclists.

1656
04:35:40.810 --> 04:35:48.170
Charles Siegel: Councilmember Blackaby's SUP calls for a long process of considering two alternatives.

1657
04:35:48.310 --> 04:35:54.679
Charles Siegel: We did that years ago. The conflict became worse and worse as the process went on.

1658
04:35:55.210 --> 04:36:01.419
Charles Siegel: A public works director and transportation director resigned as a result.

1659
04:36:01.520 --> 04:36:03.800
Charles Siegel: Two associate planners reside.

1660
04:36:03.800 --> 04:36:09.409
Boardroom: Thank you, Charles. Your time is up. Thank you for your comment. Next is Sharon.

1661
04:36:10.360 --> 04:36:13.830
Sharon Friedman: Okay, good evening. Sharon Friedman,

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1662
04:36:14.099 --> 04:36:29.310
Sharon Friedman: I am in support of the ideas proposed by Blackaby and by Councilmember O'Keefe. I am really strongly opposed to the Class 4 bike lane with dividers. I bike, I cycle, and I drive.

1663
04:36:29.439 --> 04:36:47.139
Sharon Friedman: What streets do I avoid when I drive? I don't know that anyone has said this, one person alluded to it. I avoid Milvia in downtown. It's the most dangerous place to be a cyclist ever. Why? Because drivers don't see the vehicles anymore, because cars are parked and they block the view.

1664
04:36:47.140 --> 04:36:56.379
Sharon Friedman: People block the bike lane, okay? They either put dumpsters or garbage cans in it, DoorDash parks in those bike lanes.

1665
04:36:56.380 --> 04:37:09.939
Sharon Friedman: and, workers hang out in those bike lanes, and there you are driving. You don't have a way to get out of the bike lane because there's a concrete barricade. It's totally treacherous. The best part of the bike ride is Olivia that says.

1666
04:37:10.140 --> 04:37:13.380
Sharon Friedman: Bikers may use the entire lane, and it's nice.

1667
04:37:13.380 --> 04:37:13.840
Boardroom: Yeah.

1668
04:37:13.849 --> 04:37:15.339
Sharon Friedman: It's a bicycle boulevard.

1669
04:37:15.340 --> 04:37:17.600
Boardroom: Your time is up. Thank you.

1670
04:37:17.910 --> 04:37:23.250
Boardroom: So, Seth, Michael Pierce, T. Stevens, you all are on deck, and then Makai.

1671
04:37:23.849 --> 04:37:29.269
Seth: Hello, can I have an extra minute from, Mariah, M-A-R-I-Y-A, online, and she can get off?

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1672
04:37:31.369 --> 04:37:35.850
Boardroom: Oh, Mariah, I see her there, yeah.

1673
04:37:36.029 --> 04:37:37.259
Seth: Okay, thank you.

1674
04:37:39.369 --> 04:37:52.339
Seth: Hi, I'm, I've been hit and run by a bicyclist twice while living on Hopkins in the past 30 years. I was left bloodied and injured on the ground. If I was 85 years old, I'd be dead.

1675
04:37:52.339 --> 04:38:11.449
Seth: I'm a business owner, and I must load my tools as a contractor in and out of my house and my business area on the 1600 block of Hopkins. Cyclists fail to stop at 96% of all red lights and stop signs. This is a human factors and engineering society report.

1676
04:38:12.059 --> 04:38:28.449
Seth: Also, we need more cheap stop signs and road paint applied in-house by Union City employees, not scandalous $15 million cycle tracks. We don't need to eliminate door swing zones and make dangerous areas here. It is dangerous for the fire, chiefs,

1677
04:38:28.449 --> 04:38:51.219
Seth: advising. I also could obviously tell from Wahid Amiri's statements that he has no idea, about how to go ahead and advise on this as a public works person, because he's so poorly, prepared for this and uninformed because, this is just being rushed through. The Hopkins Street wasteful investment is going to increase elderly pedestrian death.

1678
04:38:51.219 --> 04:38:59.859
Seth: and cycle deaths, because they are inherently unsafe to themselves and the public. They do not obey the rules of the road. They run stop signs non-stop.

1679
04:38:59.939 --> 04:39:09.199
Seth: They are not safe. Motorcycles that are electric must obey the rules of the road. E-bikes are no different.

1680
04:39:09.239 --> 04:39:24.489
Seth: would parents go transfer… go traveling around regularly with their children on the back of a motorcycle? No, that would be… that would look kind of weird if it was a cultural thing. But somehow doing it on a

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bicycle or on an e-bike is somehow normalized. It is child endangerment. This is dangerous behavior.

1681
04:39:24.649 --> 04:39:38.989
Seth: We need to put stop signs on Hopkins, and Carlotta, and Beverly, and Ordway. We need to paint all the crosswalk intersections on Hopkins. Hopkins Street, must be made safe for all people, and we need to put regular

1682
04:39:39.109 --> 04:39:42.259
Seth: Bike lanes, all the way up and down Hopkins, please.

1683
04:39:42.260 --> 04:39:47.690
Boardroom: Thank you. Your comment is, time is up. I do want to object to the comments made about

1684
04:39:47.850 --> 04:39:56.769
Boardroom: Our interim director, Wahit Amiri, he is a very professional and knowledgeable person, and I'm very grateful to him for his work.

1685
04:39:57.180 --> 04:39:59.819
Boardroom: Okay, next is Michael Pierce.

1686
04:40:01.980 --> 04:40:06.099
Michael Pierce: Hi, I will give my minute to Sharon Friedman if she's on the line.

1687
04:40:06.900 --> 04:40:10.349
Boardroom: She already spoke, actually. Yeah.

1688
04:40:10.940 --> 04:40:18.399
Michael Pierce: Oh, okay, well then, I would, I would say, one thing that, when I was listening to her.

1689
04:40:18.620 --> 04:40:28.419
Michael Pierce: she said she felt unsafe on Milvia when she was driving. What she meant to say is when she was riding her bike, she felt unsafe because

1690
04:40:29.160 --> 04:40:40.700

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Michael Pierce: You know, there are dumpsters in front of… in the bike lane, and that there are obstructions in the protected bike lane, and when you're in a protected bike lane on a…

1691
04:40:40.870 --> 04:40:51.370
Michael Pierce: bicycle, you can't swerve around them, because you've got the curve in… the curb in your way. So, that was one of the points that she was trying to make. So,

1692
04:40:51.590 --> 04:41:07.250
Michael Pierce: That's all. It's been very interesting to hear the discussion. I can't imagine how, given the… what the community has said, I can't imagine how you guys could vote for this, plan. But anyway, thank you very much.

1693
04:41:08.060 --> 04:41:08.800
Boardroom: Thank you.

1694
04:41:09.450 --> 04:41:12.560
Boardroom: Next is T. Stevens.

1695
04:41:15.640 --> 04:41:21.620
T Stevens: Thank you. I've been, seated minutes by Kenny Yip and Scott Selmanoff.

1696
04:41:22.800 --> 04:41:23.920
T Stevens: Okay.

1697
04:41:25.910 --> 04:41:26.360
T Stevens: Hello?

1698
04:41:26.360 --> 04:41:30.630
Boardroom: I do not see… yip, Y-I… Y-I-P.

1699
04:41:31.000 --> 04:41:38.219
Boardroom: Kenny… I do not see Kenny Yip on there, and what was the other name? I see a Kenny.

1700
04:41:38.220 --> 04:41:39.940
T Stevens: If there's a Kenny, that must be it.

1701

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04:41:39.940 --> 04:41:40.630
Boardroom: out of his hand.

1702
04:41:42.090 --> 04:41:44.740
T Stevens: And then the other is Scott Selmanoff.

1703
04:41:47.710 --> 04:41:49.960
Boardroom: Scott has his hand raised.

1704
04:41:51.190 --> 04:41:52.030
Boardroom: Yeah.

1705
04:41:52.590 --> 04:41:54.179
T Stevens: Do I have 3 minutes?

1706
04:41:57.400 --> 04:42:00.250
Boardroom: That's fine, but Kenny doesn't have his hand up, just so you know.

1707
04:42:01.120 --> 04:42:11.149
T Stevens: Okay. My name is Tina Stevens, I'm a Berkeley resident, and I would like to call attention to a troubling decision-making loop in our city's transportation planning.

1708
04:42:11.940 --> 04:42:18.240
T Stevens: The city uses taxpayer funds to routinely partner with the regional group Bike East Bay.

1709
04:42:18.590 --> 04:42:27.989
T Stevens: Bike East Bay's annual reports have listed Berkeley as a premium $10,000-plus top-tier donor and institutional partner.

1710
04:42:28.870 --> 04:42:37.659
T Stevens: Bike East Bay also receives financial backing from the private, for-profit corporation Alta Planning and Design.

1711
04:42:38.170 --> 04:42:46.179
T Stevens: Alta's business model relies on securing lucrative municipal contracts to design transportation projects.

1712
04:42:46.920 --> 04:43:01.319

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T Stevens: Bike East Bay fiscally sponsors local interest group Walk Bike Berkeley, and both of those groups lobby this council for projects that benefit the corporate donor on this pipeline, Alta Planning and Design.

1713
04:43:01.740 --> 04:43:10.010
T Stevens: This is a closed-loop ecosystem, one that is amplified by the intense lobbying and political support

1714
04:43:10.140 --> 04:43:19.309
T Stevens: of members of this council by well-funded trans-Berkeley Urban Coalition groups like YIMBY Action and East Bay NIMBY.

1715
04:43:20.100 --> 04:43:24.890
T Stevens: Consequently, voices of local opposition are being muffled.

1716
04:43:25.820 --> 04:43:34.720
T Stevens: In the meantime, ALTA has done significant work in Berkeley, including developing the city's 2017 bicycle plan.

1717
04:43:35.080 --> 04:43:39.420
T Stevens: It was lead consultant for the updated Berkeley Bicycle plan.

1718
04:43:39.550 --> 04:43:49.999
T Stevens: And in 2025, it consulted on the Adeline Street project and conducted outreach that targeted businesses and property owners to diffuse potential dissent.

1719
04:43:51.140 --> 04:44:09.140
T Stevens: When private firms affect public policy through lobbying pipelines, it dilutes the voices of residents, neighborhood associations, and small business owners who do not benefit from a taxpayer-funded, corporate-backed apparatus to echo their concerns.

1720
04:44:09.590 --> 04:44:12.480
T Stevens: In this way, democracy is subverted.

1721
04:44:12.660 --> 04:44:13.620
T Stevens: Please.

1722
04:44:13.780 --> 04:44:21.699
T Stevens: Listen to the citizens who elected you, especially those disadvantaged, by systemic inequities. Thank you.

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1723
04:44:23.010 --> 04:44:24.190
Boardroom: Thank you.

1724
04:44:26.000 --> 04:44:28.380
Boardroom: Next is Makai Freeman.

1725
04:44:30.530 --> 04:44:32.959
Boardroom: Makai, we're giving you extra time.

1726
04:44:34.730 --> 04:44:36.640
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Yes, I need it.

1727
04:44:37.890 --> 04:44:39.150
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: AEA.

1728
04:44:41.040 --> 04:44:42.890
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I wasn't going to talk tonight.

1729
04:44:43.900 --> 04:44:45.879
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I raised two rounds.

1730
04:44:46.290 --> 04:44:53.599
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Well, near to… Would you talk… Not 10 to talk to.

1731
04:44:55.660 --> 04:44:57.120
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I cannot stop.

1732
04:44:58.360 --> 04:44:59.910
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I'm moved anymore.

1733
04:45:01.550 --> 04:45:06.280
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I used to start at… Ace Hardware.

1734
04:45:07.360 --> 04:45:08.850
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: For many years.

1735
04:45:10.070 --> 04:45:11.749

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Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: But getting out on life.

1736
04:45:12.480 --> 04:45:14.110
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Accessible van.

1737
04:45:15.040 --> 04:45:19.890
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I am the… like… my caregiver?

1738
04:45:21.320 --> 04:45:22.950
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And I almost got hit.

1739
04:45:24.670 --> 04:45:25.700
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Fight.

1740
04:45:27.740 --> 04:45:29.540
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I don't accept my job.

1741
04:45:30.640 --> 04:45:32.419
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: a system change out of it.

1742
04:45:33.930 --> 04:45:38.800
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: But I can tell you… Is I who?

1743
04:45:39.840 --> 04:45:41.500
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Contacted the city.

1744
04:45:42.320 --> 04:45:43.860
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: They have a town hall.

1745
04:45:44.790 --> 04:45:46.230
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: At CIO.

1746
04:45:48.110 --> 04:45:49.720
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I shot almost.

1747
04:45:50.710 --> 04:45:52.300
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Exclusively.

1748
04:45:53.290 --> 04:45:54.850

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Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Outside of Berkeley.

1749
04:45:55.710 --> 04:46:00.160
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Because I'm able to… Where I stopped.

1750
04:46:01.330 --> 04:46:03.170
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Yeah, at the sidewalk.

1751
04:46:04.500 --> 04:46:09.040
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I don't have to be ordered by… Thy cars condemned.

1752
04:46:09.730 --> 04:46:11.350
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Bancroft Avenue.

1753
04:46:12.080 --> 04:46:16.400
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: My rep… We come directly out.

1754
04:46:17.790 --> 04:46:19.189
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: In traffic.

1755
04:46:20.380 --> 04:46:22.330
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I told you she'd be planning.

1756
04:46:23.360 --> 04:46:25.009
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And now we're left.

1757
04:46:26.640 --> 04:46:28.330
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I understand why.

1758
04:46:29.080 --> 04:46:30.870
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I can feel near you.

1759
04:46:31.690 --> 04:46:33.279
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: It's treatment services.

1760
04:46:34.600 --> 04:46:36.279
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: But we will continue.

1761

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04:46:37.950 --> 04:46:39.520
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: To fight and allocate.

1762
04:46:39.520 --> 04:46:40.650
Boardroom: Thank you, Makai.

1763
04:46:40.650 --> 04:46:41.880
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Alright.

1764
04:46:43.210 --> 04:46:44.280
Boardroom: Thanks, Makai.

1765
04:46:45.050 --> 04:46:47.419
Boardroom: Next is Lucas Cantor.

1766
04:46:48.070 --> 04:46:57.730
Boardroom: And right behind is Francesca Cantor, Vicki Sommer, Kathy Rye, and then Christopher Nol… oh, Christopher Kroll, excuse me.

1767
04:46:59.390 --> 04:47:03.290
Lucas Cantor: Thank you. This is Lucas Cantor. Good evening, Mayor and Council.

1768
04:47:03.510 --> 04:47:08.359
Lucas Cantor: I'm a Berkeley resident who walks or bikes on Hopkins with my family nearly every day.

1769
04:47:08.730 --> 04:47:11.840
Lucas Cantor: And nearly every day, we're afraid we're going to be the next to die.

1770
04:47:12.460 --> 04:47:18.839
Lucas Cantor: We love Hopkins, despite its dangerous design, and we're excited to see your plan to add protected bike lanes.

1771
04:47:19.500 --> 04:47:21.170
Lucas Cantor: The evidence is clear.

1772
04:47:21.540 --> 04:47:24.490
Lucas Cantor: Cities that build one-way curbside protected by planes.

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1773
04:47:24.660 --> 04:47:25.580
Lucas Cantor: Keep them.

1774
04:47:26.000 --> 04:47:40.570
Lucas Cantor: Not one has ever been a failure. Not for safety, not for accessibility, not for business. This is a solved problem. It does not require compromise. It requires political will and strong leadership.

1775
04:47:41.750 --> 04:47:49.059
Lucas Cantor: Oakland had this exact debate over their protected bike lanes on Telegraph, but when the dust settled, the data showed, sailed up and crashes down.

1776
04:47:49.200 --> 04:47:54.679
Lucas Cantor: Meanwhile, we've spent the past decade waiting and debating on Hopkins, and dozens of our neighbors have been hit by cars.

1777
04:47:54.830 --> 04:47:56.089
Lucas Cantor: 3 of them died.

1778
04:47:56.470 --> 04:47:59.340
Lucas Cantor: This is senseless and completely preventable violence.

1779
04:47:59.560 --> 04:48:03.740
Lucas Cantor: Paint is not sufficient, and it won't keep us safe. Pass item 27.

1780
04:48:03.740 --> 04:48:04.570
Boardroom: Thank you.

1781
04:48:06.050 --> 04:48:08.559
Boardroom: Francesca Cantor?

1782
04:48:11.790 --> 04:48:14.629
Francesca Cantor: Hi. Good evening.

1783
04:48:15.080 --> 04:48:24.199
Francesca Cantor: Everybody, I'm Francesca Cantor. I'm Luca's wife, actually, a Berkeley resident. I'm just here to add on.

1784

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04:48:24.300 --> 04:48:38.830
Francesca Cantor: To support item 27, you know, this isn't only about cyclists. Protect the flight lanes, make streets safer for anyone who can't or doesn't drive, wheelchair users, kids, the elderly, and transit riders.

1785
04:48:38.830 --> 04:48:47.400
Francesca Cantor: In Berkeley, we walk or bike for 40% of trips, but pedestrians and cyclists absorb 60% of our severe and fatal collisions.

1786
04:48:47.890 --> 04:48:51.489
Francesca Cantor: I also want to address two arguments I've heard tonight. First, parking.

1787
04:48:51.710 --> 04:49:04.139
Francesca Cantor: I think my husband said a lot about this already, but studies in New York, Toronto, and Chicago found protected bike lanes had a neutral or positive effect on local businesses, even after parking was removed. In some cases, sales grew faster.

1788
04:49:04.140 --> 04:49:11.850
Francesca Cantor: than on streets without them. Second, cost. A protected bike lane runs a fraction of what it costs to build or maintain a car lane.

1789
04:49:11.950 --> 04:49:16.919
Francesca Cantor: Cars also cost cities more just by existing on the road.

1790
04:49:16.920 --> 04:49:21.850
Boardroom: Thank you so much. Your time is up, thank you. Next is Vicki.

1791
04:49:22.160 --> 04:49:26.040
Boardroom: Followed by Kathy, then Kala, then Joanna.

1792
04:49:31.520 --> 04:49:38.249
vicki sommer: Good evening, Mayor and Council. It makes no sense to intentionally rope bikes onto a busy commercial street.

1793
04:49:38.430 --> 04:49:54.869
vicki sommer: Spend our tax dollars to repave Hopkins and other streets and direct cycle traffic to quieter side streets. Follow the plans for

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Hopkins that were proposed by O'Keefe and Blackaby, which are rational, fiscally sound, and will best serve all stakeholders.

1794
04:49:55.100 --> 04:50:10.629
vicki sommer: Don't install parking meters. That proposal is just anti-carpunitive. And don't waste local tax dollars pandering to the externally funded bike lobby. They pushed for a bike lane on the Richmond Bridge, which saw only limited usage. Be smarter than that.

1795
04:50:10.950 --> 04:50:29.019
vicki sommer: And I'm distressed to hear that a cycle track is being proposed minus critical evaluations of the space, safety, and parking. And regarding these cycle tracks, ask, how many blocks will an elder without a disability placard carrying two big grocery bags have to walk to access their car in the rain?

1796
04:50:29.180 --> 04:50:31.479
vicki sommer: Listen to O'Keefe and Blackaby.

1797
04:50:32.020 --> 04:50:32.820
vicki sommer: Thank you.

1798
04:50:34.200 --> 04:50:35.600
Boardroom: Thank you.

1799
04:50:36.040 --> 04:50:38.070
Boardroom: Next is Cappy.

1800
04:50:39.110 --> 04:50:46.490
Boardroom: Followed by Kala Schmidt, Joanna Dillon, Nick Pilch, Laura Ide, after Kathy.

1801
04:50:46.690 --> 04:51:01.079
Kathy Rai: Hi, Mayor, Councilmember, I'm Kathy Rye. I used to be a Berkeley resident. I still adore and shop at many Berkeley restaurants and shops, and it's just an amazing place to be and continue to patron.

1802
04:51:01.080 --> 04:51:07.619
Kathy Rai: I am sympathetic to the less abled churchgoers and the people who would be affected.

1803
04:51:07.620 --> 04:51:25.080

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Kathy Rai: Here's the thing, though. No one has died of inconvenience and extra time. I am sure those who lost loved ones would happily chip in for an Uber or Lyft if it would have saved their loved ones from dying. You know, maybe a bike or a helmet tax would help to fund something like that.

1804
04:51:25.080 --> 04:51:28.669
Kathy Rai: I… and… and I'm also…

1805
04:51:28.790 --> 04:51:41.059
Kathy Rai: an unreported injured where I didn't know my elbow was broken when I hit a bump, and I missed a car, because the swelling didn't go away after 2 days, I went to the ER.

1806
04:51:41.060 --> 04:51:51.060
Kathy Rai: So, Sharrow on Marin Avenue does not work. I was almost hit by a truck just this morning. Thank you for listening, and yes, the more traffic, the more bicycles.

1807
04:51:51.060 --> 04:51:51.390
Boardroom: E.

1808
04:51:51.390 --> 04:51:52.400
Kathy Rai: Turkovers.

1809
04:51:52.400 --> 04:51:55.479
Boardroom: Thanks so much. Next is Kala.

1810
04:51:59.660 --> 04:52:00.600
Calla Schmidt: Hello.

1811
04:52:00.810 --> 04:52:10.960
Calla Schmidt: I'm Kala Schmidt, a professor of environmental science and a cyclist. I want to speak in support of the referral to put protected bike lanes on Hopkins and the supplemental to extend them to Stanage.

1812
04:52:11.550 --> 04:52:20.499
Calla Schmidt: We need safe and viable alternatives to cars to meet our climate goals and to live up to other city policy, particularly Vision Zero and safe routes to schools.

1813
04:52:21.040 --> 04:52:30.170

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Calla Schmidt: As a parent that currently bikes my child to school using Rose, I want to strongly state that Rose is not a workable alternative. It is steep.

1814
04:52:30.260 --> 04:52:33.339
Calla Schmidt: In the car and school bus traffic to Ruth and King…

1815
04:52:33.420 --> 04:52:50.940
Calla Schmidt: Ruth Actee and King Middle Schools do not have a viable alternative route. Our kids deserve safe routes to school. Hundreds of parents are driving their kids short distances because it doesn't currently feel safe to walk or bike. This is creating congestion and dangerous conditions for pedestrians, young and old.

1816
04:52:51.540 --> 04:52:56.710
Calla Schmidt: It is already challenging to park in this neighborhood, as many have spoken to tonight.

1817
04:52:56.940 --> 04:53:01.300
Calla Schmidt: As we add more housing and residents at North Berkeley BART and throughout the city.

1818
04:53:01.570 --> 04:53:04.320
Calla Schmidt: We need to ensure this growth doesn't create any more traffic.

1819
04:53:04.920 --> 04:53:06.070
Boardroom: Thanks for comment.

1820
04:53:06.980 --> 04:53:09.209
Boardroom: Next is Joanna.

1821
04:53:13.450 --> 04:53:15.720
Joanna Dillon: Good evening, Mayor and Councilmembers.

1822
04:53:15.970 --> 04:53:29.229
Joanna Dillon: My name is Joanna Dillon, I'm a parent in a bike-first family that bikes every single day to Ruth Actee, the public library, park and pool, and private businesses on Hopkins. I'm also the daughter of an 80-year-old Berkeley resident in District 5.

1823
04:53:29.430 --> 04:53:38.339

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Joanna Dillon: I support Councilmember Kesarwani's item with the extension to Sanage, because I want Berkeley to be a city where everyone has more ways to get around safely, not fewer.

1824
04:53:38.390 --> 04:53:56.339
Joanna Dillon: As my parents age, I want Berkeley to offer them more choices. For people to stay independent longer, they need safe places to walk, safer crossings, reliable transit, and streets where biking feels like a real option. And I want the same independence for my children as they grow up, so they can safely bike to school.

1825
04:53:56.390 --> 04:54:00.519
Joanna Dillon: Anyone who has ridden rows during drop-off can tell you sharrows are not safety.

1826
04:54:00.810 --> 04:54:05.030
Joanna Dillon: Cities across the country have shown that protected bike lanes can improve safety.

1827
04:54:05.230 --> 04:54:14.939
Joanna Dillon: While supporting vibrant business districts. Rose is not a viable alternative. Berkeley is growing. Our transportation system needs to evolve with it. Thank you very much. Please move forward with bike lanes.

1828
04:54:14.940 --> 04:54:18.600
Boardroom: Thank you, Joanna. Next is Nick.

1829
04:54:23.420 --> 04:54:34.810
Nick Pilch he/him: Hello, good evening. This is Nick Pilch, former Albany Mayor, Sierra Club leader, 65-year-old senior, temporarily disabled, and user of Hopkins Street. I was there today on my hand cycle.

1830
04:54:34.810 --> 04:54:36.710
Nick Pilch he/him: This is simply a matter of equity.

1831
04:54:36.710 --> 04:54:59.480
Nick Pilch he/him: Please vote for the thoughtful referral from Councilmember Castewani. I'm sorry, but it's simply insulting to suggest that bicycles use Ada and or Rose instead of Hopkins. Insulting because why do we consider the desires of motor vehicle drivers over all others? Why do only motor vehicle drivers deserve good access to King Pool, the shops on Hopkins, and all the other amenities, but not bicyclists?

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1832
04:54:59.520 --> 04:55:09.939
Nick Pilch he/him: Motor vehicle drivers use the Hopkins to pass through or access these destinations, but some are saying that cyclists should use other streets and not be allowed easy and safe access to Hopkins and its amenities.

1833
04:55:09.940 --> 04:55:24.609
Nick Pilch he/him: Once again, insulting and detrimental to the businesses on Hopkins as well, because they are denied access to the many more cyclists who could have access to their businesses. Do the right thing for the environment, for cyclists, for everyone who wants a safe Hopkins, and the world is watching.

1834
04:55:24.810 --> 04:55:26.670
Boardroom: Thank you, Nick.

1835
04:55:27.860 --> 04:55:30.120
Boardroom: Laura?

1836
04:55:30.500 --> 04:55:38.049
Boardroom: Followed by Michelle Tuati, Emily, Stacey R, and then a number ending in 211. You're on deck.

1837
04:55:38.590 --> 04:56:03.509
laura ide: Thank you. I live on Hopkins Street, and while I support bicycle lanes, the cost, installation, and uncertain outcomes of physical barriers doesn't provide a comprehensive solution for the vast quantity of people who frequent Hopkins. Many people do not or cannot bicycle. We need to make it easy and convenient to use realistic alternate forms of transportation, as in ride apps and the bus. Concrete barriers could reduce errors

1838
04:56:03.510 --> 04:56:21.390
laura ide: for such vehicles to pick up and drop off riders. There's a lot of congestion and illegal driving turns at the Monterey Market intersection. If we drastically reduce parking, there will be even more drivers circling around looking for parking. Is there another way? Has the city studied the bike lane configuration in Parks like Brooklyn?

1839
04:56:21.390 --> 04:56:37.890
laura ide: I lived near Prospect Park West, which is a similarly wide street with buses. They added a painted two-way bike lane along the parkside, and cars were allowed to park outside the bike lanes, which

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provided a natural barrier from moving traffic. It became a one-way street. Has this ever been considered?

1840
04:56:38.020 --> 04:56:38.920
laura ide: Thank you.

1841
04:56:39.850 --> 04:56:40.799
Boardroom: Thank you.

1842
04:56:42.720 --> 04:56:44.850
Boardroom: Michelle?

1843
04:56:54.750 --> 04:56:55.800
Boardroom: Michelle?

1844
04:56:56.590 --> 04:56:58.410
Boardroom: Tuati, are you there?

1845
04:56:58.750 --> 04:57:02.350
Michel Thouati: Oh, so sorry. Here, here we go.

1846
04:57:02.460 --> 04:57:22.270
Michel Thouati: Mayor Ishii, council members, my name is Michel Tuetti. I've biked in Berkeley for 42 years. My wife, two kids, and I bike. When I started a food delivery nonprofit for a group of neighbors during COVID, the first thing we did was to start bike service. My mom lives in Paris, a bike-friendly city safe for cyclists. Every year in Paris, I bike.

1847
04:57:22.270 --> 04:57:33.670
Michel Thouati: Paris has many bike lanes, but few separated ones. Instead, a frequent strategy is to limit side streets to resident traffic only, and make them preferred bike itineraries.

1848
04:57:33.670 --> 04:57:47.019
Michel Thouati: I support bike lanes around Hopkins, but not this one. It divides us, and it puts us bikers in conflict with seniors. It'll cause many to oppose the November tax measure. Instead, let's unify.

1849
04:57:47.020 --> 04:58:02.549
Michel Thouati: I believe a plan that unifies us can be assembled that'll provide safe, preferred bike itineraries in this neighborhood without

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impacting parking while costing a lot less tax money. I urge you to request the staff to assemble it through Councilmember Blackaby's supplemental. Thank you.

1850
04:58:03.670 --> 04:58:04.869
Boardroom: Thank you.

1851
04:58:05.770 --> 04:58:12.770
Boardroom: Next is Emily, followed by Stacy, and then our… collar.

1852
04:58:16.870 --> 04:58:30.390
Emily: Hi, my name is Emily Walker, and I live in D5. Lackabe and O'Keefe suggest slowing down this process and dragging it out even more, but their watered-down plans that they put forth tonight

1853
04:58:30.390 --> 04:58:53.469
Emily: will lead to inferior implantation, which will later be used as an argument that bike lanes don't work. We've been through 8 years of this, and we don't need to slow down the process. We need to slow down the drivers and keep cyclists and pedestrians safe from cars. The share of proposal is NOT the answer. Thank you.

1854
04:58:53.700 --> 04:58:54.570
Boardroom: Thank you.

1855
04:58:56.920 --> 04:58:59.710
Boardroom: Next is… Stacy?

1856
04:59:02.910 --> 04:59:13.190
Stacey R: Hi, my name is Stacy, and I live on Hopkins. I'm a car-free household, but it's currently very stressful for me to bike up Hopkins to get my weekly groceries.

1857
04:59:13.530 --> 04:59:18.569
Stacey R: However, I deal with that stress because I believe in reducing emissions for our climate crisis.

1858
04:59:18.790 --> 04:59:34.550
Stacey R: If Hopkins is repaved without protected bike lanes, I worry it will become too unsafe to bike, since cars would drive faster on a newly paved road. I would seriously consider buying a car to safely run my errands. The opposite of the future Berkeley should be building.

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1859
04:59:34.600 --> 04:59:45.890
Stacey R: As Berkeley plans for more housing to address our state's housing crisis and the future North Berkeley BART development, we should be encouraging alternate modes of transportation, not just driving.

1860
04:59:46.060 --> 05:00:05.150
Stacey R: I understand change can be hard and scary, but unfortunately, we have to make big changes for our climate, affordability, and housing crises. I support Council Item 27 with the supplementals. It builds on years of studies, takes a holistic approach to safety, and includes tree assessments that will improve sidewalk accessibility for everyone. Thank you.

1861
05:00:05.590 --> 05:00:06.470
Boardroom: Thank you.

1862
05:00:07.240 --> 05:00:12.530
Boardroom: Next is, phone number ending in 211.

1863
05:00:16.680 --> 05:00:20.790
1510****211: Hi, I was a proud resident of Berkeley for 62 years.

1864
05:00:21.120 --> 05:00:25.249
1510****211: deeds, and about two and a half the kids at Cal.

1865
05:00:25.410 --> 05:00:27.160
1510****211: Studying and teaching physics.

1866
05:00:27.450 --> 05:00:34.519
1510****211: The planet is dying. We are… the planet is dying. Look at this heat, horrible heat in Europe. East Coast, all of the storms.

1867
05:00:34.860 --> 05:00:38.390
1510****211: We have… Definitely work for the pipeline.

1868
05:00:38.520 --> 05:00:44.129
1510****211: And definitely, definitely, we will walk. We will walk. Take the buses.

1869
05:00:44.260 --> 05:00:50.980

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1510****211: Number 60, 5 and 67, they usually have one or two, Riders! This is empty.

1870
05:00:51.170 --> 05:00:52.740
1510****211: Leave your car behind!

1871
05:00:52.890 --> 05:00:59.319
1510****211: Go outdoor shopping, buy groceries, do everything. Walk. Walking is good for you. I walk about 2 miles a day myself.

1872
05:01:00.180 --> 05:01:08.810
1510****211: So, please, as a resolution, we need the bike clean everywhere we can, and I'm a scientist. I'm not beginning. The Earth

1873
05:01:09.120 --> 05:01:20.070
1510****211: Venus is called Earth's evil twin because the temperature in Venus is about 900 degrees centigrade. We are going in that direction. We are going in that direction. I don't think even we're going to make it better.

1874
05:01:20.070 --> 05:01:22.580
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks for your comment.

1875
05:01:22.930 --> 05:01:28.730
Boardroom: Next is, Stephan Brown, followed by Tonya, then Gene.

1876
05:01:32.860 --> 05:01:49.309
Stephan Brown: Hi, my name's Stephon. Thank you so much, everyone, for, or thank you, thank you to the Council for going through this process. I support the bike lanes on the Hopkins Street. I think that we need to be prioritizing

1877
05:01:49.480 --> 05:01:56.630
Stephan Brown: Opportunities to save human lives and reduce climate emissions, and those should be our priorities, not parking.

1878
05:01:56.880 --> 05:01:57.770
Stephan Brown: Thank you.

1879
05:02:00.610 --> 05:02:01.460
Boardroom: Thank you.

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1880
05:02:01.780 --> 05:02:03.910
Boardroom: Next is Tonya.

1881
05:02:07.090 --> 05:02:12.470
Tonia Wall: Hi, my name is Tanya. I live on Hopkins Street at the intersection of Sacramento

1882
05:02:12.780 --> 05:02:24.899
Tonia Wall: And I am… would like to urge you to vote no on item number 27, and I am in favor of the supplemental proposals by Councilmember Blackaby and Councilmember O'Keefe.

1883
05:02:25.260 --> 05:02:30.419
Tonia Wall: I would like to note that Class 4 biplanes

1884
05:02:30.690 --> 05:02:40.650
Tonia Wall: Are not appropriate for streets with a high density of driveways, as they create multiple points of conflict between motorists and cyclists.

1885
05:02:40.950 --> 05:02:42.010
Tonia Wall: And…

1886
05:02:42.150 --> 05:03:01.240
Tonia Wall: I think there's a misunderstanding that that's going to make things safe. They also don't add protection at intersections where a lot of these conflicts happen. Without a doubt, Hopkins needs paving, it needs traffic calming. I'm also alarmed at item number 27, that there has been no

1887
05:03:01.330 --> 05:03:09.419
Tonia Wall: No outreach by the city to residents on or adjacent to Hopkins Street, or to local businesses, no coordination with AC Transit.

1888
05:03:09.420 --> 05:03:12.690
Boardroom: Thank you, Tonya. Thank you so much, your time's up.

1889
05:03:12.940 --> 05:03:14.780
Boardroom: X is Gene.

1890
05:03:19.480 --> 05:03:20.470

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Jeanne (she/her): Am I on?

1891
05:03:21.050 --> 05:03:21.700
Boardroom: Yes.

1892
05:03:22.080 --> 05:03:42.990
Jeanne (she/her): Hi. So I'm Jean, I live in Berkeley. I closely follow the spring CIP process, through the Council and its committees, and what I heard tonight from Public Works is that there's $6 million, reserved for the Hopkins project, and yet we're now looking at project options at $11 and up to $15 million.

1893
05:03:43.090 --> 05:03:51.960
Jeanne (she/her): And so, I want to point out that there are cost consequences to the choices that are being debated tonight, and if there's an extra,

1894
05:03:52.920 --> 05:04:03.039
Jeanne (she/her): 9 or even $4 million that are needed. It's going to have to come out of the Council's already approved 2027-31 5-year plan.

1895
05:04:03.040 --> 05:04:13.290
Jeanne (she/her): for paving and streets and bike paths. So I urge the Council to give very close thought to how you want to allocate fixed dollars across all the paving

1896
05:04:13.290 --> 05:04:24.850
Jeanne (she/her): pedestrian and bike lane needs that we have in the city, and your CIP documents show that there's $260 million of unfunded street projects, and $66 million of unfunded.

1897
05:04:24.850 --> 05:04:25.300
Boardroom: Hmm.

1898
05:04:25.300 --> 05:04:26.150
Jeanne (she/her): pathways.

1899
05:04:26.150 --> 05:04:27.420
Boardroom: Thank you.

1900
05:04:29.580 --> 05:04:32.749
Boardroom: Next is former Councilmember Cheryl Davila.

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1901
05:04:34.060 --> 05:04:39.479
Boardroom: Followed by Andrew Talbot and Robert Davila.

1902
05:04:40.820 --> 05:04:43.630
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Robert's, giving his minute to me.

1903
05:04:44.250 --> 05:04:45.620
Boardroom: Okay.

1904
05:04:46.840 --> 05:04:50.379
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Can you just… I have to mute myself, hold on a second.

1905
05:04:53.330 --> 05:04:55.670
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Okay, so,

1906
05:04:58.870 --> 05:05:02.010
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: You know, there's… I agree.

1907
05:05:04.400 --> 05:05:07.120
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Can you stop the clock for a second?

1908
05:05:08.920 --> 05:05:11.730
Boardroom: No, I'm sorry, your time is still moving forward.

1909
05:05:12.060 --> 05:05:12.920
Boardroom: I understand.

1910
05:05:12.920 --> 05:05:14.919
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Thanks for being so clear and gracious.

1911
05:05:17.810 --> 05:05:18.790
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: The point is…

1912
05:05:26.610 --> 05:05:28.070
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: facility for all.

1913

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05:05:30.060 --> 05:05:31.490
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Table people.

1914
05:05:37.230 --> 05:05:38.559
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: And the business.

1915
05:05:39.280 --> 05:05:42.180
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Employed bus stops creating more dangerous.

1916
05:05:43.990 --> 05:05:48.620
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: And, I think… Bye.

1917
05:05:52.200 --> 05:05:57.729
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: And, can any of the,

1918
05:06:01.760 --> 05:06:02.520
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: Who's news.

1919
05:06:02.690 --> 05:06:04.310
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: I mean, coming to the

1920
05:06:07.770 --> 05:06:09.270
Former Councilmember Cheryl Davila: The whole time I've been in Brookly.

1921
05:06:19.280 --> 05:06:21.269
Boardroom: Oh, we can't hear you at all now.

1922
05:06:26.820 --> 05:06:29.929
Boardroom: Cheryl, we can't… we can't hear you anymore.

1923
05:06:32.900 --> 05:06:36.780
Boardroom: We'll go on to the next… Speaker.

1924
05:06:38.970 --> 05:06:40.990
Boardroom: Next is Andrew Talbot.

1925
05:06:44.060 --> 05:06:46.519
Andrew Talbot: Hi, this is actually Jackie Irving, his wife.

Unofficial Text File

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1926
05:06:47.870 --> 05:06:54.979
Andrew Talbot: In January 2018, my kids were 3 and 5 when the Hopkins Safety Study referral began. They're teenagers now.

1927
05:06:55.160 --> 05:07:05.830
Andrew Talbot: In March 2021, I was rear-ended by a reckless driver while biking on a bicycle boulevard in Berkeley. My 8-year-old son watched it happen. First responders couldn't tell him if I would survive.

1928
05:07:05.830 --> 05:07:20.690
Andrew Talbot: He was left on the roadside with strangers while I was rushed to Highland Hospital. I didn't see my kids for weeks. A year later, Council voted 8-1 to advance safety improvements on Hopkins. My son stayed up past his bedtime to comment that night. Then that project was killed.

1929
05:07:20.990 --> 05:07:38.910
Andrew Talbot: My kids attend King, and they bike there every day. This year, my son's classmate was hit by a car on Hopkins. He didn't want to talk about it. My son starts high school in two weeks, kindergarten to high school, while we've kept talking. He didn't want to stay up tonight to comment, so I'll read his words.

1930
05:07:39.030 --> 05:07:51.140
Andrew Talbot: I biked to King every day. I took Rose, even though it's too steep and dangerous. I want to take Hopkins, it's quicker, but there are too many cars, and it's not safe for bikes. Our family supports protected bike lanes on Hopkins. Thank you.

1931
05:07:51.300 --> 05:07:52.450
Boardroom: Thank you.

1932
05:07:53.980 --> 05:08:02.589
Boardroom: Next… oh, next is, David… David Mendelson.

1933
05:08:05.980 --> 05:08:06.840
David Mendelsohn: Thank you.

1934
05:08:09.440 --> 05:08:12.560
David Mendelsohn: At the North Berkeley Senior Center last month.

1935
05:08:12.830 --> 05:08:14.820

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David Mendelsohn: I was chatting with another bike rider.

1936
05:08:15.060 --> 05:08:19.580
David Mendelsohn: She was recently retired, and used to drive to North Berkeley every day for her commute.

1937
05:08:20.220 --> 05:08:26.239
David Mendelsohn: But now that the Milvia bike lanes are there, she feels safe enough to bike all the way from South Berkeley, as I had done.

1938
05:08:26.550 --> 05:08:31.000
David Mendelsohn: It feels so much safer now, is what she said. It feels so much safer now.

1939
05:08:31.990 --> 05:08:34.830
David Mendelsohn: When we build good bike infrastructure.

1940
05:08:35.030 --> 05:08:39.229
David Mendelsohn: We're making it safe for people to switch away from cars.

1941
05:08:39.590 --> 05:08:43.320
David Mendelsohn: Fewer people feel the need to drive for every single trip.

1942
05:08:43.750 --> 05:08:47.670
David Mendelsohn: The Milvia bike lane gave her the freedom to not have to drive.

1943
05:08:47.990 --> 05:08:51.169
David Mendelsohn: The Hopkins bike lane will do the same for thousands more.

1944
05:08:51.690 --> 05:08:55.909
David Mendelsohn: If you believe in the city's safety and climate goals, and I think we all do.

1945
05:08:56.240 --> 05:09:01.199
David Mendelsohn: Giving people the freedom to not have to drive will be the best way forward.

1946

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05:09:01.320 --> 05:09:04.790
David Mendelsohn: The safety and freedom to not have to drive.

1947
05:09:04.970 --> 05:09:05.869
David Mendelsohn: Thank you.

1948
05:09:06.590 --> 05:09:08.310
Boardroom: Thank you.

1949
05:09:09.130 --> 05:09:16.629
Boardroom: Next is, we have Ptarmigan, followed by Samuel, then Leah, then Jackie.

1950
05:09:16.750 --> 05:09:18.970
Boardroom: So, ptarmigan.

1951
05:09:32.390 --> 05:09:33.990
Boardroom: Parmigan, are you there?

1952
05:09:38.680 --> 05:09:39.729
Tarmigan: Can you hear me now?

1953
05:09:40.070 --> 05:09:40.860
Boardroom: Yes.

1954
05:09:40.860 --> 05:09:48.050
Tarmigan: Oh, sorry about that. Thank you again to the council members, mayor, and city staff for your work.

1955
05:09:48.330 --> 05:10:07.830
Tarmigan: Even though I live on the other side of the city, my kids are currently taking swimming lessons at King Pool. We mostly get across Berkeley by bike, but on a bike, Hopkins feels unsafe. Hopkins needs better infrastructure, and the alternative parallel routes don't allow safe access to facilities directly on Hopkins Street.

1956
05:10:08.150 --> 05:10:16.079
Tarmigan: I urge you all to support Councilmember Keshirwani's support proposal with the supplemental to extend to Stanage. Thank you.

1957
05:10:17.150 --> 05:10:18.150

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Boardroom: Thank you.

1958
05:10:19.340 --> 05:10:21.039
Boardroom: Next is Samuel.

1959
05:10:24.540 --> 05:10:26.619
Samuel Malki: Hi, my name is Samuel, can you guys hear me?

1960
05:10:27.400 --> 05:10:28.680
Boardroom: Yes.

1961
05:10:28.680 --> 05:10:33.679
Samuel Malki: I just wanted to say, I live on Hopkins Street, between Ordway and Acton.

1962
05:10:33.870 --> 05:10:41.620
Samuel Malki: There's not a lot of bikers in this specific area of Hopkins, so it doesn't seem like there's a lot of demand. I've been living here since 1989.

1963
05:10:41.720 --> 05:10:47.310
Samuel Malki: Never had a problem with the designated bike lane that goes along the Berkeley BART tracks.

1964
05:10:47.550 --> 05:10:51.450
Samuel Malki: been using that for years. I don't really see a point of…

1965
05:10:51.740 --> 05:10:59.090
Samuel Malki: You know, wiping out all the parking spaces, especially, like, the mailman said, like, what if you got a big box, the mailman can't even deliver your box?

1966
05:10:59.290 --> 05:11:04.070
Samuel Malki: You know, stuff like that, let me see, how much time I got left.

1967
05:11:04.680 --> 05:11:10.760
Samuel Malki: Also, if it was in front of your house, I'm sure you wouldn't want that to happen. We can't necessarily use our driveway the way.

1968

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05:11:10.910 --> 05:11:17.030
Samuel Malki: We would want to do it. Also, the driveway has poor visibility. If we do get a car in there, more likely to hit

1969
05:11:17.190 --> 05:11:27.869
Samuel Malki: people coming out of the driveway likely to hit people, in the driveway that's trying to bike by. It's just gonna make it overall more dangerous, in my opinion. I'm totally against it. Thank you.

1970
05:11:27.870 --> 05:11:29.960
Boardroom: Thank you, Samuel.

1971
05:11:30.720 --> 05:11:33.430
Boardroom: Okay, Leah?

1972
05:11:46.230 --> 05:11:47.110
Leah Bushman: Blue.

1973
05:11:47.290 --> 05:11:57.060
Leah Bushman: Hello, my name is Leah Bushman. I'm a homeowner and resident in the Westbury neighborhood of Berkeley. For the last 8 years, I've lived a block and a half from Hopkins Street.

1974
05:11:57.140 --> 05:12:05.029
Leah Bushman: My family bikes to and from work, to the gym, local parks, to see friends, buy groceries at Monterey Market, and grab a slice at Joya.

1975
05:12:05.100 --> 05:12:17.680
Leah Bushman: My 5-year-old son, Theo, will be starting school at Ruth Acadia Elementary School as a kindergartner next month, and he is a future King Middle Schooler. He is extremely excited to start biking to and from school every single day.

1976
05:12:17.800 --> 05:12:29.929
Leah Bushman: Bike lanes on Hopkins would allow my family and others in the neighborhood to get safely around them. I'm saddened that many families in my neighborhood have expressed concern about being able to bike their children to school safely.

1977
05:12:30.170 --> 05:12:35.310
Leah Bushman: I love living in Berkeley. We moved yesterday because we love getting around by foot and bike.

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1978
05:12:35.480 --> 05:12:42.829
Leah Bushman: in public transit. Bike lanes save lives. Please vote yes to 27 and supplemental. Thank you so much.

1979
05:12:43.250 --> 05:12:44.309
Boardroom: Thank you.

1980
05:12:44.940 --> 05:12:47.090
Boardroom: Next is Jackie.

1981
05:12:48.360 --> 05:12:52.569
Boardroom: Followed by Linda's iPad, Robert Munch, and then Matt.

1982
05:12:53.690 --> 05:13:08.400
Jackie: Good evening, my name is Jackie, I'm the manager at Osaka Central Hopkins. I support safe streets for cyclists, but this current plan is not it. Hopkins is more than just another commercial corridor, it's actually a destination, we can all agree on that.

1983
05:13:08.400 --> 05:13:26.239
Jackie: Every day, we welcome not only neighbors who walk or bike, but also customers from all over Berkeley and across the Bay Area. I've personally spoken with people who drive here as far as Marin County and Vallejo, because they value the unique businesses and the character of this neighborhood, and this goes

1984
05:13:26.240 --> 05:13:28.600
Jackie: The same for all business here on the block.

1985
05:13:28.600 --> 05:13:52.329
Jackie: Removing so much parking without practical alternative will discourage those visitors, hurting the small businesses that have made this area successful in the first place, and that contribute to Berkeley's tax revenue. My concern isn't just about parking, it's about preserving the long-term vitality and identity of North Berkeley. Please reconsider this proposal and work towards a balanced solution

1986
05:13:52.330 --> 05:13:56.749
Jackie: that improves safety while preserving accessibility. Businesses… Thank you.

1987

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05:13:56.750 --> 05:14:00.399
Boardroom: Jackie, thanks so much. X is Linda.

1988
05:14:02.870 --> 05:14:05.470
Linda’s iPad: Hi! Can you hear me?

1989
05:14:05.470 --> 05:14:06.230
Boardroom: Yes.

1990
05:14:06.230 --> 05:14:16.770
Linda’s iPad: Hi, my name is Linda Harris, and I've lived in District 5 for 32 years. As a long-time Berkeley resident, one of the things I love most about Berkeley is its diversity.

1991
05:14:16.770 --> 05:14:28.389
Linda’s iPad: So, considering, you know, all the points I've used tonight, I am advocating for a plan that includes all the diverse shareholders. So, one, please let's go back to the drawing board.

1992
05:14:28.390 --> 05:14:42.639
Linda’s iPad: First, Councilmembers O'Keefe and Blackaby's, process and design an inclusive process representing all the diverse stakeholders, not just cyclists. Two, please vote to reject Councilmember Karawasi's proposal.

1993
05:14:42.640 --> 05:14:56.890
Linda’s iPad: Three, no matter what, please vote to make Hopkins safer for all by repaving it and installing the appropriate traffic controls, etc. Oh, and finally, last bonus point, please consider adding new parking

1994
05:14:56.890 --> 05:15:08.200
Linda’s iPad: on Hopkins, there's a connector street, I don't know exactly what it is, the one that fronts Monterey Market and Berkeley Hort, close it off through traffic and make it not a connector.

1995
05:15:08.200 --> 05:15:08.940
Boardroom: Thank you.

1996
05:15:08.940 --> 05:15:09.770
Linda’s iPad: parking.

1997

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05:15:11.250 --> 05:15:16.780
Boardroom: Next is, Robert, followed by Matt, Jonah, and Theo.

1998
05:15:19.800 --> 05:15:29.970
Robert Munch: Hi, my name is Robert Munch. I'm a first-time commenter. I gotta say, this has been a very illuminating experience, so, just hats off to the Council and the mayor.

1999
05:15:29.970 --> 05:15:51.389
Robert Munch: My wife and I own a house in District 3. We decided to settle in Berkeley partially because of the accessibility that living in Berkeley would provide for us and our future family. We decided to invest in Berkeley, invest in a life, invest for the future, and invest for a family. I grew up out of state, in a town, like most American towns, that had no infrastructure outside of driving.

2000
05:15:51.390 --> 05:16:14.610
Robert Munch: seeing a friend, playing pickup in the park, or meeting a girl just couldn't happen unless I could get a ride. The ability for everyone in Berkeley to have access to safe, parts of the city is really something worth preserving. I support the plan for the protected bike lane, mainly because I like the bike. It's good for your health, good for your wallet, good for the environment. But also, as someone planning a life in Berkeley, I worry that the city

2001
05:16:14.620 --> 05:16:23.520
Robert Munch: When we prioritize parked vehicles, we become a bit more like those vehicles, internalizing their lessons, staying in place, because it's easy, because it's cheap, because that's the way it's been.

2002
05:16:24.140 --> 05:16:25.660
Boardroom: Sorry, thanks, Robert.

2003
05:16:26.000 --> 05:16:28.290
Boardroom: Matt?

2004
05:16:29.260 --> 05:16:33.080
Boardroom: Followed by Jonah, Theo, and then Carrie Schulman.

2005
05:16:35.190 --> 05:16:40.519
Matt: Great. The good thing… excuse me, the good thing about Councilmember O'Keefe and

2006

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05:16:40.850 --> 05:16:57.150
Matt: Blackaby's proposals are that they reflect that they actually listen to the residents, and what the residents want, and they show interest in the concerns of the residents, who overwhelmingly oppose this.

2007
05:16:57.510 --> 05:17:02.829
Matt: The other council member's proposal, on the other hand, favors this

2008
05:17:03.290 --> 05:17:21.560
Matt: bike lobby that's part of this YIMBY group, and they're very dogmatic, and they feel like, you know, I invested in Berkeley, and I came here for this and that. Well, the long-term residents have also invested in Berkeley. In fact, their tax dollars over the years and decades

2009
05:17:21.560 --> 05:17:34.659
Matt: pay for the Berkey that you like, that attracted you here, so their concerns ought to be taken in account as well, rather than imposing this dogma on longtime residents and denigrating them.

2010
05:17:34.810 --> 05:17:35.840
Matt: Thank you.

2011
05:17:37.900 --> 05:17:39.630
Boardroom: Next is Jonah.

2012
05:17:42.530 --> 05:17:53.519
Jonah Gollub: Hi, thank you. So, we're a family of four, we're a family of three with a four-year-old, we own a home, we live at the intersection of Hopkins and Peralta.

2013
05:17:53.520 --> 05:18:08.570
Jonah Gollub: We see cyclists here all the time, community to work, school, tennis sports, the park. We moved here in 2022, believing in Berkeley's commitment to being a forward-looking community, and I want to relate our strong support of putting protected bike lanes on the streets.

2014
05:18:08.570 --> 05:18:25.710
Jonah Gollub: I think embracing biking has generally improved our lives, but I've also seen first-hand car bike accidents at our intersection because the city has failed to invest in bike lanes on this critical corridor. We regularly drive to buy our groceries in Monterey, one-fourth, drop off our kid at preschool one mile.

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2015
05:18:25.710 --> 05:18:35.189
Jonah Gollub: go to Kings Pool.5 miles, but because of how unsafe Hopkins is, we oftentimes don't bike, and it makes a lot more… I think we would much rather bike,

2016
05:18:35.230 --> 05:18:46.919
Jonah Gollub: We would prefer to bike, and, you know, we regularly bike other places in Berkeley and Albany, but simply because the infrastructure's not here, we don't. So I think adding the infrastructure is the right thing to do.

2017
05:18:46.920 --> 05:18:52.339
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks so much for your comment. Your time's up. Theo?

2018
05:18:54.410 --> 05:19:04.879
Theo: Hi, council members. My name is Theo Gordon. I'm a Berkeley dad and a homeowner. I have 26 years left on my mortgage, so I think that makes me a long-time Berkeleyan.

2019
05:19:05.190 --> 05:19:18.809
Theo: Please support the customer warning item, including the supplementals, and please do not just consider the voices who can wait for hours to make public comment, mine included. I think it'd be crazy to do this, and I am.

2020
05:19:18.810 --> 05:19:27.019
Theo: But please consider the voters who passed Measure FF. Citywide, we voted for funding for bike lanes like this.

2021
05:19:27.020 --> 05:19:35.890
Theo: We did not vote for studies and meetings, we voted for concrete, we voted for protection, and we voted for that to be done in our lifetimes.

2022
05:19:35.900 --> 05:19:55.529
Theo: We already have a bike plan, we already have Vision Zero, we already have climate emergency legislation, so none of this should actually be a decision that we really need to wait tonight. It has already been decided. Hopkins is a priority, bike corridor, so let's make it happen, and please, please, please don't study this for another decade. Thank you.

2023

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05:19:55.770 --> 05:19:56.890
Boardroom: Thanks, Theo.

2024
05:19:58.300 --> 05:20:00.560
Boardroom: Okay, next is Carrie.

2025
05:20:01.840 --> 05:20:13.590
Boardroom: Followed by Brian McNeely, Yen Track, and Julia Cox. Mayor, we just have about three and a half minutes left. Oh, I think we started at 11.10.

2026
05:20:14.230 --> 05:20:17.149
Boardroom: So… restarted, because we took a break.

2027
05:20:17.790 --> 05:20:22.510
Boardroom: read that this… I paused the timer during… Okay. Yeah.

2028
05:20:24.970 --> 05:20:26.070
Kary Schulman: Hello, can you hear me?

2029
05:20:26.360 --> 05:20:27.110
Boardroom: Yes.

2030
05:20:27.110 --> 05:20:34.209
Kary Schulman: Thank you. The Hopkins Corridor, the commercial corridor, is the place, it is THE place.

2031
05:20:34.300 --> 05:20:42.030
Kary Schulman: that every placemaker wants to make. But it happened organically. And that is so rare and so precious.

2032
05:20:42.030 --> 05:20:57.820
Kary Schulman: And it is fragile, and unique, and comparisons to other cities are useless in terms of, oh, more bike lanes increase business. I don't think they will on Hopkins, and I think you've heard enough from people to realize that. But, unfortunately.

2033
05:20:57.820 --> 05:21:03.460
Kary Schulman: We can't know this until the beloved locally owned businesses are gone, and it's too late.

2034

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05:21:04.250 --> 05:21:10.560
Kary Schulman: Please pave the streets, put in pedestrian safety features, and preserve access for all.

2035
05:21:10.720 --> 05:21:11.729
Kary Schulman: Thank you.

2036
05:21:13.630 --> 05:21:15.600
Boardroom: Okay, next, dude. It's good.

2037
05:21:15.920 --> 05:21:29.159
Boardroom: Thank you. We're gonna take 3 more people, because we are reaching our 1-hour time limit. Okay, so next is Brian McNeely, then Yen Track, then Julia Cato will be the last speaker.

2038
05:21:32.500 --> 05:21:50.199
Brian McNeilly: Hi, I'm a current D3 resident who uses a bicycle as my primary means of transit. I actually moved from Western D1 to D3 in part to find cycling infrastructure both me and my partner felt safe riding on. As future parents, if we feel unsafe cycling somewhere, we certainly won't feel safe cycling with our children.

2039
05:21:50.200 --> 05:22:06.160
Brian McNeilly: or let them cycle on their own. Adding bike lanes will help create a low-stress bike network for riders of all abilities by reducing conflicts between cyclists, pedestrians, and cars. This is the kind of bold action that will make a meaningful change in the lives of not just me, but Berkeley's future residents.

2040
05:22:06.160 --> 05:22:13.430
Brian McNeilly: I urge you all to vote yes on Councilmember Kassarwani's referral and supplementals from Councilmembers Taplin and Lunapara.

2041
05:22:13.550 --> 05:22:22.119
Brian McNeilly: I also want to thank Council for providing a Zoom alternative. I actually rushed from work to the Council meeting in an attempt to comment in person, but had to go home.

2042
05:22:22.290 --> 05:22:26.999
Brian McNeilly: To attend to Family Needs, and now barely still had time to comment, so thank you all.

2043
05:22:27.370 --> 05:22:28.530

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Boardroom: Thank you.

2044
05:22:29.650 --> 05:22:33.100
Boardroom: Okay, next is, Yen Track.

2045
05:22:37.180 --> 05:22:46.170
Yen Trac: I… I will try to be really brief, but I think I got a minute from Jessica Livingston and one from Bob Matthews.

2046
05:22:46.500 --> 05:22:47.880
Yen Trac: If they're still on.

2047
05:22:48.510 --> 05:22:49.810
Yen Trac: I don't know how to confirm that.

2048
05:22:49.810 --> 05:22:54.850
Boardroom: And I'm sorry, but we're running out of time, so you'll have your minute to speak, and then we'll have to cut off.

2049
05:22:54.850 --> 05:23:04.300
Yen Trac: Okay, alright, so I'm just here to say, please vote in favor of Councilmember Blackaby's supplemental to item 27.

2050
05:23:04.800 --> 05:23:12.409
Yen Trac: I think it's a really difficult, issue that you have, because we have such a diverse community in Berkeley.

2051
05:23:12.710 --> 05:23:20.110
Yen Trac: And, I, I think, you know, my point is, when I hear people make assumptions about,

2052
05:23:20.340 --> 05:23:27.450
Yen Trac: you know, us drivers being resistant to change, or being indifferent to environmental impact. I really just want to address that.

2053
05:23:27.610 --> 05:23:33.020
Yen Trac: It's really unfair, and honestly, a very entitled perspective.

2054
05:23:33.260 --> 05:23:45.450

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Yen Trac: I grew up in the inner city. There was no way for me to learn to ride a bike. We also didn't have money for me to have a bike. So, as an adult, I work… I work all the time.

2055
05:23:45.670 --> 05:23:48.750
Yen Trac: I don't have time to go and learn to ride a bike.

2056
05:23:49.630 --> 05:23:51.419
Yen Trac: I do a lot of errands.

2057
05:23:52.280 --> 05:23:55.459
Yen Trac: I have to do it efficiently in a very tight schedule.

2058
05:23:55.680 --> 05:24:01.769
Yen Trac: So, when you make parking impossible, it will mean that I cannot access the shops.

2059
05:24:01.770 --> 05:24:04.000
Boardroom: Thank you, Anne. Thanks for your comment.

2060
05:24:04.720 --> 05:24:08.089
Boardroom: And then, last speaker is Julia Cato.

2061
05:24:12.210 --> 05:24:16.990
Julia Cato: Hello, my name is Julia Cato, and I live…

2062
05:24:18.170 --> 05:24:25.389
Julia Cato: Near Sacramento, Martin Luther King, and Dwight, and we have bicycle streets.

2063
05:24:25.550 --> 05:24:31.450
Julia Cato: But they are California and Channing. They're not the major streets in my district.

2064
05:24:31.670 --> 05:24:33.920
Julia Cato: And it works for everybody.

2065
05:24:34.030 --> 05:24:38.470
Julia Cato: I do not understand why bike lanes have to be on…

2066

Unofficial Text File

This information provided by Zoom. The City of Berkeley cannot certify the following text since we did not create it.

05:24:39.040 --> 05:24:54.990
Julia Cato: on Hopkins, when there are all kinds of streets around, which would not require you spend a small fortune to build all of this apparatus when you could just paint a line down the street designating the bike line.

2067
05:24:54.990 --> 05:25:01.259
Julia Cato: as they have done on California, and as far as I know on California, there have never been any

2068
05:25:01.400 --> 05:25:11.409
Julia Cato: serious accidents, much less fatalities. So I'm really, really concerned about why this insistence on being on this… on the most

2069
05:25:11.830 --> 05:25:15.800
Julia Cato: Traffic street in the area when you could have them on your.

2070
05:25:15.800 --> 05:25:28.350
Boardroom: Leah, your time is up. Thanks so much. I'm sorry, folks, I know there are a number of you that are still online that weren't able to give public comment, so I'm sorry we weren't able to give you that time this evening.

2071
05:25:28.350 --> 05:25:37.409
Boardroom: We are coming back to Councils for council members com… council member comments, excuse me, starting with Councilmember Kesarwani.

2072
05:25:38.390 --> 05:25:52.420
Boardroom: Thank you very much, Madam Mayor. I want to thank all of the commenters, both in person and online. You know, I continue to reiterate what I said at the beginning, that this is a really challenging issue for us.

2073
05:25:53.750 --> 05:26:09.519
Boardroom: I, I think for the purposes of discussion, I would like to move my recommendation with the amendments that I shared earlier on screen. Second. Okay, thank you for that, and I do want to address

2074
05:26:09.540 --> 05:26:31.750
Boardroom: the supplemental from Councilmember Taplin, co-sponsored by Councilmember Lunapata, and I… first I want to thank you for it, because I know we did hear from a lot of folks tonight asking to extend to

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Stanage, and I do want to explain in more detail why I believe the proposal that I've authored is the right one for now, and

2075
05:26:32.010 --> 05:26:38.939
Boardroom: I have said, and I believe that the reallocation of the public right-of-way that we are proposing for Hopkins Street

2076
05:26:38.940 --> 05:26:58.910
Boardroom: is without precedent in our city. And when a big change like this is made, I believe it should be justified by the data that we have in terms of where the serious and fatal crashes are occurring. And that is why my item includes information about those locations.

2077
05:26:58.910 --> 05:27:16.399
Boardroom: and proposes safety treatments to address them. When we look at that far western segment, which is the five blocks from Peralta Avenue, Ohlone Greenway, to Stanage Avenue, we do propose traffic calming, because we want to make sure when we repave that street.

2078
05:27:16.400 --> 05:27:33.620
Boardroom: you know, some of what we've seen on rows and other repaved streets is the tendency for cars to go faster, so we do want to have traffic calming there. But when we looked at the data for the 15 years that we have in our report, there were no serious injuries that occurred on that segment.

2079
05:27:33.820 --> 05:27:39.060
Boardroom: And for bicyclists, there were… it appears from our map, there were 3…

2080
05:27:39.140 --> 05:27:54.249
Boardroom: incidents that occurred, none of them were serious. This is over 15 years, and so when I… when I consider that, and I consider the trade-off of the reallocation of the public right-of-way, for that segment.

2081
05:27:54.250 --> 05:28:04.270
Boardroom: it didn't appear justified to me. And I do want to talk about connecting West Berkeley to the amenities on Hopkins.

2082
05:28:04.360 --> 05:28:29.360
Boardroom: I think that that will still happen, because the Alameda County Transportation Commission is going to improve the intersection of Camellia and San Pablo Avenue, so that if you live in northwest Berkeley,

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if you're around the Virginia Street crossing, you can easily cross and get on the Greenway. If you're living, you know, more… farther north of that, you should be able to cross safely at Camellia.

2083
05:28:29.360 --> 05:28:51.429
Boardroom: and cross, and at that point, you'd have a couple options. You could go up to Santa Fe and get on the Greenway, and you'd be on a protected route and connect to the Hopkins bike lane, the protected bike lane that we propose to start at Peralta. So I want people to keep in mind, those folks would have a connection, a safe connection to the Hopkins amenities.

2084
05:28:52.750 --> 05:29:08.050
Boardroom: once we have that parallel route that's proposed for Stanage, that could be another option for folks who would feel comfortable taking the Hopkins route, and so it's not something that I want to preclude. Our item talks about

2085
05:29:08.240 --> 05:29:21.200
Boardroom: doing pedestrian safety features that would allow for a future bike lane, but I think with the information I currently have, and the ability to connect West Berkeley, that I think this is the right…

2086
05:29:21.370 --> 05:29:24.069
Boardroom: The right location

2087
05:29:24.170 --> 05:29:36.570
Boardroom: to pursue, which is the Ohlone Greenway and Peralta Avenue, stopping point. And then, on the funding issue, you know, a lot of people were saying, you know, how can you have

2088
05:29:36.570 --> 05:29:51.599
Boardroom: the funding to pursue this when you have a deficit. I just want to clarify, the funding for paving and safety infrastructure, if you look at our paving item from July 7th, those are primarily special funds

2089
05:29:51.600 --> 05:30:01.920
Boardroom: that can only be used for paving and safety infrastructure. And when we talk about our deficit, we're talking about the general fund. So, so it's, these funds are not…

2090
05:30:02.060 --> 05:30:12.899

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Boardroom: they're not fungible with each other, and I know it's very confusing, and it may not make sense, but in terms of, thinking about Hopkins Street.

2091
05:30:12.930 --> 05:30:29.719
Boardroom: and how we pay for it, you know, I feel comfortable with this proposal because of the nature of how it is funded through special funds. So I did want to say that, and help folks understand, that's the issue. You know, we can't use some of these special restricted funds

2092
05:30:29.720 --> 05:30:33.250
Boardroom: To pay for things that we're proposing,

2093
05:30:33.580 --> 05:30:42.229
Boardroom: through our sales tax measure and our bond measure. So I wanted to clarify that, and I look forward to hearing comments from my colleagues. Thank you very much.

2094
05:30:42.710 --> 05:30:45.739
Boardroom: Thank you. Moving on to Councilmember Taplin.

2095
05:30:46.410 --> 05:31:01.800
Boardroom: Thank you very much, and I wanna… I wanna thank the speakers, especially, the people who spoke, who were themselves survivors of traffic violence. I wanna really underscore how much courage it takes to come here to us tonight and share that.

2096
05:31:01.980 --> 05:31:03.530
Boardroom: Those stories with us.

2097
05:31:03.750 --> 05:31:07.200
Boardroom: And I, I thank you for, for, for doing that.

2098
05:31:07.310 --> 05:31:13.320
Boardroom: And for me, that's really what's at the heart of this for me,

2099
05:31:16.450 --> 05:31:23.619
Boardroom: ends… There, I mean, there's, like, no end to what I could say right now, but,

2100
05:31:23.930 --> 05:31:40.280

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Boardroom: I want to circle back to what Councilmember Humbert was saying during the question round, you know, really pointing out all of our policies that we have. You know, the bike plan, climate action plan. These are things that we continuously adopt and declare as priorities, and…

2101
05:31:40.550 --> 05:31:45.530
Boardroom: Profess that will contribute resources to move these things forward, and then…

2102
05:31:46.480 --> 05:31:51.460
Boardroom: So, far too often, the choice comes to us, and… and…

2103
05:31:51.630 --> 05:31:55.559
Boardroom: you know, perhaps previously, at times, Council has

2104
05:31:55.750 --> 05:31:58.100
Boardroom: Has not set forward in the way that

2105
05:31:58.300 --> 05:32:02.829
Boardroom: it should have, and I think tonight we can correct that.

2106
05:32:03.990 --> 05:32:09.329
Boardroom: And for me, it's… I also want to just point out that

2107
05:32:11.330 --> 05:32:15.180
Boardroom: I mean, I've been here 6 years, but 6 years ago, the conversation has…

2108
05:32:15.360 --> 05:32:34.929
Boardroom: really… I'm actually grateful that we can choose between, you know, the protected lanes and protected lanes for a larger stretch. The fact that we're having that conversation right now, to me, is really indicative of how far we've come as a community, so… so thank you to all of you.

2109
05:32:36.960 --> 05:32:50.599
Boardroom: you know, with the ACTC project, and with the Hopkins project, I did see… I did see the chance to integrate these two things, but it sounds like… sounds like you don't support that, and, you know, I certainly would, and I would even support extending it to Milvia.

2110

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05:32:50.930 --> 05:32:54.279
Boardroom: But, sounds like that's not really an option tonight.

2111
05:32:54.840 --> 05:33:12.410
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Taplin. You know, I do appreciate it. I know we heard that from a lot of commenters, and I think we… you know, I sort of explained my feeling on the western segment. In terms of that eastern segment.

2112
05:33:12.410 --> 05:33:25.199
Boardroom: We do have the… the buffered… we're proposing the buffered Class 2 bike lane there. It's the same reason that when we looked at the crash data, we didn't see the serious injuries there that warranted the protected bike lane.

2113
05:33:25.200 --> 05:33:35.790
Boardroom: And on that segment, you have significant costs. There's a church there that has parking, and, you know, people are pointing out the cost of this, and we do have to be sensitive to that, because…

2114
05:33:35.940 --> 05:33:39.029
Boardroom: As we know, you know, the…

2115
05:33:39.280 --> 05:33:57.519
Boardroom: these, dollars. We have hard choices to make in terms of funding this, doing the safety infrastructure, and then trying to do everything else that we have in our paving plan and what we voted on for FF. So that is the reasoning behind really focusing the protected bike lane

2116
05:33:57.610 --> 05:34:12.229
Boardroom: where the serious injuries occur, but doing as much as we can to connect the network. You know, we do recognize the Milvia Bike Boulevard is there. We want to bring people down safely and, connect to the Greenway.

2117
05:34:12.710 --> 05:34:23.090
Boardroom: And other options. Thank you. Yeah, thank you very much. Yeah, you know, I think, I really want to thank you for your leadership and your work on all this, and I, you know, I don't want to let the…

2118
05:34:23.280 --> 05:34:26.350
Boardroom: Perfect be the enemy of the good, and so I'm happy to support the motion.

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2119
05:34:28.070 --> 05:34:30.140
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Lunapara.

2120
05:34:30.430 --> 05:34:43.960
Boardroom: Thank you. I know everyone has a lot to say, and it's been a long night, and given that I proudly and loudly helped organize the die-in protest on Hopkins several years ago, I know everyone knows where I stand.

2121
05:34:43.960 --> 05:34:51.390
Boardroom: So I want to thank all of the public commenters, and I just really want to hone in on a few points that particularly struck me and that I think are important.

2122
05:34:51.710 --> 05:35:02.360
Boardroom: I know it seems to many as if these proposed changes are not that serious for people on bikes. We have… but we have redesigned our streets and our cities around cars, and the consequences of that have been deadly.

2123
05:35:02.490 --> 05:35:15.619
Boardroom: I love our bicycle boulevards, but when you are on a bicycle and you are sharing a road with cars without physical separation, you are entirely at the mercy of the driver. A driver that is operating a machine that can be and is often used as a deadly weapon.

2124
05:35:15.710 --> 05:35:30.440
Boardroom: A simple moment of road rage can and often leads to loss of life for the person outside of the car. And that is why sharrows and painted bike lanes, especially with the goal of preserving non-blue curb parking spaces, is a disservice and feels like a slap in the face.

2125
05:35:30.800 --> 05:35:42.779
Boardroom: It especially feels like a disservice to our young residents, who deserve the right to move about the city safely and independently, to our low-income residents, who are most likely to rely on modes of transportation other than cars.

2126
05:35:42.990 --> 05:35:52.040
Boardroom: To the many residents of all ages who want alternatives to driving but do not feel safe using our current streets, and to our residents who have been personally victims of traffic violence.

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2127
05:35:52.600 --> 05:36:01.280
Boardroom: I want to focus in on that fact that these are not passive decisions. Every fatality from traffic violence on our streets is a policy choice.

2128
05:36:01.360 --> 05:36:20.660
Boardroom: And I know that maybe connecting this issue to the threats of our democracy is a bit melodramatic, but I believe that part of our grander national problem is exactly what we've been hearing about today. The City Council has been debating the single street for almost a decade, with residents, especially residents at disproportionate risk of traffic violence, forced to wait.

2129
05:36:20.900 --> 05:36:36.860
Boardroom: I believe very, very strongly that we need to fix the faults of our predecessors and prove to people that a better world, or in this case, better, safer, concrete infrastructure, is possible. That our government is actually willing to think big, and make actual decisions and to deliver for them.

2130
05:36:36.860 --> 05:36:41.670
Boardroom: That's what I believe will help rebuild our democracy, and that's what Berkeley deserves. Thank you.

2131
05:36:42.390 --> 05:36:44.390
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember.

2132
05:36:44.830 --> 05:36:46.360
Boardroom: Councilmember O'Keefe.

2133
05:36:48.500 --> 05:36:50.089
Boardroom: Okay, vibe shift.

2134
05:36:51.310 --> 05:36:56.890
Boardroom: So, I've spent a lot of time thinking about this.

2135
05:36:57.200 --> 05:36:59.580
Boardroom: Over the last weeks, months.

2136
05:36:59.860 --> 05:37:15.980
Boardroom: years. And, there's a little part of a framework that I want to share with everyone that's, how I've been thinking about it. And

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there's two important questions I want to talk about. One is, what's wanted versus what's needed. Another one is what are the trade-offs?

2137
05:37:16.270 --> 05:37:18.769
Boardroom: Those are the two important questions to ask here.

2138
05:37:19.110 --> 05:37:22.329
Boardroom: There are many…

2139
05:37:22.510 --> 05:37:35.019
Boardroom: Many wants deserve considerations, but at times of serious financial constraints and just always in the business of running cities, we have to be highly discerning about how we allocate our increasingly limited resources.

2140
05:37:35.230 --> 05:37:44.239
Boardroom: So, I do agree, actually, that a Class 4 bike lane would be better for cyclists than a Class 2 bike lane, and certainly better than Sherro's. That's not up for debate. It would be a lot better.

2141
05:37:44.480 --> 05:37:45.390
Boardroom: But…

2142
05:37:45.560 --> 05:37:52.849
Boardroom: As civic leaders, we are not here to implement what's best for bicyclists, we're here to implement what's best for the community at large.

2143
05:37:53.230 --> 05:38:08.219
Boardroom: And while the bike lane is understandably wanted by some in the bike community, and, you know, I say some, because we heard from many cyclists who do not support this, but granted, many people in the bike community very much want this, and for good reason.

2144
05:38:08.340 --> 05:38:15.379
Boardroom: The fact that other alternative routes exist demonstrates that this is not a need.

2145
05:38:16.510 --> 05:38:19.929
Boardroom: I understand Rose is a little steeper.

2146
05:38:21.240 --> 05:38:23.359

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Boardroom: But bikes have gears.

2147
05:38:23.610 --> 05:38:36.319
Boardroom: My son graduated from Longfellow, he's gonna be so mad that I brought him into this, but he graduated from Longfellow this year, which is now in San Pablo, and he rode his bike home from there to Spruce Street.

2148
05:38:36.400 --> 05:38:45.790
Boardroom: Every single day. It is absolutely possible for cyclists to take other routes. And I recognize that Rose is not currently a great street to bike on. I am not claiming that.

2149
05:38:45.880 --> 05:38:54.500
Boardroom: But it could, with not much effort compared to what we're talking about, be turned into a proper bicycle boulevard.

2150
05:38:54.600 --> 05:39:11.039
Boardroom: there is an alternative, and we're serious about that. I am serious about that when I put that into my motion. That is staff… that is direction to staff. They would do it. They would make it a bicycle boulevard, and that is a fantastic alternative that does not have these trade-offs.

2151
05:39:11.980 --> 05:39:13.649
Boardroom: So all this to say.

2152
05:39:14.220 --> 05:39:19.559
Boardroom: A Class 4 bike lane on Hopkins has obvious advantages, but it is not needed, it is wanted.

2153
05:39:20.670 --> 05:39:25.510
Boardroom: We have to be discerning about that. What is needed is for the street to be paved.

2154
05:39:26.070 --> 05:39:29.149
Boardroom: And for the street to get major pedestrian upgrades.

2155
05:39:29.650 --> 05:39:34.270
Boardroom: Those things are absolutely needed, and they're also not up for debate. I think everybody agrees with that.

2156

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05:39:34.960 --> 05:39:37.870
Boardroom: So, the second question, what are the trade-offs?

2157
05:39:38.390 --> 05:39:50.729
Boardroom: I've already spoken about the parking, and many commenters eloquently summed up their concerns about that. I'm really glad we got to hear from some of the merchants who are understandably terrified of losing parking in front of and near their businesses.

2158
05:39:51.600 --> 05:40:00.200
Boardroom: It's hard being a small business owner, so I don't have any interest in making it harder for them. Parking laws should not be waived away as a concern.

2159
05:40:00.330 --> 05:40:10.849
Boardroom: We heard so many people worried about loading zones. We have questions about garbage trucks, mail delivery, fire access, preschool drop-offs. So many questions.

2160
05:40:11.090 --> 05:40:16.020
Boardroom: We've never removed all the parking before along a busy commercial corridor.

2161
05:40:16.340 --> 05:40:21.709
Boardroom: We don't know… we don't know what would happen, but there's a lot of questions and a lot of concerns.

2162
05:40:22.100 --> 05:40:39.180
Boardroom: We would also be jeopardizing access to park amenities for everyone who drives, including… which is a group that notably includes older people, people with disabilities, families with little kids, and those who live in the hills, and anyone who visits from far away, who visits our wonderful little corner of town.

2163
05:40:40.080 --> 05:40:44.349
Boardroom: That… jeopardizing that access is a major trade-off.

2164
05:40:44.740 --> 05:40:56.810
Boardroom: And then the second trade-off, I might run out of time. I hope I could be granted a little bit of, grace, given this is my district. And I am almost done. The second trade-off is the cost.

2165
05:40:57.480 --> 05:41:08.870

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Boardroom: $5 million is a huge amount of money, that is a third of our yearly FF budget. And I represent the area of Hopkins that has the commercial area and the park. And I am against this plan.

2166
05:41:11.690 --> 05:41:22.059
Boardroom: And I can tell you, there are… while there are some people in the neighborhood who support it, I have met them, they exist, they were here tonight, I acknowledge that. The vast majority of the neighborhood does not want this.

2167
05:41:22.200 --> 05:41:24.950
Boardroom: And I'm not saying that because of who came tonight.

2168
05:41:26.130 --> 05:41:28.760
Boardroom: And I'm not saying that because of the emails.

2169
05:41:30.110 --> 05:41:38.659
Boardroom: I believe I'm the only person up here who has knocked nearly every single door in that neighborhood. I have. And I can tell you, the neighborhood

2170
05:41:39.250 --> 05:41:46.559
Boardroom: The significant majority of that neighborhood does not want this, and I do not want this for my district.

2171
05:41:47.410 --> 05:41:59.739
Boardroom: And we are considering spending $5 million, once again, a third of our yearly FF budget, on an infrastructure project that the representative for the district does not want, and the neighborhood does not want. This is absolutely madness.

2172
05:42:00.210 --> 05:42:01.629
Boardroom: Absolute madness.

2173
05:42:01.840 --> 05:42:07.420
Boardroom: And I… I try not to get upset up here. I usually don't.

2174
05:42:07.540 --> 05:42:15.420
Boardroom: I try not to get mad at my colleagues. I know we're all doing our jobs, and we disagree, and I know that's part of it. But this is trying me, because…

2175

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05:42:16.750 --> 05:42:35.390
Boardroom: Please do not force this expensive, disruptive, unwanted plan on District 5. We do not want it, and there are other alternatives. So, councilmember, your time's up. I'm gonna just open mine. Okay. Oh, thank you very much, I appreciate that. And I am almost done. I actually want to say what I want now. That's how I feel.

2176
05:42:35.390 --> 05:43:00.250
Boardroom: What I want is, obviously, I support my own supplemental. I also, can support Blackaby's. I think it cleverly addresses one of the biggest issues here, which is lack of information. It's a big problem. So I'm happy to, I'm happy to give a little more time to explore options. I feel like his item wouldn't derail us for getting it paved in 2028 as it's currently scheduled, and so, because of that, I would support it. And I would actually like to

2177
05:43:00.250 --> 05:43:09.940
Boardroom: I still want to have a discussion and hear from people, but I would like to make a substitute motion to move my supplemental with, I'd like to adopt the change in the tree language.

2178
05:43:10.000 --> 05:43:17.900
Boardroom: from Kessarwani and remove the word, buffered from Class 2 bike lanes, but otherwise, I'd like to make a substitute motion to…

2179
05:43:17.970 --> 05:43:22.039
Boardroom: For my supplemental. And thank you very much for the time.

2180
05:43:22.670 --> 05:43:23.420
Brent Blackaby: Second.

2181
05:43:24.650 --> 05:43:38.700
Boardroom: Okay. Moving on to Councilmember Humbert. Before I speak, I think we should move to extend for maybe an additional 15 minutes. We're 14 minutes from the end of the meeting, so I move to extend.

2182
05:43:40.410 --> 05:43:49.149
Boardroom: Maybe, maybe a half an hour. Sorry, I think you should give it a half an hour just to be safe, because then we won't have to do this again. Move to extend a half an hour. Second.

2183
05:43:50.410 --> 05:43:57.460
Boardroom: Okay, to… Extend to 1AM, Councilmember Cassarwani? Yes. Taplin? Yes.

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2184
05:43:57.700 --> 05:44:02.360
Boardroom: Bartlett? Yes. Tregeb? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

2185
05:44:03.410 --> 05:44:04.030
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

2186
05:44:04.460 --> 05:44:08.390
Boardroom: Munapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii?

2187
05:44:08.860 --> 05:44:15.190
Boardroom: Only because I want us to vote tonight, yes. Okay. Motion carries.

2188
05:44:16.290 --> 05:44:17.420
Boardroom: Okay.

2189
05:44:18.120 --> 05:44:19.420
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor.

2190
05:44:19.700 --> 05:44:36.360
Boardroom: I want to thank Councilmember Kasarwani, I want to thank the Mayor and all their staff for their work on this item. I also want to thank Interim Director Amiri and his staff in the Public Works Department, and the former Public Works staff who contributed to earlier iterations.

2191
05:44:36.360 --> 05:44:54.800
Boardroom: of this project, as well as the City Manager's Office, and finally all the people who wrote to Council and who came to speak here tonight. In some ways, it's honestly a little crazy that this is the amount and intensity of discussion that we need in order to install a protected bike lane. But at the same time, it makes sense.

2192
05:44:54.800 --> 05:45:07.070
Boardroom: Because this is about more than just a bike lane on one street. It's about what kind of a city we want to be, and what we're willing to do to live up to our professed priorities and principles set forth in all of our plans.

2193
05:45:07.070 --> 05:45:28.350

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Boardroom: Through our bicycle plan, our Climate Action Plan, our Vision Zero plan, our declaration of a climate emergency, and most importantly, through citywide elections, Berkeleyans have shown what kind of a city we want to be. Berkeleyans want to join the ranks of world-class cities, like Copenhagen and Paris, in taking real action to make walking and biking safer.

2194
05:45:28.410 --> 05:45:35.480
Boardroom: Not just for the health of their communities, but frankly, for the health of the climate. And these things are incredibly urgent.

2195
05:45:35.500 --> 05:45:58.690
Boardroom: Devastating wildfires have spread across Canada, the Pacific Northwest, Colorado and New Mexico, Spain, and even France. We have to recognize that in a warming world, the quality of life impacts from a bike lane will feel like nothing compared to the heat, smoke, and severe storms we will increasingly face. And if we are to fight back against the people who say that climate change is a hoax.

2196
05:45:58.690 --> 05:46:16.120
Boardroom: We here in Berkeley cannot act like climate change is a hoax by refusing to take action in our community and in our lives. We must avoid making Berkeley a city that believes in climate action, except if it would mean parking our second car further away from our house.

2197
05:46:16.380 --> 05:46:32.309
Boardroom: That said, I get it. I feel that same twinge of annoyance, yeah, maybe more than a twinge, when the parking spot in front of my house is taken, or I have to park a block away from my destination. Less concerned about that. It's usually the parking spot in front of my house.

2198
05:46:32.310 --> 05:46:39.699
Boardroom: But you know who almost always has to walk or roll one or more blocks on either end of their trips? People who take the bus.

2199
05:46:39.860 --> 05:46:55.089
Boardroom: Those of us who primarily use cars need to recognize the privilege of our position, and have some perspective on the level of inconvenience that we face when there isn't a parking spot exactly where we want it. I absolutely agree that we need to be cognizant

2200
05:46:55.150 --> 05:47:06.320
Boardroom: completely of disabled access, and make sure that we're placing ADA parking spaces nearby. But at the same time, I want to recognize that disabled people are actually less likely to drive than

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2201
05:47:06.320 --> 05:47:15.700
Boardroom: those who are not. Prioritizing bikes, micro-mobility devices, and transit is the pro-disabled mobility approach.

2202
05:47:15.760 --> 05:47:26.969
Boardroom: And this is a good segue into the other reason we need protected bike lanes. Public safety. Study after study have shown that protected bike lanes improve safety for not just cyclists.

2203
05:47:26.970 --> 05:47:36.460
Boardroom: But also pedestrians, and even drivers themselves, because they push drivers to slow down, pay attention, and be more conscientious of their surroundings.

2204
05:47:36.460 --> 05:47:47.440
Boardroom: The current toll of injury and death on Berkeley streets is far too high. No parking spot on Hopkins is worth a human life. And, you know, that's not hyperbole.

2205
05:47:47.460 --> 05:48:11.199
Boardroom: Finally, I want to turn to the concerns of merchants, for which I do have great sympathy. For someone driving, walking a block is a minor inconvenience, but for a small business, a decrease in foot traffic can spell doom. But I think it's worth thinking about that term, foot traffic. There's a reason we use it, because everyone who visits a business does so by walking, or using a personal mobility device at some point in the process.

2206
05:48:11.200 --> 05:48:15.450
Boardroom: Improving street safety means improved safety for all customers.

2207
05:48:15.450 --> 05:48:38.680
Boardroom: And just as importantly, the data are, frankly, conclusive. Putting in bike lanes, even at the expense of parking, does not hurt business districts. In fact, many business districts see their business increase after the installation of safe bicycle and pedestrian infrastructure. And we see this in neighboring cities, like Oakland, where Temiscal is more vibrant and busy than ever.

2208
05:48:38.770 --> 05:49:01.400
Boardroom: And parenthetically, pedestrian and cyclist safety has vastly improved in the Temiscal since the installation of those bike lanes. In

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summary, I believe that safe bike infrastructure is the right thing to do in Hopkins for our climate, for our kids, for safety, and even, frankly, for small businesses. I want to thank, again, everyone who worked on this.

2209
05:49:01.410 --> 05:49:18.450
Boardroom: but especially Councilmember Kessarwani and her staff, and the Mayor and her staff, all of whom have listened to all the perspectives and put an incredible amount of care and effort into this proposal. I, of course, will be voting in support of Councilmember Kasarwani's item. Thank you. Thank you.

2210
05:49:19.310 --> 05:49:20.890
Boardroom: Councilmember Traja.

2211
05:49:22.180 --> 05:49:35.630
Boardroom: Thank you. First of all, I want to say, that everyone who contacted me provided very valuable and thoughtful input, regardless of where they are on on this issue.

2212
05:49:35.760 --> 05:49:47.519
Boardroom: I have read every single email. My office has met with 3 different groups of neighbors. I've done my best to respond to all emails received from direct constituents.

2213
05:49:47.730 --> 05:50:01.510
Boardroom: I biked different sections 3 years ago. The last time this was an issue, before I was on the council, I spent time, in the Hopkins corridor today just to take a look at it.

2214
05:50:01.590 --> 05:50:20.109
Boardroom: And like, in Councilmember Castrovani's district, comments in mine have been split generally down the middle. We received a great deal of feedback from avid bicyclists who completely opposed protected bike lanes separated by concrete barriers.

2215
05:50:20.110 --> 05:50:28.159
Boardroom: and said that they felt less safe with that design. As well as from those who said they feel safe biking on city streets.

2216
05:50:28.200 --> 05:50:31.379
Boardroom: Only when protected bike lanes are in place.

2217

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05:50:31.560 --> 05:50:34.859
Boardroom: I myself started biking as a child in Europe.

2218
05:50:34.860 --> 05:50:57.669
Boardroom: Where my parents felt comfortable letting me ride to school because there were protected bike lanes. Since then, I've associated protected bike lanes with bicycling safety. Of course, as someone mentioned, they have to be unobstructed by trash cans, delivery vehicles, and other objects. My office constantly works on that issue to try to address it on Milvia.

2219
05:50:57.680 --> 05:51:12.379
Boardroom: We've heard from community members who support this proposal because they believe it restarts a project that has been under discussion for years, improves safety for bicyclists and pedestrians, and preserves more parking than earlier concepts.

2220
05:51:12.470 --> 05:51:29.419
Boardroom: The supporters have also pointed to the proposal's inclusion of additional AGA parking and loading zones as an effort to improve accessibility while accommodating multiple modes of travel. Many also shared that Hopkins is a key gap in Berkeley's bicycle network.

2221
05:51:29.420 --> 05:51:37.960
Boardroom: An important connector between the Alani Greenway and the Milvia Bicycle Corridor, and a critical route to schools, businesses, and other key destinations.

2222
05:51:38.220 --> 05:51:44.710
Boardroom: Some expressed that they currently avoid bicycling on Hopkins because they find it intimidating.

2223
05:51:45.000 --> 05:51:59.149
Boardroom: Frankly, as do I, and I try to minimize the distance I travel on a bike on that street as much as possible. And I believe that completing this connection is an important step towards reducing dependence on cars.

2224
05:51:59.530 --> 05:52:03.910
Boardroom: I understand that this debate is not only about bicycling.

2225
05:52:03.910 --> 05:52:20.079
Boardroom: It is about the safety of everyone who uses our streets, our public comments. It's about accessibility of our residents, including

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seniors and people with disabilities. It's also about ensuring that our beloved local businesses have access and infrastructure they need.

2226
05:52:20.080 --> 05:52:21.360
Boardroom: to succeed.

2227
05:52:21.360 --> 05:52:38.510
Boardroom: We've heard from many residents and business owners who remain concerned that the proposal would still remove too much parking, could negatively affect Monterey Market and other nearby businesses, does not adequately address accessibility concerns, and does not reflect what many neighborhood residents want.

2228
05:52:38.510 --> 05:52:42.779
Boardroom: Others suggested that staff should also study alternative routes.

2229
05:52:42.930 --> 05:52:45.889
Boardroom: Rather than focusing exclusively on Hopkins.

2230
05:52:46.230 --> 05:53:04.970
Boardroom: And some have also questioned whether Hopkins has been studied sufficiently, expressed concerns that cycle tracks do not address the intersection safety issues where many collisions occur, worried that traffic could be diverted onto neighboring residential streets, and urged the city to allow staff to evaluate all feasible options for improving

2231
05:53:04.970 --> 05:53:11.579
Boardroom: bicycle access to the Hopkins area, rather than presupposing that Hopkins itself Is the best location.

2232
05:53:11.620 --> 05:53:17.240
Boardroom: This is not an easy issue. It's clearly extraordinarily divisive.

2233
05:53:17.320 --> 05:53:23.759
Boardroom: We have received many comments expressing very strong opinions on all sides.

2234
05:53:24.470 --> 05:53:34.370
Boardroom: Personally, I would like to provide our staff, especially our fire department and transportation division, with the greatest possible flexibility and trust.

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2235
05:53:34.370 --> 05:53:59.359
Boardroom: They're professionals and specialists in their fields, and I would like them to present us with a plan that truly works. One that includes official outreach to all members of the community and gathers feedback from nearby residents and those who use the corridor. I also want to make sure that the commissions on disability and aging and Individuals and Organizations representing, our senior residents, have an opportunity

2236
05:53:59.360 --> 05:54:21.179
Boardroom: to weigh in before anything beyond the reform to study options is adopted. Overall, I appreciate that Councilmember Blackhabby's proposal provides flexibility and includes multiple options, but I would love to see it move a little closer to the main motion in some respects, particularly around minimizing or eliminating the use of shuttles, which I agree, do not make cyclists safe.

2237
05:54:21.210 --> 05:54:33.519
Boardroom: It also explicitly calls for coordinating with AC Transit, which I think is essential, given that Hopkins is a bus route. I need 30 more seconds. Is someone gonna give you 30 seconds?

2238
05:54:34.990 --> 05:54:37.030
Boardroom: Did I have 30 left?

2239
05:54:37.030 --> 05:54:55.279
Boardroom: I can get in 30 seconds. Alright, Councilmember, we'll give you 30 seconds. Thank you. I believe coordinating with AC Transit is essential, given Hopkins is also a bus route, and several bus stop reconfigurations are proposed. I would also like to see if we can consult with East Bay Paratransit.

2240
05:54:55.630 --> 05:55:07.410
Boardroom: I am concerned that if we were to constrain our staff's options at the outset, we may be putting ourselves in a corner, both financially and in terms of the range of solutions available to us.

2241
05:55:07.410 --> 05:55:30.720
Boardroom: I would much rather allow our professional staff to evaluate the corridor comprehensively, incorporate the perspectives of all affected stakeholders, and return to us with recommendations that are informed by data, technical expertise, and broad community engagement within a reasonable but expeditious timeframe. With that said, I want to reiterate that I want to move

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2242
05:55:30.720 --> 05:55:37.439
Boardroom: forward tonight, so that we can have our staff assess options and come back to us with their recommendations. Thank you.

2243
05:55:38.590 --> 05:55:42.029
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Bartlett.

2244
05:55:42.030 --> 05:55:59.270
Boardroom: And then Councilmember Blackaby, and then back to Councilmember Taplin. Thank you, Madam Mayor, and I'll be brief. And I want to thank everyone for all the work you've done, all my colleagues, all the different versions, supplementals, the staff, for the years of effort into this, and the community members advocating for positions.

2245
05:55:59.270 --> 05:56:22.659
Boardroom: whatever side they are, I respect them all. And while this isn't usually my issue portfolio, you know, I'm not… this is more you guys' thing. But, you know, but people care about it, I care about it, right? And so, the two things that trigger my attention on this matter, which made me join Councillor Blackaby's item, is that, you know.

2246
05:56:22.740 --> 05:56:29.019
Boardroom: By and large, I try to… I try to move for consensus when I… when I deliver things, and when I…

2247
05:56:29.020 --> 05:56:42.799
Boardroom: We ask the community to submit to expense or sacrifice. I think it's healthy and sustainable to achieve consensus, and in this one, there's not consensus. There's not even close. This is… this feels like a wedge

2248
05:56:42.800 --> 05:57:03.090
Boardroom: Coming driven, and I think that's not sustainable, and it might get overturned in the future. Learn that lesson. And also, I don't think this is the vineyard to litigate the details of the plan. These are really interesting notes I've heard about the different modes and the different elements. Really interesting. However, this is… I'm not an expert, and I'd like to see this

2249
05:57:03.090 --> 05:57:08.939
Boardroom: discussed in a room full of experts, right? That's our commissions, that's our staff, etc.

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2250
05:57:08.940 --> 05:57:24.349
Boardroom: And then, and then more importantly, I think, from my personal point of view, is that… and I have two streets, Ward Street and Stewart Street. If they're online, I guess I can't see. If you're listening, just send me a mental note. You know, these two streets I've funded. I got them funded twice.

2251
05:57:24.690 --> 05:57:27.699
Boardroom: The years, and they've both been removed from the paving plan.

2252
05:57:28.240 --> 05:57:30.700
Boardroom: The streets look like the Flintstones.

2253
05:57:31.340 --> 05:57:32.660
Boardroom: It's gravel.

2254
05:57:33.740 --> 05:57:40.150
Boardroom: And damaging people's cars. You can't ride a bike on those streets. You will wipe out. And, you know, it's just…

2255
05:57:40.270 --> 05:57:43.299
Boardroom: The cost to repair those streets is so minimal.

2256
05:57:44.190 --> 05:57:51.210
Boardroom: That it's difficult for me to really accept this incredibly expensive Perfect.

2257
05:57:51.840 --> 05:57:58.690
Boardroom: proposal… Without at least studying a cheap alternative. There may be a cheap alternative.

2258
05:57:59.430 --> 05:58:18.879
Boardroom: We haven't even looked at it. So, I mean, that's my driving point. I can't accept my neighbors riding on gravel when we could look at a cheaper alternative to achieve the same amount of safety. And I do not want to downplay the safety. It's super important for me that people are safe on our streets. And of course, the businesses must thrive.

2259
05:58:18.880 --> 05:58:35.609
Boardroom: And there is a way to do it all. I know there is. If we put some evidence at work and really discover it, we can find something that works for everyone, and achieve consensus, and also save some money, so

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that all of us have our streets like mine, like HARP, like, Ward and Stewart, that deserve to be paved as well.

2260
05:58:35.900 --> 05:58:36.950
Boardroom: Thank you.

2261
05:58:37.720 --> 05:58:40.199
Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Blackaby?

2262
05:58:40.780 --> 05:58:59.409
Brent Blackaby: Thanks, Madam Mayor. I made most of my comments during my supplemental introduction, so I'll be briefer. I do want to pick up on what Councilmember Bartlett said, which is, you know, I do share the concern that we're not reaching consensus here, and that does not bode well for other items later this fall and next year, and that's too bad.

2263
05:58:59.410 --> 05:59:07.110
Brent Blackaby: I was hoping we could get there, and I'm disappointed that we couldn't. That said, I do appreciate, the hard work that everyone has put into this.

2264
05:59:07.110 --> 05:59:25.120
Brent Blackaby: Emotions have run pretty high, and as Councilmember Humbert said, in some ways, it's just a cycle track, but yes, it's a cycle track, and emotions have run pretty high, but generally it's been a very civil discussion, so I want to appreciate everyone who's participated in that. I also appreciate the advocacy from all groups on all sides of these issues.

2265
05:59:25.150 --> 05:59:33.290
Brent Blackaby: I will say something I've learned in the first two years, I guess, I've been on council, that, you know, we often are faced with tough decisions, and

2266
05:59:33.340 --> 05:59:44.779
Brent Blackaby: I think I disappoint someone or some group with just about every vote, and that's something that I live with, but I find my mantra is to try and find the decision that makes the most

2267
05:59:44.780 --> 05:59:53.720
Brent Blackaby: sense for the most amount of people, and it's going to deliver the most good for the most amount of people, and that's really what I endeavor to do through my time on council, and solve problems in a pragmatic and level-headed way.

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2268
05:59:53.750 --> 05:59:56.669
Brent Blackaby: I still believe,

2269
05:59:56.700 --> 06:00:11.829
Brent Blackaby: that we share the same concerns about safety as well as neighborhood vitality. It's really just a question of how we get there. I think that we should be looking at other things to deliver safety in this corridor. I think there are other options that we haven't fully explored.

2270
06:00:11.830 --> 06:00:28.020
Brent Blackaby: So, that said, I strongly support Councilmember O'Keefe's item. I will vote, for her item, as a substitute. If the substitute does not pass, I do intend to offer another substitute, so, before we, before we proceed.

2271
06:00:28.020 --> 06:00:36.939
Brent Blackaby: Two other points, I do want to comment, as the Representative District 6, there have been some kind of comments about folks who live in the hills and drive, and sort of

2272
06:00:37.210 --> 06:00:45.819
Brent Blackaby: why we do what we do, and I wouldn't be a good representative if I didn't, sort of defend the fact that we care an awful lot about climate change.

2273
06:00:45.850 --> 06:00:57.580
Brent Blackaby: where we live. We care so much about climate change that we are putting ourselves through extraordinary efforts, to prepare ourselves for wildfire in a way that no other community in the state has.

2274
06:00:57.630 --> 06:01:14.220
Brent Blackaby: And we've asked people to do a lot up there, and people are responding, and I'm gratified by that. So I just… I want people to know that just because we drive cars and drive down the hill to go to Hopkins doesn't mean we don't care about climate change, because we do. And I want folks to know that.

2275
06:01:14.460 --> 06:01:25.450
Brent Blackaby: And then last, about the parking spots, you know, I know people say it's just about, you know, it's just about parking, what's the deal about parking? Just a reminder what 145 parking spots means.

2276

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06:01:25.530 --> 06:01:44.490
Brent Blackaby: And I'm just doing back-of-the-envelope math, I don't have… these aren't hard and fast numbers. But in 145 parking spots, if you've got 2 people in a car, is, you know, 300 people at a time. If those parking spots turn over 5 times a day, that's 1,500 people a day. Over the course of the week, that's 10,000 people over the course of the week that go in and out of Hopkins.

2277
06:01:44.610 --> 06:02:03.560
Brent Blackaby: So 145 parking spots isn't just 145 parking spots, it's 10,000 people who come in and out of Hopkins using a car. And yes, maybe it's going to be a little more inconvenient to walk a block, but some of those people, many of them, are just not going to come there as often. And I just want people to be realistic about the trade-offs, because these are the trade-offs.

2278
06:02:03.710 --> 06:02:05.629
Brent Blackaby: It's not just about parking spots.

2279
06:02:05.810 --> 06:02:21.919
Brent Blackaby: It's about who's gonna use this neighborhood. I've seen the same studies about overall economic output, and the fact that I think, you know, you know, I think those businesses probably can do okay. I think most of the studies say neutral to slightly positive. I don't dispute that.

2280
06:02:22.060 --> 06:02:34.549
Brent Blackaby: It's just a question about these 10,000 people that are currently using Hopkins in and out every day. Many of them are my constituents, or Councilmember O'Keefe's constituents, are gonna have to figure out other things to do, and that's a shift.

2281
06:02:34.850 --> 06:02:47.429
Brent Blackaby: And that's something that we should just be honest about. So, anyway, that's where I am. I will support Councilmember O'Keefe's supplemental, but I would intend to offer something else, in the event that it does not succeed. Thank you.

2282
06:02:47.780 --> 06:02:51.940
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Taplin. Thank you.

2283
06:02:52.120 --> 06:03:08.449
Boardroom: I'll just state very briefly, the city does have a bike plan, so I hear what people are saying when they say that they want stakeholder engagement, and they want to look at alternatives. I do think that work

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does take place, and that's how we got to the bike plan that we have today, which does include Hopkins.

2284
06:03:09.280 --> 06:03:10.490
Boardroom: And…

2285
06:03:15.390 --> 06:03:21.189
Boardroom: When we adopt plans, we do have to assume that someday we will implement these plans.

2286
06:03:21.290 --> 06:03:31.540
Boardroom: That will perhaps never have unanimous consensus in the community, or even amongst the nine of us, but… I've…

2287
06:03:31.730 --> 06:03:40.749
Boardroom: believe in the city's goals and the plans we adopt, and I believe in our policies, and that's why I'll be voting for the main motion. Thank you.

2288
06:03:42.680 --> 06:03:49.000
Boardroom: Okay. I have some comments, and then we will take a vote.

2289
06:03:49.660 --> 06:04:03.210
Boardroom: Sorry. So first, I just want to thank you all so much for staying until this very late hour, those of you here in person and those of you online. I know that this is an issue that people really care about, and…

2290
06:04:03.420 --> 06:04:14.699
Boardroom: You know, I, I, quite frankly, I wish this energy was placed behind some of the other issues that are in our community that, are… are really very serious that we've been addressing recently.

2291
06:04:15.150 --> 06:04:32.100
Boardroom: I want to thank everyone who has also written in. My staff, thank you very much to Nella, who has read over a thousand emails in the last week on this issue. Thank you so much to everyone who sent me a postcard. I've been sitting here looking at them. I've got lots of

2292
06:04:33.210 --> 06:04:38.530
Boardroom: Pictures and letters from young people in our community.

2293

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06:04:38.650 --> 06:04:42.909
Boardroom: And, I really want to reiterate that the discussion tonight

2294
06:04:42.910 --> 06:05:07.900
Boardroom: We'll provide Council direction to staff so that they can do all of the analysis that people are asking for. I know a lot of folks are saying, hey, why haven't you figured this out yet? Why can't people answer these questions? And that's because that's where we're at in the process. We need to give them direction, policy direction, before they can do a lot of these studies that people are talking about, and analysis. So, I want people to understand that. It's not that we haven't thought about this, it's just that

2295
06:05:07.900 --> 06:05:09.919
Boardroom: This is where we're at in the process.

2296
06:05:09.920 --> 06:05:32.100
Boardroom: And I know that Hopkins Street has been a source of controversy for a decade or so. I've heard people's concerns about safety, support for local businesses and parking, and I am deeply invested in ensuring that our streets are safe for all users, pedestrians, cyclists, and drivers, and that is why I support bike lanes on Hopkins Street.

2297
06:05:32.120 --> 06:05:55.800
Boardroom: I really want to acknowledge that folks have different ideas of what safety means, and I'm making my decision today based off of the studies that have been referenced today about safety, as well as my own personal experiences. Something that I talked about a lot on the campaign was the importance of street safety, because I'm someone who was on a bicycle, who was hit by a car on Milvia Street before there was protected bike lanes.

2298
06:05:55.800 --> 06:06:20.569
Boardroom: And I think folks sometimes forget that. But believe me, it's very painful to get hit by a car, on a bicycle or as a pedestrian. And certainly, I don't want to disregard anyone's concerns about getting hit by a bicycle. I'm sure that that's also very painful. But my dad used to say, between a bike and a car, or a person and a car, like, who's gonna win? And so, you just keep that in mind as we're talking about safety here.

2299
06:06:22.080 --> 06:06:36.929
Boardroom: Cyclist infrastructure improves safety for everyone, and the reason why we're doing this, just to kind of take a step back, as someone was saying, I like to do, the reason why we're doing this in the first

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place is because Hopkins is a high injury corridor for pedestrians and cyclists.

2300
06:06:36.930 --> 06:06:49.950
Boardroom: And those numbers that we've talked about earlier, with 46 pedestrian bicycle crashes occurring and 3 fatalities, is the reason why we're talking about Hopkins Street. And it's not the… it's why we're not talking about the other places. Excuse me!

2301
06:06:50.910 --> 06:07:14.110
Boardroom: There are many studies that show how bike lanes and infrastructure can produce also tangible economic benefits. I know this has been mentioned multiple times, I don't want to go into it too much more. I understand that the loss of parking is a concern, because not everyone can ride a bike or walk to the places they want to go, and adding parking management in the commercial areas will encourage turnover, and, we are retaining some parking

2302
06:07:14.260 --> 06:07:38.809
Boardroom: along parts of the corridor. I just don't want folks to think that we're eliminating all parking. I also wanted to briefly share that I've spoken with wheelchair users who use bike lanes to get around the city, because they actually feel like that feels safer than riding on the sidewalk. And I've also seen these really awesome tricycles, with folks that are older cyclers, and that feels safe to them, that they can ride on a tricycle, and sometimes an e-tricycle.

2303
06:07:38.840 --> 06:07:57.429
Boardroom: Very exciting that we have all these other options now. Regarding the concerns about accessibility, we will ensure that it's incorporated into the design plans with things like ramps, curb cuts, and loading zones. I mentioned a few other ways that we are also thinking about accessibility, and I just want to be clear that, like.

2304
06:07:57.430 --> 06:08:20.330
Boardroom: We have not done a perfect job in bike lanes and bus islands. I understand that those have not always been successful, and definitely, as we bring in our new Director of Public Works, I know that this is something that he will consider, and we on Council will make sure that these areas are accessible for people. That is absolutely important to me. As someone who is disabled, it's absolutely something that I keep in mind.

2305
06:08:20.510 --> 06:08:34.319
Boardroom: We need to also balance, we've talked about being fiscally responsible and safe, and by incorporating bike lanes now, we're saving

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money compared to adding them later. It will be a lot more expensive to add bike lanes in later.

2306
06:08:34.320 --> 06:08:43.450
Boardroom: They're only adding around $3 million to the project, compared to green… requirements like green infrastructure, which I also support, which costs $6 million, and that's a requirement.

2307
06:08:43.450 --> 06:08:57.430
Boardroom: Right now, Hopkins Street is unsafe for cyclists, pedestrians, and drivers alike. We need to move forward with this referral to repave Hopkins and implement bike and pedestrian safety improvements to help us reach our climate goals and keep everyone safe.

2308
06:08:57.500 --> 06:09:02.020
Boardroom: Thank you very much. Alright, so we have the sub…

2309
06:09:02.290 --> 06:09:15.840
Boardroom: Excuse me. You… you are being very rude, no booing. You can… you can be disappointed. You can be disappointed, but you can do it quietly or outside. Thank you.

2310
06:09:15.840 --> 06:09:28.870
Boardroom: Alright, so we have a motion that's on the floor. Alright, excuse me! Excuse me, excuse me, you need to either step outside or… or please be quiet.

2311
06:09:29.020 --> 06:09:48.700
Boardroom: Okay. So, we are… we have two motions on the floor, and, if you could, Mr. City Clerk, just run us through where we're at. Yeah, so the first… the main motion is Councilmember Kesarwani's motion. The substitute motion is from, Councilmember O'Keefe.

2312
06:09:48.950 --> 06:09:58.030
Boardroom: to, to adopt the, supplemental submitted by Councilmember O'Keefe with the reference to the language from trees, from Councilmember Kesarwani's.

2313
06:09:58.370 --> 06:10:09.730
Boardroom: Item, and to remove the word buffered from the edits that were made. So that's currently the pending motion, is the substitute motion from Councilmember O'Keefe, seconded by Blackaby.

2314

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06:10:10.960 --> 06:10:22.970
Boardroom: You ready for a vote? Yes, we're ready for a vote. On the substitute motion from Councilmember O'Keefe, Councilmember Kesarwani? No. Taplin? No. Bartlett? Yes. Traga? No.

2315
06:10:23.110 --> 06:10:25.860
Boardroom: O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby?

2316
06:10:25.860 --> 06:10:26.590
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

2317
06:10:27.260 --> 06:10:30.319
Boardroom: Lunapara? No. Humbert? No.

2318
06:10:30.500 --> 06:10:34.220
Boardroom: And Mayor Ishii? No. Okay, that motion fails.

2319
06:10:34.570 --> 06:10:36.990
Brent Blackaby: Madam Mayor, I'd like to offer another substitute.

2320
06:10:38.810 --> 06:10:39.500
Boardroom: Okay.

2321
06:10:39.900 --> 06:10:41.060
Boardroom: Good.

2322
06:10:42.070 --> 06:10:43.869
Brent Blackaby: Great, let me share my screen…

2323
06:10:49.000 --> 06:10:54.030
Brent Blackaby: So this is an adjusted substitute on my previous SUP.

2324
06:10:54.380 --> 06:10:57.249
Brent Blackaby: With a couple of amendments that I've marked.

2325
06:10:57.750 --> 06:11:09.160
Brent Blackaby: One amendment is that I'm asking that as part of the staff analysis, that they do a parking impact analysis, including potential impact for lost parking on local businesses.

2326

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06:11:09.330 --> 06:11:21.459
Brent Blackaby: I've also got confirmation, again, just a reminder that Mr. Meary confirmed that Hopkins is going to be paved in the FY2028 cycle, and that he could do the study in 6 months or less.

2327
06:11:21.750 --> 06:11:26.250
Brent Blackaby: So, my direction is that we basically take the 6 months.

2328
06:11:26.500 --> 06:11:33.990
Brent Blackaby: do the extra work, and confirm that paving will commence on Hopkins as planned in fiscal 2028, no delay.

2329
06:11:34.310 --> 06:11:42.450
Brent Blackaby: So what I'm basically saying is there's a way of doing the analysis and developing an alternative approach that we couldn't put against the cycle track plan.

2330
06:11:42.630 --> 06:11:57.930
Brent Blackaby: do them both, and we don't delay Hopkins one bit. There's nothing that we do here that will move that back. So, counter to some criticisms that we're adding a bunch of time, we're putting it in the existing time. We're just taking the time to look at one other option for consideration.

2331
06:11:58.050 --> 06:12:07.399
Brent Blackaby: And lastly is in response to other people's concerns, which I agree are very valid, we've basically said we want to make sure that sharers are not

2332
06:12:07.420 --> 06:12:21.050
Brent Blackaby: the default, they're actually the very last resort, if used at all. And the way we get there is we say, we're willing to accept and look at Class 2 or Class 4 bike lanes, and bump up the acceptable parking lots to 20%.

2333
06:12:21.310 --> 06:12:37.989
Brent Blackaby: So more parking lots is acceptable. Sharrows are at last resort. We really want to do Class 2, Class 4 bicycle boulevards as sort of the preferred options, in whatever plan that we ask staff to do. And so, my motion is to offer my item as a substitute

2334
06:12:38.040 --> 06:12:42.000
Brent Blackaby: To the Kessler Wining item with these additional amendments.

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2335
06:12:43.210 --> 06:12:44.369
Brent Blackaby: That's my motion.

2336
06:12:45.830 --> 06:12:46.860
Boardroom: Second.

2337
06:12:47.090 --> 06:12:48.000
Boardroom: Yep.

2338
06:12:50.160 --> 06:13:00.169
Boardroom: Okay, can we take a vote? Oh, can I just confirm something? Does your question also take the amended street trees language out of Council?

2339
06:13:00.170 --> 06:13:00.720
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

2340
06:13:00.720 --> 06:13:01.190
Boardroom: Come on, easy.

2341
06:13:01.190 --> 06:13:04.510
Brent Blackaby: also takes the minute of street trees language. Yes, thank you. Thank you, Councilmember Traeger.

2342
06:13:06.940 --> 06:13:22.150
Boardroom: Okay. On the substitute motion, from Councilmember Blackbee, Councilmember Kastarwani? No. Kaplan? No. Bartlett? Yes. Drago? Aye.

2343
06:13:22.820 --> 06:13:24.439
Boardroom: O'Keefe? Yes.

2344
06:13:24.650 --> 06:13:26.000
Boardroom: Blackaby?

2345
06:13:26.000 --> 06:13:26.830
Brent Blackaby: Yes.

2346
06:13:27.110 --> 06:13:28.550
Boardroom: Lunapara? No.

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2347
06:13:28.680 --> 06:13:30.269
Boardroom: Humbert? No.

2348
06:13:30.450 --> 06:13:34.610
Boardroom: Mayor Ishii? No. Okay, that motion fails.

2349
06:13:35.700 --> 06:13:51.650
Boardroom: Can we vote on the main motion, please? On the main motion… May I… oh, go ahead, summary. I'd like to speak before we do that, if possible. Do you want to summarize it? Well, the main motion is the motion from Councilmember Kastarwani to,

2350
06:13:51.650 --> 06:13:59.079
Boardroom: Adopt, her item as submitted with the amendments that were introduced, at the meeting.

2351
06:14:00.600 --> 06:14:14.549
Boardroom: Councilmember? Yeah, may I offer an amendment? A friendly amendment? A friendly amendment? Yeah, I'd like to request that you amend the motion to, change the end of the Class 2 bike lane from the Alabita to McGee.

2352
06:14:14.550 --> 06:14:25.639
Boardroom: So, extending the painted bike lane just along the park, so we'd be able to preserve the parking along the park. So, my understanding is we will be able to preserve

2353
06:14:25.810 --> 06:14:35.309
Boardroom: parking on one side from McGee to the Alameda. Yes. And so, with that proposal, essentially, you're asking for parking on both sides.

2354
06:14:35.450 --> 06:14:50.460
Boardroom: with a Class 2 green-painted 5 feet bike lane, and because of the width of the street, as you amended your item, there would be no buffer. I appreciate why you're asking, I understand the concerns.

2355
06:14:50.490 --> 06:15:04.939
Boardroom: That we heard tonight, but given that there would be no buffer and no protection there, unfortunately, I can't accept it. But I, I, I respectfully thank you for asking. Okay. Thank you.

2356

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06:15:05.460 --> 06:15:13.690
Boardroom: Okay, so on the main motion, from Councilmember Kesarwani, Councilmember Kesarwani? Yes.

2357
06:15:13.920 --> 06:15:15.360
Boardroom: Taplin? Yes.

2358
06:15:15.530 --> 06:15:17.140
Boardroom: Bartlett? Yes.

2359
06:15:17.470 --> 06:15:18.949
Boardroom: Trey Gaub? Aye.

2360
06:15:19.090 --> 06:15:22.289
Boardroom: O'Keefe? No. Blackabee?

2361
06:15:22.550 --> 06:15:23.230
Brent Blackaby: No.

2362
06:15:23.520 --> 06:15:25.000
Boardroom: Unapara? Yes.

2363
06:15:25.200 --> 06:15:30.299
Boardroom: Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay, that motion carries.

2364
06:15:31.120 --> 06:15:32.230
Boardroom: Thank you.

2365
06:15:35.740 --> 06:15:43.689
Boardroom: So, item 28 was moved to consent, and so we will… I will see if there's any public comment for items not listed on the agenda.

2366
06:15:48.170 --> 06:15:49.550
Boardroom: Anybody online?

2367
06:15:50.530 --> 06:15:56.900
Boardroom: Well… I think it's all the hands that were raised.

2368
06:15:57.460 --> 06:16:01.889
Boardroom: Okay. I'm gonna lower everybody's hands. Okay.

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2369
06:16:02.550 --> 06:16:06.169
Boardroom: If there's any public comment for items not on the agenda.

2370
06:16:07.900 --> 06:16:09.880
Boardroom: There can… you can raise your hand.

2371
06:16:11.730 --> 06:16:13.820
Boardroom: Makai Freeman.

2372
06:16:20.740 --> 06:16:22.460
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Didn't I?

2373
06:16:23.660 --> 06:16:35.039
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: We all see that… Ready for… You access, and… Exciting now, it's loaded.

2374
06:16:36.390 --> 06:16:47.740
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Yeah, I went up with… For seniors and those… Individuals who have… You are punishment.

2375
06:16:49.210 --> 06:16:50.950
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The Brooking Rights Program.

2376
06:16:52.470 --> 06:16:54.100
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: This is just married.

2377
06:16:55.610 --> 06:16:57.280
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And later to come.

2378
06:16:58.360 --> 06:17:00.190
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And discuss the stance.

2379
06:17:01.520 --> 06:17:03.250
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I would maintain.

2380
06:17:04.690 --> 06:17:06.659
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The independent dignity.

2381

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06:17:07.920 --> 06:17:09.729
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And accessority.

2382
06:17:11.240 --> 06:17:12.120
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Good night.

2383
06:17:13.000 --> 06:17:14.250
Boardroom: Thank you, Mackay.

2384
06:17:16.220 --> 06:17:17.540
Boardroom: Sarah Bell.

2385
06:17:20.160 --> 06:17:27.079
Sarah Bell (she/her): Hi! Sorry to speak on a non-agenda item, I know we're all tired. I'm tired.

2386
06:17:27.220 --> 06:17:38.550
Sarah Bell (she/her): I just want to say that I called into this meeting because I have a knee injury, and so it's, you know, just a lot more difficult for me to come in person, and

2387
06:17:38.850 --> 06:17:41.060
Sarah Bell (she/her): It doesn't feel great.

2388
06:17:41.260 --> 06:18:00.840
Sarah Bell (she/her): for some slack in, like, extra time given to… to give, speaking time to everybody who's trying to comment in person, but then to have a hard cutoff for those 10 people with hands raised on Zoom, or however many. Yeah, it doesn't feel great.

2389
06:18:00.880 --> 06:18:11.560
Sarah Bell (she/her): And so I would love, I would love a bit more equity in that process. I do want to praise the city for listing out all of the Zoom speakers who are on deck.

2390
06:18:11.690 --> 06:18:21.190
Sarah Bell (she/her): If you could do it even more consistently, that would be amazing, just so that, you know, we're not, like, you know, for an hour wondering when we're gonna come up. So, thank you for that piece.

2391
06:18:21.470 --> 06:18:24.490
Boardroom: Thanks for your feedback, Sarah, I'm sorry about that.

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2392
06:18:26.640 --> 06:18:29.960
Boardroom: Speaker with a phone number ending in 211.

2393
06:18:35.650 --> 06:18:39.200
1510****211: Hi, good evening. So now my last comment for the day.

2394
06:18:40.270 --> 06:18:43.070
1510****211: The Density Institute came with a figure.

2395
06:18:43.630 --> 06:18:48.880
1510****211: Last week, the actual deaths, Gaza, Over 600,000.

2396
06:18:49.270 --> 06:18:51.759
1510****211: The 70,000 years in the news is not correct.

2397
06:18:52.290 --> 06:18:55.500
1510****211: More than half are babies and children.

2398
06:18:55.880 --> 06:18:57.639
1510****211: We're all murdered by Israel.

2399
06:18:58.280 --> 06:19:03.499
1510****211: Palestinian, Johns Hopkins University made a DNA study on Israelis and Palestinians.

2400
06:19:03.830 --> 06:19:07.969
1510****211: Israelis came to 0-2%, all Hebrews.

2401
06:19:08.600 --> 06:19:09.760
1510****211: Palestinians…

2402
06:19:09.860 --> 06:19:20.519
1510****211: 78%. No way in hell could we kill people because of the religion, no more than killing him because of his color. Imagine it was black, or killing whites, or whites killing blacks.

2403
06:19:21.700 --> 06:19:26.019
1510****211: genocide, and they used the APGN file to blackmail

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2404
06:19:26.470 --> 06:19:31.350
1510****211: Trump to go in this awful Iran war, but she did nothing good to anybody.

2405
06:19:31.630 --> 06:19:33.610
1510****211: It destroyed the whole economy in the world.

2406
06:19:34.180 --> 06:19:36.099
1510****211: destroyed many functions in America.

2407
06:19:37.300 --> 06:19:39.570
Boardroom: Thank you. Next is Connie.

2408
06:19:44.510 --> 06:19:45.929
Connie: Can you hear me now?

2409
06:19:46.140 --> 06:19:46.840
Boardroom: Yes.

2410
06:19:47.640 --> 06:19:58.980
Connie: I am calling, just to bring to your attention a very large double standard,

2411
06:19:59.270 --> 06:20:03.870
Connie: All the lip service paid to public safety.

2412
06:20:03.970 --> 06:20:21.190
Connie: I just find absolutely ridiculous, because there is a cell antenna that is about to be built right in front of the North Berkeley Library on Josephine Street, about,

2413
06:20:21.420 --> 06:20:33.420
Connie: very, very close to Hopkins, and children… there are 3 preschools within a half a mile of there, and some are much closer.

2414
06:20:33.810 --> 06:20:49.180
Connie: I will not be able to use that library after that cell antenna goes in, because I have severe electromagnetic hypersensitivity. I know other people who will start… who cannot use that library after that goes in, and.

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2415
06:20:49.380 --> 06:20:52.860
Boardroom: Thank you, Courtney. Next is Seth.

2416
06:20:59.120 --> 06:21:09.290
Seth: Hello, thank you for being here this evening. Just want to make sure that we can address our homelessness crisis and our lack of child care crisis.

2417
06:21:09.390 --> 06:21:11.910
Seth: And our lack of public health crisis.

2418
06:21:11.920 --> 06:21:18.350
Seth: And our lack of access to food crisis, before we start wasting, tens

2419
06:21:18.350 --> 06:21:32.049
Seth: of millions of dollars on, ridiculous programs, involving, District 5, a district that most of you, representatives don't live in and don't represent.

2420
06:21:32.130 --> 06:21:37.459
Seth: So, hands off, Hopkins. Mind your own business if you don't live in District 5.

2421
06:21:37.460 --> 06:21:41.529
Boardroom: Okay, your comment has to be something that's off the agenda, so…

2422
06:21:47.070 --> 06:21:47.870
Boardroom: Okay.

2423
06:21:48.280 --> 06:21:50.850
Boardroom: Zoom user.

2424
06:22:01.810 --> 06:22:02.540
Zoom user: Nope.

2425
06:22:03.040 --> 06:22:03.840
Boardroom: Yes, go ahead.

2426

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06:22:03.840 --> 06:22:16.259
Zoom user: I thought you would say my name. I didn't see it on my screen, sorry. This item not on the agenda, and it happened a week and a half ago. I was walking down the street after talking to a friend in the park at Civic Center.

2427
06:22:16.820 --> 06:22:33.020
Zoom user: And as I walked by the YMCA, 5 foot tall young woman, fully unclothed, no shoes, no socks, no clothes, nothing whatsoever, and she was walking in a class clip, and I said to her quickly, you need clothes, dear, you need clothes.

2428
06:22:33.440 --> 06:22:42.180
Zoom user: she just kept walking, and I called 911. When I went back to the park, Civic Center Park, I saw that she had been stopped

2429
06:22:42.450 --> 06:22:44.399
Zoom user: They had 2 police cars.

2430
06:22:44.930 --> 06:23:03.519
Zoom user: 5 men, five officers, 5 male officers, 1 motorcycle, and two officers. The officers felt like they shouldn't be the ones to answer the call, and they had hoped that the, outreach team would be present. They called the outreach team, and they were told they were disbanded last night, the day before.

2431
06:23:03.520 --> 06:23:11.319
Zoom user: We are in desperate need of the outreach team. That was a successful program in the City of Berkeley for 49 years, so please look at us again.

2432
06:23:11.320 --> 06:23:15.710
Boardroom: I think that's Moni. Thanks, Moni. That's it.

2433
06:23:17.090 --> 06:23:23.359
Boardroom: Okay. Thank you very much, everyone. Is there a motion to adjourn? Second.

2434
06:23:23.550 --> 06:23:25.199
Boardroom: Can we take the roll on that, please?

2435
06:23:26.610 --> 06:23:28.650
Boardroom: Councilmember Kessarwani?

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2436
06:23:28.890 --> 06:23:36.479
Boardroom: Yes. Taplin? Yes. Bartlett? Yes. Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby? Yes.

2437
06:23:36.620 --> 06:23:44.669
Boardroom: Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Okay. We are adjourned. Thanks, everyone. Have a good night.

2438
06:23:45.520 --> 06:23:53.790
Boardroom: You gotta go back. I gotta go back. I gotta finish this, and then I gotta go back. You can buy things there. I know, right? Finish it up.

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